

FABLED LANDS 9

The Isle of a Thousand Spires

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- First Draft -

DISCLAIMER

This is a fan written work of fiction designed to fit into the *Fabled Lands* series by Dave Morries and Jamie Thompson. This is in no way designed for personal profit and is intended solely for distribution as a work of fan written fiction that can be enjoyed by the many supporters of the *Fabled Lands*.

I have written this book to relieve my own anxiety about the incomplete nature of this fantastic series, and I hope that my attempt will assist the ongoing project. This work is complete in terms of paragraphs, statistics and story. In its current state it is completely playable and links directly with the existing books. However as a warning, I must note that I really have no professional training or skill in creative writing, and as such I consider my descriptions quite poor. Definitely not in the league of the original writers! I welcome anyone who can write more eloquently than I (which I am sure there will be numerous people out there) to help me revise this work. You can add your name to the authors of course.

House Rules Primer

The Difficulty level of challenges and the power of opponents have been carefully calculated with both the beginning and experienced adventurers in mind. Even the strongest of adventurers will encounter difficult obstacles in this book to ensure that play remains fun as there is always an element of risk and failure. In terms of opponents, there are many instances where groups of villains are treated as a single opponent, rationalising the necessity for particularly high COMBAT scores in this region to challenge experienced adventurers. However, to ensure that play runs smoothly, I recommend that anyone playing through higher level adventures in the *Fabled Lands* (books 7 through 12) employ two house rules that I use.

House Rule 1 – Ability Scores and Items

As stated in the rules, no one Ability score may exceed 12. Furthermore, no item may exceed a +6 bonus *unless otherwise stated*. This means no +13 **white sword** from Molhern's smithy. Also note that the smithy only benefits weapons and armour, so a **centaur flute** and the like cannot be increased in this way (same goes for a **royal sceptre**). As for the **sword of ice** (etc.), these items are stated as increasing the character's Ability *score*, so if their Ability is already 12, the item cannot increase it further. If your ability score is less than 12, it will increase the score by 2, up to a maximum of 12, and is not counted as an item that grants a bonus when identifying only your one item with the highest Ability bonus. This is the fundamental difference between increasing an ability *score* by 2 and an item with a +2 Ability bonus)

For each ability there are *constant* bonuses and *temporary* bonuses. An item that benefits you all the time is considered a constant bonus (such as a **sword**, COMBAT +3) whilst an item or situation with transient benefits is considered a temporary bonus (such as a **potion of strength**). You can only have one of each at any one time, so in the same way that two swords with COMBAT bonuses are not cumulative, two potions with COMBAT bonuses are also not cumulative.

House Rule 2 – Defence Values for Heroic Characters

Three problems arise when there is no cap for defence bonuses from very high COMBAT scores and Rank. First, the COMBAT scores of opponents in higher level adventures (books 7 through 12) must rise to impossibly high values to compete with powerful characters, making adventuring for beginning characters a frustrating experience. Second, with such high COMBAT scores to compete with

phenomenal Defence values, the result of the roll of two attack dice becomes insignificant, and often two characters will be unable to damage each other regardless of the roll. Last, the importance of wearing armour is belittled, and its benefits to a powerful adventurer become trivial. In order to avoid these problems whilst maintaining a good level of fun and challenge for higher level characters, I employ the following house rule:

The maximum bonus to Defence from a character's COMBAT is 12. Whether it is a character with 9 COMBAT and a +5 **sword** or a character with 12 COMBAT a +8 **white sword** and a **potion of strength**, they will all receive 12 to their Defence. They will of course still benefit from a high COMBAT score when attacking and damaging opponents.

The maximum bonus to Defence from a character's Rank is also 12. Whether the character is 16th Rank or 11th Rank with a **ring of ultimate power**, the most they will both add to Defence is 12.

A 12th Rank character with 12 COMBAT will have a Defence of 24 without equipment, which is still a very high value. With this plateau, the importance of armour, blessings and equipment is maintained forcing later books to issue every opponent with 50 COMBAT. As a clarification, the **jade defender** grants its additional +3 Defence from the COMBAT bonus over the maximum 12 COMBAT rule. In essence, to a character with 12 COMBAT it grants a constant +6 Defence bonus.

Defence values are also affected by one *constant* bonus and one *temporary* bonus rule. Thus, a character can receive +9 Defence from **heavy plate** and a blessing of 'Defence through Faith'. However, a character cannot wear a **regal helm**, **vulcanium mail** and wield a **magic shield** and a **jade defender** for a +26 Defence bonus! Only the item with the highest constant bonus applies. The same goes for transient sources of Defence bonus. If you have a **ring of defence +4 (three uses)** and a blessing of 'Defence through Faith' you must choose which one to use as multiple temporary bonuses are not cumulative.

CODEWORDS: *The Island of a Thousand Spires* – Fabled Lands book 9

☐☐☐ **Iambus**
☐ **Ibis**
☐ **Igneous**
☐ **Ignoble**
☐ **Ilk**
☐ **Ill**
☐ **Illegitimate**
☐ **Illiad**
☐ **Illuminate**
☐ **Illustrate**
☐ **Imbibe**
☐ **Imbue**
☐ **Imp**
☐ **Impeccable**
☐ **Impede**
☐ **Implicate**
☐ **Implore**
☐ **Importance**
☐ **Impress**
☐ **Impromptu**
☐ **Impudence**
☐ **Inadequate**
☐ **Incomplete**

☐ **Increment**
☐ **Indecent**
☐ **Indefatigable**
☐ **Indefinite**
☐ **Indicate**
☐ **Indirect**
☐ **Indomitable**
☐ **Indra**
☐ **Indubitably**
☐ **Infidel**
☐ **Ingenious**
☐ **Ingrate**
☐ **Injure**
☐ **Ink**
☐ **Innocent**
☐ **Insane**
☐ **Insolent**
☐ **Interpol**
☐ **Intimidate**
☐ **Intricate**
☐ **Intrinsic**
☐ **Intuit**
☐ **Irredeemable**

1

The approach of dawn has turned the sky a milky-grey green, like jade. The sea is a luminous pane of silver. Holding the tiller of your sailing boat, you keep your gaze fixed on the glittering constellation known as the Spider, the sign under which you were born. It marks the north, and by keeping it to port you know you are still on course.

The sun appears in a trembling burst of red fire at the rim of the world. Slowly, the chill of night gives way to brazen warmth.

You lick your parched lips. There is a little water sloshing in the bottom of the barrel by your feet, but not enough to see you through another day.

Sealed in a scroll case tucked into your jerkin is the parchment map your grandfather gave you on his death-bed. You remember his stirring tales of far sea voyages, of kingdoms beyond the western horizon, of sorcerous islands and ruined palaces filled with treasure. As a child you dreamed of nothing else but the magical quests that were in store if you too became an adventurer.

You never expected to die in an open boat before your adventures even began.

Securing the tiller, you unroll the map and study it again. You hardly need to. Every detail is etched into your memory by now. According to your reckoning, you should have reached the coast of Chrysoprais days ago, but your hope is fading fast as you lie on the deck of your sailing boat waiting for rain. It never comes.

You pray for salvation.

A thick fog blankets your vision. Now you are sure the gods have forsaken you. You wait for hours, peering through the thick white fog hoping for any sign of land. There is a deafening crack and your ship lurches. As you turn around, you realize to your surprise that a galleon has collided with you! Your ship is sinking fast, and the crew drop you a ladder and haul you aboard. They wrap you in warm blankets and offer you hot soup. You are battered, bedraggled, but alive. Now your adventures can begin. Turn to **69**.

2

You must escape before the house guards arrive in full force. Roll three dice and add your Rank. Add 1 to this number if you are a Rogue or a Warrior:

19 or less You are overcome by the masses. Turn to **700** immediately.

20 – 25 Forced to escape out a window. Cross off any equipment left here

26+ You kill a few and manage to escape with your equipment

You inform the relevant authorities but the cult has vanished by the time they arrive. No evidence remains and the owner of the manor is released from all accusations. Gain the codeword *Illegitimate* and turn to **50**.

3

You try for several days to master the doctrine of the Sage of Peace, but the understanding seems out of your grasp and the whole experience proves too much for you. The abbot sees that you are not yet ready to achieve enlightenment, and tells you to come back when you have gained more wisdom.

You may not attempt to become an initiate of the Sage of Peace again until you have either increased your SANCTITY score by at least 1 point, or until you have gained a Rank. Note this on your adventure sheet and turn to **300**.

4

You are in the middle of the countryside. You can head for:

The Crimson Fort	turn to 244
Kurani	turn to 600
Vulture's Peak	turn to 300
The River Ajantur	turn to 659

5

The guards are not swayed by your words. 'Very suspicious if you ask me' says one as he nods to a third soldier emerging from the guardhouse. You consider running, until you notice the crossbowmen lined along the castellation, bolts levelled at your heart. The guards bundle you up and take you inside for interrogation. If you have any of the codewords *Jump*, *Ilk* or *Injure*, turn to **592**. Otherwise turn to **486**.

6

With a bit of skill and luck you manage to get control of the ship in time, your crew working hard to take advantage of the winds and steer clear of the Edge of the World. Feeling both amazed and humbled by the experience you plot a course back to the world of men. Turn to **411**.

7 □□□□□ □□□□□

Each time you assist Umbart in his research you may tick one of the boxes above and choose one reward from the list below. There are a mix of exotic and mundane items. If you take an option with an empty box, put a tick in it. That option is no longer available when you next select a reward:

Enchanted Scimitar (COMBAT +3)

Centaur Flute (CHARISMA +3)

Ebony Wand (MAGIC +2)

Cross-staff (SCOUTING +2)

Ring of Protection (Defence +5)

Banner of the Shadar and a Shadar Scroll □

Scarab Amulet □

Tatsu Pearl □

Verdigris Key □

Selenium Ore

800 Shards

Training in sorcery

Training in cartography

Remove a curse

If you select one of the training options, Umbart will grant you access to his maps and tomes and teach you a few tricks. Choose either MAGIC or SCOUTING and roll two dice. If the roll is higher than the current score, increase it by 1. If you request that he removes a curse, he can remove any curse you may be suffering, including a curse bestowed by a demon lord such as the Curse of Immolation.

Now, if all ten boxes above are ticked, turn to **532**. Otherwise, return to **304** and choose again.

8

Remember to cross off the fare for passage to Mithdrak. Your journey through the Sea of Stilts is relatively uneventful due to the heavy penalties imposed for piracy west of the Innis Archipelago. Restore 1 – 6 Stamina (the roll of one die) and turn to **50**.

9

‘Such is the penalty for piracy,’ says a merchant to your left as the pirate is drawn and quartered. You had certainly heard that the Sea of Stilts was almost devoid of the red flags of the reavers, but until now you never knew the severity of the crime. ‘Seafaring life is much easier for us this side of the Innis Shoals’ says the smiling merchant. Turn to **50**.

10

The royal bazaar primarily deals with exotic trade goods or novelties from abroad that would delight nobility and the finest equipment for the royal guard. The weapons and armour are crafted by the royal blacksmith, Rao Shivpuri – widely reputed as the greatest armorer in all of Chrysoprais. As a tradition of the country, royalty never wear armour as a symbol of their power, protection and of course for their comfort. The only armour worn by royal guards and other high rank soldiers is splint armour, because they detest the smell of leathers, the sound of chain and

the weight of plate. Shivpuri makes the best suit in the west, much lighter than its counterparts in the northern continents. The thick voluminous silks hide the lines of woven steel splint. As for weapons, Shivpuri only makes the traditional Chrysoprasian arms – the long spear and the ‘talwar’, a Chrysoprasian scimitar. You must note one of these two options if you choose to purchase a weapon from here.

Rao Shivpuri will not purchase any weapons or armour from you:

<i>Armour</i>	<i>To Buy</i>
Splint Armour (Defence +4)	450 Shards

<i>Weapons</i>	<i>To Buy</i>
COMBAT bonus +3	1200 Shards
COMBAT bonus +4	2000 Shards
COMBAT bonus +5	3000 Shards

<i>Other Items</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Bag of pearls	300 Shards	200 Shards
Courtier’s Mask	-	800 Shards
Four-leaf clover	90 Shards	80 Shards
Jewelled Turban	250 Shards	200 Shards
Peacock Feather	-	500 Shards
Platinum Earring	-	900 Shards
Silver nugget	-	350 Shards
Tatsu pearl	1500 Shards	1000 Shards

You have the great honour to meet Rao Shivpuri in person as you browse the armoury. If you have a **golden katana**, turn to **618** immediately. If not, when you are finished here turn back to **400**.

11

As the elemental dissipates in the water you notice that you have been dragged quite far out to sea. As you look down into the settling waters you can see a sparkle from the sea bed around 10 metres below. The sparkle is fading fast and it may be carried out by the current. Make a SCOUTING roll at a Difficulty of 19. If you fail, you lose sight of it and must return to the shore. Turn to **79**. If you succeed, turn to **168**.

12

You find overgrown ruins in the northernmost quadrant of the forest. It looks centuries old, perhaps even a thousand years old, and the forest has grown up around it. Surprisingly no moss or undergrowth grows within a metre of the perimeter, and the sounds of wildlife have ceased. There is one prominent archway permitting entrance to the ruins, however you will need a light source. If you are a Mage you can cast a spell to illuminate your weapon as you enter. Otherwise you will need a **lantern** or **candle** (remember you will have to cross off the latter if you choose to use it). If you have no light source you will have to leave.

Enter	turn to 715
Leave	turn to 198

13

Make a COMBAT roll at a Difficulty of 21. If you fail, turn to **495** immediately. If you succeed, you manage to make it to the bay and escape to your ship in the cutter. If you had the codeword *Infirm*, lose it and reduce your crew quality by two steps (down to a minimum of poor). Turn to **275**.

14

You spend nights and days looking to the horizon for a ship to take you away from this bleak island. One day you finally spot one and wave it down with a flag made of an old robe. They send a longboat out to you and take you on board. Roll two dice. Add 1 if you are an initiate of The Three Fortunes, and an additional 1 if you have the title Blessed of the Three Fortunes.

Score 2 – 4	turn to 167
Score 5 – 6	turn to 491
Score 7 +	turn to 634

15

You drop anchor a little way out and the bosun suggests the crew take a little time off. The island appears to have its own infrastructure and the men are eager to taste something other than their regular fish stew! If you decide to take the men with you, record the codeword *Infirm*. Now turn to **131**.

16

‘I sense this one has much potential indeed,’ says the snake demon. ‘Come forth, young one.’ If you are an initiate of Kæla Karna, turn to **407** immediately. Otherwise, she offers to induct you into the worship of their great lord Kumba Karna of the Land of Roots if you can pass the trial of immolation.

Pledge yourself to Kumba Karna	turn to 236
Refuse	turn to 433

17

A bell rings and dinner is served. You move to the dining hall where an enormous table is set to seat around fifty guests. You take your place and enjoy some fine wines before the main course. A man next to you leans over eagerly, ‘I had a chance to purview the live meats earlier, and it looks like a good one has been chosen for tonight.’ As he says this, the man at the head of the table stands and gains the attention of the room by tapping his glass. He is the owner of the manor, a tall regal man named Lord Sehastramal. He announces that the main course will be prepared according to the old laws, and calls the head chef and his assistants in. They are carrying a young child of around 7 or 8, who has been gagged and hog tied. They bring in a bucket and place it near the panic-stricken boy’s throat and the head chef draws a long, wavy obsidian knife.

If you have the codeword *Interpol*, turn to **56**. Otherwise you could offer to do the honours yourself and possibly use the opportunity to escape with the child (turn to **341**). No one is carrying weapons or armour here as they were all checked at the door, but nevertheless there are fifty men here that bar your escape, and the house guards will be called immediately so the only option would be to make a run for it (turn to **2**). If you want to sit and watch the child as he is slaughtered like cattle, turn to **299**.

18

If you wish to journey to Kurani, turn to **600**. Otherwise you could make your way to the Temple of the Eye. Turn to **29**.

19

The island is completely barren but for the low lying entrance to an underground chamber. It is built of granite and looks weathered by the ages. If you wish to investigate you will need a light source. If you are a Mage you can illuminate the chamber with a cantrip. Otherwise you will require a **lantern** or **candle** to proceed. If you do not have a light source or choose to turn back instead, turn to **425** immediately.

You walk down a flight of stairs carved directly into the rock. The chamber below is lined with more than two dozen large stone slabs, atop which lie the bodies of knights dressed in ceremonial armour. Surprisingly the crimson trappings of their uniforms are completely intact, and their flesh though pallid and drawn has not yet rotted. If it weren’t for the thick layers of

dust blanketing everything you could swear that they had only passed away in the last day. As you stroll between the slabs you can see many of the knights appear to have died of old age, though some still bear the grievous wounds of battle. Each knight rests with a peculiar sword of dark red metal on their chest clasped in their hands. You are astounded that such a tomb has remained untouched by grave robbers all these years!

If you are carrying a **crimson sword**, turn to **274** immediately. If you do not have a **crimson sword** but you are a Warrior by profession or you have the title Crimson Knight, turn to **434**. Otherwise, all you could do is:

Steal one of the swords	turn to 66
Set sail	turn to 425

20 □

If the box above is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading. If it was already ticked, turn to **719** immediately. You spend some time browsing the wares and arranging purchase and sale of cargo. At some point you mention your mine in the Grumes and another merchant tells you that a budding entrepreneur named Harvin Vishuamitra is eager to purchase minerals from distant lands. Strangely no one seems to know why he has such an interest in minerals, but there is a suggestion that he intends to capitalise on a shortage when the reserves in Chrysprais are depleted. You do a little research and eventually manage to get into contact with Harvin, who turns out to be one of the largest and most influential merchants in Chrysoprais. The fat fellow shows off his riches with gold rings and layers of elaborate necklaces. You expect to go through the extended discussion of import prices, but instead he gives you an outright offer on control of the mine itself! 'I'll give you 10,000 Shards for it,' he says confidently.

Accept	turn to 584
Decline	turn to 332

21

The faces of the Rakshasa contort as the bare lines of long teeth. First comes a chuckle... and then uproarious laughter that sounds like a hundred cats being strangled. 'I like this one, Lakha!' says the one on the left to the leader. The leader nods, still chuckling from the display you made. 'Much more spirit than the last few,' says Lakha.

'So you aren't going to kill and eat me?' you ask, hoping that it doesn't make them change their minds.

The one on the right snorts derisively. 'I'd rather starve than eat disgusting monkey meat like you! No, we'd just kill you.' It somehow doesn't make you feel any better.

The Rakshasa take you back to large hut built around the base of a number of trees, where they behave rather civilised. You are offered a large chair which takes you number of attempts to climb up to, and from which you can barely even reach the table. You feel like a child as you drink hot tasteless tea from an oversized mug.

Lakha takes time to explain the long and boring history of the Rakshasa race, where they once lived in harmony with the humans. However, one of their kind – a self-proclaimed 'Lord' Mugal-Ji – took advantage of their relationship with man and founded his own city, now known as Auriculum, where he subjugated humans to do his bidding as slaves. This in turn created a bad name for all other Rakshasa, who were quickly hunted down and forced into exile in their own home country. They were given this forest, and over time they became extremely territorial. 'Besides, this is the only land we have,' Lakha preaches, 'and having humans try to take it away from us by logging... or hunting us for the prestige of killing a Rakshasa... well that's just not acceptable.'

'So now we get 'em first,' pipes the second one.

If you have a **sapphire pendant**, turn to **479**. Otherwise, turn to **294**.

22 □

If the box above is ticked, you aren't so lucky this time. Turn to **700**. If it is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading.

You awaken to see a spartan room in what you can only assume to be a temple. Acolytes arrive when they hear you rousing to explain how they found you wandering around the coast of the island, completely out of your mind. The abbot managed to remove the curse for you, but not without cost. Unless you have the codeword *Ibis*, you are now expected to pay 500 Shards to the temple of Nagil in Auriculum. You look down for your money pouch but they explain that you were found without any money, and were probably robbed. Cross all your money off your character sheet.

When they bring out your personal effects you are sure there has been some kind of mistake – these aren't yours! They insist this is what you were found with. Cross off all your possessions and instead replace them with a **jewelled turban**, **selenium wand (MAGIC +4)**, **severed hand**, and a **fishing hook**. Furthermore, you have lost one point of CHARISMA but gained a point of THIEVERY for some inexplicable reason.

The abbot of the temple insists that you pay your dues, otherwise you would be dead. The acolytes escort you to the bank of Auriculum, where you may withdraw payment. Note this paragraph number and turn to **501** (unless you have the codeword *Ibis*). Once you have withdrawn the money you can

pay them and you are free to go (turn to **380**). If you cannot or will not pay them, it is easy enough to flee from the acolytes. Gain the codeword *Incomplete* and note that if you had a resurrection arrangement at any temple of Nagil, it is now cancelled. May Nagil have mercy on your soul. Turn to **380**.

23

Thankfully in this wealthy auditorium there is almost no jeering during executions, just a light applause after each. ‘Wait!’ you protest ‘there’s been a terrible mistake – that is Aklar the Bold!’ It is easy for you to be heard, but you will have to convince them with your words. Make a CHARISMA roll at difficulty 17. If you succeed, turn to **377**. Otherwise, turn to **651**.

24

The spectres mill about the deck and eventually dissipate into the wind. When you go below deck you are shocked to see half of your crew are dead. They lie curled up in their sheets, the colour drained from their faces and their bodies freezing cold to the touch. Reduce your crew quality to poor. The next morning as you stroll the deck you notice a strange item lying behind some barrels as if forgotten. It is a **spectral veil**. If you wish to keep it, note it on your Adventure Sheet and turn to **150**.

25 □

Put a tick in the box above. If there was already a tick in it, turn to **357** immediately and continue reading. It takes you a moment or two to realise that the man in the water is actually swimming away from your ship! He appears unfazed that you are attempting to rescue him and instead swims in a very purposeful nature toward the empty horizon. You direct your ship to sail alongside him and he barely blinks an eye at you. The man is in his forties, rugged and muscular, but his face shows great experience. He wears nothing but a loincloth, a bandolier of water flasks and a plain looking sword strapped to his side. You recognise him as one of the greatest swordsmen alive – Yanryt the Son!

As you call out his name he stops, looking up at you as he treads water. If you had met him before he shows no sign of recognition. ‘Do you require assistance, sir?’ you ask respectfully.

‘Does it look like I require assistance? I am doing quite fine on my own,’ he retorts. You ask the first thing that leaps to mind. ‘Why are you out here?’ Yanryt explains that he is testing himself. If he can accomplish one worldly feat he believes he will have the strength to challenge the Demon Lord Kumba Karna to a duel. He intends to swim from Mithdrak to Aku and is currently half way through his journey.

‘You’ve swam all the way from *Mithdrak*!’ you exclaim. ‘I think that is a worldly feat enough.’ He shakes his head. ‘I must prove it to myself,’ he replies. You insist that you wish to help him in some way. ‘Come to think of it, I think you can,’ he says as he tosses the bandolier of water flasks up to you. ‘I am running low on fresh water and I am only half way through my test.’

You fill them from your ship’s store and throw them down to him. ‘Thanks kid,’ he says. ‘You look like you have some potential... have we met before?’ he ponders for a moment and then shakes his head. ‘Anyway, I will be preparing for my challenge in the underworld, so if you are still alive at that time you’ll find me in Erebus. Perhaps you’ll learn a thing or two on your way there,’ he says as starts swimming again.

‘But how will I find you?’ you call out after him but he simply ignores any more of your distractions. Gain the codeword *Indomitable* and turn to **525**.

26

You batter one of the fiends overboard and it howls in frustration – Vampires cannot swim! You brave crew know that whilst they are no match for the creatures in combat, they may have a chance if they follow your tactic. They team up and work hard under your instruction, and when the vampires have realised their folly they make a hasty retreat. One is abandoned on the deck of your ship and it turns and faces you with a snarl. Luckily the moon is not yet high in the sky, and its strength is halved... but nevertheless a dangerous foe. The vampire screeches like an angry owl and lashes out with its long white talons.

Vampire COMBAT 15 Defence 18 Stamina 18

If you defeat the vampire, it throws up its bloodless hands, utters a terrible howl and vanishes like smoke on the wind. The echoes of its final cry are a long time in dying away. All that remains are a pile of musty old grey robes, some ornate rings worth 200 Shards (note the money directly in your petty cash), and a **scarab amulet** which may add to your list of possessions if you wish.

You have displayed valiant leadership and mettle in the face of adversity. Choose either CHARISMA or COMBAT and roll two dice. If you roll higher than the chosen ability, increase it by 1.

Turn to **650**.

27

Waters this close to the vortex are known for their frequent and ferocious storms.

Roll two dice:

2 – 6	A storm on the horizon	turn to 305
7	An uneventful voyage	turn to 275
8 – 10	An uncharted island	turn to 192
11 – 12	A lesser sea god	turn to 427

28

Your ship is suddenly swirling in a huge circle half a mile in diameter around the vortex. At this distance you can see a bizarre palace floating a few feet above the water half way into the vortex. It seems remarkably unaffected by the cyclonic waters below. As your ship gradually spins closer and closer to the palace, your only hope is to time your jump perfectly. The ship is completely out of control and there is no hope of saving it. Some of the crew have already been washed overboard, and the others are far too scared to attempt the jump. They have resigned to go down with the ship.

If you follow your crew to their fate, turn to **122**. Otherwise, roll three dice and add your Rank. You may add 2 if you are an initiate of The Three Fortunes.

19 or less	You fall to your doom.	turn to 700
20 – 24	You slip at the last moment	turn to 443
25 +	You land safely	turn to 163

29

Temple of the Eye is designed in the traditional Chrysoprasian style, with spiralling towers, and spires that stretch skyward. Atop the tallest spire is a bejewelled disk representing a disembodied eye gazing across the sea. Inside the temple you see men and women dressed in expensive silk robes, along with garbs that hail from many ports across the *Fabled Lands*. The main circular room has exquisite lounges on which rest seers and mystics reading the fortunes of visitors. There are also a small number of good laid out on velvet cushions about the room. The second level is an open balcony, with many different ornate doors running the length of the walls. However, judging by the size of the room, you are sure the doors must be enchanted somehow, as they would lead directly outside to a 15 foot drop!

If you have the codeword *Ingenious* turn to **371** immediately. Otherwise, choose from the following options:

Look for a priest	turn to 638
Have a seer read your fortune	turn to 421
Peruse the items for sale	turn to 570

Head up to the second floor	turn to 206
Leave for Kurani	turn to 661
Follow the coast to Mithdrak	turn to 320

30 □

If the above box is ticked, you spend some time in contemplation and are filled with piety. Restore 1 – 6 Stamina and return to **181**. If the above box is empty, put a tick in it and read on.

You spend days in contemplation, sitting atop the sheer cliff face of one of the islands. You have a vague sensation of the weather changing, the feeling of rain on your skin, the sun on your face. Your desire for food and water is a dull impulse in the back of your mind.

Make a SANCTITY roll at Difficulty 28

Successful SANCTITY roll	turn to 77
Failed SANCTITY roll	turn to 459

31 □

If the above box is ticked, turn to **340** immediately. Otherwise, you are granted an audience with General Murtabaht Singh, a man in his fifties with the look of a veteran of many campaigns. His audience chamber is remarkably sparse and he explains that they are currently planning a campaign to dominate Atticala. You mind reels at the impossibility of this task, considering this island's military force against the size and wealth of an entire continent. 'One step at a time' says the general. 'I would at least like to see the port of Hopias captured before my life is at its end.'

If you offer to aid him in his campaign, he explains that the island of Hopias represents a significant geographical advantage that will facilitate their attack on the mainland. 'If we were to leave the island in Atticalan hands it is only a matter of time before they launch an attack on Chrysoprais. We must capture it by diplomacy or force.' He explains that he has been building his army here and leaking misinformation to Atticalan spies to warn them of the size of our army. 'From what we know it has worked well, and sources tell us that the Atticalans believe our army to number in the tens of thousands, far more than reality. Now I require a brave adventurer to deliver a message to Colonel Sergios In Hopias, declaring that they will vacate the island or face the wrath of Chrysoprais!' You realise the danger of being caught up in the political situation between these two nations. If you wish to accept this quest, record the codeword *Imbibe*. He has you memorise the message and explains that it must be delivered with haste, and if you do not accept he will ask

another brave messenger to execute the mission. Whether or not you accept, turn to **708**.

32

You have realised that mundane seafaring techniques will be of little help in the vortex. From Umbart's instruction you believe that you will have to rely on your magical prowess to ensure you don't hit a ley line that will pull you directly into the mouth. If you play it right, you will be able to place the ship in just the right place to orbit the mouth of the vortex without being drawn in.

Make a MAGIC roll at a Difficulty of 25. You can add 1 to the roll if you are a Wayfarer.

Successful MAGIC roll	turn to 322
Failed MAGIC roll	turn to 54

33

The horizon remains empty, with no sign of a ship or land. You will soon die of dehydration unless you have a source of water. If you have a **water flask**, turn to **447**. Otherwise, turn to **700**.

34

You stroll through the well maintained streets and marvel at the mansions, villas and palatial houses with their own sentries. The people here flaunt their wealth, and you cannot see a man without a jewelled turban or a woman without the most exotic silks. If you have a **party invitation** and are here to attend, turn to **718**. If you have either of the codewords *Illegitimate* or *Illustrate*, turn to **709**.

If not, roll two dice:

2 – 5	A travelling merchant	turn to 144
6 – 8	An enjoyable stroll	turn to 50
9 – 12	Invited to a private party	turn to 255

35

You find a tavern where you are well treated. The citizens of Auriculum are used to pandering to the needs of rich merchants. You may stay here for as long as you like and recuperate. Each day you spend here costs you 3 Shards and you may restore 1 Stamina point. If you spend 3 or more days here, turn to **210**. Otherwise, you can return to the city centre by turning to **380**.

36

The **vulcanium ore** is used up in the creation process so you must cross it (and the cash) off your Adventure Sheet. A few days later the artificer calls you back into

his workshop and presents you with an impressive looking wand. Add the **vulcanium wand (MAGIC +7)** to your list of possessions. Vulcanium being an exceptional material ignores the +6 limit for item bonuses when crafted into weapons, wands and armour. Feeling extremely privileged to carry such an item, you return to the city centre. Turn to **280**.

37

Libyrrsh cannot believe what you are saying. 'Blasphemer!' she yells, and she levels a wand at you. 'To even consider renouncing worship is the greatest sin!' Despite how fast you could run, you are immolated with hellfire that scorches your skin. You may erase Kumba Karna from your god box, but you are now cursed. Each demon lord had a specific hex to place upon those who renounce their faith so that all in the underworld can see whom the sinner has crossed. Kumba Karna's specialty is the Curse of Immolation, wherein your skin shrivels as if you have been horribly burnt in the pits of hell. Your hair has been scorched from your head and your skin weeps pus constantly, making everything you touch feel like agony. Your face is especially repulsive to look upon. Put your current CHARISMA score in brackets, and note that your new CHARISMA score is 1. It can be improved with items that grant bonuses, but never increases otherwise. If you gain a CHARISMA score increase or penalty in the course of your adventures, add it to your score in brackets. When you have the curse removed you can restore your CHARISMA to the score in brackets.

Libyrrsh chuckles. 'You realise that only denizens of the underworld have even seen such a curse, let alone know how to remove it. Perhaps if you prove yourself to our lord Kumba Karna again, he will take pity on you...'

Note that the Curse of Immolation cannot be removed unless specifically stated in the entry. An instance where you may remove 'all curses' will not suffice. You could take the lesser demon's suggestion and venture into the underworld (remember you will need a light source), or you could leave by ship.

Enter the tunnel	<i>Into the Underworld</i> 403
Leave by ship	turn to 450

38

You have a sneaking suspicion that you are being set up for a highway robbery. You turn at precisely the right moment to block one of the three 'bodyguards' as he attempts to sap you in the back of the head. Throwing him down you draw your weapon and confront the disguised brigands. You have taken them by surprise, and if you succeed at a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 19 you intimidate them so much that they will flee.

Successful CHARISMA roll turn to **291**
Failed CHARISMA roll turn to **667**

39

Which direction will you head?

To Kurani turn to **600**
To the Crimson Fort turn to **244**

40

You feel as if your soul was just rammed into your body and you sit up with a start. Libyyrsh the Lesser sits by your side. Cross off your resurrection arrangement and then check your unmodified SANCTITY score, turning to the appropriate reference.

1 turn to **290**
2 – 8 turn to **669**
9 + turn to **577**

41

Executions are a form of entertainment in Mithdrak. The wealthy take great joy in watching the punishment of pirates, thieves and general villainy. It costs you 5 Shards to enter the auditorium, a technique employed by the city to preclude its poorer denizens entering. If you wish to pay the money to watch, amend your sheet accordingly and continue reading. If not, return to **50**.

A number of executions are taking place today, the most notable of which will be determined by a roll of two dice:

2 – 5 A pirate captain turn to **9**
6 – 8 A gang of criminals turn to **630**
9 – 12 An adventurer turn to **702**

42

You hear the sound of giggling and a little spec on the horizon grows larger and larger. You can see what looks like a boy riding a flying carpet! He veers toward you and stops just above your head. Looking over the edge, you can see that the boy is barely a teenager.

‘Wanna ride?’ he asks eagerly.

Climb onto the carpet turn to **671**
Continue on your way turn to **18**

43

The merchant’s ship is beyond saving, and it is hard enough to keep alongside it and rescue the passengers. Many of them perish from a mistimed jump, but you

manage to get a handful of the men including the captain safely aboard your ship. He watches with sorrow as his ship is pulled inexorably in to the vortex.

Once you are back in safe waters he thanks you for saving his life and you arrange to set the men down at your next port. He was a merchant from Chrysoprais sailing to sell fine silks in the markets of Kunrir, but now without his ship and cargo he is almost destitute. ‘I know not how to repay you, kind adventurer. I have only what I carry. Here, take these,’ he insists, handing you his **jewelled turban** and a pouch of 90 Shards.

Refuse his offer turn to **412**
Accept his offer turn to **625**

44 □

If you have the codeword *Igneous*, turn to **4** immediately. As you walk through the countryside you can hear the sound of cymbals and stringed instruments from up ahead. Brightly dressed dancing figures whirl and spin toward you. They encircle you smiling and wordlessly enticing you to dance with them.

If there was already a tick on the box above, turn to **426** immediately. If the box is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading.

If you have either of the codewords *Bones* or *Chill*, turn to **426** immediately. Otherwise, make a MAGIC roll at a Difficulty of 19. Add 1 to the roll if you are a Troubadour.

Successful MAGIC roll turn to **426**
Failed MAGIC roll turn to **388**

45 □□□

You spend a little time with a farmer who is taking a break to catch fish in the river. Tick a box above and turn to the appropriate entry.

First tick turn to **334**
Second tick turn to **586**
Third tick turn to **179**

If all three boxes are already ticked, turn to **586**.

46

You can detect the resonance of ghosts within each burial plot. You know that many undead cannot pass a line of salt and iron filings. If you have **salt and iron filings** and wish to use it, you can draw a protective barrier along your path between the burial plots. Cross it off and turn to **458**. If you do not have **salt and iron filings** or do not wish to use it, you can attempt to cross anyway (turn to **697**). Otherwise you could leave the forest. Turn to **358**.

47

Making your way down from this point is proving harder than you had thought.

Make a SCOUTING roll at a Difficulty of 16.

Successful SCOUTING roll turn to **300**

Failed SCOUTING roll turn to **481**

48

The stranger is a short, balding man from Chrysoprais who introduces himself as Arbudh Pradesh, chief artificer of the Walking City. Over a hearty meal he explains how his magic carpet failed when he tried to fly out over the Sea of Stilts and unfortunately no one on the Walking City saw! As a reward for saving him he offers to make you a magic carpet. If you have a **green carpet**, cross it off and replace it with a **magic carpet (safe travel x3)**. It has three charges which you can expend after rolling an encounter dice to avoid an unfavourable encounter. If you do so, chose the 'uneventful journey' option and remove one charge from the **magic carpet**. When there are no charges left it simply becomes a **green carpet** again. 'Oh, and make sure you don't make the same mistake I did,' he says, 'only use it for cross-country travel, and don't try flying out to sea!' Note that it cannot be used when sailing or when in a city or town. Also, you can only carry one **carpet** on your person at any time because they are very bulky and heavy, even when rolled up.

You arrange to drop him off at your next port of call. 'Come and visit me in the Walking City and I can provide you with a magic carpet whenever you like. It is the least I could do for my saviour!' Gain the codeword *Indubitably* and turn to **525**.

49

Knowing that if you simply lie about being innocent or tell them they have the wrong person they will simply take you in for questioning. Instead, you try to convince them that the information they have is old, explaining that you have already been convicted of the crime and done your time in jail for it. It won't be easy though...

Make a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 17. If you succeed, the captain assures you that he will double check with the records at Mithdrak and you are allowed to continue your journey. Otherwise, he doesn't believe you and your only other options are to:

Fight them turn to **399**

Surrender willingly turn to **589**

50

Mithdrak is a city of fabulous renown across the *Fabled Lands*. The capital is most famous for its beautiful spires that stretch ever skyward. The Chrysopraians once believed that without the support of a thousand towering spires the sky would fall onto the world of men. The royal palace is the focal point of Mithdrak, and it lies within a central fortified area larger than the whole of Yellowport! Within its walls reside only richest of the rich and famous. The wealthy district forms a band around the walls, an area reserved for powerful merchants who capitalise on Chrysoprais' reputation for the finest silks and cloths. A number of wealthy adventurers and courtiers have retired here too, comfortable in the knowledge that their worldly goods will be safe from thieves in this heavily policed area. On the outskirts of the city lie the poor quarters, containing some of the most appalling conditions known to man. The nobles of Mithdrak care not for the health and safety of its peasants, and a primary role of the city guard is to ensure that the dirty and diseased do not contaminate in the pristine streets of the wealthy.

If you wish to purchase a town house in Mithdrak, you must decide whether to buy in the wealthy district or the poorer quarters. A villa in the wealthy district costs 450 Shards and is relatively safe due to the regular city guard patrols. A small unit in the poorer quarter costs only 75 Shards but is more likely to be robbed or vandalised. Whichever you decide to purchase, cross off the cost and tick the box next to the

Visit the marketplace turn to **535**

Visit the merchant's guild turn to **516**

Visit the royal palace turn to **226**

Stay at an inn turn to **735**

Look for a temple turn to **178**

Look for the authorities turn to **78**

Explore the wealthy district turn to **34**

Visit your villa ☐ turn to **485**

Explore the poorer quarters turn to **348**

Visit your unit ☐ turn to **262**

Go to the gallows turn to **41**

Go to the Harbour turn to **85**

Leave the city on foot turn to **591**

51

The abbot explains the sage's teaching. 'To achieve enlightenment you must free yourself from desire,' he says.

'Surely a person without desire is merely apathetic?'

He shakes his head. ‘The force of your spirit is like a wild horse that pulls you headlong. You must tame this horse so that you can ride it. The essence of the sage’s teaching is to make you a whole person.

Make a SANCTITY roll at a Difficulty of 17.

Successful SANCTITY roll turn to **121**

Failed SANCTITY roll turn to **3**

Do not make the attempt turn to **300**

52

The vortex throws you off course and the ley lines wreak havoc with your navigation equipment. You lose sight of the Umbart’s Vortex and it may take some time to recalculate your current position. Roll two dice:

2 – 4 turn to **704**

5 – 6 turn to **172**

7 *Legions of the Labyrinth* **211**

8 – 9 turn to **27**

10 – 12 turn to **100**

53 □

If there is a tick in the box above, turn to **342** immediately. Otherwise, put a tick in it and continue reading. Your ship teeters on the brink of the fall. As the sea spray blankets your face with a fine mist you close your eyes and hold your breath, awaiting the inevitable. There is blast of wind and you figure you must be falling through the endlessness of the void now. To your surprise when you open your eyes you are in open waters... somewhere else! ‘Are we in the afterlife cap’n?’ asks the bosun as he gingerly pinches himself.

You count your blessings as you try to get your bearings. Turn to **450**.

54

You attempt to navigate the ley lines but the task is simply beyond you. The cyclonic waves threaten to draw you into the yawning darkness, and your only hope is that you managed to realise your mistake and pull out in time. If you are a Wayfarer or you succeed at a SCOUTING roll at Difficulty 18, you manage to backtrack to the palace before you are in too deep. Return to **163** and note that your ship is docked at Umbart’s Palace.

If you fail the SCOUTING roll, turn to **122**.

55 □□□

Each time you arrive at this paragraph tick one of the empty boxes above. When all three boxes are ticked, turn to **533**. The Saint holds out his hand silently. You place

your hand in his. Gain the codeword *Ink* if you didn’t already have it. Restore your Stamina to its normal unwounded score, and erase any curses, diseases, poisons or other ailments that you were suffering from. He then disappears in the blink of an eye.

You descend the peak. Turn to **524**.

56

Lose the codeword *Interpol* and record the codeword *Illustrate*.

You call out and the city guard come crashing through the windows. The party guests are soon subdued and taken under arrest. You set to work freeing the child and soon find the remaining children stored in cages in the large pantry. Gain 1 point of SANCTITY for ending such a despicable practice. Also, if you have the codeword *Indra*, turn to **621** immediately. Otherwise, return to **50**.

57

The guards do not believe your story against the eyewitnesses and move to arrest you. Gain the codeword *Incomplete* and roll three dice. If you roll equal to or under your Rank, you elude them without difficulty, but are forced to flee into the mountains to hide. Turn to **528**. If you roll higher than your Rank, you are captured and shackled. Turn to **71**.

58 □

An artificer takes you into his laboratory and shows you a variety of bodies in large vats. ‘I can grow you a new body, and if you die, your soul will fly here and you will be reborn!’ he says with confidence. You aren’t sure how they manage to bring someone back to life without petitioning the gods, but you have a bad feeling about it...

Nevertheless, to your surprise you are offered a resurrection arrangement for free. ‘First one is always on the house,’ he explains. If you choose to accept, tick the box above and write ‘The Walking City’, *The Isle of a Thousand Spires* **270** in your resurrection arrangement box. Remember that you can only have one resurrection arrangement at any one time. If you already have one, you could either replace it or come back here another time to receive your first free arrangement. Once the box is ticked, you can purchase further resurrection arrangements for only 200 Shards a piece. The artificer smiles at you, insisting that it is a real bargain!

If you have accepted an arrangement, the artificer takes a sample of your blood and then sets to work. As you turn to walk out he casually asks you your preference for your new body – ‘So what would you like? Male or female? Tall? Brunette?’ You can tailor your new body to any preference

within normal human diversity. If you choose an unaltered duplicate, he seems slightly dejected but makes the appropriate arrangements.

You leave feeling slightly apprehensive. Turn to **280**.

59

Your stories are so uninteresting that the king himself falls asleep! The sound of his snoring echoes through the hall and you are laughed off the stage. Stories about your failure are likely to spread like wildfire here. Lose 1 CHARISMA and turn to **400**.

60

The great turtle swims on a whim, and you will have to recalculate your position. You are sure you are still somewhere in the Cragdrift sea...

Roll two dice:

Score 2 – 4	turn to 125
Score 5 – 6	turn to 350
Score 7	turn to 381
Score 8 – 9	turn to 475
Score 10 – 12	turn to 625

61

You watch as the tribesmen boil large cauldrons of water, adding vegetables and spices to taste. Your crew are lined up and beheaded. Thankfully they are not stewed alive. Their heads however are sent to the witchdoctor for pickling. Reduce your crew quality by two steps (it cannot fall below poor) and lose the codeword *Infirm*.

You share in the unholy practice, which is said to bring you the strength of the dead. Lose 1 point of SANCTITY, and then roll two dice. If you score higher than your MAGIC score increase it by 1. Now turn to **649**.

62

You lose 3 – 18 Stamina (the roll of 3 dice) from prolonged exposure, unless you have a **tent**. If you are still alive, continue reading. Only after your crew had perished from thirst do you finally see a ship in the distance. You can barely stand as you wave them down. They send a longboat out to you and take you on board. Roll two dice. Add 1 if you are an initiate of The Three Fortunes, and an additional 1 if you have the title Blessed of the Three Fortunes.

Score 2 – 5	turn to 167
Score 6 – 8	turn to 491
Score 9 +	turn to 634

63

If you have the title Royal Assassin, turn to **369** immediately. If you do not have that title but have the codeword *Jury*, turn to **770** instead. If you do not have the title but have the codeword *Injure*, turn to **151** immediately. Otherwise you could offer some counterintelligence on General Singh's plans if you have them (turn to **249** if you have the codeword *Imbibe*). If you have none of these, the Prince becomes angry at you for wasting his time and you are dismissed. Lose the codeword *Indefatigable* if you had it and turn to **400**.

64

You spend some time with a passing merchant who recognises you as an adventurer and is eager to discuss trade with foreign countries. It turns out that he has his ship docked in Kurani and has hired a horse to ride to Mithdrak and check the commodity market there. 'I'm considering travelling to Teleos to sell my goods, but I thought it best to check Mithdrak first whilst my crew have a day or two of shore leave. No rest for the wicked, eh?'

You also learn a little about the trade in Chrysoprais. Harvin Vishuamitra, one of the most influential merchants in Kurani, is currently buying minerals at prices no one can refuse. However there is a catch – strangely he doesn't buy cargo through other merchants, insisting that he isn't interested in the 'small scale' business. He only buys actual mines so that he can monopolise mineral supply in all the *Fabled Lands*. The sheer scale of his plan makes your mind reel, and you ask the merchant what could Vishuamitra want with such a large supply of minerals.

'Beats me,' he says with a shrug. 'Most people I have talked to think it boils down to money and power, but I have heard a more convincing theory.' You listen intently. 'Some say he is actually a powerful wizard, or at least has his own personal sorcerer, and minerals are a key component in the construction of flying ships.'

Turn to **291** and continue on your journey.

65 □

Walking through the streets of a city teeming with vampires is a surreal experience. They stride in groups, conversing about matters you have never heard of, and some speaking in languages that have never been uttered in the realm of mortals. You also see a handful of trau here and there setting up market or conducting manual labour. If the box above is already ticked, return to **330** and choose another option from the list. If it is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading.

You bump into a trau as it exits a side street with its companions, all drunk on faery mead. It looks up at you and its jovial grin turns to something more malicious...

‘Look what we have here boys... a mortal a city of vampires!’

It looks as if your spectral veil only works on the undead. A number of passing vampires turn to look at the commotion and you will have to think fast to avoid having your identity revealed.

Offer them some **faery mead** turn to **769**

Attack them turn to **191**

66

You pick a particularly old and decrepit looking knight and attempt to prise the Crimson Sword from his death grip. You realise your mistake almost immediately as the man’s eyes flash open and he sits bolt upright. He turns to face you, raising the sword ominously. As he opens his mouth a deep booming voice emanates forth as if from the room itself. ‘Death to all evildoers!’

Banish it with a holy word turn to **113**

Flee to your ship turn to **628**

67

Before you know it the creature is on you – a bombardier beetle the size of a large dog! It levels a funnel at you, spouting gouts of liquid fire from its backside. Were this a normal sized beetle you would likely have an itchy rash, but with a weapon this size it feels like being set on fire! Roll four dice and lose that many Stamina points. If you are still alive, it seems to have emptied its defence mechanism for now and approaches you with clicking mandibles.

Bombardier Beetle COMBAT 15 Defence 25/17 Stamina 23

If you are using an edged weapon such as a sword or spear, it is nearly impossible to penetrate its toughened exoskeleton and you must use the higher of its two defence values. If you are using a bludgeoning weapon like a mace of quarterstaff, you will be able to crush it easily. Use the lower of its defence values. If you have no weapon, you have no hope of penetrating its armour and must flee. If you flee, it will get a parting strike on you for 1-6 damage, but if you live you may turn to **615**. If you defeat it, you can continue your journey by turning to **227**.

68

‘Never heard of it,’ says a merchant with a shrug. An adventurer from Golnir leans over. ‘I was wondering the same thing,’ he says to you. ‘Some of my maps have it in the north of this island, whilst others show nothing but a forest. Perhaps it is in the forest? Though I have heard bad things about the Forest of Rakshasas... giant

insects and tiger-headed men... I doubt I will go and investigate anytime soon, but I’d be eager to heard what you find!’

Turn to **356**.

69

The captain apologises profusely for nearly killing you. Perhaps he did you a favour? Nevertheless, he offers you a gift in an attempt to redeem himself, explaining that the ‘Sage of Peace’ would not approve of his conduct. Roll a die and add the items to your Adventure Sheet.

- 1 **centaur flute (CHARISMA +3)**
- 2 **scimitar (COMBAT +2)** and **splint armour (Defence +4)**
- 3 **amber wand (MAGIC +1)** and **witch’s hand**
- 4 **lotus talisman (SANCTITY +1)** and **catastrophe certificate**
- 5 **compass (SCOUTING +1)** and **mariner’s ruttier**
- 6 **lockpicks (THIEVERY +1)**, **rope** and **climbing gear**

You tell him that the least he can do is drop you off the next port, as you are eager to see dry land again. The ship is a merchant vessel bound for Chrysoprais, and the captain briefs you on country.

‘The isle of a thousand spires is so-called for its traditional architecture. The daft Chrysopraisians once though that without their towers the sky would fall down! The capitol, Mithdrak, is renowned for its wealth and beauty. In fact, the wealthy upper class not only shun the poor, but have employed a city guard specifically to keep the dirt-ridden underclass off their streets and out of their affairs. Auriculum, the southernmost city is renowned for its remarkable silks and you can always pick up a bargain there. It also happens to be the self-titled religious capitol of Chrysoprais.’

‘So where exactly are you headed?’ you ask, eager to discover where your adventures will begin. Roll one die.

- | | | |
|-------|-----------|--------------------|
| 1 – 3 | Mithdrak | turn to 50 |
| 4 – 5 | Kurani | turn to 600 |
| 6 | Auriculum | turn to 380 |

70

You approach and see your old crew on the deck. Their eyes brighten when they see you. ‘Cap’n is back!’ says the bosun, ‘we’re saved!’ As you board the ship you notice all the men are particularly pale, some suffering from scurvy, dehydration, malnutrition among other ailments. The bosun explains that whilst they were waiting at sea they rescued a drowning woman and brought

her aboard. They later found out she was a witch and threw her overboard, but not quickly enough to prevent her from cursing the ship. ‘We cannot put in at any port. We haven’t set foot on dry land for ages, and our provisions are almost depleted.’ To dispel the curse you will have to make a MAGIC roll at Difficulty 19, or Difficulty 16 if you have a **witch’s hand**.

Successful MAGIC roll	turn to 568
Failed MAGIC roll	turn to 183

71

You are apprehended and escorted to the dungeons of Mithdrak, deep below the palace grounds. All your cash is confiscated for ‘processing fees.’ Any possessions you were carrying at the time should be removed from your character sheet and transcribed into the box provided at paragraph **483**. Note this paragraph number so you can return her when you have finished.

You are put in shackles and thrown into a small cell. ‘Where is my trial?’ you ask. ‘Already done,’ the guard grunts, ‘you’re in for a year.’

Do your time	turn to 611
Attempt to escape	turn to 298

72

If you have the codeword *Clutch*, turn to **337** immediately. You give the man food, water and warm clothes and he is very appreciative. He explains that he was a crewman aboard a ship that had been mutinied two days earlier. The rest of the crew killed the captain and threw everyone else loyal to him overboard. He managed to swim to this deserted island and thought he would surely die out here. Unfortunately he now has no money, possessions, and no family to return to as he was an orphan.

Offer him 50 Shards to get his life back in order	turn to 419
Offer him a new life aboard your ship	turn to 261
You arrange to drop him off at the next port	turn to 650

73

Note the codeword *Imbue* on your adventure sheet if you did not already have it. Turn back to **300**.

74

From the crow’s nest you spot an amazing sight – a city on the back of a giant turtle. It is making way toward your ship. This must be the city you heard of in legend – Carapace! If you do not wish to dock at Carapace, return to the paragraph you were just reading and treat it as if you had rolled ‘uneventful journey’ on your

encounter roll. If you are currently suffering from a disease of any kind or you have the codeword *Ignoble*, you are denied entry and must return to the previous paragraph as stated. If you satisfy neither of those conditions and wish to dock at Carapace, turn to **444**.

75 □

‘Iambus...’ muses the nobleman. If the box above is ticked, then he’s never heard of it. Turn to **356**. If it is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading.

‘Iambus, eh? Yes indeed – my stockbroker mentioned it not long ago... he heard from his associate who heard from an Atticalan captain who’s great grandfather went there. He said it was directly due south of Mithdrak all the way to the Edge of the World.’

‘So, what was there?’ you ask eagerly. ‘No idea,’ he replies, ‘the guy never returned. They figured he fell off the Edge of the World!’ Gain the codeword *Iambus* if you didn’t already have it and put one tick in an available empty box beside it (ie. if this is the second time you have gained the codeword, put a tick in the second box beside it).

Turn to **356**.

76

What would you like to ask about? Umbart is a specialist in underworld research, so you are likely to receive detailed information on such topics.

The Trau	turn to 229
Vulcanium	turn to 385
Underworld religion	turn to 509
Iambus	turn to 711

77

You have no need for your corporeal body any longer, and your spirit transcends to the next realm of existence. Your essence persists until the very end of eternity, watching over the realm of mortals.

Begin a new character and start from **1** in any Fabled Lands book.

78

If you have the codeword *Illustrate*, turn to **613**. Otherwise read on. Law enforcement is relatively strict in this city, primarily to keep the poor out of the business of the wealthy. You are made to queue up in a congested line. You are finally seen by a town guard who is surrounded by stacks of paperwork. ‘State your business’ he commands gruffly.

Chrysoprais put some of the heaviest fines on piracy in all the *Fabled Lands*. If you have a **pirate captain's head**, you can cross it off and you will be given a 500 Shard reward. Now, if you have a **party invitation**, turn to **698**. Otherwise you are thrown out. Turn back to **50**.

79

From here you can head to the north edge of the Forest of Apsaras, or to the south edge, close to Auriculum. Alternately you could just enter the forest from here.

Head north	turn to 358
Head south	turn to 281
Enter the forest	turn to 548

80

If you have a ship docked here you may go aboard and set sail. Turn to **411**. Otherwise, you could pay for passage to one of the other ports nearby. Cross off the listed fee and turn to the relevant entry. If you reconsider leaving the city, you may return to the city centre by turning to **380**.

Mithdrak	15 Shards	turn to 8
Kurani	15 Shards	turn to 600
Pethumar	30 Shards	<i>The Lone and Level Sands</i> 75
Hopias	25 Shards	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 176

81

A large warship sails directly for you. It looks of Chrysopraisian design, with its narrow hull and triangular sails. Policing in this rich merchant country is reputed to be very fair, unlike the corrupt officials of Sokara and other nations. As long as you have nothing to hide you will no doubt be allowed to go on your way.

If you do not have any of the codewords *Bullion*, *Evade*, *Fracas*, or *Incomplete*, you can go about your business. Turn to **225**. If you do have any of those codewords and do not have the codeword *Face*, turn to **563** immediately. If you do have the codeword *Face*, the police will have not chance of recognising you anyway so turn to **225**.

82

The denizens of the Walking City prefer to keep to themselves and are unlikely to offer training to a stranger freely. If you are a Mage or a member of a college at Dweomer, you can attempt a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 20. If you succeed, turn to **688**. If you fail, or you are neither a Mage nor a member of a college, turn back to **280**.

83

You eventually reach the sea bed. It is pitch black apart from your light, which must seem like the tiniest spec in an ocean of void. You follow the warmth to a volcanic vent. You stand at the base of a deep sea geyser, and though your light only illuminates the base you calculate that it must be the size of Sky Mountain! Volcanic dust cascades down the side and you scoop fistfuls of the warm mineral into a pouch. Cutting the ropes you swim for what feels like hours back to the surface, using the enormous body of the sea god as a guide.

Heilmir, looking somewhat surprised, congratulates you as you reach the surface. 'Very, very well done,' he booms, nodding in approval. Write Heilmir in your god box and lose initiate status of any other gods except for the Alvir and Valmir (you may be an initiate of both Alvir and Valmir at the same time as an initiate of their son Heilmir). You hold out the pouch of volcanic silt and the god plucks it from your hand with precision.

'Actually, I have no need for this,' he says casually. He is about to toss it over his shoulder when he reconsiders, and then with a swift move he pounds the dust between his giant palms with a thunderous crack. 'Perhaps you do?' he says throwing it back on to the deck of the ship. He departs with a splash and you are left alone. Looking inside the compressed pouch you find a lump of the volcanic mineral. Note the **vulcanium ore** on your Adventure Sheet if you wish to take it.

The whole experience has taught you much on the nature of faith. Roll two dice and if you roll higher than your SANCTITY score, increase it by 1. Also, if you are a Priest, roll four dice and if you roll higher than your Rank, gain a Rank. Roll one die and increase your normal unwounded Stamina by that number.

Feeling somewhat proud of yourself, you continue on your journey. Turn to **275**.

84

Your attempts to navigate the Innis Archipelago are proving harder than you had expected. Make a SCOUTING roll and compare the result to the table below. You may add 1 to the roll if you have a **mariner's ruttier**.

14 or less	Disaster strikes!	turn to 580
15-19	Snagged on a reef	turn to 462
20+	Successfully avoid danger	turn to 550

85

The Mithdrak harbour is filled with merchant vessels from all over the *Fabled Lands*. In fact, everywhere you look you can see foreign faces, some of which you cannot even put a place to!

You can buy goods from the warehouses only if you own a ship which is docked at Mithdrak. You can buy as much cargo as your ship has room for. You can also sell cargo here. All prices are for 1 Cargo Unit.

	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Furs	200 Shards	120 Shards
Grain	190 Shards	175 Shards
Metals	990 Shards	900 Shards
Minerals	550 Shards	500 Shards
Spices	900 Shards	800 Shards
Textiles	160 Shards	120 Shards
Timber	320 Shards	290 Shards

Here you can also buy a ship of your own, to fill with cargo and crew. If you wish to purchase a ship, you are the captain and can take it wherever you wish, exploring and trading. You also get to name it. Three types of ship are available.

<i>Ship Type</i>	<i>Cost</i>	<i>Capacity</i>
Barque	250 Shards	1 Cargo Unit
Brigantine	450 Shards	2 Cargo Units
Galleon	900 Shards	3 Cargo Units

If you do buy a ship, add it to your Ship's Manifest, and name it as you wish. The quality of your ship's crew is poor unless you pay to upgrade it. If you already own a ship, you can sell it back to the harbourmaster at half the above prices.

It costs 50 Shards to upgrade a poor crew to average and 100 Shards to upgrade an average crew to good. Upgrading a good crew to excellent costs 200 Shards, and all prices are cumulative so upgrading a poor crew to excellent will cost 350 Shards.

When you are finished and wish to go to the city centre, turn to **50**. If you wish to set sail, turn to **108**. Alternately you could pay for passage aboard a ship. Turn to **498**.

86

The guards eventually recognise you and talk amongst themselves. You would have no chance of outrunning them whilst mounted, but you could forsake the boy and flee on the carpet.

Wait and see	turn to 455
Flee on the carpet	turn to 579

87

Roll three dice and add your Rank. Add 1 to this number if you are a Rogue:

19 or less	You are overcome by the masses. Turn to 700 .
20+	You manage to escape through the window. Continue reading.

You hoist the child over your shoulder and flee from the cries of outrage behind you. You inform the relevant authorities but the cult has vanished by the time they arrive. No evidence remains and the owner of the manor is released from all accusations. Gain the codeword *Illegitimate*. The child is returned to his mother and you are given the 50 Shard reward. It is not until later that you discover you still have the obsidian knife in your possession. It is a **Kris (COMBAT +4, MAGIC +4)**. Note that whilst you carry this sacrificial instrument, your SANCTITY score is reduced by 1, down to a minimum of 1. Other items may be used to mitigate this penalty unless otherwise stated. This item cannot be sold in any marketplace, but specific sects or cults may purchase it from you. Turn to **50**.

88

The summit of Vulture's Peak is roughly flat, but not particularly wide. You even fear to stand completely upright with the powerful winds threatening to blow you off to an early demise. Note that this location is of great spiritual significance, and counts as a temple to the Sage of Peace (if you are told to descend and you have an alternative means of travel you may use it).

If you are an initiate of the Sage of Peace, turn to **655** immediately. Otherwise, if you have the title Demoniac and the codeword *Lament* but not the codeword *Irredeemable*, turn to **201**. If you satisfy none of these conditions, the peak is completely empty and your only option is to descend. Turn to **524**

89

If you have the codeword *Iteration*, turn to **573**. Otherwise, roll two dice:

2 – 4	A storm	turn to 748
5 – 8	An uneventful journey	turn to 125
9 – 11	A passing minstrel	turn to 279
12	Carapace. Note this paragraph number	turn to 74

90

You peer inside the main room from the cover of darkness. A group of a dozen men and women in purple velvet robes are prostrated in front of a demonic figure of a black snake-headed woman with four arms. It looks like some kind of unholy sermon. She hisses the great deeds of some legendary Demon Lord named Kumba Karna, who is creature of near deity status widely worshipped in the Land of Roots. You also learn that Kumba Karna is currently at odds with his sister, Kæla Karna who vies for control over their third of the underworld. You surmise that Karna is some kind of title for Demon Lords of their rank and status.

Another treat of the night is to witness one of the humans being inducted into the worship of Kumba Karna. It seems that to become an initiate they must undergo a test of faith and be immolated in hellfire as a rite of ‘purification’. Unfortunately the would-be initiate fails and his charred corpse is removed from the temple. You have a few minutes before the followers will exit the building with the body. If you wanted to spring a surprise attack, you could gain the upper hand against the demonic figure (gain the codeword *Impeccable* if you wish to attack her).

Attack the snake-headed woman	turn to 433
Ask to join the congregation	turn to 554
Leave for your ship	turn to 450

91

You create a melody that counteracts their enchantment. The dervishes slow to a halt and stare at you in amazement, and then slowly they begin to sway, dancing to your tune. You have them under your spell! You speed up, making them dance faster and faster until there is a flash of light. You reopen your eyes to see nothing but piles of dust on the ground where the malevolent spirits were. It quickly blows away on the breeze, leaving you alone with your thoughts. Roll two dice and if they total higher than your MAGIC score, increase it by one. Also, if you are a Troubadour, the experience has taught you a lot about the nature of music and enchantments. Roll four dice and if you roll higher than your Rank, gain 1 Rank.

Gain the codeword *Igneous*. When you have made the necessary adjustments, turn to **4** and continue your journey.

92

You will have to succeed at a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 17, or the skittish creatures will leap back into the sea and swim away.

Successful CHARISMA roll	turn to 276
Failed CHARISMA roll	turn to 197

93

The bosun turns to you wise-eyed. ‘Do you really think that is wise, cap’n? Ain’t nothing out there but the edge of the world... that’s suicide. Besides, the men gotta have a lot of confidence in you to follow you to certain death!’

If you have the codeword *Curdle*, you can lead your faithful crew to the Edge of the World. Turn to **245**. If you do not have the codeword or you have reconsidered your course, return to **575** and choose again.

94

You leap into action, drawing your weapon and lashing out at the nearest one in within the bat of an eyelid. You stop your weapon at his groin, being the only vital area you can reach on these giants. You turn to the other two, a threatening fire in your eyes that only comes from desperation. Turn to **21**.

95

As you are stuffing your pack full of treasure, the coffin lid slides open and a huge form sits up. A tiger-headed giant over four metres tall steps out of its resting place, pieces of rotted flesh dropping from its surprisingly well preserved body. It blocks your exit. It reaches into the coffin to grab an enormous scimitar and turns to you

Rakshasa Lord COMBAT 25 Defence 21 Stamina 50

There is no escape from this battle. If you are slain, turn to **700**. If you somehow manage to defeat the hulking beast, you may roll two dice. If you roll higher than your COMBAT score, add 1 to it.

You turn to leave. Turn to **543**.

96

You are just too fast for the thief and quickly have him on his knees at your mercy. The unkempt Chrysopraisian bandit spits at your feet. You have a feeling that if you let him live you may just be robbed again anyway.

Kill him and take back your possessions	turn to 528
Deal him the common punishment for thievery	turn to 159
Spare him	turn to 397

97

You spy the red flags of the reavers approaching from the east. They must be particularly daring if they risk being caught by the heavy policing on piracy in the Sea of Stilts. Then again, they may also be particularly good at their jobs too.

Attempt to outrun them	turn to 545
Parley	turn to 417
Stand and fight	turn to 297

98

After sundown as you stroll the deck making preparations for the next day, you spot three ships approaching from the south. They look so outdated even your aging bosun can't pick their make. 'They look like quinqueremes cap'n,' he says stroking his beard. If you have the codeword *Intimidate*, turn to **464** immediately. If you do not have the codeword *Intimidate*, but have three ticks next to the codeword *Iambus*, turn to **204**. Otherwise continue reading.

The ships make their approach, changing vector to intercept you. The moonlight is fairly poor and you can barely make out the crew milling about on the deck. By the time you can see them in detail it is far too late to outrun these small but powerful vessels. The crew are vampires, dressed in dull grey and black robes, fingers adorned with rings that only serve to make their flesh look more like ivory. They lean over the side of their ship to get a good look at you and your crew.

You cannot hope to fight all three ships and they look intent to board. Even if you were to ram one ship, the other two will board. Will you:

Turn them back with holy words?	turn to 140
Rally your men for battle?	turn to 442

99

On which topic would you like to gather information?

Vulture Peak	turn to 739
The City of the Dead	turn to 68
The Great Turtle	turn to 742
Umbart's Vortex	turn to 208
The Forest of Apsaras	turn to 753
Iambus	turn to 75
The Walking City	turn to 759
Rakshasas	turn to 731

100

Waters this close to the vortex are known for their frequent and ferocious storms. Roll two dice:

2 – 6	A storm on the horizon	turn to 305
7 – 12	An uneventful voyage	turn to 375

101

If you have the codeword *Ingrate*, turn to **454** immediately. Otherwise, the royal guard allow you through and you have the great opportunity to wander the palace grounds. You haven't gone ten paces before a nobleman confronts you and asks what your business is with the royal family.

Entertain them with stories of adventure	turn to 668
Seek an audience to offer your services	turn to 496
Request a boon	turn to 451

102

Roll two dice. If you roll a double 1, your ship has disappeared. You wonder what happened but there are no clues to be found. Could it have been hijacked? Cross it off your manifest, gain the codeword *Ill*, and turn to **358**. If you roll any other number you return to your ship and set sail without a problem. Turn to **660**.

103

You sail on, as if forever, with your cabin boy atop the crow's nest constantly scanning the horizon for something... anything...

Finally one morning you hear that fateful cry – 'Edge!! The Edge of the World!!' There is a sudden uproar as your crew scramble onto the deck and look out to their doom. Panic sets in and the deck is in chaos. You attempt to keep your cool as you realise that your ship is being pulled faster and faster toward that sharp drop. You can't help but consider it somewhat poetic as you look upon that undefinable point at which the sky ends and that deep black impenetrable void begins. You are one of the few mortals who have gazed upon the Edge of the World, and your fame will soon spread through seafaring myth. If you didn't have the codeword *Intricate*, gain 1 CHARISMA, then gain the codeword *Intricate*.

You are snapped out of your reverie with the sudden realisation that you must get control of your ship. Roll three dice and add your Rank. You may add 1 to the roll if you are a Wayfarer and add 2 if you are an initiate of Alvir and Valmir:

24 or less	turn to 710
25 or higher	turn to 402

104

Umbart listens intently to your tale of how you came across the item, and claps his hands with glee. ‘This will make a great addition to my collection!’ If you wish to give it to him, he clicks his fingers and a trau servant escorts you to collect a reward. Turn to **7**. Otherwise, you can sell him the item to him. The price he is willing to pay is listed below:

<i>Other items</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Ankh of Karna	3,000 Shards
Cloak of darkness	2,000 Shards
Demon’s head	1,000 Shards
Fretwork key	2,500 Shards
Vulcanium ore	3,500 Shards

When you have finished here, whether or not you sell the item return to **304** and choose again.

105

‘You need not ask for what you already have,’ says the saint as he disappears in the blink of an eye. Gain one point of SANCTITY. You descend the peak. Turn to **524**.

106

The Auriculum harbour has all manner of goods on sale, but most notably a vast array of cloths, silks and cottons. You can buy goods from the warehouses only if you own a ship which is docked at Auriculum. You can buy as much cargo as your ship has room for. You can also sell cargo here. All prices are for 1 Cargo Unit.

	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Furs	200 Shards	150 Shards
Grain	180 Shards	160 Shards
Metals	900 Shards	850 Shards
Minerals	550 Shards	500 Shards
Spices	780 Shards	700 Shards
Textiles	120 Shards	80 Shards
Timber	320 Shards	290 Shards

Here you can also buy a ship of your own, to fill with cargo and crew. If you wish to purchase a ship, you are the captain and can take it wherever you wish, exploring and trading. You also get to name it. Three types of ship are available.

<i>Ship Type</i>	<i>Cost</i>	<i>Capacity</i>
Barque	250 Shards	1 Cargo Unit
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Galleon	900 Shards	3 Cargo Units

If you do buy a ship, add it to your Ship’s Manifest, and name it as you wish. The quality of your ship’s crew is poor unless you pay to upgrade it. If you already own a ship, you can sell it back to the harbourmaster at half the above prices.

It costs 50 Shards to upgrade a poor crew to average and 100 Shards to upgrade an average crew to good. Excellent crews are not available in Kurani

After you have made the necessary amendments, if you have the codeword *Incomplete* and not the codeword *face*, turn to **596** immediately. Otherwise you can either return to the city centre (turn to **380**), or leave Auriculum by sea (turn to **80**).

107

You pass a group of priests heading toward Vulture’s Peak and spend sometime chatting with them. You learn that many people try to climb the mountain in search for a Saint who is reputed to be one of the first disciples of the Sage of Peace. This would make him centuries old, and many consider his existence just a myth. Perhaps you should see for yourself? Whilst they assure you that the mountain would be difficult to climb, conviction to the task and of course the Sage will keep you from harm.

‘He would save me if I fell?’ you ask. One of the priests chuckles in response. ‘No of course not. He would expect you to save yourself. That is the test... just don’t take the task lightly,’ he recommends.

Turn to **448**.

108

You leave the fine port of Mithdrak behind. ‘What course, cap’n?’ asks the bosun.

Plot a course for Auriculum	turn to 411
Head due south	turn to 327
Head east toward Pethumar	turn to 453
Follow the coastline northeast	turn to 560

109

Heilmir folds his arms across his chest again and watches your every move. The bosun turns to you. ‘The pressure down there will kill you, cap’n!’ he says with fear. ‘Not to mention how you expect to swim that far!’

Make a SCOUTING roll at a Difficulty of 17. If you succeed, turn to **410**. If you fail, you leap into the water but simply can’t swim far enough, your body aching with cramps. The water breathing spell soon wears off and you are forced to surface. Heilmir simply chuckles and dives back into the water. Turn to **275**.

110 □

If the box above is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading. If it was already ticked and you have the codeword *Incomplete* and not the codeword *face*, turn to **293**. Otherwise, if it was already ticked your journey is uneventful. Turn to **448**.

You pass two washer women who are caught up in a debate and become inadvertently involved. They turn to you to solve their dispute. Make a THIEVERY roll at a Difficulty of 17.

Successful THIEVERY roll	turn to 499
Failed THIEVERY roll	turn to 219

111

Charat welcomes you and his daughter Indra prepares you a small meal. ‘You are welcome to stay here as long as you like.’ You may restore your stamina to its normal score and store any items or money here with no chance of robbery. Whenever you are finished you may return to **50**.

Possessions at Charat’s house

112

‘Greetings my friend,’ growls Ulgraghsk the Lesser. ‘Mistress Kæla Karna has sent me here to find you.’ If you are an initiate of any Demon Lord other than Kæla Karna, turn to **326** immediately. Otherwise, turn to **717**.

113

You bellow a mighty power word and call forth the holy power of your god. Little do you realise, the knights are not creatures of the night – they are the revered

dead. In fact as a trespasser on this holy land *you* are the wrongdoer. The time you wasted is your undoing and the knight deftly cuts you in twain with his enchanted sword before returning to his place of rest. Turn to **700**.

114 □□□□

Each time you visit the Library of the Fabled Lands, tick one of the boxes above. When you tick the fourth box (or all the boxes are ticked), turn to **176** immediately. You follow the priest’s instructions and tell the password to the guard. You learn that the password changes regularly to prevent those with unscrupulous goals from reading about the future. Lose the codeword *Ingenious*. You descend some stairs behind a secret door and find yourself in a massive underground library. Books line every shelf, all with the same identical binding. *The History of the Fabled Lands* is written on each spine, with volumes ranging into numbers you haven’t even heard of! Scribes are posted at many desks, constantly writing. You spend hours here trying to locate information of interest but to no avail. A passing scribe informs you that it is almost impossible to locate anything in this library due to its sheer size and poor indexing system. One thing that is always easy to find is information about yourself. In your curiosity you scan the indexes and eventually locate a strange book. It is written in third person but describes intimate details about your own life! Where you were born, raised, the beginnings of your adventuring career... what astounds you even more is that you are now reading a page about how you obtained the password to the secret library, and then started reading a book about yourself.

Roll three dice. If you roll higher than your Rank turn to **585** immediately. If you roll equal to or less than your Rank, continue reading.

You recall what the priest said and resist the urge to read the rest of your life. Knowing all the details like the day of your death (or deaths in case of resurrection), when terrible or great things happen to you, and believing that your whole life is predetermined is just something you do not want to know. However you do manage to get a glimpse of an event that will happen to you in the future. Without the context though it is hard to tell whether it will happen tomorrow or next decade. Nevertheless it may prove useful in your adventures.

Write ‘Foresight’ in your Blessings box. Once used you must cross the blessing off. The blessing of foresight allows you to read *one* available option presented in an entry before making a decision. Essentially, you can turn to one of the options presented (whether or not you actually satisfy the conditions like codewords or titles, etc.) and read that entry before turning

back and deciding which of the options to actually choose. Remember that you may only have one blessing of a particular kind at any one time.

You hastily leave the Library of the Fabled Lands before you have the temptation to read any more. Turn to **29** and choose from the options presented.

115

A little way into the forest you are greeted by the same three Rakshasas you has met before. This time not a arrow-point! 'Good to see you are still alive!' Lakha bellows. If you have a **sapphire pendant**, cross it off your Adventure Sheet and turn to **157**. If you have been to the tomb of Mugal-Ji but didn't retrieve the **sapphire pendant**, or have somehow lost it along the way, turn to **177**. Otherwise, the Rakshasa look despondent and growl to each other in their own language. Lakha eventually turns to you. 'We have decided to let you live for now,' he declares as he escorts you to the edge of the forest. 'But you obviously do not consider this quest important. Leave now.' Lose the codeword *Implore* and turn to **615**.

116

The temple of Nagil is a tall tower with stretching spires in traditional Chrysopraian design. Despite being a god predominantly worshipped in the northern continent, the highly religious people of Auriculum have accepted him as their own. Nagil is always recognised as the god of death, as a dark cowed reaper, but here many see him as a god of new beginnings and the death of old practices. You notice a sign on the door requesting for brave adventurers to see the head priest. It is weathered with age – perhaps they just forgot to take it down?

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Seek an audience with the head priest | turn to 373 |
| Become an initiate of Nagil | turn to 195 |
| Renounce his worship | turn to 476 |
| Leave | turn to 600 |

117

You feel like you are being followed. Looking over your shoulder a few times, you see nothing but the dank trees crowding around you. Just when you were confident it was only your mind, you look over your shoulder and reel in horror as the face of a grinning ghost stares at you with bloodshot eyes. It reaches out and its hand passes straight through your heart. It skips a beat and throws your stomach into your throat. Note you are suffering from the Curse of Blighted Magic, which halves your MAGIC score (rounded up) until you can find a cure. If you are already suffering from the Curse of Blighted Magic, you must halve your MAGIC score

again (remember to round up). If your MAGIC score ever reaches 0 in this way your body has been drained of vital essence and you are dead (turn to **700**).

Frozen to the spot you see other ghosts, equally a grim, appearing out of the forest to the south. You eventually regain your senses and run frantically away from the ghosts. The pack of undead fly after you, making no sound at all as they pass through the trees hot on your heels. You could

- | | |
|--|--------------------|
| Turn around and attempt to banish them | turn to 396 |
| Continue running out of the forest | turn to 239 |

118

You are about three quarters of the way up the mountain and the summit is in sight. It is shrouded in clouds and it is becoming hard to breathe. You mutter a prayer under your breath as you look at the long drop below. If you have the codeword *Calcium* or are an initiate of the Sage of Peace, you are somehow able to breathe in the rarefied air here and may press on. Otherwise, you will have to turn back. It is just too risky if you were to faint this high up.

- | | |
|-----------|--------------------|
| Press on | turn to 633 |
| Turn back | turn to 296 |

119

You haul the man aboard and give him some hot water and a blanket. He talks to you at length about his previous experience as a soldier in the service of the independent barony of the Crimson Fort. Among his tales is one of an island rumoured to lie somewhere west of Chrysoprais, wherein rest the forefathers of the Crimson Knights. Their duty was to protect the Chrysoprais from the threat of Atticalan invasion. 'If you do find it make sure you carry a crimson sword. I heard that the spirits there wouldn't trust a foreigner otherwise.'

You arrange to drop him off at the next port. Turn to **525**.

120

A Chrysopraian warship pulls up alongside you, and by the uniforms you expect that they are in the service of the Mithdrak sea patrol who police this sector. The captain looks at you. If you have any of the codewords *Bullion*, *Evade*, *Fracas*, or *Incomplete*, and do not have the codeword *Face*, turn to **658** immediately. Otherwise, he looks at you sternly. 'Go about your business,' he commands dismissively. Turn to **325**.

121

You train hard and the abbot is pleased with your progress. ‘You have mastered all I can teach,’ he says. ‘You are ready to climb the peaks. There your faith will be tested.’

Note that you are now an initiate of the Sage of Peace. This does not prevent you from also being an initiate of another temple, because the sage is not a jealous god.

Now turn to **185**.

122

Note the codeword *Indicate* on your Adventure Sheet.

Your crew cry out in horror as the ship circles inexorably toward the gaping black hole. Waves crash across the deck, sweeping many of your crew to a watery grave. Everyone else holds on for dear life, despite knowing that their end is near. Note that your crew quality is now Poor.

If you have a **rope** you can strap yourself to the wheel and attempt to guide your ship into the funnel of the vortex with the fewest casualties. Turn to **478** in *Into the Underworld*. Otherwise, roll three dice and add your Rank. Add 1 if your ship is a Brigantine and add 2 if it is a Galleon. You may add 2 to this if you are an initiate of Alvir and Valmir.

19 or less	You are drowned	turn to 700
20 – 29	You are swept overboard	<i>Into the Underworld</i> 726
30 +	Your ship remains intact	<i>Into the Underworld</i> 478

123

With no time for caution you slide down the rope as fast as possible (lose 1 die of Stamina). If you are still alive, you will have to hide somewhere within the walls and hope you aren’t found before daybreak when the gates reopen. Luckily there are many places to hide.

Make a THIEVERY roll at a Difficulty of 17. If you fail the roll, they find you hiding in a refuse area and you are quickly overcome. Turn to **361**. If you succeed, they eventually call off the search, assuming that you may have escaped over the castle walls during the night. Luckily, you don’t think they have identified you. They will no doubt step up the general’s guard detail, and another assassination attempt may carry great risk. Turn to **708**.

124

The market of Carapace reflects its idyllic setting, as they do not sell any weapons or armour. They do however have numerous other items of interest that could benefit the adventurer. You hear that although they accept Shards for their goods,

they actually only use money when making transactions with outsiders in order to purchase cargo that they could not otherwise survive without. In fact, their shamans create some of the magical items solely to sell to enterprising adventurers, and yet have no need for these items themselves. In fact, their lifestyle is based on trading goods and services with each other, and they aren’t interested in buying many items from outsiders.

<i>Magical Items</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Amber Wand (MAGIC +1)	500 Shards	-
Ebony Wand (MAGIC +2)	1000 Shards	-
Cobalt Wand (MAGIC +3)	2000 Shards	-
<i>Other Items</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Flute (CHARISMA +1)	200 Shards	-
Silver Flute (CHARISMA +2)	400 Shards	-
Centaur Flute (CHARISMA +3)	800 Shards	-
Lotus Talisman (SANCTITY +1)	200 Shards	150 Shards
Paradise Talisman (SANCTITY +2)	400 Shards	300 Shards
Nirvana Talisman (SANCTITY +3)	700 Shards	550 Shards
Compass (SCOUTING +1)	400 Shards	-
Cross-staff (SCOUTING +2)	800 Shards	-
Sextant (SCOUTING +3)	1200 Shards	-
Mariner’s ruttier	300 Shards	250 Shards
Rope	35 Shards	25 Shards
Candle	2 Shards	1 Shards
Parrot	80 Shards	-
Witch’s hand	300 Shards	-
Water flask	25 Shards	20 Shards
Coral-red tresses	1000 Shards	-
Fishing hook	2 Shards	1 Shard

When you are finished, return to **444**.

125

You are deep in the Cragdrift sea. You are sailing on the latitude of Krateros the city-state, with the Arches of Jarm not too far to the north of your current position.

Head north for the Arches of Jarm	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 171
Head west into coastal waters	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 632
Head due east	turn to 202
Head due south	turn to 704

126

As you get within arm's reach the man's face twists into a macabre grin – a Vampire! He lashes out at you with razor sharp talons. Lose three dice worth of Stamina unless you have the codeword *Impeccable*, then lose the codeword if you had it. If you are dead, the vampire wastes no time regaining its strength by devouring your corpse (turn to **700**). If you still live you jump back with a start. The creature looks up at you in frustration and you realise just how weak it is. It looks as skeletal as a starved hound and can barely raise its arm after trying to attack you. Now that the moon is low in the sky and sunrise is near, you can see the desperation in the vampire's eyes.

Kill it	turn to 510
Interrogate it	turn to 364
Leave it be	turn to 79

127

You ridicule them on their plan to rob the merchant's mansion, and gain their trust. They invite you to join in their attempt and offer you an equal share in the loot. If you wish to join in their robbery attempt you will have to make a THIEVERY roll at a Difficulty of 19.

Successful THIEVERY roll	turn to 424
Failed THIEVERY roll	turn to 267
Refuse their offer and leave	turn to 395

128

The straits are most commonly used by merchants who trade between Auriculum and Kurani. Due to the narrow nature of the straits, they almost exclusively use barques. It takes a degree of skill to navigate larger ships safely through. If you are sailing a brigantine, roll three dice and add your Rank. If you are sailing a galleon, roll only one die and add your Rank:

13 or less	Disaster!	turn to 289
14-19	A minor collision with a merchant ship	turn to 652
20+	Successfully navigated	turn to 675

129

You search all the niche stores and manage to find a number of interesting and powerful items that can be created for you. However in each case they require a rare and exotic item for base materials, in addition to a construction fee. The severed hand of a convicted thief can be made into a Hand of Glory to increase your cunning, a unicorn's horn and vulcanium ore can both be forged into powerful wands, whilst a Ring of Ultimate Power improves your all round skill. If

you wish to have a listed item made for you, ensure that you have the required component and cash, then cross them off and turn to the relevant page number.

*Items to be crafted**Requirements*

Hand of glory	750 Shards and a severed hand	turn to 629
Vulcanium wand	9,000 Shards and vulcanium ore	turn to 36
Rod of woe	3,000 Shards and a unicorn's horn	turn to 389
Ring of Ultimate Power	1,500 Shards and a hyperium wand	turn to 408

If you have none of the times required or do not wish to have an item crafted for you, return to **280**.

130

The two of you fight hard, blocking each other swing for swing. Passing soldiers even stop to watch and place bets. After a marathon fight that leaves both of you sweating profusely and panting for air, you call it a draw. 'A worthy challenge,' he says. 'until next time, my friend.' Increase your unwounded Stamina by 1 point *permanently* and then turn to **39**.

131

You head toward the shore in the cutter, and you can see a few men on their fishing boats returning with the morning's catch. They eye you warily. On the beach you are greeted by a throng of people, whose tanned and weathered skin suggests that they hail from Ankon-Konu. A young girl puts a lay of strange leaves around your neck and the group of excited men and women escort you up to the settlement. Their language is completely foreign, and barely resembles the traditional tongues spoken by tribes along the Nozama river. If you have the codeword *Germinate*, turn to **312** immediately. If you have the title Unspeakable Cultist, turn to **583**. Otherwise, you are sat in a large hut that must be a meeting room of some sort. An ancient looking elder sits in front of a large wooden idol. You are ushered to sit on the straw mats provided. If you have the codeword *Infirm*, turn to **477**. If you do not have the codeword, turn to **216**.

132

Your ship shudders to a halt as if you had just dropped anchor. ‘Real strange, cap’n’ says the bosun anxiously. ‘Its like we’re caught in the grip of the twin gods themselves...’

Suddenly your ship lurches and you realise that you are slowly being dragged under! Looking over the side you can see a pair of thick black tentacles that have attached themselves to the hull with powerful suction cups. Despite your best efforts you simply cannot get the ship free and you can see the level of the water rising as you are slowly pulled under with every second you waste.

‘Abandon ship!’ yells the bosun in panic.

Abandon ship turn to **447**

Try and cut it loose turn to **604**

133

There is a glimmer of recognition and then the sound of bones crunching and grinding as the shark transforms into a humanoid shape. It is so large that its feet touch the base of the sea and it stands chest high in the water. The god’s body is that of a powerful man but its head remains that of a shark, terrifying to look upon. It folds its arms across its chest and looks squarely at you. Although its mouth does not move, you hear a loud voice in your head, booming with such an echo that you feel your skull rattle.

‘I am Heilmir, god of the deep seas, son of the twin Gods.’

The crew look at you in abject fear. If you are an initiate of Heilmir, turn to **626** immediately.

Attack him turn to **393**

Request a blessing turn to **478**

Pledge yourself to him turn to **576**

Flee turn to **275**

134

The priest describes a vision given to him by their deity the All Seeing, an aspect of Molhern. Apparently they foresaw that they would meet you here and have come to initiate you into their order. If you choose to accept, they can initiate you on the spot. Write Molhern in your god box. If you were already an initiate of another god (except the Sage of Peace) erase it and lose all your blessings for incurring the deity’s wrath. The priests then bestow their god’s blessing on you. Write MAGIC in your blessings box. This allows you to reroll any one failed MAGIC roll, after which it must be crossed off.

‘Come to the temple anytime and we can provide you with another blessing,’ says the priest. As you walk away you hear voices down the road as the

priests have found another traveller. ‘The All Seeing has predicted you will journey here...’

Turn to **18**.

135

You approach skilfully, and stand within arm’s length of the nearest one, a youthful looking mermaid with flowing orange hair. You could either:

Make your presence known turn to **92**

Steal something from her satchel turn to **694**

Leave turn to **197**

136

You hear the sound of heavy footfalls heading your way. Make a SCOUTING or THIEVERY roll at a Difficulty of 20, adding 1 if you are a Wayfarer.

Successful SCOUTING or THIEVERY roll turn to **414**

Failed SCOUTING or THIEVERY roll turn to **67**

137

The **casket of gems** is worth 1500 Shards and the **coffer of shards** contains 1800 Shards (cross the items off and add the money to your cash). The other items are a **rakshasa scimitar (COMBAT +5)** and a **stone arrowhead (SCOUTING +4)**. If you took the **obsidian amulet**, note the number **221** and turn to that paragraph in this book anytime you wish to wear it. If you took the **locked chest**, note the page number you are on and turn to **565** in this book when you wish to attempt to open it.

Now, if you took four or fewer items, you manage to sneak out and run to the edge of the forest without being detected. Turn to **358**. If you took five or more items, turn to **95**.

138

You are forced to make camp for the night, but it is freezing up in the mountains, and you are quickly thrown into a fit of shivers. Roll two dice and lose that many stamina unless you have a **wolf pelt** or **fur coat**. If you are still alive, you rejoice when the sun rises the next day and fills your body with warmth. Turn to **528**.

139

Within the first two days of your imprisonment, you are approached by a guard wearing a silk mask that hangs down from his turban to cover the lower half of his face. He opens your cell and leads you down a corridor. Without a word he

undoes your shackles and gives you a nudge out a back door. You count your blessings. Turn to **50**.

140

As the vampires leer at you as their ship draws closer and closer. You hold your hand aloft and call upon the power of your god. Make a SANCTITY roll at a Difficulty of 25.

If you succeed, turn to **484** immediately. Otherwise, you manage to banish one or two if the fiends, but the remainder laugh in triumph as they prepare to board. Turn to **547**.

141

‘Preposterous!’ yells one guard. ‘To think we would allow someone like you into the palace of our royal highness!’ he swings a gauntleted fist into your gut. Lose 1 – 6 Stamina (the roll of one die). ‘Now go back to the gutters where you belong, swine!’

Turn back to **50**.

142

You convince them that you have come to report a matter of political intrigue to the general, and convince them you are neither a spy nor a murderer. They reluctantly allow you to enter the fort. Turn to **708**.

143

You sail on, as if forever, with your cabin boy atop the crows nest constantly scanning the horizon for something... anything...

Finally one morning you hear that fateful cry – ‘Edge!! The Edge of the World!!’ There is a sudden uproar as your crew scramble onto the deck and look out to their doom. Panic sets in and the deck is in chaos. You attempt to keep your cool as you realise that your ship is being pulled faster and faster toward that sharp drop. You can’t help but consider it somewhat poetic as you look upon that undefinable point at which the sky ends and that deep black impenetrable void begins. You are one of the few mortals who have gazed upon the Edge of the World, and your fame will soon spread through seafaring myth. If you didn’t have the codeword *Intricate*, gain 1 CHARISMA, then gain the codeword *Intricate*.

You are snapped out of your reverie with the sudden realisation that you must get control of your ship. Roll three dice and add your Rank. You may add 1 to the roll if you are a Wayfarer and add 2 if you are an initiate of Alvir and Valmir:

24 or less
25 or higher

turn to **710**
turn to **6**

144

‘It is great living here,’ says a merchant, ‘waters protected from piracy, regular guard patrols, cheap spices and adventurers always looking for an exotic bargain.’ He opens up a small box of wares.

<i>Other Items</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Bag of Pearls	100 Shards	80 Shards
Copper Ore	150 Shards	100 Shards
Four-Leaf Clover	25 Shards	20 Shards
Mariner’s Ruttier	200 Shards	150 Shards
Parrot Fungus	200 Shards	170 Shards
Platinum Earring	900 Shards	-
Selenium Ore	350 Shards	280 Shards
Silver Horseshoe	100 Shards	80 Shards
Silver Nugget	100 Shards	70 Shards

Whenever you are finished, return to **50**.

145

You may leave items here if you are about to depart on a mission for Umbart. If you have returned to collect items you must collect all remaining items here or they will be discarded. Umbart will not hold on to them if you aren’t helping him.

Items in Umbart’s Palace

When you have finished here, if you are about to depart on a mission for Umbart, turn back to **552** and continue reading. If you have only come back to collect your items, erase any remaining items left behind and turn to **488** and choose from the list of options remaining.

146

You find a bottle washed up on the shore. You pick it up expecting to find a message or a map to hidden treasure, but to your surprise it is sealed and

contains the most mundane treasure... wine. Note the **bottle of wine** on your list of possession if you wish to keep it. You wander off scratching your head and wondering who could have thrown this overboard, or whether the ship sank, or perhaps...

Turn to **79**.

147 □□□

In the time you have spent with Umbart in his study you have gained some knowledge of ancient languages and how to decipher archaic texts. You pile through the library for anything of interest. Each time you come here, tick a box and choose an ability (CHARISMA, COMBAT, etc.). Roll two dice and if you roll higher than the chosen ability you may add 1 to it. However if you ever roll a double one, you have found a cursed text and must lose 1 from that ability score. If there are no empty boxes remaining, you have exhausted the knowledge here.

Now you could either:

Loot the bodies	turn to 387
Leave the ruins	turn to 198

148

If you are an initiate it costs only 5 Shards to propitiate the twin gods of the sea. A non-initiate must pay 20 Shards. Cross off the money and write Safety from Storms in the Blessings box on your Adventure Sheet. The blessing works by allowing you to ignore any *one* storm at sea. When you use the blessing, cross it off your Adventure Sheet.

You can have only one Safety from Storms blessing at a time. Once it is used up, you can return to any branch of the temple of Alvir and Valmir to buy a new one.

When you are finished here, turn to **50**.

149

Near the base of the pinnacle of rock you see a gaping hole in the waterfall. It is bordered by huge stone statues that look as if they were built aeons ago. A ley line guides your ship toward it and in an instant you are swallowed up by darkness.

Turn to **541** in *Into the Underworld*.

150

You are sailing on the latitude of Teleos and the Sleeping Isle. Kunrir lies far to the north and the Innis Shoals are visible on the horizon to the east.

Head North	turn to 100
Head South	turn to 220

Head West	turn to 27
Head into the Innis Archipelago	turn to 84

151

‘Word has already spread of your deed – you needn’t even tell me the details. You have done very, very well,’ he says shaking your hand. ‘With your identity preserved you will be a great asset to further the goals of the royal family.’

You are awarded the title Royal Assassin. Outside of your private conversations, the Prince treats you like any other visiting guest to ensure that you do not arouse suspicion. As long as your identity as the prince’s assassin remains secret you will be in their employ. You are cautioned to stay out of compromising situations, and as soon as your identity is revealed you will be rescinded by the Prince and punished as a normal criminal.

Prince Alaburdh awards you with gifts from the royal treasury. You receive 2,000 Shards and your choice of one of the following items:

hand of glory (THIEVERY +4)

stone arrowhead (SCOUTING +4)

jade crown (CHARISMA +5)

Furthermore, you rewards you with an item that he says may assist you in further business for the family. He hands you a long, curved dagger with a serrated blade. The hilt is ornate and the blade is decorated with delicate designs, but for all its exquisite beauty it is indeed a deadly weapon. Add the **assassin’s dagger (COMBAT +6)** to your list of possessions. It holds an enchantment that has three charges, which can be expended at any time to reroll a failed THIEVERY roll of your choice (exactly like a blessing). Once the charges are used it is essentially a mundane dagger with a +6 COMBAT bonus.

‘Now get some rest. I will set to work planning your next mission. Unfortunately I cannot offer you favouritism and grant you a room in the palace, but if you do not yet have a place to stay I can arrange a villa for you outside the walls. This should not arouse suspicion.’ If you do not yet have a house in the wealthy district, tick the box next to the ‘villa’ option on **50**. Now, turn to **400**.

152

The monks ask for only a small donation to assist in the upkeep of the temple and feeding the poor. They will heal you of 1 – 6 Stamina (the roll of one die) for 3 Shards or allow you an extended stay to heal 2 – 12 Stamina (roll two dice) for 5 Shards.

When you are finished, cross off the money and turn to **600**.

153

The boy whoops with excitement and flies the carpet down along the coast and over the water. As soon as you reach the middle of the straits you realise that something is wrong. The carpet flies closer and closer to the water. The boy looks shocked 'I don't know what's wrong!' he yelps. You hit the surface of the water. Roll one die and lose that many Stamina. If you are still alive, the strong currents that help ships pass through the straits works against you and despite how hard you try to swim toward the land you are pulled out into the Sea of Stilts.

'You owe me 250 Shards!' you yell out to the boy as he floats off into the distance. Gain the codeword Turn to **447**.

154

Unfortunately your recent transaction and your criminal record have drawn too much attention. You turn to leave, only to bump right into a very large patrol of the town guard. They have you shackled and take you down an alley in order to threaten you. You will be taken directly to jail and have all your money confiscated unless you agree to their terms. 10,000 Shards to have your entire criminal record wiped. Either way you will lose the money...

Refuse to be extorted	turn to 71
Agree to their terms	turn to 673

155

They welcome you into their event, and the head acolyte Virji Delwatha happy to have someone from abroad in their group. You spend time discussing your adventures and your various misdeeds whilst the young man protests. Finally his incessant whining is ended when you are given the honour to sacrifice him to the Demon Lord Kumba Karna whom they worship.

During your various discussions on belief and sacrifice, the Virji mentions that there is a place you may like to visit in the Sea of Stilts. 'I was initiated into the arms of our Lord Kumba Karna many years ago on an island there. It must be one of the only places outside of the underworld where you may undergo the initiation rite.' He tells you to sail into open waters north east of Chrysoprais and you will find it. Bidding you farewell you part your separate ways in good spirits. Turn to **4**.

156

You sail away at top speed and the merchant's abuse fades off in the distance. Gain the codeword *Incomplete* and turn to **675**.

157 □

If the box above is empty, put a tick in it and read on. If it was already ticked, turn to **674** immediately. Their faces contort into what you can only surmise is a smile. They thank you and offer you a service in return. Any gear they may make is far too large for you to carry, so instead they take you hunting and teach you the ancient techniques of the Rakshasa. You spend hours crouched in trees, covered in overgrowth and smeared with animal faeces but it is all worth while. Gain one point of SCOUTING. If you are a Wayfarer, you find their approach to life and hunting extremely interesting and manage to modify your own techniques in life of their ancient ways. Roll four dice and if they total higher than your Rank, gain 1 Rank. Note that this will increase your normal unwounded Stamina score by the roll of one die.

After a few weeks they bid you farewell and you are escorted safely to the edge of the forest. Turn to **615**.

158

If you have the codeword *Jury*, inexplicably the abbot initiates you on the spot. Turn back to **268**. Otherwise, you will have to be instructed in the sacred doctrine. To comprehend this doctrine requires a SANCTITY roll at a Difficulty of 16. Success means you are made an initiate. The monks are open-minded and aren't bothered if you were already an initiate of another god; you can be both. You can renounce initiate status of the Sage of Peace freely at any time.

If you attempt the SANCTITY roll and fail it, the doctrine is so confusing that you must lose 1 from your SANCTITY score.

Turn to **268**.

159

You show him the punishment for thievery. He wails in panic as you line him up on a boulder and cut off one of his hands. You set the bandit free, assuring him that his pilfering days are well and truly over. Gain the codeword *Indirect*.

Make a MAGIC roll at a difficulty of 17. Add 2 to your roll if you are a Rogue.

Successful MAGIC roll	turn to 355
Failed MAGIC roll	turn to 528

160

You behead the bosun in front of the crew and then throw the rest of the traitorous dogs into the sea to be judged by the gods. Raiding their spoils you find a meagre sum of 200 Shards, which you may add to your Adventure

Sheet. You send your apprentice navigator and some of you nonessential crew aboard and they should be able to make it back to Mithdrak without too much hassle. Reduce your crew quality by one category (to a minimum of poor).

Lose the codeword *Ill* or *Just* (you may choose which one to lose if you have both) and note your old ship back on your Ship's Manifest. The crew quality is poor, it has one cargo unit of textiles and is currently docked at Mithdrak. Now turn to **150** to continue your voyage.

161

The ship begins to crumble and you are stuck by a falling cross beam. Roll two dice and lose that many stamina. If you are still alive, despite your efforts the fire takes hold of your whole ship and you are forced to abandon it. Cross your ship and crew off the manifest and turn to **447**.

162

A passing priest tells you that most religious pilgrims take great voyages from distant lands, seeking the Saint of Vulture's Peak. 'He is said to be the very first initiate of the Sage of Peace over a thousand years ago,' he says. 'He can help you forgive yourself.' You raise an eyebrow. 'Don't you mean he can forgive my sins?' you ask quizzically. The priest just looks at you plainly and walks off as you are suddenly accosted by a throng of beggars crying 'Alms!'

You can either ignore them and turn back to **300**, or you can give them some money. Decide how much you will give them and cross the money off your adventure sheet as they pick up the coins greedily and scurry away. Turn to **420**.

163

You are standing on the docking platform at the base of Umbart's palace. The towering mansion looks as if it were piece torn from Mithdrak, with the same gaudy expensive gold, purple and red spires. A large set of double doors lies atop a grand staircase. If you have a ship docked here, you notice that it remains remarkably unaffected by the powerful waves that caused you so much hassle when you arrived. If you wish to set sail away from the vortex, turn to **52**. If you do not have a ship here you will have to find another way back to civilisation.

The doors appear to be the only entrance, and as you approach them you notice that they are unlocked and slightly ajar. A butler greets you at the door. To your amazement, it is a trau – the dark shadowy denizens of the underworld. It grins a wide and unnerving smile as it ushers you in. 'Master Umbart has been expecting you... yes, indeed...'

Turn to **488**.

164

You watch for the right time and snap out your hand and grab the pebble. Indeed his hand is empty and you hold out the pebble victoriously, surprised at how easy the test was. The abbot shakes his head and walks off, leaving you standing confused in the middle of the temple.

You may not attempt to become an initiate of the Sage of Peace again until you have either increased your SANCTITY score by at least 1 point, or until you have gained a Rank. Note this on your adventure sheet and turn back to **662**.

165

Umbart listens to your story intently. Unless you have the codeword *Hollow*, he simply doesn't believe your fanciful tale – there are too many inconsistencies. The wizard has his trau servants usher you back to your ship and tell you to leave the vortex. Turn to **52** immediately. If you do not have a ship docked here, turn to **616**.

If you do have the codeword *Hollow*, you explain the rest of your fantastic tale and he claps his hands with glee. 'This will make a great addition to my new research paper!' he clicks his fingers and a trau servant escorts you to collect a reward. Turn to **7**.

166

'You need not ask for what you already have,' says the saint as he disappears in the blink of an eye. Gain one point of COMBAT. You descend the peak. Turn to **524**.

167

You are hauled aboard a ship and as soon as you get on deck you realise your misfortune. It is a pirate ship. The eyes of the crew gleam with greed as they divest you of all your money and possessions. Cross the off your character sheet and turn to **472** in *Over the Blood-Dark Sea*.

168 □

If the box above is ticked, turn to **714**. If it was empty, put a tick in it and continue reading. You dive down and see a large pouch nestled amongst some sparkling clean Shards. With your breath pushing to its limit you grab the pouch and swim back to shore. You find a small pouch of what must have been someone's finest treasures – 450 Shards, a **potion of stealth (THIEVERY +1)** and a **catastrophe certificate**. You wonder why the catastrophe certificate

didn't save the poor sailor losing his riches... perhaps it is in the definition of 'catastrophe'?

Turn to **79**.

169

If you fail to hold them off you will surely be devoured. Luckily the sun has not yet set and the ghosts are not at their strongest. Make a SANCTITY roll at a Difficulty of 15.

Successful SANCTITY roll	turn to 716
Failed SANCTITY roll	turn to 700

170

The black snake-headed demon, Iibyyrsh the Lesser awaits you in her temple. You could request a blessing or make a resurrection arrangement with her. The option to renounce worship of Kumba Karna is also available, but you expect it will carry a hefty penalty. Iibyyrsh also points out that here is an entrance to the Land of Roots here if you wish to use it.

Request a blessing	turn to 646
Make resurrection arrangements	turn to 196
Deposit items for resurrection	turn to 669
Renounce Kumba Karna	turn to 37
Leave the island	turn to 266

171

A mysterious island looms up ahead, pinpricks of flame glowing in the cover of night. The bosun gets a shiver and shakes his head. 'We'll not follow you there cap'n,' he says.

Take the cutter to the island	turn to 581
Ignore it and continue on	turn to 450

172

Waters this close to the vortex are known for their frequent and ferocious storms. Roll two dice:

2 – 6	A storm on the horizon	turn to 305
7	An uneventful journey	turn to 625
8 – 11	A ship in distress	turn to 273
12	Carapace. Note this paragraph number	turn to 74

173

Maratha Suresh informs you that he has finally received his title and is now a Knight! 'But, I do so enjoy travelling the paths and practicing my swordplay with strangers,' he says. 'I think I will continue until we are called upon for war.'

You have grown to know Suresh well through your duels and conversations, and you spend a good few hours practicing and discussing swordplay. Eventually, the two of you part ways. Turn to **39**.

174

As soon as you hoist the body aboard and move to inspect it you realise why he must have been thrown overboard. The body is diseased and now you and a number of your crew are infected. You are now suffering from the Red Ague, which reduced your CHARISMA and COMBAT ratings by 1 each until you can find a cure. If you had a blessing of Immunity to Disease/Poison, cross it off now and you are unaffected. On his body you find a small pouch of 50 Shards hidden in his boot. The rest of his items must have been stolen by his callous crewmen. The grizzly find has not done well for crew morale. Reduce your crew quality by one step (if it was already Poor it remains unchanged). Turn to **350**.

175

You are sailing in the shallower waters between Chysoprais and the western continent of Atticala. The port of Hopias lies to the west and you estimate Teleos to be somewhere north.

Head north to coastal waters	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 138
Head west toward Hopias	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 710
Sail southwest along the coast to Kurani	turn to 382

176

You haven't noticed that your lust to know your future has been slowly driving you mad. Finally you give into your temptation and read your entire life history, from beginning to end. You come to the pages that tell of your insanity as you read your entire life story and how the priests could do nothing to save you from gibbering madness but to erase your memory.

You awaken in a bed, priests by your side and handmaidens placing towels over your forehead to cool your fever. You don't remember where you are, or why you have suddenly aged a few years... or did you just lose the last few years of your life? You stand up and start pacing. You seem to be able to walk, talk and do things like a normal person, but some of your skills are not

intact. Lose 1 point from all of your Ability scores (CHARISMA, COMBAT, etc.) and reduce your Rank by 2. Your Stamina remains unchanged as you are physically fine but your sense of identity is gone. Erase your profession and choose a new one. The priests insist that it must be different from your previous Profession as your old behaviours could remind you of your lost memories and reinduce the madness. The priests refuse to give you your old gear for the same reason. Instead they give you the choice of any three of the following items which they have obtained from other adventurers who had befallen the same fate:

Centaur flute (CHARISMA +3)
Scimitar (COMBAT +3)
Ebony wand (MAGIC +2)
Nirvana Talisman (SANCTITY +3)
Sextant (SCOUTING +3)
Gloves of Sig (THIEVERY +3)

In addition they give you 150 Shards, a suit of **splint armour (Defence +4)**, and a **verdigris key**. ‘This key will open the doors to new adventures in your new life,’ says the head priest. ‘May the All Seeing watch over you.’ You return to the world. Turn to **29**.

177

‘What a pity,’ Lakha says, though the emotion on his tiger face is completely undefinable. Nevertheless, we thank you for the effort. He rummages around in a belt pouch the size of your rucksack and hands you something you are sure has come from the dead body of another adventurer. ‘You could probably use this more than us,’ he says. The third one chuckles – ‘That rag wouldn’t even fit my little son!’

Add the **chameleon cloak (THIEVERY +3)** to your Adventure Sheet if you wish to take it. Note that it can be sold at any marketplace for 500 Shards. Lose the codeword *Implore*. Lakha then escorts you to the edge of the forest and bids you farewell. Turn to **615**.

178

The royal family hold political power in Mithdrak, and as such anything that would divert focus from the King and Prince has been pushed to the margins, including religious worship. The worship of the Sage of Peace, famous for his influence in Akatsurai, actually originated in Chrysoprais, and temple exists here in Mithdrak. A small temple to the twin gods of the sea found hidden in a remote area, and a passer-by suggests that you visit the distant city of Auriculum where the royal family has less sway. It is said to be the religious capital of Chrysoprais.

Visit the temple to the Sage of Peace	turn to 662
Visit the temple of Alvir and Valmir	turn to 599
Return to the city centre	turn to 50

179

If you do not have the codeword *Increment*, turn to **586** immediately. If you do have the codeword, lose it and continue reading.

Your hook snags a fish, and you hoist it out of the water. You raise your knife as you prepare to gut it and a familiar voice cries out. ‘Spare me and I shall reward... erk!’ the water sprite has recognised you. You spend a good hour berating it for its cheek and eventually force it to give you the reward. It tells you to follow the river to the bend 100 metres upstream and plunge your arm into the silt. Still suspicious you carry the sprite with you and do as he says. Your hand closes around a small box and as you are distracted the sprite leaps from your hand and into the water. It turns and pokes its tongue out before swimming off... the curse has made you lose all your blessings again! Nevertheless, you pull the small box out and open it. Inside are a number of pieces of jewellery obviously stolen from passersby. They amount to 400 Shards (note the money directly on your Adventure Sheet). Among the stolen items is a **severed hand** which you can take if you wish. You cringe to think what these sprites have been up to...

Turn to **395**.

180

You purview all the goods available – they are all of tremendous value! The Shards are stamped with a face you have never seen before and must be antiques. Weapons crafted by the Rakshasa are huge, making their short swords look like scimitars in your hands.

Take as much of the following loot as you think you can carry:

Casket of gems
Rakshasa Scimitar
Obsidian amulet
Verdigris key
Coffer of coins
Tatsu pearl
Stone arrowhead
Sapphire pendant
Locked chest

Add what you wish to take to your list of possessions and then turn to **137**.

181

There is little else to do here but leave. If you have a ship docked in the Innis Shoals, you may set sail. Otherwise, you have very limited choices. There are only two other captains here willing to take you on board, and they will charge an exorbitant fee. If you do not have the cash required you will have to pay them double the fee when you reach a bank in the relevant port (cross off the payment as soon as you arrive).

Pay 95 Shards for passage to Mithdrak

Pay 55 Shards for passage to Aku

Pay 35 Shards for passage to Dweomer

Sail west into the Sea of Stilts

Sail east into the Violet Ocean

turn to **8**

The Court of Hidden Faces **444**

Over the Blood-Dark Sea **242**

turn to **617**

Over the Blood-Dark Sea **96**

182

You are simply not powerful enough. The Saint manages to grasp your wrist and his touch sears your flesh like a hot poker. You feel your whole body combust from the inside as you are immolated by a holy flame. There is no trace left of you but ash blown away in the wind. Your tormented soul has been banished, and there is no chance of resurrection. Erase all codewords and tick boxes and begin a new character from paragraph **1** in any *Fabled Lands* book.

183

You cannot help them and must continue on your voyage. Your crew appear despondent and fear that a similar fate could befall them in the future if they continue to serve you. Reduce your crew quality by one step (no lower than poor) and lose one of the codewords *Ill* or *Just*. If you have both you may choose which one to lose. Turn to **150**.

184

You marvel at the stupidity of the followers of the Sage of Peace. Even after the Saint's demise they still follow with blind faith, flocking to this peak like a swarm of hungry insects. Pathetic.

Return to **300** and choose an option from the list.

185

You make a donation of 10 Shards to help feed the poor, and you spend some time with your fellow monks and feel refreshed and ready to experience new wonders of the world. Restore 1 – 6 Stamina if injured (the roll of one die). You may also make a SANCTITY roll at a Difficulty of 17. If you succeed, write 'Luck' in the Blessings box on your Adventure Sheet. The Sage of Peace can be called on to

help his followers at any time. The blessing can be used once to allow you to reroll any dice result, after which you must cross it off your Adventure Sheet. Remember that you can have only one Luck blessing at a time, and once it is used you will have to get a new one.

Turn to **300**.

186

The road between the Crimson Fort and Kurani is relatively quiet. You occasionally pass a troop of soldiers heading to Kurani on leave, and merchants transporting supplies of metals and smithing equipment to the keep. Roll two dice:

2 – 4 A thief! turn to **644**

5 – 9 An uneventful journey turn to **39**

10 – 12 A challenge turn to **555**

187

You are admitted immediately and General Singh shakes your hand vigorously. 'Good, I assume that by your being here you have delivered the message I asked?' If you have the codeword *Juniper*, turn to **531**. If you have the codeword *Jury*, the General is outraged and can only surmise that you are a spy. Turn to **486** immediately.

If you have neither of these codewords, he scowls at you. 'I said the message was to be delivered with haste!' he yells and you are quickly put in shackles. You are beaten in front of a crowd of onlookers and degraded. You have set back the General's plans for expansion of the empire, but at what cost to yourself? Roll three dice and lose that many Stamina. If you are still alive you are kicked out of the fort. Turn to **244**.

188

Using the information you have gathered, you steer your ship on the right course, locating a deep sea ley line that will carry you over the Edge of the World safely to Iambus. You repeatedly consult your maps, make calculations and pray for blind luck as you near the precipice.

'Hold on for your lives, lads!' yells the bosun as he straps himself to the mast. Your crew's faith in you is admirable, but you barely have confidence yourself!

Your ship teeters on the edge and the ley line pulls it through the waterfall, sea foam blinding you. As you leave the mortal world behind, day turns into night and the sky above is nothing but eternal starlit darkness. You see an enormous needle of rock projecting from the edge of the world that was

not visible from sea level. You marvel at the gothic city that has been built around it, defying the laws of gravity, with buildings overflowing in all directions.

Turn to **391**.

189

Not a wise decision as you realise that someone of such standing in Chrysoprais is likely to have powerful friends. As you walk around the palace grounds you feel your heart sink. You are under the Curse of Covetousness. As long as you have the **golden katana** in your possession (on your person or in any of your houses) you must reduce all your Abilities by 1 point. The curse will be lifted the moment you rid yourself of the item by selling, trading or discarding it. You may also have the curse lifted in the normal manner, such as a priest or wizard.

Turn to **400**.

190

Roll two dice:

2 – 5	A sea beast!	turn to 132
6 – 8	An uneventful voyage	turn to 450
9 – 12	An uncharted island	turn to 171

191

Your only chance is to slay them as quickly as possible. Make a COMBAT roll at a Difficulty of 23. If you fail, turn to **256** immediately. If you succeed, you slay one of them with such speed and efficiency that the others panic and flee. The vampires seem to take the death of tra as a common occurrence and walk off disinterested. On the body of the tra you find 200 Mithrals and some **vulcanium ore**, which you can add to your Adventure Sheet if you wish.

Turn to **330**.

192

You spot a large island up ahead. It appears to be inhabited with ramshackle huts not unlike those you might find in Smogmaw. A small bay is lined with quaint fishing vessels no larger than a canoe. The whole thing seems very out of place for the Sea of Stilts.

Dock at the island	turn to 15
Sail on	turn to 275

193

The storm whips up the sea into white-frothed grey breakers. If you have a blessing of Safety from Storms, cross it off and turn to **575**. Otherwise turn to **767**.

194

Now you will have to make your escape. You must make a THIEVERY roll at a Difficulty of 17 plus one for every item you took from the treasury. If you succeed, turn to **744** immediately. If you fail, you are caught red-handed and executed the next day. Record the codeword *Incomplete* if you didn't already have it and lose the codeword *Indefatigable* and the title Royal Assassin if you had them. Turn to **700**.

195

The temple seems rather understaffed for a building of such size, but nevertheless there is a priest available to induct you. If you wish to become an initiate of Nagil you cannot be an initiate of any other god even the Sage of Peace. Whilst the Sage who is predominantly worshipped in Chrysoprais is not a jealous god, many other gods are, including Nagil.

You will have to undergo a rite of passage in order to prove yourself to the god of death. You are buried up to your neck in the ground and made to wait a sleepless night without panicking. If you roll equal to or less than your Rank on three dice, erase any gods in your god box and write 'Nagil'. Now turn to **380**.

196

As an initiate, a resurrection arrangement will cost you only 100 Mithrals. Ilibyrsh explains that Kumba Karna will intercept your soul and send it back to the world of the living. However, she warns you that demon lords cannot tolerate piety, and if he senses that you have strayed from his path he will not return you to life and you will be damned for eternity.

If you wish to purchase the resurrection arrangement, write 'Isle of Kumba, *Isle of a Thousand Spires* **40**' in your arrangement box and cross off the 100 Mithrals. You will be returned to life here, and Ilibyrsh allows you leave items with her for safekeeping, which she can return to you when you are resurrected. Turn to **669** to deposit items.

When you have made the necessary amendments, turn back to **170**.

197

Now will you head toward Mithdrak or the Temple of the Eye?

To Mithdrak	turn to 50
To the temple	turn to 29

198 □

If the box above is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading. If it is already ticked, turn to **615** immediately. You turn to leave the forest and behold an amazing sight. Standing before you is a pure white deer with great horns that look like solid silver. It is a celestial stag.

Approach it turn to **470**
Leave turn to **615**

199 □□

You draw your first breath of a new life. Put a tick in an empty box above and then write Vulture's Peak, *The Isle of a Thousand Spires* **199** in your Resurrection Arrangement box. If all the boxes are now full, then the arrangement you have just received is your last resurrection arrangement with the Saint and he cannot help you any further, asking you to find your own way along the path of enlightenment.

You are still in a daze and the sound of the winds at the top of the peak are deafening. The sounds slowly fade into the distance and you sit up, rubbing your eyes. Inexplicably, you are lying at the base of Vulture's peak, surrounded by curious pilgrims and priests. As you stand, you notice that you are dressed in undyed robes of a priest, and hanging around your neck is a **dorje pendant (SANCTITY +4)**. Note this on your list of possessions. The journey between life and death has given you a chance to contemplate the meaning of your existence. If you are a priest, roll two dice and if you roll higher than your SANCTITY score, add 1 to it. If you belong to any other profession you gain no benefit, however you may now change your profession to Priest if you wish.

Turn to **300**.

200

You have accomplished a great feat. Even the blacksmith praises you on your craftsmanship. You have returned the weapon to its former glory. Cross off the **ancient scimitar** and replace it with a **Rana scimitar (COMBAT +6)**. The blacksmith is well versed in weapons lore and tells you that these blades are very rare and have been made by great craftsmen since the dawn of Chrysopraisian history. You learn that one is wielded by Prince Azimishtra himself, and others have been used as gifts in trade negotiations between Chrysopraia and the other great nations of the *Fabled Lands*.

It is indeed a beautiful sight, the curved blade so highly polished that it displays your undistorted reflection. Furthermore, it still retains an ancient enchantment that was laid on it centuries ago. When the blade is thrown into the ground, the pommel will always point unerringly north. There is still enough magic left in it for three charges, which can be used to reroll any failed SCOUTING roll of

your choice (exactly like a blessing). Once the charges are used it is essentially a mundane scimitar with a +6 COMBAT bonus, though perhaps the enchantment could be replenished somehow?

Now return to the entry you were previously reading.

201

There is no chance that the Saint will show himself to someone as impure as yourself. Demon Lord Kæla Karna taught you the dark incantation required to force him to manifest. 'Show yourself, coward!' you yell as you hold your hands in the correct somatic gesture.

The Saint materialises with a look of apprehension on his face. 'May your soul rest in peace,' he says quietly as he reaches out to banish you. If you have a **unicorn's horn**, a **rod of woe** or a **wand** with a MAGIC bonus of +6 or higher (such as a **hyperium wand**), turn to **544** immediately. Otherwise, you will have to make a MAGIC roll at a difficulty of 27.

Successful MAGIC roll turn to **544**
Failed MAGIC roll turn to **182**

202

The waters of the Cragdrift Sea this far north are particularly cold. If you were to be tossed overboard you would surely freeze to death. Roll two dice:

2 – 6	A body in the water	turn to 254
7 – 11	An uneventful voyage	turn to 350
12	Carapace. Note this paragraph number	turn to 74

203

The guard falls limp and you place him gently on the ground. With haste you disrobe him and trade clothes, lying him in the corner of the room. Hopefully none of the other guards will look too closely! You lock the cell with the guard's keys and head down the corridor. You will have to make a THIEVERY or SCOUTING roll at a Difficulty of 18 in order to navigate the maze-like dungeon. If you succeed, turn to **705**. If you fail, you become lost and are eventually spotted by a patrol. They chase you down and tackle you to the floor. Turn to **637**.

204

From a distance you recognise the Iambic pentameters... vampire ships! You have the chance to flee before they get too close. If you wish to flee, turn to **359**. Otherwise you could attempt to call upon the power of your god, but you will have to wait until they are close enough to board. In the meantime, you

prepare the men for the fight of their lives. You bolster their spirits and strengthen their resolve. Gain the codeword *Impeccable*.

The ships make their approach, changing vector to intercept you. The vampire crew are dressed in dull grey and black robes, fingers adorned with rings that only serve to make their flesh look more like ivory. They lean over the side of their ship to get a good look at you and your crew. You cannot hope to fight all three ships and they look intent to board. Even if you were to ram one ship, the other two will board. You could:

Turn them back with holy words	turn to 140
Prepare to be boarded	turn to 547

205

You find all manner of trinkets and souvenirs being sold by priests outside their tents. ‘All proceeds go toward housing the poor’ says a bald Akatsurese monk as he sits on a mat eating his meagre breakfast. A few items are laid out in front of him:

<i>Other items</i>	<i>To buy</i>	<i>To sell</i>
Lotus Talisman (SANCTITY +1)	200 Shards	-
Paradise Talisman (SANCTITY +2)	400 Shards	-
Catastrophe Certificate	-	450 Shards
Parchment	8 Shards	5 Shards
Paper Sword	15 Shards	10 Shards

When you are finished, he also mentions in passing that you can make a donation to the poor. He guarantees that your money will be put to good use building shelters and providing food and medical treatment for the needy. If you do so, decide how much you will donate and turn to **420**. If not, you can return to **300** and choose again.

206

As you make your way upstairs, you see a traveller open one of the doors. Beyond it is a portal of glowing blue energy. The magic in the air is tangible, however other people in the temple appear unaffected by the wonder you are experiencing right now. More than a dozen doors, each with its own ornate plaque displayed boldly above; Yellowport, Dweomer, Chambara... the list goes on!

‘You look like the adventuring sort,’ says a man nearby. He wears voluminous robes and bears an ancient looking key in one hand. ‘If you do not have your own means of transportation I can provide one-way travel to any destination for a small fee of 100 Shards.’

You will require a **veridgris key** to unlock one of the doors. Otherwise, the scholar will unlock one for you, allowing you to step through (cross the money off). If you wish to travel, turn to the listed paragraph in the relevant book. If not, return to **29**.

Aku	<i>The Court of Hidden Faces</i> 10
Auriculum	turn to 380
Chambara	<i>Lords of the Rising Sun</i> 79
Dunpala	<i>The Serpent-King's Domain</i> 85
Dweomer	<i>Over the Blood-Dark Sea</i> 100
Krateros	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 23
Metriensis	<i>Cities of Gold and Glory</i> 48
Pethumar	<i>The Lone and Level Sands</i> 85
Ruined Tarshesh	<i>The Serpent-King's Domain</i> 672
Sky Mountain	<i>The Plains of Howling Darkness</i> 185
Thanatos Caverns	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 561
The Isle of Druids	<i>The War-torn Kingdom</i> 65
The Isle of Mystery	<i>The Plains of Howling Darkness</i> 121
The City of Stargazers	<i>the Lone and Level Sands</i> 134
Trefoille	<i>The War-torn Kingdom</i> 670

207

You sneak into the bed chamber and approach the sleeping figure. With one swift thrust you drive your weapon into his heart. You quickly discover that you have fallen for the ruse, as all that lies in the bed is a stuffed manikin. You realise your foolishness – obviously the general would take measures to protect himself from such a banal assassination attempt. An alarm screams in your ears and you hear the booted footfalls of a guard patrol running toward the room. The manikin must have been warded magically.

Gain the codeword *Ingrate*. You have little time escape, and your only option is the window. If you have a **rope**, turn to **123**. If not, you are quickly cornered. Turn to **361**.

208

The nobleman you are speaking with explains that Umbart’s Vortex is an artificially generated whirlpool, constructed by manipulating the ley lines that lie along the deep sea bed. ‘The wizard Umbart is an avid underworld researcher,’ he explains. ‘He thinks that by stabilising the whirlpool he created he will be able to fashion a permanent portal there.’

You muse about the sanity of some of these wizards. The man explains that Umbart has a floating palace above the vortex, and there is only

one safe path to reach it. Gain the codeword *Illiad*. ‘Be careful though,’ he adds, ‘even sailing around the vortex is treacherous due to its magical influence on storm activity. A good gale could capsize a small ship even with the best crew in all the *Fabled Lands*!’ Turn to **356**.

209

You notice that your piece of driftwood is being pulled away from you. The strength of the pull draws you in, gradually getting stronger and stronger. Your heart sinks as you realise where you are – Umbart’s Vortex. Despite your futile efforts to swim away you are drawn into the powerful torrents and tossed over and over. All that awaits you is the gaping black maw into the underworld.

Roll three dice and add your Rank. You may add 1 if you are a Wayfarer and an additional 1 if you are an initiate of Alvir and Valmir.

19 or less	You are drowned	turn to 700
20 +	You are sucked into the void	<i>Into the Underworld</i> 726

210

You spend some time talking with a merchant from Pethumar who frequently trades for textiles from Auriculum. He has heard that timber is a great commodity in Chrysoprais, but coming from a desert country he obviously has none to trade. It sparks your interest. ‘Why is timber in demand when Chrysoprais has its own forests?’ you ask. ‘See that’s the thing,’ he explains, ‘both their forests are haunted, so no commonfolk will log there! I hear that in their native tongue, Apsara means ghost or spectre of the departed...’

If you have the codeword *Incomplete* and not the codeword *Face*, turn to **596**. Otherwise, you can continue to rest here beyond three days and recover Stamina as long as you like, turning to **380** when finished.

211

Your ship is buffeted by a wave as three ships burst out of the ocean. They are galleons from the underworld, manned by the twisted bodies of the dead and captained by lesser demons. Their faces leer at you as the pack plot a course to intercept. To fight would be utter foolishness, leaving only two options.

Try to outrun the ships	turn to 513
Stay and surrender or parley	turn to 643

212

The deep sea god Heilmir whom you angered bursts forth in the form of a colossal shark and swallows you whole. You slide down into his cavernous stomach and are immersed in powerful stomach acids. Roll ten dice and lose that many Stamina. If

you are still alive, you manage to swim to a raised fleshy island, where the remnants of previous fools are still being digested. Aside from teleportation, there is absolutely no way you will escape and you will soon be immersed in acid again. Luckily, being that you are actually *inside* a god, the area counts as a temple in the event you have a means of escape, such as a **sacred rod of teleportation** or Targdaz’s Recall Spell. If you do not, you will die a slow and excruciatingly painful death. Turn to **700**. If you do have an escape plan, you will have just enough time to search the nearby body of a hapless adventurer, though you will only have enough time to grab one item at random.

Roll a die to see what you find.

Score 1 – 2	hand of glory (THIEVERY +4)
Score 3 – 4	vajra baton (SANCTITY +5)
Score 5 – 6	stone arrowhead (SCOUTING +4)

213

Men and goods are washed overboard by huge waves that snap your hawsers like twine. Lose 1 Cargo Unit (if you have any cargo) and reduce your crew quality by one step – i.e. an excellent crew becomes good, a good crew becomes average, and an average crew becomes poor. (A poor crew can’t get any worse!) At last the storm blows itself out. Turn to **539**.

214 □□□

If all three boxes are already ticked, turn to **173**. You learn that the man’s name is Maratha Suresh and he is looking to become a Crimson Knight. He will challenge you multiple times. Each time you duel him, put a tick in the box above. The man is delighted and he drops his pack, pulling out two curved wooden swords that resemble the weight and balance of the traditional talwar of Chrysopraisan warriors. He hands you one and then turns to you, raising his wooden sword above his head. Look at the boxes above and for each additional tick beyond the first, add 1 to his COMBAT, Defence and Stamina values.

Knight-in-training	COMBAT 10	Defence 20	Stamina 25
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You must duel without aid of items that increase your COMBAT or Defence values as the knight says it must be a fair match – only skill and experience is a factor. Note down your current Stamina value in brackets. This is not a duel to the death, so when either of you is reduced to zero Stamina, restore your Stamina to the number in brackets (bruises heal quickly).

If you reduce him to zero Stamina	turn to 473
If he reduces you to zero Stamina	turn to 233
If neither of you can damage each other	turn to 130

215

As the leader raises his knife above the young man's chest, you deftly topple two of the restraining men and grab the knife. Slashing the leader's throat to wheel around and level the knife at the heart of another man, glaring into his eyes with unrelenting rage. The group as so taken aback by your sudden and dramatic action that they begin to panic. Your demonstration was so intimidating that they all flee! Roll two dice and if they total higher than your CHARISMA score you may add 1 to it. Turn to **520**.

216

The old man grins a toothy smile and a gang of tribesmen move in to apprehend you. There is only one exit and your only chance may be to fight your way to it and run, though if you had crew here you will have to forsake them. Alternately, you could attempt to take the village elder hostage and hope that they will free your crew if they were with you. Though if you were to fail, there would be no other escape.

Fight your way out	turn to 13
Take a hostage	turn to 287

217

Whilst you are spending time at the harbour, knowledge of your cargo spreads and you are soon confronted by the mayor or Carapace, who insists that you leave their island. 'This kind of behaviour will not be tolerated here,' he says, as a retinue of his men confiscate your slaves (cross any cargo units of slaves off your Ship's Manifest). They will be set free and granted citizenship of Carapace or sent back to their homelands. Gain the codeword *Ignoble* and turn to **60**.

218

If you have the codeword *Ingenious*, turn to **18** immediately. A party of priests from the Temple of the Eye make their way toward you purposefully. They have long flowing robes and the leader in the centre wears a mask displaying a large solitary unlicked eye. As soon as he reaches you he raises a hand and the group halt. 'The All Seeing has predicted you will journey here.'

If you have the title *Illuminate* of Molhern, or are an initiate of Molhern, or are a Priest by profession, turn to **606**. Otherwise, turn to **134**.

219

They seem happy to have you resolve their argument and give you 5 Shards for your help. Unfortunately a few minutes down the path you realise that your belt pouch feels significantly lighter. The canny women robbed you and then paid you

with your own money! Cross off all but 5 Shards from your cash. If you were carrying less than 5 Shards anyway, cross it all off. You turn back to find them but they are long gone. Turn to **448**.

220

Policing of piracy in the Sea of Stilts extends all the way to the Innis Shoals, however a few daring pirates make a living by evading the law around here.

Roll two dice:

2 – 3	Pirates as feared	turn to 97
4 – 5	A storm brewing	turn to 680
7 – 9	An uneventful journey	turn to 525
10 – 12	A man in the water	turn to 357

221

Make a MAGIC roll at a Difficulty of 22. If you succeed, you realise the **obsidian amulet** is cursed and can discard it if you wish (cross it off your Adventure Sheet unless you wish to retain it). If you fail, the realisation comes too late as the moment you put the amulet around your neck it begins to constrict. You are now afflicted with the Curse of Strangulation, and you cannot remove the **obsidian amulet** until you have the curse removed. Each time you turn to a new entry you must lose one point from your *unwounded and current* Stamina scores as the necklace gradually strangles you to death. If you are reduced to zero Stamina (either wounded or unwounded) you are of course dead and must turn to **700**. Note that when you have the curse lifted or if you are resurrected, your normal unwounded Stamina score will return to its normal value. Now turn back to the entry you were reading... and lose one Stamina...

222 □

If you have the codeword *Jury*, turn to **566** immediately.

If the box above is ticked, return to **600** and choose from the options presented there. If it was empty, put a tick in it and continue reading. As you are strolling through the city, you are met by a contingent of turbaned elite city guard. The captain explains that your mission from the Crimson Fort is of great importance and Lady Nasitha wishes to meet with you and discuss how she may be of assistance. You are lead to one of the largest buildings in the city, extravagant and colourful but obviously no match for the royal palace in Mithdrak. You are led inside, seated and offered a glass of fine wine and surrounded by platters of exotic foods. Soon after you arrive, Lady Nasitha enters the room and greets you by name. news must travel fast!

She is a plain looking Chrysopraisian woman, dressed in regal gowns and carrying a case of documents at her side. From what you have heard, she is one of the many bureaucrats vying for control in this city. Prince Azimishtra does little to manage it so the duty often rests on the more reliable lords and ladies.

‘I understand that General Singh of the independent barony of the Crimson Fort wishes to declare war on Atticala,’ she says, eyes filled with great concern. ‘I believe this course of action is unwise, especially Kurani in its current state. If the Atticalan navy in Hopias were to refuse to retreat and instead launch a counterattack on our shores, we would be done for,’ she explains. ‘Of course, the Crimson Fort would have little difficulty holding off an extended siege, and as such I understand Singh’s brazen move. If instead we were to encourage peace between our two great nations, I believe we could move forward and build a stronger... and safer relationship between Chrysoprais and Atticala.’

Lady Nasitha asks how comfortable you would feel if instead of passing the message of war to the commander in Hopias, you were to extend the hand of peace. If you choose to accept the mission, gain the codeword *Importance*. Lady Nasitha also encourages you not to return to the Crimson fort for you would surely be executed if he discovered your betrayal. The general is not a forgiving man. Whether or not you accept the mission, return to **600** and choose from the options presented.

223

As soon as the man sets foot on the deck, your animal begins behaving wildly, causing a ruckus that has the crew worried. ‘Animals can smell a ghost,’ says the bosun quietly. ‘This is most likely a revenant... a man drowned at sea, destined to draw other mortals down to the depths of the ocean.’ You heed his advice and have him thrown overboard immediately. The bosun nods to you. ‘Best we take no chances, eh? Then again, I could be wrong...’

You look over the side of the ship and the man is nowhere to be seen. Turn to **525**.

224

You pass a great galleon from Atticala. They will only regard you if you are a Warrior of 11th Rank or higher. If not, turn to **575** immediately. Otherwise, the captain, an officer in the Atticalan navy recognises you immediately and invites you aboard. He is eager to regale his old war stories and asks you about your exploits. In the course of conversation, you hear that Atticala is growing wary of the growing might of the Crimson Fort in Chrysoprais. He feels that were war declared both countries will be locked in an extended struggle, leaving them vulnerable to attack from the masked lords of Aku as they did Old Harkuna. He

confides in you that Colonel Sergios in Hopias is looking for someone daring enough to ‘remove’ the general of the Crimson Fort from his position in order to stem the growth of their army.

You eventually part ways, thanking the captain for his hospitality. Turn to **575**.

225

The port of Kurani lies within sight, and your maps indicate that Hopias, an island port off the coast of Atticala should be somewhere north of your current position. If you wish to go ashore at Kurani, note that your ship is now docked at Kurani and turn to **260**. Otherwise you could:

Head north toward Hopias	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 710
Follow the coast of Chrysoprais northeast	turn to 428
Head due west	turn to 660
Navigate south through the straights of Chrysoprais	turn to 128

226

If you have the codeword *Incomplete* turn to **71** immediately. If not, but you are 11th Rank or higher, turn to **319**. Otherwise, you will have to boast your reputation to convince the guards to allow you through.

Make a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 18. You can add 1 to the roll for each of the following titles; Masked Lord/Lady, Junior Court Rank and Senior Court Rank.

Successful CHARISMA roll	turn to 319
Failed CHARISMA roll	turn to 141
Do not make the attempt	turn to 50

227

Make a SCOUTING roll at a Difficulty of 20. If you fail, you find nothing of interest wandering aimlessly in the forest. Turn to **198**. If you succeed, turn to **12**.

228

With the guards taken care of you creep into the bedchamber of General Murtabaht Singh. He sleeps soundly, no knowledge of the inglorious fate about to befall him. You plunge your weapon into his heart and there is a slight gasp but nothing more. The general is dead.

Record the codeword *Injure* and lose the codewords *Imbibe*, *Juniper* and *Jury* if you had them. You make your hasty escape before more guards discover your deed and hide in a refuse area overnight. You awaken the next

morning to find that a sombre tone has befallen denizens of the keep. You watch the funeral with great irony before leaving. Turn to **244**.

229

‘The trau are natural miners with their dark vision and keen sense of direction,’ he says. ‘Though normally they make poor slaves or servants due to the fact that they can easily burrow away from their masters at any time. This is not a problem for me here, obviously... not only can they not burrow, but trau cannot abide the touch of water!’ He goes on to explain that he doesn’t push his trau servants like slaves, but rather provides them with a lavish life free of the stressors of the underworld. ‘Furthermore, they have a weakness for faery mead! If you ever have any I would gladly pay top price for it – you can never have enough around here.’ If you have **faery mead** and wish to sell it to him he will pay you 500 Shards for it. Anytime you are at paragraph **488** and wish to sell Umbart more faery mead, he will pay you 500 Shards for each unit.

The trau quickly usher you back to your ship and tell you to leave the vortex. Turn to **52**. If you do not have a ship docked here, turn to **616**.

230

On this barren rock there is not a trace of edible matter, let alone fresh water. Without rain you realise that you will have to mediate in order to slow down your metabolism and sustain your body. If you can succeed at a SANCTITY roll at Difficulty 17 you can sustain your body long enough until a ship arrives. If you fail, you die of thirst before anyone can come to your aid. Turn to **700**.

If you succeed, you manage to stave off your mortal needs until you see a ship on the horizon. You hail it, and as you are hauled aboard you collapse on the deck severely dehydrated.

Roll two dice. Add 1 if you are an initiate of The Three Fortunes, and an additional 1 if you have the title Blessed of the Three Fortunes.

Score 2 – 5	turn to 167
Score 6 – 8	turn to 491
Score 9 – 12	turn to 634

231

As you are walking along the coastal cliff looking out to sea, the last thing you expected were highwaymen in this tranquil scene. Sure enough, four brigands appear from behind the shrubs by the path and move to surround you. ‘Make this easy on yourself,’ says the leader as he holds out his hand expectantly.

If you have the codeword *Indirect*, turn to **345** immediately. Otherwise, if you give them all the money you are carrying they will let you live. Cross if off

and turn to **197**. Alternately, you can refuse but you expect that they will not go lightly. Turn to **511**.

232

You strengthen your resolve as you continue to drop into the darkness. The pressure starts to build and it feels like your head is going to implode. Your only chance is to create a bubble of force to protect you from the intense pressure.

Make a MAGIC roll at a Difficulty of 21.

Successful MAGIC roll turn to **83**

Failed MAGIC roll turn to **700**

233

With a swift move he sends your sword clattering to the ground and lays the tip of his at your throat. ‘Very good,’ he says, admiring your swordplay. ‘You have great potential. Perhaps next time we meet, you will be the victor? Until then...’

Roll two dice and if the total is higher than your COMBAT score, increase it by 1. Turn to **39**.

234

From what you can tell, the vampires of Iambus do not worship any of the Demon Lords. They prefer to keep to themselves, only venturing out of their homeland to restock their larders with mortal blood. Other than that, the denizens need very little to survive, and their markets are predominantly run by trau who seek to sell to a niche market. Some can even sell the very heads of demons here in Iambus – an act of blasphemy in the rest of the underworld.

<i>Armour</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Vulcanium mail (Defence +7)	1500 Mithrals	900 Mithrals

<i>Other Items</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Stone arrowhead (SCOUTING +4)	3000 Mithrals	-
Demon’s head	2000 Mithrals	-
Faery mead	-	1200 Mithrals
Scarab amulet	1250 Mithrals	1100 Mithrals
Selenium ore	1000 Mithrals	850 Mithrals
Four-leaf clover	400 Mithrals	300 Mithrals
Silver Horseshoe	300 Mithrals	250 Mithrals

Rabbit's foot charm	300 Mithrals	250 Mithrals
Uncanny salts	200 Mithrals	150 Mithrals

When you have finished here, return to **330**.

235

Becoming an initiate of Alvir and Valmir gives you the benefit of paying less for blessings and other services the temple can offer. It costs 40 Shards to become an initiate. You cannot do this if you are already an initiate of another temple.

If you become an initiate, write Alvir and Valmir in the God box on your Adventure Sheet – and remember to cross off the 40 Shards. Once you have finished here, turn to **556**.

236

She hisses with absolute delight, her beady black eye glistening in the fire light. 'If your heart is truly dedicated to the path you are about to walk, you will be untouched by the Fires of Immolation,' she explains, gesturing to what looks like a large funeral pyre in the back of the room. You are tied to a stake and a follower brings in a torch, lit from the very flames of hell fire. The pyre ignites and gouts of flame dance toward you as if seeking out your very soul.

If your SANCTITY score is 9 or higher, you automatically fail the test (do not include item bonuses, but include penalties from evil items). If your SANCTITY is 8 or lower, you may make a MAGIC roll at a Difficulty of 20.

Successful MAGIC roll	turn to 309
Failed MAGIC roll	turn to 700

237

You are greeted by Arbudh Pradesh, the man you rescued in the Sea of Stilts. He spends much time with you talking of his new inventions, none of which seem very practical or interesting to you. If you have a **green carpet** he can enchant it for you for free. Cross it off and write **magic carpet (safe travel x3)** on your Adventure Sheet. If you do not have a **green carpet**, you can purchase a **magic carpet** from Arbudh for a meagre 250 Shards, a special deal just for you. It has three charges which you can expend after rolling an encounter dice to avoid an unfavourable encounter. If you do so, chose the 'uneventful journey' option and remove one charge from the **magic carpet**. He reminds you that when your magic carpet runs out of charges you can bring it back to him for him to re enchant for free! When you use the last charge just cross it off and write **green carpet** in its place.

'Oh, and make sure you don't make the same mistake I did,' he says, 'only use it for cross-country travel, and don't try flying out to sea!' Note that it cannot

be used when sailing or when in a city or town. Also, you can only carry one **carpet** on your person at any time because they are very bulky and heavy, even when rolled up. When you are finished, turn to **280**.

238

There are more than a dozen of them, so they expect that you are either very brave or very foolish. The cultists draw long knives and begin to surround you, ensuring that there will be no escape. This will be the fight of your life!

Horde of Cultists	COMBAT 27	Defence 20	Stamina 60
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If you reduce them to 30 Stamina, reduce both their COMBAT and Defence values by 2. You cannot flee. If you lose, you will certainly be next on the long list of sacrifices. Turn to **700**. If you manage to defeat them, your fighting skill is becoming truly formidable. Raise your COMBAT score by 1 and your unwounded Stamina by 2 *permanently*. Now turn to **520**.

239

If the ghosts catch up you will surely perish here, so you are literally running for your life! Roll three dice and add your Rank. Add 1 if you are a Wayfarer as you may move through the forest more freely.

23 or less	The ghosts catch up	turn to 700
24 +	You make it to the coast	turn to 315

240

'It would be a sin to divest a minstrel of his music,' you say, passing the flute back to the bard. Gain the codeword *Innocent*. If you are a Troubadour, the two of you spend some time discussing your past adventures and exchanging tales of old. Roll four dice and if you roll higher than your current Rank, gain 1 Rank. Roll one die and add this number to your normal (unwounded) Stamina score.

You eventually part ways. Turn to **125**.

241

You gaze starboard and behold the most unexpected sight... it is your ship! It has been a long time coming but finally you may be able to reclaim what is yours. If you wish to leave the matter be and continue with your voyage, cross off the codeword one of the following codewords – *Ill* or *Just* (if you have multiple, you may choose which one to erase), and turn to **150**.

Otherwise, you decide it would be best to approach under the guise of a merchant vessel, that way you would be close enough to board and attack if required. Roll two dice:

2 – 5	turn to 418
6 – 8	turn to 503
9 – 12	turn to 70

242

You pass a classic desert island. A bedraggled man hails you
 Bring him aboard your ship turn to **72**
 Ignore him turn to **650**

243

The monks ask for only a small donation to assist in the upkeep of the temple and feeding the homeless. They will heal you of 1 – 6 Stamina (the roll of one die) for 3 Shards or allow you an extended stay to heal 2 – 12 Stamina (roll two dice) for 5 Shards.

When you are finished, cross of the money and turn to **300**.

244

You are standing outside the Crimson Fort on the very edge of the forest. The fort itself is well guarded, and you can hear the sound of men training inside. You have heard that the fort itself is an independent barony, but it must have the permission of the king of Chrysoprais to amass military might within the jurisdiction of the throne.

Enter the Crimson Fort	turn to 301
Head to the Forest of Rakshasas	turn to 615
Enter the mountains	turn to 528
Head southwest toward Kurani	turn to 186
Head south into the countryside	turn to 466

245

You sail on, as if forever, with your cabin boy atop the crows nest constantly scanning the horizon for something... anything...

Finally one morning you hear that fateful cry – ‘Edge!! The Edge of the World!!’ There is a sudden uproar as your crew scramble onto the deck and look out to their doom. Panic sets in and the deck is in chaos. You attempt to keep your cool as you realise that your ship is being pulled faster and faster toward that sharp drop. You can’t help but consider it somewhat poetic as you look upon that undefinable point at which the sky ends and that deep black impenetrable void begins. You are one of the few mortals who have gazed upon the Edge of the World, and your fame will soon spread through seafaring myth. If you didn’t have the codeword *Intricate*, gain 1 CHARISMA, then gain the codeword *Intricate*.

You are snapped out of your reverie with the sudden realisation that you must get control of your ship. Roll three dice and add your Rank. You may add 1 to the roll if you are a Wayfarer and add 2 if you are an initiate of Alvir and Valmir:

24 or less	turn to 710
25 or higher	turn to 467

246

Umbart listens to your story intently. Unless you have the codeword *Intricate*, he simply doesn’t believe your fanciful tale – there are too many inconsistencies. The wizard has his trau servants usher you back to your ship and tell you to leave the vortex. Turn to **52** immediately. If you do not have a ship docked here, turn to **616**.

If you do have the codeword *Intricate*, you explain the rest of your fantastic tale and he claps his hands with glee. ‘This will make a great addition to my new research paper!’ he clicks his fingers and a trau servant escorts you to collect a reward. Turn to **7**.

247

You see a string of islands on the horizon – the Innis Shoals! You swim toward them. Jagged coral slashes your body as you attempt to make your way ashore. Roll four dice and lose that many stamina points. If you are still alive, you manage to make it ashore.

You rejoice momentarily, happy to be back on dry land. However, now you are confronted with a more serious problem. How will you get off this island? The seas have become extremely rough since you arrived, and as you know they filled with razor-sharp coral. If you are lucky, the island you are on may provide some hope.

Roll two dice. If you are an initiate of Alvir and Valmir or the Three Fortunes, add 1. If you have the title, Blessed of the Three Fortunes, add another 1.

2 – 5	A barren rock	turn to 344 .
6 – 8	A ship on the horizon	turn to 62
9 – 12	An old man?	turn to 695

248

As you approach, the celestial stag bows its head, allowing you to touch it. You feel a sensation of serenity run through you. Gain 1 point of SANCTITY. Furthermore you may add a Blessing of Immunity to Disease/Poison to your

character sheet. Unlike a normal blessing however, this one can never be used up (it is permanent). If you ever lose a point of SANCTITY though, you will lose this blessing. Such is the difficult path one walks to achieve purity of spirit. Note this on your Adventure Sheet and turn to **615**.

249

Lose the codeword *Imbibe*. ‘Excellent,’ he says, rubbing his hands together. ‘I will have others informed of his plan to ensure no one else transfers such a message.’ Gain the codeword *Indefatigable* and turn to **451** for your reward.

250

You are sailing in the peaceful coastal waters of Auriculum, not to far south of the Straits of Chrysoprais. If you wish to go ashore at Auriculum, note that your ship is now docked at Auriculum and turn to **106**. Otherwise you could:

Sail north through the Straits of Chrysoprais	turn to 128
Sail east	turn to 327
Sail south toward the Edge of the World	turn to 508

251

You stay out of sight and manage to dash to a rope ladder leading to the deck of the ship. Once onboard you can see that this is no ordinary ship – in the middle of the deck lies some kind of magical apparatus, a large box with a basin in which miniature lightning arcs around an empty dish. You move to investigate until you realise that you have been spotted. There is a sudden commotion and the technicians who are on the ship call for the guards. Luckily they aren’t trained for combat so they just stay out of reach and holler for help. Either way, your alerting the guards is not going to go down well with the brotherhood, and it is unlikely you won’t be getting a share in the loot!

Now you turn your attention to getting out of here. By the looks of it, unless the merchant Harvin is completely mad, this must be a flying ship. Perhaps you could fly out of here?

Put some selenium ore in the dish (if you have it)	turn to 761
Flee the conventional way	turn to 741

252

To renounce the worship of Alvir and Valmir, you must pay 30 Shards in compensation to the priesthood. A merchant standing beside you catches your arm and shakes his head. ‘If you want my advice, you’ll stay an initiate. I left the temple, and the following week half my fleet was wrecked in a storm off the Innis Shoals!’

Do you want to reconsider? If you are determined to renounce your faith, pay the 30 Shards and delete Alvir and Valmir from the God box on your Adventure Sheet. When you have finished here, turn to **50**.

253

Your tales make even the Prince raise an eyebrow. The king chuckles to himself, clapping whenever you tell of a beheaded beast or a defeated knight. You have certainly won his favour! Gain the codeword *Indefatigable* and turn to **451**.

254

Your cabin boy spots the body of a shipwrecked mariner floating in the water. You could ignore it and turn to **350**. Otherwise, you hoist it aboard. Roll one die:

1 – 2	turn to 174
3 – 4	turn to 653
5 – 6	turn to 561

255

If you are carrying a **pirate captain’s head, shrunken head, dead head, demon’s head, witch’s hand, severed hand**, or **Kris**, turn to **562**. If you have any of the codewords *Clanger*, *Evil*, *Judas*, *Kink*, or the title Unspeakable Cultist, turn to **562**. Otherwise, turn to **431**.

256

The vampires nearby snarl at you, baring their fangs. ‘Mortal!!’ they yell, and a veritable army of pallid-faced vampires run toward you howling for your blood. If you have the codeword *Intimidate*, they recognise you immediately and your awe-inspiring reputation makes the vampires hesitate long enough for you to get away. If you do not, you will have to outrun them. You must roll your Rank or less on five dice. If you fail, you are quickly overcome. Turn to **700**.

If you have the codeword *Intimidate* or roll equal to or less than your rank, you must leave Iambus, either on foot or by ship (if you have one docked here).

Sail up the waterfalls at the Edge of the World	turn to 755
Sail through the falls and into the underworld	turn to 149
Enter the gates to hell (requires light source)	turn to 430

If you have neither a ship nor a light source, you are overcome by the horde of vampires. Turn to **700**.

257

If you have the **book of the dead** and wish to give it to the head priest, cross it off your Adventure Sheet and gain the codeword *Ibis*. He tells you to return in a few days for your reward. If you do not have the **book of the dead**, the young man just sighs and dismisses you. Either way, turn to **380**.

258

Ever since you entered the forest you have felt as if someone is watching you, and the hairs on the back of your neck stand tall. Every so often you feel a hand on your shoulder, and turn to see nothing but the gloomy forest. The longer this lasts, the more your mind starts playing tricks on you.

Make a MAGIC roll at a Difficulty of 18.

Successful MAGIC roll turn to **316**

Failed MAGIC roll turn to **677**

259

You spend your sleepless nights piling over maps and planning the course for the next day. On this particular night however you get the feeling that something is not quite right. Despite the warmth of the lantern beside you, your body is shivering. Your intuition tells you that something is wrong and you make your way on deck, weapon in hand. Turn to **336**.

260

Kurani is currently in a metals shortage, and you can see many ships from abroad here capitalising on the current market. You hear word that the general of the Crimson Fort is preparing to wage a military campaign is draining most of Chrysoprais for steel for his soldiers' arms and armour.

You can buy goods from the warehouses only if you own a ship which is docked at Kurani. You can buy as much cargo as your ship has room for. You can also sell cargo here. All prices are for 1 Cargo Unit.

<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>	
Furs	200 Shards	120 Shards
Grain	190 Shards	175 Shards
Metals	-	990 Shards
Minerals	550 Shards	500 Shards
Spices	810 Shards	750 Shards
Textiles	150 Shards	100 Shards
Timber	320 Shards	290 Shards

Here you can also buy a ship of your own, to fill with cargo and crew. If you wish to purchase a ship, you are the captain and can take it wherever you wish, exploring and trading. You also get to name it. Three types of ship are available.

<i>Ship Type</i>	<i>Cost</i>	<i>Capacity</i>
Barque	250 Shards	1 Cargo Unit
Brigantine	450 Shards	2 Cargo Units
Galleon	900 Shards	3 Cargo Units

If you do buy a ship, add it to your Ship's Manifest, and name it as you wish. The quality of your ship's crew is poor unless you pay to upgrade it. If you already own a ship, you can sell it back to the harbourmaster at half the above prices.

It costs 50 Shards to upgrade a poor crew to average and 100 Shards to upgrade an average crew to good. Excellent crews are not available in Kurani

Once you have finished here, if you have the codeword *Ebb*, turn to **20** immediately. Otherwise, turn to **600** to head to the city centre. If you have a ship docked at Kurani and wish to set sail, turn to **382**. If you do not have a ship you can pay for passage to any port in Chrysoprais or some of the nearer ports in Atticala. Turn to **308**.

261

The man is overjoyed and agrees to serve alongside your crew. It turns out that he is a skilled navigator. Increase your crew quality by one step (there is no change if your crew quality was already Excellent). Turn to **650**.

262

Roll two dice and add 1 if you are an initiate of The Three Fortunes:

- 2 Arson! Your unit is lost. Erase the tick by the unit option at **50**.
- 3 – 4 A thief has stolen all the money you left here
- 5 – 6 Squatters stole 1 item (your choice) and caused 20 Shards worth of damages
- 7 + Your money and possessions are safe

Possessions left in Unit

When you are finished, turn back to **50**.

263

To become an initiate of the All Seeing you are required to undergo a number of tests in which you read portents and attempt to predict the outcome of a game of chance. Make a MAGIC roll at difficulty 16. If you succeed, they induct you as an initiate of the All Seeing. Write Molhern in your god box. If you fail, you see nothing, and the head priest recommends that you gain some more worldly knowledge before you attempt the test again. You reattempt the initiation test after you have gained a point in any one of your Abilities, or gained a Rank. Note this on your Adventure Sheet and turn back to **29**.

264

If you are at any entry in a book other than *The Isle of a Thousand Spires*, the **crimson sword** will sell for 500 Shards more than the listed value of any COMBAT +6 weapon. If there is no listed price to sell a COMBAT +6 weapon, there is no market for sale at that location and you must try somewhere else.

If you are at any entry in *The Isle of a Thousand Spires*, the sword is quickly recognised and you are assumed to be a thief, as no Crimson Knight would ever dream of selling such an heirloom. Gain the codeword *Incomplete* if you didn't already have it and the merchant you are attempting to sell the sword to calls the city guard. Roll three dice and add your Rank, adding 1 if you are a Rogue.

17 or below	Captured and taken to jail	turn to 71
18 – 24	Escape but must leave the sword behind (cross it off and turn back to the entry you were in previously)	
25 +	Escape without a problem (turn to your previous entry)	

265

You describe your successful passage through the vortex to the underworld and pull out your rough map of the underground rivers. He is absolutely ecstatic! Everything he has worked for has come to fruition, and he believes that the data you have collected will help him stabilise the vortex for commercial travel. You leave him to dream of fame and fortune as you are escorted by a trau servant to receive your reward.

You have learned much from your journey into the underworld and back. Gain 1 Rank and roll a die. This is the number you may add to your Stamina *permanently*. Also, you may add 1 point to your SCOUTING score. Now turn to **7** and tick two of the boxes. You can collect two rewards as Umbart is particularly generous to you today.

266

If you have the codeword *Impede* or are an initiate of Kumba Karna, turn to **321** immediately.

Otherwise, if you arrived here by ship you can set sail. If you did not arrive by ship, your only exit would be a dank looking tunnel in the centre of the island, with a granite archway erected around it. The arch looks ancient, and on its weather-beaten surface you can just make out old carvings depicting demons bursting forth from hellfire. If you wish to enter the tunnel, you will need a source of light such as a **lantern** or a **candle**. If you are a Mage you can create light through sorcery.

If you arrived by ship and wish to investigate the tunnel, your crew will sail to Mithdrak and await your return. Note that your ship is now docked at Mithdrak.

Enter the tunnel	<i>Into the Underworld</i> 403
Leave the island by ship	turn to 450

267

The robbery goes horribly wrong – you should have known better than to trust such dastardly men. They barricade you in one of the mansion's treasure rooms to take them blame. It takes you precious time to escape and by the time you are outside your accomplices are long gone. 'There he is!' yells the owner from his bedroom window as town guard hustle toward you. Gain the codeword *Incomplete* if you didn't already have it and roll three dice. If you roll under your Rank you are able to escape from the authorities and only stop running when you are on the outskirts of the city. Turn to **395**. If you roll above your Rank, you are apprehended and escorted to the gaol in Mithdrak. Turn to **71**.

268

There are numerous temples dedicated to the Sage of Peace whose example guides men towards enlightenment. Here the clerics can live a life of monastic contemplation, far from the materialistic needs of the wealthy that dominate life in the larger cities like Mithdrak. Lay worshippers can also come to a temple for healing, blessings and advice.

Ask for healing	turn to 721
Seek a blessing (initiates only)	turn to 734
Become an initiate	turn to 158
Leave the temple	turn to 380

269 □□□

Prince 'Azim' as he insists you call him asks you what you have to report. If you have the codeword *Iambus*, you will be rewarded according to the amount of information you can give him. For every tick you have next to the codeword, put a tick in the box above and Prince Azim will reward you with 400 Shards. Any time you return here, if you have more ticks next to the codeword than ticks in the box above, transfer them to the boxes above. Whenever you tick an empty box above, you will receive a reward of 400 Shards. For example, if you have two ticks next to *Iambus*, put two ticks above and receive 800 Shards. Then when you return again and have all three ticks next to *Iambus*, put the last tick in the box above and receive another 400 Shards.

Now if you have the codeword *Insane*, turn to **647** immediately. Otherwise, turn back to **600**.

270

You awaken, coughing and spluttering on an operation table still slick with viscous green fluid. You look down and feel relieved to be all in one piece. Your new body is tailored perfectly to the preferences you had stated to the artificer (make the necessary amendments to sex and physical description). Furthermore, the skilled artificer has fixed all those little defects that you used to have like clicking shoulders or ugly scars. If you had the codeword *Anger*, lose it and restore that point of CHARISMA you had lost. If you had the codeword *Face*, lose it and restore your CHARISMA to its normal value. He smiles proudly and encourages you to choose his service in the future.

Roll two dice, adding 1 if you are an initiate of either the Three Fortunes or Molhern:

2 – 3	A slight mishap	turn to 457
4 – 11	Everything is fine	turn to 768
12 +	A strange occurrence	turn to 607

271

Cross your ship off the ships manifest – you will never see it again. It is a pity that you couldn't save the ship, but you are confronted with a more serious problem. How will you get off this island? The seas are extremely rough and filled with

jagged coral. If you had a cutter here it has since been dashed to pieces. If you are lucky, the island you are on may provide some hope.

Roll two dice. If you are an initiate of Alvir and Valmir or the Three Fortunes, add 1. If you have the title, Blessed of the Three Fortunes, add another 1.

2 – 5	A barren rock	turn to 344 .
6 – 8	A ship on the horizon	turn to 62
9 – 12	An old man?	turn to 695

272

You leap at the boy, tackling him to the ground without a problem. He looks shocked and starts to panic when the horsemen arrive. You realise that they are city guards from Kurani, and they have been chasing a thief! 'Thankyou for apprehending the robber – he is the one who raised the treasury of Prince Azimishtra Deoraj! Without your help we would have had no chance to catch up to him one the Prince's carpet!'

If you have any of the codewords *Bullion*, *Evade*, *Fracas* or *Incomplete*, and do not have the codeword *Face*, turn to **86** immediately. Otherwise, the guards check their logs and note that a reward was on offer for the boy's capture. You are passed a pouch of 700 Shards. Futhermore, you have won the Prince's favour and the guards will pass your name to him in the event that you would like to meet him in the future. Gain the codeword *Impress* if you didn't already have it. They bid you farewell and drag the boy away for his punishment. You loathe to consider what will happen to him... Turn to **18**.

273

You spot a ship far to port which appears to be in distress. It is caught in some kind of tide and is being pulled south, toward Umbart's Vortex you suspect. You cannot hear their cries, but the crew are waving to you desperately from the deck. If you have the codeword *Illiad*, turn to **605** immediately. Otherwise you will have to make a MAGIC or SCOUTING roll at a Difficulty of 20 in order to pull alongside and attempt a rescue.

Successful MAGIC or SCOUTING roll	turn to 43
Failed MAGIC or SCOUTING roll	turn to 381
Leave them to their fate	turn to 625

274 □

If the box above is already ticked, turn to **434** now. Otherwise, put a tick in it and continue reading. One of the knights sits up and turns to you, looking you up and down with glazed eyes. A number of others do the same, the sound of

ancient chainmail echoing through the room. The eldest opens its mouth and a booming voice emanates forth as if from the chamber itself. ‘You bare the spirit of a great and noble knight and the trappings to suit. Your presence warms our hearts. Indeed the youthful have carried on our quest for glory.’ You are asked to kneel and the eldest knight draws his crimson sword, and touches it to your head.

Raise your COMBAT score to 12. If you are a Warrior, roll four dice and if they total higher than your Rank, gain 1 Rank. Note that an increase in Rank will also add 1-6 points to your normal (unwounded) Stamina.

‘Now go forth, young Knight, and do our reputation proud.’

The knights all lie back and resume the peace of their eternal rest. With bolstered spirits you set sail again. Turn to **425**.

275

You are sailing in open ocean through the Sea of Stilts. You estimate to be roughly on the same latitude as Teleos and the Innis Shoals.

‘What course cap’n?’

North to Umbart’s Vortex	turn to 303
Head east	turn to 617
Head south	turn to 190
West toward Teleos	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 138

276

The mermaid wakes up with a start but your natural charm calms her. The others watch on in curiosity. If you have a **mermaid’s comb** or **coral-red tresses**, turn to **352** immediately. Otherwise, you alleviate their anxiety by playing games with them. They usher you into the water and swim around you in a pattern. Before they leave, the mermaid you befriended touches you on the forehead with her comb. Note that you now have a blessing of Immunity to Disease/Poison. She giggles and the group swim away, waving at you from a distance. Turn to **197**.

277

You turn to leave. If you previously used **salt and iron filings** when you passed through the burial mounds, you may exit unmolested and reach the edge of the forest. Turn to **358**. Otherwise, you will have to test your luck again... Roll two dice, adding 1 if you are a Priest and 2 if you are an initiate of The Three Fortunes.

2 – 8	You are followed	turn to 117
9 +	You luck out... again!	turn to 358

278

A man appears behind you, as if out of thin air. He is of indistinct nationality, and looks to be in his mid forties though his eyes indicate a wisdom far beyond a mortal lifetime. He wears plain undyed cloths that billow in the wind.

If you have all three of the codewords *Innocent*, *Imbue* and *Insolent*, turn to **335** immediately. Otherwise, he simply stares at you, answering your question before you even ask it. ‘I cannot help you on your path unless you can help yourself,’ he says solemnly. You look at him quizzically. ‘But would I be selfish to help myself?’

In the blink of an eye he is gone. The peak is now completely empty and your only option is to descend. Turn to **524**.

279

A troubadour from Atticala is sailing a small ship south-eastward. If you have the codeword *Cerumen* or *Cynosure*, turn to **609** immediately. Otherwise, the bard spends some time with your crew, singing the songs of old, and spirits are high when you sail off. Increase your crew quality by one category, up to a maximum of excellent. Turn to **125**.

280

Your ship is tied to a jetty that floats on pontoons dragged behind the Walking City. You walk along it to the city itself and marvel at the ingenuity of its construction. A large platform the size of a small town carries towers of Chrysopraian design. It appears that the denizens live vertically, with the towers and spires of large buildings winding their way up toward the heavens. Here and there an extension that seems to defy gravity juts out the side of a tower and you can see wizards milling about their business. Underneath the platform are numerous mechanical legs that extend all the way to the sea bed. Every few seconds you hear the dull sound of gears turning and cogs clicking as on of the legs whirrs into action and takes a long stride forward.

Go to the market	turn to 468
Find an artificer	turn to 631
Pay for magical training	turn to 82
Go to the harbour	turn to 559

281

You are standing on the southern border of the Forest of Apsaras. A small river extends southward toward the coastal town of Auriculum. From here you could make your way to the northern edge of the forest by walking along the

coast – turn to **505**. Otherwise you could enter the forest (turn to **548**), or follow the river to Auriculum (turn to **682**).

282

You manage to chart a relatively safe path through the deep sea ley lines that control the vortex. Gain the codeword *Illiad* if you didn't already have it and note that your ship is now docked at Umbart's Palace. Turn to **163**.

283

You are clubbed over the back of the head and awaken tied to a chair in a dingy basement. You are surrounded by a few thugs dressed as noblemen, who have taken all money but not your possessions. You are beaten to within an inch of your life.

'Courtesy of Lord Sehastramal,' says the leader as he draws a long wavy knife and plunges it into your belly. They then leave you to an ignoble death in the muddy waters by the side of a canal. If you had a blessing of Immunity to Injury, cross it off as you look down to sea your gut is miraculously intact! You are on 1 Stamina, and you may return to the city centre (turn to **50**). Otherwise you will have to rely on your natural hardiness to survive. Make a COMBAT roll at Difficulty 16 without the assistance of any item bonuses. If you succeed, you manage to cling to life and bandage your wound, though you will need serious medical attention. Return to the city centre on 1 Stamina point (turn to **50**). Otherwise, turn to **700**.

284

The Auriculum market has fewer wares than you had expected. It is primarily a trading port, and most revenue originates from their booming textile business. Aside from this it is known as a religious haven, and numerous trinkets to the Sage of Peace and the new gods can be found here. In Chrysoprais, to wear the hide or skin of a dead animal is considered uncouth, and as such leather armour is not available.

<i>Armour</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Ring mail (Defence +2)	130 Shards	100 Shards
Chain mail (Defence +3)	-	200 Shards

<i>Weapons</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
No COMBAT bonus	60 Shards	50 Shards
COMBAT bonus +1	-	200 Shards

<i>Magical Items</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Amber wand	-	400 Shards
<i>Other Items</i>		
Lotus talisman (SANCTITY +1)	200 Shards	150 Shards
Paradise talisman (SANCTITY +2)	400 Shards	300 Shards
Nirvana talisman (SANCTITY +3)	800 Shards	600 Shards
Dorje pendant (SANCTITY +4)	-	1200 Shards
Vajra baton (SANCTITY +5)	-	3000 Shards
Rope	50 Shards	45 Shards
Candle	3 Shards	1 Shard
Lantern	100 Shards	90 Shards
Parchment	2 Shards	1 Shard
Tent	200 Shards	150 Shards

You find an old mystic who sells potions. She offers you a **Potion of Nature (SCOUTING +1)** for a mere 35 Shards. If you wish to purchase it mark it on your Adventure sheet. It can be used once to add 1 to any SCOUTING roll. Cross it off before you roll the dice.

When you are finished here, turn back to **380**.

285 □

If you do not have any **vulcanium ore**, there is nothing else to do here so you must set sail. Turn to **89** immediately. If you do have come ore and the box above is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading. If the box was already ticked, turn to **343**. Otherwise, you hand Danuo the **vulcanium ore** and he offers for you to stay in his little cottage whilst he sets to work on your new sword. Days turn into weeks, and you marvel at the sorcerer's tenacity as he sleeps only once every few days. Eventually he returns, satisfied with his workmanship.

Danuo hands you the sheathed sword. The guard is uninteresting, and the hilt is bound with plain black leather. However as you draw the sword you marvel as it glows dancing flames. Runes are carved along the blade and they exude a noticeable heat. Note the **vulcanium sword (COMBAT +7)** on your list of possessions. 'That will ensure it doesn't get stolen,' Danuo states as he points to the vulcanium belt buckle on the scabbard. 'Take good care of it'

Note that this item cannot be stolen or lost by accident (such as during random encounters). The only time you can lose this item is when you willingly relinquish it by specifically leaving it somewhere, or if you are stripped of all your possessions, or if you die and are resurrected. Furthermore,

the flaming sword can be treated as a **lantern**. As long as you are carrying this sword you are considered to be carrying a lantern.

You return to your ship and set sail. Turn to **89**.

286

You see small portable wooden altar in the middle of a field. It is bloodstained and stabbed into the centre is a long, wavy bladed dagger. You can take the **kris** if you want. Note that it can be used as a weapon (no COMBAT bonus) but cannot be sold as a weapon in a market due to the social stigma associated with the sacrificial knife. Though, certain niche buyers may be interested in such an item...

Decide whether or not to add it to your Adventure Sheet and turn to **4**.

287

You leap out and grab the elder without a problem. He is frail and easily handled. You hold him out, ready to snap his neck like a chicken. You will have to convince the tribe that you mean business. Make a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 21. If you fail, turn to **495**. If you succeed, the crowd are awed by your action and you strike fear into their hearts. If you have the codeword *Infirm*, your crew are returned to you and you are allowed to escape back to the cutter. Lose the codeword *Infirm*. Now you could set the elder free before you leave, or kill him anyway.

Set him free	turn to 406
Kill him	turn to 691

288

Being in Iambus is a unique experience, and one that you will surely never forget. Gain the codeword *Insane*. Few mortals have witnessed such a supernatural place, and having the opportunity to study it has taught you something about magic in the *Fabled Lands*. If you are a Mage, roll four dice. If the total is higher than your Rank, gain 1 Rank. Roll a die and increase your unwounded Stamina score by that number.

Now turn back to **330** and continue reading.

289

You cause serious damage to a passing merchant's ship. It starts taking on water. You could mount a rescue (turn to **435**) or you could sail away at full speed (turn to **156**).

290

You notice that you are dressed in purple velvet robes with a gold trim. libyrrsh nods. 'Our lord approves,' she hisses. Note that you are wearing a **cloak of darkness (CHARISMA +3, THIEVERY +3)**. You are likely only to find a buyer for something like this in the underworld. Turn to **170**.

291

Where will you travel from here?

Head south for Mithdrak	turn to 50
Head north for Kurani	turn to 600
Head cross country for the Crimson Fort	turn to 466

292

An Atticalan barque pulls along side and a friendly captain chats to you about trade and politics between his nation and Chrysoprais. He is looking to take the fine silks of Auriculum back to Teleos to trade. If you have a cargo unit of Textiles he will be willing to trade it with his one cargo unit of Grain. Alternately he will sell you his cargo unit of Grain for only 150 Shards if you have space for it in your hold.

Make any necessary amendments and turn to **175**.

293

You look over to a commotion behind you. It looks like someone has recognised you from a wanted poster and is talking to a troop of guards as he points in your direction. You will have to make a THIEVERY roll at a Difficulty of 17 to avoid arrest. You can add 1 if you are a Rogue and 2 if you have some kind of **mask**. If you succeed, you manage to elude them without difficulty, but are forced to flee into the mountains to hide. Turn to **528**. If you fail the THIEVERY roll, you are captured and shackled. Turn to **71**.

294

Lakha explains that there may be something you can do for them. As they cannot leave the forest, you could journey to the Forest of Apsaras where Lord Mugul-Ji is reputedly buried in a long forgotten tomb. 'He was buried with a sapphire pendant which was stolen from us centuries ago,' Lakha explains. 'It belonged to the high priest of Sobha Rana, a Rakshasa who forged the union between us and humans in the ancient times. He used to proclaim that its clarity represented his vision for our future. It was stolen by Lord Mugul-Ji when he became tyrannical ruler of Auriculum and was instead used as a symbol of oppression.'

The object is of little monetary value, but of great historical value to the Rakshasas here. They request that you return it to them, though warn you to be careful. ‘Lord Mugal-Ji was obsessed with the thought that someone may steal his power, reputation and money, so it is likely that he will have taken appropriate measures to prevent this,’ Lakha warns. ‘Some even say that he made a pact with the underworld to remain in a deathly sleep, ready to awake and punish any would-be graverobbers!’

With that you are guided back to the edge of the forest. If you accept the mission, gain the codeword *Implore*. ‘This might be of some assistance in your quest,’ says Lakha as he places in your hand a small parcel of leaves containing a foul smelling herbal mixture. Note the **potion of intellect (MAGIC +1)** on your list of possessions. It can be used once only to add 1 to your MAGIC before you roll the dice. Turn to **615**.

295

As soon as you move closer to investigate the coffin, you hear a terrible grating sound and freeze in terror as the lid slides to the side. A huge, rotting hand bursts out with tremendous speed toward your throat. You will have to roll your Rank or less on four dice. If you roll higher than your Rank, the hand grasps your throat and snaps your neck before you can even scream. Turn to **700**. If you roll equal to or lower than your Rank, you manage to flee into the forest before the beast rises, however you have a feeling that you have caused enough commotion to alert the ghostly guardians of the forest... Turn to **117**.

296

The peak begins to get steeper, and you start to realise why so few people actually manage to climb it...

Make a SCOUTING roll at a Difficulty of 19. You may add 1 if you have a **rope** or 2 if you have **climbing gear** (only one bonus applies to the roll, your choice).

Successful SCOUTING roll	turn to 118
Failed SCOUTING roll	turn to 678
Turn back without trying	turn to 47

297

The ship lurches with the impact. Timbers groan and crack. Pirates pour over the rail with a lusty yell, eager on seasoning your decks with blood.

Roll four dice if you are a Warrior, or three dice if you belong to any other profession. Add your Rank to this roll. Then, if your crew is poor quality, subtract 2 from the total. If the crew is good, add 2. If the crew is excellent, add 3.

Score 0 – 12	Calamity; you are killed	turn to 700
Score 13 – 18	Crushing defeat; lose 3-18 Stamina	<i>Over the Blood-Dark Sea</i> 435
Score 19 – 24	Forced to give in; lose 2-12 Stamina	turn to 635
Score 25 – 29	The pirates withdraw	turn to 150
Score 30 +	Outright victory!	turn to 398

298

Security is not as tight in these dungeons, as it is expected that even if you do find a way out of your cell the corridors to the surface are like a maze. You take some time to plan your escape, watching the timetable of the guards carefully. If you have the title Royal Assassin, turn to **139**.

Otherwise, you wait until the time is right and then feign illness. You know the guards won’t fall for such a simple trick, so you keep the act up for a few days before feigning death. You will have to rely on making a very convincing act. Make a CHARISMA roll at Difficulty 15. If you are successful, turn to **463** immediately. Otherwise, your ruse fails and the guards never fall for your antics again. Turn to **611**.

299

After the child stops kicking and falls lifeless, his blood is shared around and the body is stuffed, roasted and served in small portions to all members. Lose 1 point of Sanctity for partaking in the gory feast. You also lose any Sanctity blessings you may have had, and the title Enlightened One if you had it. After the feast the members bid each other farewell and you return to the city centre. Turn to **50**.

300

If you have the codeword *Irredeemable*, turn to **184**.

You are standing at the base of the great mountain known as Vulture Peak. A ramshackle shanty town has developed in this area, housing pilgrims, priests and the homeless. Beggars are scattered around the town, preying on the wealthy adventurers who make pilgrimage to the peak. There is a ‘temple’ to the Sage of Peace in the centre of the shanty, however it is more like a small tent.

Climb the peak	turn to 587
Talk to the locals	turn to 162
Visit the temple	turn to 465
Explore the shanty town	turn to 205
Leave	turn to 506

301

‘What business do you have here?’ asks a guard, levelling his spear at your throat. Could you expect a warmer welcome from a military base? If you have the title Crimson Knight or the codeword *Imbibe*, the guards recognise you and usher you inside (turn to **708**). Otherwise you will have to convince them of your good intentions. Make a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 17.

Successful CHARISMA roll	turn to 708
Failed CHARISMA roll	turn to 5

302

If you have the codeword *Jury*, inexplicably the abbot initiates you on the spot. Turn back to **662**. Otherwise, you spend time trying to master the teachings of the Sage of Peace. After many weeks, the abbot tests you. ‘This stone represents the teachings of the Sage of Peace,’ he says holding out a pebble, ‘when you can take the pebble from my hand, you will have mastered all I can teach.’

Make a SANCTITY roll at a Difficulty of 17	
Successful SANCTITY roll	turn to 551
Failed SANCTITY roll	turn to 164

303

Plotting a course for Umbart’s Vortex is not particularly difficult, however plotting a safe course may be quite tricky. There are mysterious under currents and unpredictable waves caused by the vortex that could pull your ship into dangerous waters.

Make a SCOUTING roll at a Difficulty of 18. You may add 1 to the roll if you are a Mage:

Successful SCOUTING roll	turn to 500
Failed SCOUTING roll	turn to 381

304

‘As you can tell, my interest is in cartography and the underworld,’ he says as he gestures to the limitless piles of books and maps strewn about the room. ‘At present I am studying how to stabilise this vortex to allow travel to the underworld

via ship. I believe I have rectified the mistakes we made last time and another journey into the vortex will be less... messy.’

If you wish to take up his quest, you will require a ship docked at Umbart’s Vortex. He tells you that payment will be granted upon your return, but for some reason you get the feeling that your return may not be a high statistical probability. To begin the task, turn to **552**.

If you do not wish to attempt the task at this time, Umbart tells you that he is always in need of brave volunteers and you may return at any time to make the attempt. He also has interest in knowledge from other areas of the *Fabled Lands* and their relationship with the underworld. If you wish to tell him about your adventures, tick the relevant box and turn to the appropriate paragraph. If it was already ticked you cannot tell him the same story or sell him the same item twice. He asks whether you:

Have gazed into the Hole in the World	turn to 165 □
Have located the port of Iambus	turn to 594 □
Have climbed the peaks at the Edge of the World	turn to 423 □
Have sailed to the Edge of the World	turn to 246 □
Are an initiate of a Demon Lord	turn to 403 □
Possess a lump of vulcanium ore	turn to 104 □
Possess a fretwork key	turn to 104 □
Possess a cloak of darkness	turn to 104 □
Possess a demon’s head	turn to 104 □
Possess an ankh of Karna	turn to 104 □

Otherwise, the trau quickly usher you back to your ship and tell you to leave the vortex. Turn to **52**. If you do not have a ship docked here, turn to **616**.

305

The sky turns sulphur grey. Thunderheads pile up on the horizon like vengeful gods. Lightning flickers like burning pitch on the world’s rim. ‘It’s the end,’ shrieks the bosun, ‘say your prayers, lads!’

If you have a blessing of Safety from Storms, it will only protect you against the worst of the storm. However the magical nature of the vortex has thrown you off course. Cross off the blessing and turn to **640**.

Without a blessing to save you, the hurricane strikes with fury unlike anything you have seen before, filling you with a deep seated sense of dread. Roll one die if your ship is a barque, two dice if it is a brigantine, or three dice if it is a galleon. Add 1 to the roll if you have a good crew, 2 if you have an excellent crew, but subtract 1 if your crew is poor. Add 1 if you are 11th Rank or higher.

0 – 7	Your ship sinks	turn to 447
8 – 9	Crew and cargo washed overboard	turn to 574
10 +	You weather the storm	turn to 640

306

Make a SANCTITY or CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 23.

Successful SANCTITY or CHARISMA roll	turn to 248
Failed SANCTITY or CHARISMA roll	turn to 534

307

Remember to cross off 250 Shards for a weapon or 100 Shards for armour. The more powerful the enchantment, the more risk involved. Remember that Luck blessings can be used with any kind of roll, and it may help you avoid disaster here. Look at the table below and find the *current* Defence or COMBAT bonus of the item to be enchanted. The number listed beside it is the number you must roll on two dice. If you roll the listed number or above, the artificer has successfully increased the item's bonus by +1. If you roll lower than the listed number, consult the second table.

<i>Current bonus</i>	<i>Roll two dice</i>
+0	automatic success!
+1	automatic success!
+2	4 or higher
+3	6 or higher
+4	8 or higher
+5	9 or higher

If your roll was successful, remember to increase the item's bonus by +1 and turn back to **372**. If your roll failed, you will have to determine the consequences with a roll on the table below. Roll two dice:

2 – 5	The item is destroyed (cross it off your Adventure Sheet)
6 – 8	The bonus of the item is <i>reduced</i> by 1
9 – 12	The item is unaffected (no gain or loss).

When you have made the necessary adjustments turn back to **372** and decide whether you will have it enchanted again.

308

If you wish to pay for passage to another port, simply cross off the fare and turn to the relevant entry (ignore any instructions in the entry that request a different fare). If you reconsider leaving Kurani, you can return to the city centre by turning to **600**.

Mithdrak	15 Shards	turn to 8
Auriculum	15 Shards	turn to 106
Hopias	10 Shards	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 176
Teleos	20 Shards	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 18
Port Skios	45 Shards	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 439
Aku	45 Shards	<i>The Court of Hidden Faces</i> 502

309

The snake demon is ecstatic, contorting her face and baring her fangs in what you can only assume to be a smile of approval. Erase any gods in your god box and write Kumba Karna. Although the Sage of Peace is not a jealous god, he cannot abide by the path you are now choosing to follow, and as long as you are an initiate of a Demon Lord you may not become an initiate of the Sage of Peace.

The snake demon spends a surprising amount of time with you explaining the nature and workings of the underworld deities. She, along with other lesser demons are entrusted with the task of spreading the word of their lords and commanding the armies of hell. She is a high priestess in her circle, and introduces herself as Iibyrsh the Lesser. The various Karna of the underworld are constantly battling for power over the domains of hell, and recently they have taken an interest in the use of canny mortals to further their ends in the realm above. She will be greatly rewarded by her lord for delivering an experienced adventurer like you into his service.

‘In fact, it would be wise of you to journey to his stronghold right now. He is guaranteed to have a task for someone such as yourself.’ Nevertheless, Iibyrsh cautions you. ‘The journey to hell can be treacherous for a mortal, so I understand if you have matters to attend to here first... such as your last will and testament.’

Turn to **170**.

310

As soon as you recognise the deep sea kraken, you try to calm your mind and call upon Heilmir for salvation. Make a SANCTITY roll at a Difficulty of 15. If you fail, you are pulled to your doom. Turn to **700**.

If you succeed, your lungs are bursting for air and seconds before you pass out the grip of the tentacle loosens slightly. With renewed vigour you swim desperately for the surface. You gasp lungfuls of fresh air and count yourself lucky... or blessed? Roll two dice and if you roll higher than your SANCTITY score, increase it by 1. You are hoisted aboard and the crew give you congratulations all around. Turn to **450**.

311

A feeling of dread washes over you as you see the red banners of the Reavers on the horizon. They have spotted your ship and are heading directly for you. Luckily you have a chance to flee or prepare yourselves. If you wish to abandon the ship and take your chances on the island with the crew, turn to **271**. Otherwise you can:

Inspire your men to fight off the pirates	turn to 440
Lay an ambush	turn to 601

312

You realise that this must be the home of the exiled Bhora tribe. The story you heard in Ankon-Konu was true! If you have the title Unspeakable Cultist and wish to investigate their practices, turn to **583**. Otherwise, you decide it would be wise to flee to your ship before they corner you and shrink your heads! The villagers give chase but you are soon far away from their island. Lose the codeword *Infirm* if you had it and turn to **275**.

313

You will have to convince them that you are an ally and will not be reporting them to the authorities. Make a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 18. Add 1 if you are carrying a **kris** and add 2 if you have the codeword *Iota*. Subtract 3 if you have the codeword *Illegitimate*.

Successful CHARISMA roll	turn to 390
Failed CHARISMA roll	turn to 238

314

You will have to make a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 18 to win their favour. If you fail, your only other option is to attack one (turn to **522**). If you succeed, you spin a tale of how you heard tell of the Rakshasas who lived in this forest and how you have journeyed far and wide to pay homage. You praise their race for their nobility and humble yourself, declaring the Rakshasa to be the true owners of Chrysoprais. They stare at you coldly, the tiny slits of their cat eyes piercing your soul. Turn to **21**.

315

The ghosts emerge from the forest behind you. Unfortunately for you, it is already nightfall and they fly toward you slowly. You are at the north edge of the forest of Apsaras, and if you have a ship docked here, you can use it to flee the ghosts. Turn to **102** (note this paragraph – **315** so you can return here if you roll a double 1 when you return to your ship).

If you do not have a ship docked here, your only option is to wade into the water and hope the ghosts don't follow. You wade out as far as possible into the freezing water and the pack of ghosts waits for you at the very edge of the beach. They grin with glee as you shiver uncontrollably, both from the cold and the fear. You must spend all night here until the sun rises and sends the ghosts back to the forest. You will have to test your natural hardiness by making a COMBAT roll at a Difficulty of 16. If you succeed, you manage to last the night. Turn to **358**. If you fail the roll, you eventually succumb to the fatigue, cold and fear and you faint. Your unconscious body is washed onto the shore and the ghosts cackle with pleasure. Thankfully you are not conscious for your own demise. Turn to **700**.

316

You are standing at the centre of the forest of Apsaras is the entrance to an ancient underground tomb, surrounded by burial plots. There must be two dozen or more! You will have to pick your way between them to get to the tomb in the centre.

Make a MAGIC roll at a Difficulty of 17.

Successful MAGIC roll	turn to 46
Failed MAGIC roll	turn to 697
Leave without trying	turn to 358

317

You watch in horror as the vampires disembowel your crew one by one, spilling their guts across the deck. Their cries will haunt your dreams forevermore. Your only option is to abandon ship and hope that they don't pursue you. You turn around in preparation to jump when you are confronted by one of the fiends. Luckily the moon is not yet high in the sky, and its strength is halved... but nevertheless a dangerous foe. The vampire screeches like an angry owl and lashes out with its long white talons.

Vampire	COMBAT 15	Defence 18	Stamina 18
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If you defeat the vampire within three combat rounds, it throws up its bloodless hands, utters a terrible howl and vanishes like smoke on the wind.

You dive overboard, turn to **447**. Otherwise you will be surrounded by the creatures of the night, and your carcass is drained of its lifeblood. Turn to **700**.

318

Just when you think your luck has run out, you see an island on the horizon... moving? It is Carapace, the town built on the back of a colossal turtle. You are hoisted up to the streets above. If you have the codeword *Ignoble*, or you are suffering from a disease of any kind, you are thrown back into the water regardless of your screams of protest. Turn back to **447**. Otherwise, you are welcomed aboard, dried off and given food and a place to rest. Turn to **444**.

319

'I guess we could allow someone like yourself into the walls of our royal highness...' mutters one of the guards as the part their ornate spears.

Turn to **400**.

320

You are walking along a quiet path along the southern coast of Chrysoprais. Roll two dice:

2 – 5	Accosted	turn to 231
6 – 8	An uneventful journey	turn to 197
9 – 12	A curious discovery	turn to 413

321

If you arrived here by ship you can set sail. If you did not arrive by ship, you could either wait here and hail a passing vessel or enter a dank looking tunnel in the centre of the island.

The granite archway around the tunnel looks ancient, and on its weather-beaten surface you can just make out old carvings depicting demons bursting forth from hellfire. If you wish to enter the tunnel, you will need a source of light such as a **lantern** or a **candle**. If you are a Mage you can create light through sorcery.

If you arrived by ship and wish to investigate the tunnel, your crew will sail to Mithdrak and await your return. Note that your ship is now docked at Mithdrak.

Enter the tunnel	<i>Into the Underworld</i> 403
Leave the island by ship	turn to 450
Wait for a passing ship	turn to 14

322 □

You gently guide the ship along a prominent ley line and manage to put it in a gentle orbit around the mouth of the vortex. Gain the codeword *Indicate*.

To have harnessed the power of the ley lines is no mean feat. You can feel their power flowing through you and realise that you have learned much from the experience. Tick the box above and raise your MAGIC score to 12. Furthermore, if you are a Mage, roll four dice and if they total higher than your Rank, gain 1 Rank (and 1-6 unwounded Stamina). If the box was already ticked, you learn no further lessons from the experience.

After a few minutes you backtrack your course and return to Umbart's Palace unscathed. Note that your ship is docked here and turn to **163**.

323

You notice the man is not breathing and emanates an eerie aura. Your experience tells you that he is undead. With this knowledge you can approach the man with more caution. If you wish to, gain the codeword *Impeccable* and turn to **126**. Otherwise you could just ignore him and continue on your way. Turn to **79**.

324

You notice an old talwar, the traditional curved sword of Chrysoprais, that to anyone else would be considered trash, however with some effort you could restore it. Note the **ancient scimitar** on your Adventure Sheet if you wish to take it. It has a resale value of only 5 Shards due to its state of disrepair (can be sold in any marketplace), however when you are in a town or city that sells weapons or armour you could attempt to find a blacksmith and restore the weapon. Note the paragraph **436** beside it and turn to that entry in this book when you wish to make the attempt.

There is nothing else for you to do here but leave. Turn to **198**.

325

You are sailing along the eastern coast of Chrysoprais. From the crow's nest you can spy towering cities with beautiful minarets that stretch their way into the sky.

'Should we put in at Mithdrak, cap'n?' asks the bosun.

Follow the coast and dock at Mithdrak	turn to 85
Head northeast into open waters	turn to 190
Head due south	turn to 327
Head east toward the great southern continent	turn to 453

326

The lesser demon grabs you by the throat and hoists you aloft to eye level as his crew of tortured dead and the other two demon captains swarm aboard. They leave your crew alive just long enough to watch what is in store for them. Even if you were to Ulgraghsk you would not survive.

‘Our mistress is greatly disappointed in you, mortal,’ Ulgraghsk roars, his fetid breath bathing your face. ‘She offered you everything... and now she will take it away. Everything.’

He breathes a gout of flame across your head and you cry out in pain as you feel your face melt in the inferno. Ulgraghsk leaves you alive just long enough to tell you that Kæla Karna will ensure that your soul never finds another body. You will be pulled into the Land of Roots to be tormented for all eternity. You are well and truly dead. Erase all ticks and codewords, and begin a new character from **1** in any *Fabled Lands* book.

327

These waters are quite frequently travelled and it is not uncommon to pass multiple other vessels in the same day. Roll two dice:

2 – 4	A storm on the horizon	turn to 193
5 – 9	An uneventful journey	turn to 575
10 – 12	An Atticalan warship	turn to 224

328

You regain consciousness in a large empty room. From the sound of it you are probably in a warehouse in a city harbour. The leader of the brigands checks your bonds to ensure you cannot escape. ‘The ransom will be 600 Shards’ he says coldly as he cleans under his fingernails with a knife. Cross off any money you were carrying (they have taken all of it and you must pay 600 Shards on top of that!), but you will get all your items back if you can pay their ransom. Turn to **449** and check how much you have in the bank, and then turn to the ‘if paying a ransom’ option.

329

To renounce the worship of Alvir and Valmir, you must pay 30 Shards in compensation to the priesthood. The priests advise you not to put to sea for a while after renouncing your initiate’s vows – ‘in case the gods are angered by your faithlessness.’

Do you want to reconsider? If you are determined to renounce your faith, pay the 30 Shards and delete Alvir and Valmir from the God box on your Adventure Sheet. When you have finished here, turn to **380**.

330 □

If the box above is empty, put a tick in it and turn to **288** immediately. If it was already ticked, continue reading.

With the spectral veil over your head the vampires cannot smell the sweet scent of mortal blood and regard you as any other undead. You walk past them nonchalantly, even passing them a greeting.

There are many houses here, all built in an archaic style not unlike the many spired palaces of Chrysoprais. The only difference is there are no stairs. As you walk up the mountain, your focus changes and it feels as if you are walking along a flat path. The buildings that once appear to be spawning from every side of the pinnacle of rock in fact appear on level ground wherever you walk. The experience is both fascinating and confusing at the same time.

Vampires mill the streets and it feels like a twisted mockery of normal life. They discuss trading cargo and the best sites to acquire it, however the only cargo vampires ever need is mortal flesh. You see money changing hands in their marketplace, though strange onyx coins called Mithrals are used in place of Shards. It appears this is the currency of the underworld. You also notice a few trau here and there, trading wares and swapping stories of underworld intrigue. You overhear that an entrance to the underworld can be accessed by ship here, as well as by foot.

Visit the market	turn to 234
Explore the city	turn to 65
Visit the merchant’s guild	turn to 514
Go to the harbour	turn to 740
Leave the city on foot	turn to 430

331

Your ship has been recognised and reported to the authorities and the police captain boards, looking for you intently. The bosun is no expert in lying so he simply keeps his mouth shut. This is a common occurrence for the authorities and you will have to rely on your ingenuity to avoid capture. Make a **THIEVERY** roll at a Difficulty of 21. If you succeed, the captain gives up after a full hour of searching and you are free to go, but your crew are quite shaken by the ordeal. Reduce your crew quality by one step (down to a minimum of poor) and turn to **225**. If you fail, you are quickly discovered hiding in one of the empty rum barrels. You are flogged as a punishment for evading arrest. Lose 3-18 Stamina (the roll of three dice) and if you survive, turn to **589**.

332

‘You want more?! I am the most powerful merchant in Chrysoprais and if you cross me you will never work in this town again!’ He waves his hand and a retinue of personal guards approach you. ‘If you ever return here I will have you arrested immediately!’ Thankfully he gives you the option to go aboard your ship and leave if you have one docked here. If you do have a ship docked here and choose not to take it, you are unlikely to get it back...

Set sail (if you have a ship docked at Kurani)	turn to 382
Return to the city centre	turn to 600

333

You fall through the eternal void for countless aeons. Your mind reels as if you hit the ground from a great distance and you sit up, coughing and spluttering. The young priest at the Temple of Nagil welcomes you back into the world of the living, looking quite proud of his accomplishment. You may turn to **676** and collect any items you desire and/or arrange another resurrection before heading into the town. Turn to **380** when ready.

334

The fish you catch wriggles and squirms and you raise a knife ready to gut it. To your surprise it cries out ‘No! Spare me and I shall reward you, master!’

Spare it	turn to 632
Eat it and be on your way	turn to 395

335 □

If the box above is ticked, turn to **55** immediately. Otherwise, tick it and continue reading.

‘Three random acts of kindness,’ you say to him. ‘Kindness propagates kindness, and in so doing we help ourselves by helping others.’ You feel a little proud of yourself as you say this, and the Saint nods his head in approval.

‘Now,’ he says, ‘what do you want from yourself?’ You furrow your brow. ‘Don’t you mean what do I want from you?’ you ask. He says nothing more and stands, awaiting your answer.

‘Conviction’	turn to 105
‘Forgiveness’	turn to 713
‘Courage’	turn to 166
‘Peace’	turn to 404
‘Nothing’	turn to 699

336

You set foot on the deck and can’t believe your eyes – an army of spectres! By the look of them they were once crewmen, but now their faces are long and drawn, with sunken pale white eyes and translucent flesh. Some of them are gliding down the stairs to the quarters of your crew, completely oblivious to your presence. You get the feeling that if you do not draw attention to yourself they will ignore you.

Attack one of them	turn to 657
Banish them	turn to 588
Stand and watch quietly	turn to 24

337 □

If the box above is already ticked, return to **72** and continue reading. Otherwise, tick it now. You feed and clothe the shipwrecked mariner and provide him with quarters for the night, arranging to drop him off at the next port. That night you awake as a shock of pain runs through your body. The mariner you rescued stands over your bed and has just plunged a makeshift knife into your gut. Roll four dice and lose that many Stamina. If you are still alive, the crewman prepares to drive the weapon into your chest. ‘That’ll teach you to betray me in Ankon-Konu. Finally I have my revenge!’ You will have to fight him without the aid of weapons, armour or any other items.

Enraged Sailor COMBAT 10 Defence 11 Stamina 13

If the man is not dead by the end of the first two rounds of combat, your crewman have heard the commotion and arrive with belaying pins in hand. He is bludgeoned to death. Even after the fight as you patch your horrible wound you still have seem to remember this man at all. Perhaps it happened during the time you lost your memory?

Turn to **650**.

338

As you walk away you can’t help but feel as if a burden was lifted from your shoulders. If you were suffering from a curse you are now cured. If you were not suffering from a curse, instead you have received a blessing for SANCTITY. This allows you to reroll any one failed SANCTITY roll. Once the blessing is used, cross it off your adventure sheet as it cannot be used again until you receive a new one. Note that you cannot have more than one SANCTITY blessing at any one time. If you already had one you receive no additional benefit. Return to **300**.

339

Remember to cross off the 25 Shards if you aren't an initiate of Molhern or don't have the title *Illuminate* of Mohern. Note **MAGIC** in your blessings box. This blessing allow you to reroll any one failed **MAGIC** roll. Once it is used you need only return to the Temple of the Eye for a new one. Note that you may only have one blessing of a particular kind at any one time. Return to **29**.

340

If you are destitute (no money in the bank or in investments, and no weapons or armour on your person or in your chambers if you have them), General Singh will grant you a boon of 250 Shards, and a **scimitar**. He cannot spare any armour or sea vessels due to the oncoming campaign.

Whilst the guards lead you to and from the meeting room you get a good look at the complex halls and corridors of the inner keep. You hear that the rooms are often reorganised to ensure that would-be assassins will have a hard time. You may record the codeword *Impeccable* and turn back to **708**.

341

To convince them to allow you the honour of draining the child's blood, you must either have the title *Unspeakable Cultist* or succeed at a **CHARISMA** roll at a difficulty of 19. If you succeed, turn to **415**. Otherwise, it is simply too late for you to run as the house guard are eyeing you suspiciously. You watch in horror as the child's throat is slit and he is drained of his blood like cattle. Turn to **299**.

342

You grasp your **catastrophe certificate** and close your eyes, awaiting the fateful gust of wind to blow you to safety. It doesn't.

With a deep sense of betrayal you watch your crewmen as they turn to you on the brink of oblivion and scowl. Lose the codeword *Curdle*. You are doomed to fall into the void for eternity. That is unless you collide with something or have the wherewithal to end your life with your own blade. Either way turn to **700**.

343

'I hope you didn't sell the last one...' warns Danuo. 'Well at least you must really like my craftsmanship for you to journey all the way here for another one!' He charges you an additional fee of 7,000 Shards. If you still wish for him to forge you a sword cross the money and the **vulcanium ore** off your Adventure Sheet. Danuo forges you a new sword. Mark the **vulcanium sword (COMBAT +7)** on your list of possessions. Note that this item cannot be stolen or lost by accident due

to the secure belt buckle of toughened vulcanium. The only time you can lose this item is when you willingly relinquish it by specifically leaving it somewhere, if you are stripped of all your possessions, or if you die and are resurrected. Furthermore, as long as you are carrying this sword you are considered to be carrying a **lantern**.

You return to your ship and set sail. Turn to **89**.

344

You wait for rain whilst you scan the horizon for other ships, but to no avail. You watch your crew go mad, and some even try drinking seawater. All of them perish before you. If you have the codeword *Illuminate*, turn to **230**. Otherwise, your death is painfully slow. Turn to **700**.

345 □

If the box above is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading. If it is already ticked, turn back to **231** and choose from the options presented there.

As the leader's brow furrows in thought, you look down and notice that the other arm he holds by his side is missing a hand. A glimmer of recognition crosses his face and he shrieks in terror. The other three look to each other in confusion as their leader runs off in panic, and they quickly follow suit.

All you can do is shrug and continue on your way. Turn to **197**.

346

You eventually find their headquarters, and are ushered into a main room. You note that the building is well guarded, and they must pay the few officials in Kurani to stay out of their business. If you have the title *Nightstalker* or the codeword *Indefinite*, turn to **756**. Otherwise, you will have to gain their trust before you are considered welcome to dabble in brotherhood affairs.

Make a **THIEVERY** roll at a Difficulty of 23. Add 1 to your roll if you are a *Rogue* and another 1 for each of the following codewords you may have; *Bullion*, *Evade*, *Fracas*, and *Incomplete*.

Successful THIEVERY roll	turn to 756
Failed THIEVERY roll	turn to 600

347

The merchant's guild in Auriculum is extremely busy, with the wealthy from all over the *Fabled Lands* checking on investments and banking their large profits as they capitalise on the recent trade situation. Here you can bank your money for safe-keeping – or invest it in guild enterprises in the hope of turning

a profit. If you have the codeword *Incomplete* and not the codeword *Face*, turn to **596** immediately.

You find that the thriving textile industry in Auriculum has a significant affect on the economy of the cities nearby. Record the codeword *Intrinsic* and then choose from the options presented below:

- Make a deposit or withdrawal turn to **449**
- Make an investment turn to **757**
- Check on investments turn to **538**

When you are ready to return to the city centre, turn to **380**.

348 □

If you have both the codewords *Indra* and *Illustrate*, turn to **111**. Otherwise, exploring this district is very depressing, and the social divide between rich and poor is most obvious. The despondent peasants of Mithdrak wander through the streets begging, stealing, or working dangerous jobs just to make a living. There is very little to find here except the misery and suffering of the marginalised citizens of Chrysoprais.

Whilst you are here, roll three dice. This is the number of Shards you must cross off, either having been stolen or forced to give to beggars just to leave you alone! Now if the box above is already ticked, turn back to **50**. If the box is empty, put a tick in it and turn to **494**.

349

When you are close enough to see the inside of the main building through the archway, a voice hisses from within. ‘Who disturbs our peace?’ A group of a dozen men and women in purple velvet robes are prostrated in front of a demonic figure of a black snake-headed woman. She points at you with one of her four arms, beckoning you forward. Turn to **554**

350

You are sailing in the Cragdrift sea. Krateros lies far to the west, and the domain of the masked lords lies closer to the east. You estimate your position to lie roughly on the latitude of the Icicle Woods.

- Head north *Legions of the Labyrinth* **50**
- Head east *The Court of Hidden Faces* **81**
- Head south turn to **172**
- Head west turn to **89**

351 □

You are welcomed to spend as much time as you want in this idyllic setting. Restore all lost Stamina points. If you are a Wayfarer, you learn a lot from their approach to life and the opportunity to talk with these people broadens your mind. If the box above is empty, put a tick in it and roll four dice. If you roll higher than your Rank, gain 1 Rank and add 1-6 Stamina to your unwounded score. If the box was already ticked, you enjoy your return here and recuperate, but do not learn anything further. Turn to **444**.

352

When you put your pack down and move closer to the group, the mermaid recognises the items you are carrying and they all leap back into the sea. She turns and curses at you in their alien tongue. If you had a blessing of Safety from Storms, cross it off your Adventure Sheet. If you didn’t, cross off any other blessing of your choice and turn to **197**.

353 □

If the box above is already ticked, turn to **227**. Otherwise put a tick in it and continue reading. You are walking through the dank forest and leap nearly five feet into the air when you feel the cold steel of an arrowhead pressed against your temple. You have no idea how someone could get past your defences so quietly, and your heart beats in your chest as you turn slowly to look at your assailant. A group of three men twice your height and covered in orange and black fur stare coldly into your eyes. Their heads are those of tigers and they look as if they carry the same predatory nature, though equipped with the oversized weapons of humans. Surprisingly you are not dead yet and they look at you as if waiting for something. If you are carrying a **sapphire pendant**, turn to **437** immediately. Otherwise you could:

- Try diplomacy turn to **314**
- Attack one of them turn to **522**

354

You nearly stumble over a dead body.

- Investigate it turn to **608**
- Ignore it turn to **316**

355

You recall from arcane lore that the hand of a thief can be used as a potent spell component or magical item. Perhaps you could find a wizard who will

pay good money for it. Note the **severed hand** on your Adventure Sheet if you wish to take it and turn to **528**.

356

You enjoy the rest of the party and are well fed. Restore 3 stamina points if wounded. The relaxation time was well deserved but you soon tire of the pomp and pageantry. Return to **50**.

357

If you are a Warrior, turn to **25** immediately. Otherwise, continue reading. The shipwrecked man is hoisted aboard and thanks you profusely for saving him.

Roll two dice:

2 – 4	turn to 119
5 – 9	turn to 526
10 – 12	turn to 48

358

You are standing on the northernmost edge of the forest of Apsaras. If you have a ship here and wish to set sail, turn to **102**. Otherwise you can either make your way to the south side of the forest by walking around the coast, or you could enter the forest.

Walk along the coast	turn to 505
Enter the Forest of Apsaras	turn to 548

359

Outrunning three pentameters will not be an easy task. You rally the crew. Roll three dice and add your Rank. Deduct 1 if you have a poor crew, add 1 if you have a good crew, or 2 if you have an excellent crew.

22 or less	Prepare to be boarded	turn to 547
23 +	You outrun them	turn to 650

360

The road between Kurani and Mithdrak is well travelled by merchants and traders.

Roll two dice:

2 – 4	An entourage	turn to 432
5 – 9	An uneventful journey	turn to 291
10 – 12	A passing merchant	turn to 64

361

They have discovered your identity and you are sent to the gallows immediately. A priest comes forward to read your last rights. ‘Your death will be long and painful,’ he says as the noose is slung over your neck. ‘Oh,’ he adds casually ‘and we will also ensure that the gods see fit not to return your treacherous soul to the world of the living...’

This is truly the end for you. Not even a resurrection arrangement will save you now. Begin a new character from **1** in any *Fabled Lands* book.

362

You round a corner into an alley and a quickly prepare yourself. As the band of thugs turn the corner you skilfully dispatch the first two in line and then turn to the others. They approach you drawing long wavy daggers. You will have to fight the remaining three as one opponent:

Mercenaries COMBAT 14 Defence 15 Stamina 15

For every 5 Stamina the mercenaries lose, reduce both their COMBAT and Defence values by 1. If you win, you can take their knives, but they carry no other loot. List five **kris** on your Adventure sheet and turn to **50**. If you lose, turn to **283**.

363

The Kurani marketplace has run dry of arms and armour. The general at the Crimson Fort has purchased all available supplies and it appears that he is stockpiling for an extended campaign. On the up side, these things are in big demand here and you may be able to profit from his venture. Also, note that in Chrysoprais, to wear the hide or skin of a dead animal is considered uncouth, and as such leather armour is not available. Chrysopraisians tend to use thick cloths instead of leather.

<i>Armour</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Leather Armour (Defence +1)	-	-
Ring mail (Defence +2)	-	120 Shards
Chain mail (Defence +3)	-	300 Shards
Splint armour (Defence +4)	-	450 Shards

<i>Weapons</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
No COMBAT bonus	100 Shards	60 Shards
COMBAT bonus +1	400 Shards	300 Shards
COMBAT bonus +2	-	600 Shards

<i>Magical Items</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Amber Wand (MAGIC +1)	500 Shards	400 Shards
Ebony Wand (MAGIC +2)	-	800 Shards

<i>Other Items</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Compass (SCOUTING +1)	-	450 Shards
Lockpicks (THIEVERY +1)	320 Shards	290 Shards
Magic lockpicks (THIEVERY +2)	-	600 Shards
Rope	50 Shards	45 Shards
Lantern	100 Shards	90 Shards
Climbing Gear	-	90 Shards

When you are finished here, return to **600**.

364

The vampire is desperate and will readily believe anything you say if it means he may be saved. You convince it that you will donate some of your blood if it gives you some information. The vampire tells you that it was bosun aboard an Iambic pentameter that had departed in search of fresh blood from the realm of mortals. He made a mistake insulting the captain and was thrown overboard. As vampires cannot tolerate running water but need not breathe, it floundered in the darkness of the deep ocean for days, desperately avoiding the sunlight. Eventually he was washed ashore this evening, but had barely enough energy to stand, let alone hunt.

‘Iambus?’ you ask.

‘Yes, our homeland,’ it responds. ‘But I am sworn to secrecy.’ It takes a lot of coercing but eventually you force it to spill the information. ‘The town lies on an huge rocky outcrop off the edge of the world, completely invisible from sea level. Being off the edge ensures that we can live in perpetual darkness and need never fear the sun.’ He goes on to explain that the only way to access it is to locate a major ley line that runs directly off the Edge of the World and only a skilled navigator can use it to guide his ship safely over the edge to port Iambus. Gain the codeword *Iambus* and put one tick beside it if you didn’t have it. If you already have the codeword Iambus, put a tick in the next empty box beside it.

‘Now, some blood...’ he pleads.

You ask where exactly Iambus is, but it realises that you have played it for a fool and refuses to give away any more information. ‘You will never find it!’ it yells, ‘and even if you do, you will be devoured before you even set foot on our land – such is the delicious scent of your blood!’ As the first rays of the sun creep over the horizon it cries out in agony. You take morbid pleasure watching the unholy creature suffer... the sunlight must be excruciating in its weakened state.

Finally it utters a terrible howl and vanishes like smoke on the wind. You continue your journey. Turn to **79**.

365

An artefact of ancient Chrysopraisian culture stands near the town centre. A huge stone monolith on which is carved the figure of a tall, turbaned man holding a scimitar. Sobha Rana was one of the oldest gods of the people of these islands, before even they were even referred to as the thousand-spire islands. Back when the people of Chysoprais lived in thatch huts and hunted wild game, before their ascent to a decadent culture, they worshipped the god of the hunt who provided them with nourishment. He was said to wield a scimitar that always pointed unerringly north when thrown to the ground. The monolith is weathered and has been broken many times over the centuries. It has been restored but is largely ignored by the people of Auriculum.

You can leave 30 Shards at the base of the monolith and pray (turn to **492**). Otherwise there is little else to do here. Turn back to **380**.

366

The water is filled with a viscous oil as you sever the tip of the tentacle that had you ensnared. Lungs bursting for air you swim back to the surface and inhale the fresh sea air. Roll two dice and if the total is higher than your SCOUTING score, increase it by 1. Your crew hoist you back aboard. Turn to **450**.

367

The sea tosses fretfully, the sky is thick with muttering clouds. ‘Storms or dark sorcery,’ remarks the bosun in a doomful voice. If you have a blessing of Safety from Storms, cross it off and turn to **225**. Otherwise turn to **722**.

368

Your piety and strong words make the demon captain unsure of whether to risk attempting an abduction. They return to their ship and let you go free. The bosun turns to you, knees still trembling. ‘I aint never seen a cap’n brave as you! I thought we were gonners!’

The demons are not without malice though. As soon as they are out of sight you begin to feel particularly thirsty. You have been cursed. Until you find some way to remove the Curse of Unquenchable Thirst you will lose one point from your *unwounded and current* Stamina scores every time you turn to a new entry. If you are reduced to zero Stamina (either wounded or unwounded) you are of course dead and must turn to **700**. Note that when you

have the curse lifted or if you are resurrected, your normal unwounded Stamina score will return to its normal value. If you have the codeword *Illuminate*, turn to **692**. Otherwise, turn to **475** and lose one Stamina...

369

You are welcomed in private by the Prince and he awards you all the comforts that he could not otherwise give in public. You are provided with new clothing of fine silks and encouraged to sit by the fire and share a fine wine. The Prince tells you that a privateer in Dangor is amassing quite a powerful influence in the silk trade in the east. Apparently he has found a cheaper and faster way to produce textiles and his enterprise is reducing the economic power of the textile industry in Chrysoprais.

‘I want you to kill him,’ he says, as if on a whim.

If you accept the mission, record the codeword *Indecent*. He also tells you that he may have other missions for you to work on, and will send messengers to meet you and pass on information when he has worked out the details. He will be monitoring your travels closely so you could be approached by one of his trusted messengers anywhere. He makes you memorise a greeting to confirm your identity with the messengers and a cipher to decode his instructions.

Turn to **400**.

370 □

If the box above is already ticked, turn to **18** immediately. If it is empty, tick it and continue reading. A familiar sight approaches, the same boy you remember flying his carpet toward you again. He stops next to you. ‘Well, you walk this path a lot don’t you?’ If you have the codeword *Impudence*, lose it and he throws you a pouch of 250 Shards.

Down the path you see a troop of armed men riding horses toward the two of you. ‘Apprehend him!’ yells the leader. The boy looks over his shoulder but appears unfazed by the approaching threat. ‘Hey, you wanna come with me?’ he asks eagerly.

Apprehend the boy	turn to 272
Jump on the carpet	turn to 627
Do nothing	turn to 558

371

If you wish to access the secret library now, turn to **114** now. Otherwise, return to **29** and choose from the options presented.

372

Many artificers offer you the opportunity to upgrade your weapons or armour. With all the competition you can find a good deal. At the cost of 250 Shards for a weapon (only 100 Shards for armour) you can have your item enchantment increased by +1. This can be done multiple times up to the maximum limit of a +6 bonus. So **leather armour (Defence +1)** can be enchanted up to five times to make **enchanted leather (Defence +6)**, but **heavy plate (Defence +6)** does not benefit at all from enchantment. Likewise a **sword** without a combat bonus can be made an **enchanted sword (COMBAT +1)** with one successful attempt, all the way up to six attempts for a COMBAT bonus of +6. A weapon that already has a +6 bonus cannot be enchanted further. As a side note, unique or nonstandard items that are weapons or armour such as a **wizard’s cape (defence +1)**, **regal helm (Defence +3)**, or **rakshasa scimitar (COMBAT +5)** can all be enchanted as normal as long as they have a bonus of less than +6. Nonstandard items like **rings** or **sceptres** that have a COMBAT or Defence bonus but are not weapons or armour cannot be enchanted in this way.

The artificer reminds you that there is always a risk that the item cannot contain the magic imbued in it, and it may be destroyed. If you decide to have it enchanted you are asked to sign a disclaimer removing the artificer from all responsibility should anything go wrong. If you do not wish to have your item enchanted, turn back to **280**.

The artificer tells you that enchantments are done in increments so as not to cause irreparable damage to the item. You must cross off the money for one enchantment attempt now and turn to **307**. You will then be redirected here so you have a choice to attempt again or leave.

373

If you have the codeword *Ibis*, turn to **676**. If you have the codeword *Impromptu*, turn to **257** immediately. Otherwise, continue reading.

You are ushered in to see the head priest, who is far younger than you had expected. He gestures for you to sit, and explains that the previous head priest died of old age a few years back. ‘The one thing our sweet lord Nagil cannot reverse,’ he says with a far away look in his eye. ‘Unfortunately, many of our religious secrets died along with him, and there are very few priests of Nagil in Chrysoprais! I have yet to learn the secret to resurrection.’ He explains that he requires something called a **book of the dead**, a manuscript which includes this among other things. I am told that you can find one in the City of the Dead, deep within the forest of Rakshasas on the mainland. ‘If you

were to bring this to me I would be ever so grateful,' he says. If you wish to undertake this quest, record the codeword *Impromptu* and turn to **380**.

374

The rope goes taught and jerks your neck back violently. Roll five dice and lose that many Stamina. As you hang there, barely conscious you contemplate your demise. Minutes pass before you regain your senses and swing to a nearby outcropping. Turn to **296**.

375

You are sailing on the same latitude as Port Skios and Aku. To the north lies the port of Kunrir, south east lie the Innis Shoals.

Head North toward Kunrir	<i>The Court of Hidden Faces</i>	400
Plot a course for Aku	<i>The Court of Hidden Faces</i>	200
Head East to the Violet Ocean	<i>Over the Blood-Dark Sea</i>	58
Head South		turn to 617
Plot a course for Umbart's Vortex		turn to 303
Sail around Umbart's Vortex toward Cragdrift Sea		turn to 172

376 □

If the box above is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading. If it was already ticked, turn to **679** immediately. You spend a night dreaming of drowning in icy waters, sinking like a rock to the bottom of the ocean. In the pitch black void the only thing you can feel are cold, clammy hands clutching at your throat. You awaken with a start... was it really a dream? Lose one Rank. Roll one die and lose that many Stamina *permanently*. Turn to **150**.

377

Your protest is enough to halt the execution and reopen the case, wherein you vouch for Aklar's identity. He is soon set free and thanks you. 'Looks like I saved your life' you say. 'Should we consider that a debt repaid?' Aklar shrugs. 'I had a resurrection arrangement anyway,' he mentions casually. 'But thanks anyway. Consider it repaid.' Lose the codeword *Aklar* and turn to **50**.

378

The merchant sighs as he watches his ship and cargo fall beneath the waves. 'You realise you will have to pay for your folly', he states coldly. 'The ship and cargo together were easily worth 1,000 Shards, so I would say 1,500 Shards would pay for my time and inconvenience.' He asks to be dropped at the nearest port where you can make the required financial arrangements. If you agree, cross off 1,500

Shards from your cash or turn to **501** and cross off the money from your bank account. Then, turn to either **260** if you want to drop him off in Kurani or **106** for Auriculum.

If you can't or won't pay, you can always just throw him overboard. Turn to **156**.

379

If you have either or both of the codewords *Ill* or *Just* turn to **241** immediately. Otherwise, you think you recognise a ship sailing not too far starboard, but as soon as you climb to the crow's nest you dismiss your suspicions. Turn to **150**.

380

Auriculum is the southernmost port in Chrysoprais, and perhaps in all the *Fabled Lands*. Despite its geographical isolation from much of the northern and western continents, Auriculum is a thriving mercantile city, known particularly for its silks. Almost every Chrysopraisan noble wears garbs from here. You can see open markets with the widest array of coloured garments you have ever seen!

Auriculum is also reputed to be the religious capital of Chrysoprais, with a prominent temple to the Sage of Peace and even permitting the practice and worship of the new gods. You can buy some of the most coveted religious trinkets in this very market.

Go to the market	turn to 284
Go to a tavern	turn to 35
Go to the financial institution	turn to 347
Visit the temple to the Sage of Peace	turn to 268
Visit the temple of Alvir and Valmir	turn to 556
Visit the temple of Nagil	turn to 116
Visit the shrine of Sobha Rana	turn to 365
Explore the harbour	turn to 106
Leave the city by sea	turn to 80
Leave the city north on foot	turn to 682

381

Suddenly a current pulls your ship into a dizzying spin. A blessing of safety from storms will not save you here, however if you have a **catastrophe certificate** you may cross it off and turn to **500**. Otherwise, you spot a huge vortex ahead in your path. You doubt that escape in the cutter would be wise with such a strong current, and your only available option would be to attempt to steady your ship and navigate your way out of danger.

Make a MAGIC roll at a Difficulty of 19. If you succeed, you locate one of the powerful ley lines that influences the current deep below the sea and you manage to navigate out of its path. Turn to **500**. Otherwise, you are pulled inexorably toward to swirling funnel. Turn to **28**.

382

Policing in the waters between Atticala and Chrysoprais has increased recently due to the growing tension from rumours suggesting that the Crimson Fort is planning a large campaign to attack the great western continent. Roll two dice:

2 – 4	A storm on the horizon	turn to 367
5 – 9	An uneventful voyage	turn to 225
10 – 12	A regular patrol	turn to 81

383

You are lost in the mountains.

Roll two dice:

2 – 5	A cold night	turn to 138
6 – 8	A thief in the night	turn to 460
9 – 12	An old shrine	turn to 656

384 □

If you do not wish to execute the plan to assassinate the general now, return to **708** and choose an option from the list. If you do wish to make the attempt now, tick the box above and continue reading. If the box was already ticked, turn to **445** immediately.

You know General Murtabaht Singh is an experienced warrior, so your best bet would be to sneak into his chambers under the cover of darkness and kill him in his sleep. A good knowledge of the keep schematics would aid in this mission. Make a THIEVERY roll at a Difficulty 21 (or 19 if you have the codeword *Impeccable*).

Successful THIEVERY roll	turn to 593
Failed THIEVERY roll	turn to 207

385

‘Vulcanium is a rare metal mined directly from the root of volcanoes. Some consider it magical in nature, but everyone agrees that it is the strongest metal in all the *Fabled Lands*. I recall a colleague of mine from Dweomer, back in the days of my schooling... what was his name... Danuo? That’s right. Well he now spends his life researching the magical properties of Vulcanium, and I hear he has taken on the blacksmith life in solitude on an uncharted island.’ He walks over to a huge

stack of maps and ruffles through them. ‘Here it is,’ he points to the tiniest spec of land somewhere along the latitude of Krateros, south of the Arches of Jarm. Note the codeword *Iteration*.

The trau quickly usher you back to your ship and tell you to leave the vortex. Turn to **52**. If you do not have a ship docked here, turn to **616**.

386

‘5,000 Shards,’ he says. You look inside the sizable pouch he handed you and it looks to be correct. You hand over the **golden katana** before he changes his mind. Cross it off your Adventure Sheet and add the money to your petty cash. If you were suffering from the Curse of Covetousness, it has been lifted and you may return your ability scores to normal. Turn to **400**.

387

Many of the items are long since rusted or beyond repair, however you do find a small cache of very old shards. Add 650 Shards to your money. However your greed has disrupted the peace of this place. Lose one point of SANCTITY. Now if you are a Warrior, turn to **324**. Otherwise, there is nothing else to do here and you must leave. Turn to **198**.

388

The call is irresistible and you begin to dance with them, whirling and spinning until the sun goes down. The moment the last ray of sunlight dips below the horizon the dervishes reveal their true forms – twisted, malevolent spirits intent on consuming you. You are still caught in their spell and your body continues to dance, whilst your mind cries out to stop. You will have to rely on your natural purity to deflect their attempts to devour you.

Make a SANCTITY roll at a Difficulty of 17.

Successful SANCTITY roll	turn to 716
Failed SANCTITY roll	turn to 700

389

The **unicorn’s horn** is used up in the creation process so you must cross it (and the cash) off your Adventure Sheet. A few days later the artificer calls you back into his workshop and presents you with the same horn – it is almost unchanged! Perhaps he just took your cash? Either way, the item now radiates an aura of evil. Small plants wither around it, children cry without reason and animals panic. This is a **rod of woe (MAGIC +5)**, and whilst you carry it your SANCTITY *score* is reduced by 1. This penalty can of course be mitigated by other items, and the moment you leave the item anywhere (in a town house or

sell it) your SANCTITY score will return to normal. The rod leaves disease in your wake. Trees cease to bear fruit and some people even break out in boils. Any time you enter combat you may allow the opponent to have the first attack (instead of the normal rule of you striking first). If you do so, you can use the power of the rod and as you level it at your target they break out in festering boils and immediately suffer 2-12 damage (the roll of two dice). This ability can only be used at the beginning of combat and once only. Furthermore, whilst you carry the **rod of woe** you are completely immune to disease. Anytime you would be affected by a disease (not poison) in text, you are considered to have a Blessing of Immunity to Disease/poison. This is never used up and affects you until you relinquish the rod. If an effect is not specified as either a disease or poison but asks whether you have the blessing, treat it as if you do have the blessing.

Turn to **280**.

390

They are convinced that you aren't a threat. You could leave now if you wanted (turn to **4**). Otherwise, you earn their trust by participating in the beginning of the ritual, giving a sly wink to the young man to be sacrificed. You will need to strike at exactly the right moment.

Make a COMBAT or THIEVERY roll at Difficulty 20, adding 1 if you are a Rogue.

Successful COMBAT or THIEVERY roll	turn to 215
Failed COMBAT or THIEVERY roll	turn to 238

391

To your surprise, your ship is carried safely into a harbour where dozens of Iambic pentameters are also docked. It is bizarre that the water fall plummets into the void below and yet your ship remains suspended there as if defying the laws of nature. In fact, you should be falling off the deck to your doom, but instead you are able to walk about it freely. Your mind reels in confusion as you see the huge projection of rock now standing above you like a mountain, yet the buildings now appear to be on their sides...

You shake your head and try to refocus, but it takes some time. Many of the other crewmen are feeling dizzy, and the bosun walks across the deck to you as if on a tightrope, expecting to fall off at any moment. 'The place is unnatural, cap'n. The men will stay here. We'll not follow you.'

You grab your belongings and leap onto the jetty, which leads to the base of the 'mountain'. Note that your ship is now docked at Iambus. Up ahead you can see the pale forms of vampires milling about the harbour. They turn to acknowledge you.

If you have a **spectral veil**, turn to **330**. Otherwise, turn to **256**.

392

Remember to cross off the 500 Shards, and then roll two dice:

2 – 3	Item is destroyed. Cross it off and turn to 280
4 – 6	No effect, your money is wasted. Turn back to 515
7 – 12	Restore one charge and turn back to 515

393

Your crew will not follow you regardless of your leadership. You lung forward with your weapon and Heilmir bellows in rage, bringing a fist twice the size of a galleon down onto your ship. Gain the codeword *Infidel*. Roll five dice and if you roll higher than your Rank you are killed instantly. Turn to **700**. If you roll equal to or below your Rank you throw yourself into the sea at the last moment and avoid the fate of your crew. Cross off your ship and crew as you will never see them again. Turn to **447**.

394

If you succeeded at the CHARISMA roll, you manage to strike a bargain allowing you to go free as a trade for the lives of your crew. If you succeeded at the SANCTITY roll, the creatures cannot harm you and you are 'spared' and thrown overboard. Your crew are not so lucky. Cross off your ship and crew as you will never see them again. Turn to **447**.

395

Now, will you head north to the forest of Apsaras, or south to the town of Auriculum?

Head to Auriculum	turn to 380
Head to the forest	turn to 281

396

You turn and stand your ground. The ghosts swarm around and encircle you, ensuring there will be no escape should you fail...

Make a SANCTITY roll at a Difficulty of 20.	
Successful SANCTITY roll	turn to 546
Failed SANCTITY roll	turn to 700

397

To his surprise you raise your weapon and set him free. He flees as quickly as possible, and when the thief thinks he is just out of earshot you hear cackles of laughter. You have a sinking feeling that you may have made an unwise

decision. Checking your pack you find that one item is missing (your choice). Gain the codeword *Insolent* and turn to **528**.

398

The pirates' treasure comprises 1,000 Shards, which you can record on your Adventure Sheet. Your mate suggests taking the **pirate captain's head** in case it carries a bounty. Their ship's hold contains 1 Cargo unit, which you can add to your own cargo if you have room for it. Roll one die to see what kind of cargo you will find:

- 1 – 2 Timber
- 3 – 4 Textiles
- 5 – 6 Metals

You also get a chance to increase in Rank after your stirring leadership in battle. Roll three dice, and if the result is greater than your current Rank then you gain a Rank. You also gain 1-6 Stamina points permanently: increase your normal (unwounded) Stamina score by the roll of one die. Remember that going up in Rank may increase your defence (see rules section).

Once you have made the necessary adjustments on your Adventure Sheet, turn to **150**.

399

You will have to fight them without the aid of weapons or armour, however if you were carrying a **ring** or **cape** you may include any bonuses from them. Your crew will not interfere in police business. You are beset by nearly a dozen guards wielding clubs. Treat them as one opponent:

Mithdrak Guards COMBAT 17 Defence 17 Stamina 40

The guards are attempting to apprehend you and will not deal you lethal damage. If you are reduced below 1 Stamina, instead leave your current Stamina total at 1 and turn to **589**. If you win, you incapacitate all the guards and the captain vows to return with more forces. They limp back to their ship and you are free to go... for now. Gain the codeword *Incomplete* if you didn't already have it and turn to **325**.

400

Before you had entered these walls, you thought that the wealthy district was rich, but this makes them seem like a slum. Private estates sprawl around the base of the palace, each as beautiful as the last. Public gardens are available at every street corner, and Chrysopraisian nobles allow their children to play freely, without fear of crime. The land within the walls is reserved for only the richest of merchants and investors, who rub shoulders with the most prestigious of retired heroes. All

the wealth here pales in comparison to the royal palace itself. The palace grounds have every symbol of the riches of the *Fabled Lands*, such as manicured blue grass gardens from Ankon-Konu and expensive masonry from Atticala. Even the paths leading to the palace are made from imported marble. A passer-by tells you that the royal family enjoy throwing around their riches and especially love the stories of heroes. If you consider yourself a heroic adventurer, perhaps you will find opportunity within the palace?

- Enter the Palace Grounds (11th Rank or higher) turn to **101**
- Browse the royal bazaar turn to **10**
- Rob the treasury turn to **763**
- Return to the real world turn to **50**

401

You can rest and recuperate here for as long as you wish, and you may restore your Stamina to full. You may also be treated by the medics for diseases here for the nominal fee of 5 Shards. Mark any possessions or money you would like to leave here in the box below

Possessions in Knight's Chambers

Whilst you are in the keep you may practice swordplay with your fellow soldiers. They warn you that they won't be holding back just because you are a Crimson Knight (turn to **549**). Otherwise, return to **708** and choose from the options there.

402

With a bit of skill and luck you manage to get control of the of the ship in time, your crew working hard to take advantage of the winds and steer clear of the Edge of the World. Feeling both amazed and humbled by the experience you plot a course back to the world of men. Turn to **660**.

403

You talk about the Demon Lord you worship, the trials you had to undergo for initiation and the precepts of the deity. Umbart is very impressed and claps his hands with glee. 'This will make a great addition to my new research paper!' he clicks his fingers and a trau servant escorts you to collect a reward. Turn to **7**.

404

He holds out his hand. You place yours in his palm and feel your body imbued with holy energy. Cross off any prior Resurrection Arrangement you may have had and write Vulture's Peak, *The Isle of a Thousand Spires* 199. The Saint disappears in the blink of an eye and you descend the peak. Turn to 524.

405 □

If the box above is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading. If it was already ticked, turn to 107 immediately.

You pass a group of priests with shaven heads and bright orange robes. They are on a pilgrimage to Vulture Peak to help the poor homeless people who live there. 'They pray for salvation, but do not realise that the Sage of Peace does not give,' says the eldest monk. 'I pity them,' says the youngest, 'for the help they desire will not come to those who do not work for it.'

You scratch your head. 'But doesn't that mean that they would just be helping themselves anyway?' you say with a puzzled look. The eldest priest just smiles at you. Perhaps he knows something you don't...

'Here,' says the youngest priest as he hands you a talisman. 'This may help you in your search for enlightenment,' he says. Add the **paradise talisman (SANCTITY +2)** to your possessions if you wish to take it.

'A very generous gift!' you say, thanking them with a bow. The eldest priest continues smiling. 'In giving to others, we receive,' he says cryptically. 'Thankyou.' They depart for the mountains.

You muse about why he would thank you for giving *you* a gift. Turn to 448.

406

The moment you loosen your grip the traitorous wretch squirms around and bites off your little finger with his sharpened teeth! Lose one point of unwounded Stamina *permanently*. He scurries back up the beach. Gain the codeword *Insolent* if you didn't already have it and turn to 275.

407

She looks you up and down and sighs. 'A pity indeed,' she hisses, 'that our lord's treacherous sister has already claimed thee.' She reaches a hand toward the hilt of a large scimitar. 'What a waste.'

You could either hastily pledge yourself to the Demon Lord Kumba Karna (turn to 236). Otherwise, turn to 433.

408

The **hyperium wand** is used up in the creation process so you must cross it (and the cash) off your Adventure Sheet. A few days later the artificer calls you back into his workshop and presents you with a plain looking ring. Note on your possessions that you now have a **ring of ultimate power (+1 all abilities, +2 Rank, +10 Stamina)**. While you carry the ring, all your abilities (ie. CHARISMA, COMBAT, MAGIC and so on) are increased by one. Remember that if you are carrying another item with a higher bonus for a specific ability, use that one instead for that ability – the bonuses are not cumulative. Your Rank is also increased by two (which may increase your Defence by 2 if under 12th Rank), and your total unwounded Stamina score is increased by 10. If you ever lose the ring you will have to restore everything to normal.

Turn to 280.

409

To your surprise, the dog-headed demon kneels at your feet and bows its head. If you have *any* codewords beginning with the letter *L*, turn to 112 immediately. Otherwise, the demon introduces himself as Ulgraghsk the Lesser, on a mission from his mistress Kæla Karna, a Demon Lord of the underworld.

'Mistress Kæla has watched your progress and invites you for an audience,' Ulgraghsk growls in the most sophisticated voice he can manage. 'And she grants you this boon,' he says gesturing to his left. You cannot believe what you are hearing... he is offering one of the ships! You spend some time with the demon, as your crew watch on in terror. Ulgraghsk explains that Demon Lords often petition the services of mortals to serve them in tasks they could not accomplish themselves, such as spreading their word and will in the world of mortals. You get the feeling that there is a great deal of competition between the Demon Lords for control over powerful mortals such as yourself.

'Should you be inclined to journey to the Land of Roots now, I have instructed your new crew to follow you without question.' If you wish to board your new ship and descend into the underworld now, turn to 441 in *Into the Underworld*. Otherwise, Ulgraghsk understands if you have matters to resolve in the realm of mortals before you begin your journey into hell. 'Whenever you are ready to meet with our mistress, return here. We will be watching...'

Turn to 475.

410

You search the ship for all the heavy items you can find and stuff them into potato sacks. You tie them to your feet and take a kitchen knife to release them when necessary. The moment you dive into the water you sink like a rock, just as planned. The water grows dark quickly. If you are a Mage, you can illuminate your belt buckle like a torch. Otherwise you will need a **lantern** (not a **candle** as it doesn't have watertight shutters). Without a light source you have no hope of finding what Heilmir requested and must cut the weights and return to the surface. You have failed. Turn to **275**. If you do have a light source, you illuminate the area around you and the sensation of fear grips you as you are surrounded by utter darkness and desolation.

Make a SANCTITY or COMBAT roll at a Difficulty of 19 to test your mettle. If you succeed, turn to **232**. If you fail, you bottle out, cutting the weights and swimming to the surface in panic. Turn to **275**.

411

These waters are frequented by merchants and relatively safe with the strict policing of piracy. Roll two dice:

2 – 4	Ship on fire!	turn to 707
5 – 9	An uneventful journey	turn to 250
10 – 12	Merchants	turn to 569

412 □

'Saving a life is reward enough,' you say, passing the man's few worldly possessions back to him. The remaining crewmen are so impressed with your generosity that they pledge themselves to serve faithfully aboard your ship. They turn out to be quite skilled mariners and you may increase your crew quality to Excellent (if it wasn't already).

Now, if the box above is already ticked, turn to **625** immediately. Otherwise put a tick in it and continue reading. Gain the codeword *Innocent*. If you are a Priest *and* an initiate of the Sage of Peace, you feel as if you are gradually gaining insight into the person you must become. Roll four dice and if you roll higher than your current Rank, gain 1 Rank. Roll one die and add this number to your normal (unwounded) Stamina score. Turn to **625**.

413 □

As you look out across the ocean on your pleasant stroll, some movement on the coast draws your eye. A few dozen metres down you spy a group of merfolk basking on some rocks in the warm glow of the sun. They are blissfully unaware of you and lie on their backs with their eyes closed.

Climb down to them	turn to 542
Ignore them and continue	turn to 197

414

You manage to leap into the cover of some bushes in time to see a large insect burst through the undergrowth. It is a bombardier beetle the size of a large dog! It clicks its mandibles and prowls around the area you were in. Luckily insects like this don't have a sense of smell, and have very poor vision, so you sit tight and wait until it gets bored and leaves.

You continue on your trek. Turn to **227**.

415

You boast of your sacrificial skill and they allow you to do the honours. You are handed the obsidian knife and the watch in anticipation. It would be foolish to attempt to escape with a defenceless child through the front door, so your only other option would be to escape out the window. You may grab the child and flee by turning to **87**. Otherwise you will have to follow through with the despicable act. Turn to **712**.

416

You recognise the schematics as one of the mansions you walked past near the Prince's mansion. You make it known that you have ample experience to be an asset in their upcoming raid and you are invited to join. They explain that the house belongs to one of the riches merchants in Chrysoprais, a man named Harvin Vishuamitra. They intend to rob it, and you are offered an equal share if you contribute significantly to the plan.

If you decline the offer, turn to **600** now. Otherwise, you make your way with half a dozen other expert housebreakers to the merchant's mansion. It is indeed a gaudy display of riches, with expensive golden spires and a two metre wall around the grounds. You will have to make a THIEVERY roll at a Difficulty of 19. If you are successful, turn to **754**. If you fail, the other rogues make it inside but you are spotted by a guard patrol and forced to run for your life. Gain the codeword *Incomplete* if you didn't have it already and turn to **600**.

417

The ship pulls alongside. The pirates cast out grappling hooks and within moments are swarming aboard. You offer the captain your goods in exchange for your freedom.

Make a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 17

Successful CHARISMA roll
Failed CHARISMA roll

turn to **635**

Over the Blood-Dark Sea **435**

418

As you near the ship you can see your old bosun leading the crew. It appears you have been mutinied! As you approach, they recognise you and turn their ship to flee. The treacherous bosun is a canny man and it will take some skill to keep up with his ship.

Roll three dice and add your Rank. You may add 1 if you have a good crew and 2 if you have an excellent crew.

19 or less	You can't keep up	turn to 183
20 +	Catch up to their ship	turn to 610

419

Gain the codeword *Imbue* if you didn't already have it and turn to **261**.

420

If you gave less than 30 Shards, you feel a sense of contentment. Turn to **300** immediately. If you gave 30 Shards or more, turn to **338**. If you donated all your money, turn to **73**.

421

To have your fortune read will cost 250 Shards, or 150 for initiates of Molhern. 'A seeing will not always make sense' warns the woman. 'You may see your life in the distant past, choices that you had forgone, or possible futures.' If you wish to have your fortune read cross off the money and turn to a paragraph at random in any *Fabled Lands* book. You may read up to six consecutive paragraphs before returning here.

Turn back to **29**.

422

You make a donation of 20 Shards for the upkeep of the temple. You spend some time with your fellow monks and feel refreshed and ready to experience new wonders of the world. Restore 1 – 6 Stamina if injured (the roll of one die). You may also make a SANCTITY roll at a Difficulty of 17. If you succeed, write 'Luck' in the Blessings box on your Adventure Sheet. The Sage of Peace can be called on to help his followers at any time. The blessing can be used once to allow you to reroll any dice result, after which you must cross it off your Adventure Sheet. Remember that you can have only one Luck blessing at a time, and once it is used you will have to get a new one. Turn back to **50**.

423

He marvels at your story of surviving the rarefied air and descending the sheer cliffs that open out into the limitless void. When you describe the celestial harbour he begins to doubt your story. 'And how exactly did you get back to realm of men?' he asks dubiously. You must have the codeword *Limitless* or show him a **sacred rod of teleportation**. Otherwise he has his trau servants usher you back to your ship and tell you to leave the vortex. Turn to **52** immediately. If you do not have a ship docked here, turn to **616**.

You explain the end of your fantastic tale and he claps his hands with glee. 'This will make a great addition to my new research paper!' he clicks his fingers and a trau servant escorts you to collect a reward. Turn to **7**.

424

The plan you suggest runs smoothly, and you break into a prominent merchant's mansion and steal pockets full of shards. You return to the outskirts of the city to divvy up the treasure. With seven people in the gang your share only comes to a paltry 150 Shards! One of the highwaymen also seems disappointed with his takings and eyes your pouch.

Leave before any trouble arises	turn to 395
Attack them (gain the codeword <i>Impeccable</i>)	turn to 687

425

From the crow's nest you can see the Forest of the Apsaras to the south. Due north is the continent of Atticala, and to the west you surmise to be the Edge of the World... or at least the edge of your map...

Head north into coastal waters	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 533
Dock somewhere near the coast of the forest	turn to 512
Head east toward Kurani	turn to 382
Head west toward the Edge of the World	turn to 595
Navigate southeast through the straights of Chrysoprais	turn to 128

426

You immediately recognise the whirling dervishes as hungry ghosts, and they are attempting to ensnare you in their hypnotic dance so that they may devour you once the sun has completely set. You will have to decide quickly though, as you can feel the lure of their dance threatening to enchant you.

Rely on your natural piety to hold them off	turn to 169
Counteract their music with your own	turn to 472

427

The sea becomes inexplicably rough and your ship is tossed about like a toy. ‘This be no natural storm, cap’n!’ cries the bosun. ‘We’ve angered the gods!’ A huge wave threatens to capsize the ship and to your absolute terror a giant shark surfaces to starboard. It is five times the length of your ship, dwarfing any kraken from seafaring myth! A black bead twice your height glares at you with uncanny intelligence.

If you are an initiate of Alvir and Valmir, an initiate of Heilmir, if you have the codeword *Covet* or a **sea-green lens**, turn to **133** immediately. If you have none of these, the enormous beast submerges, throwing a flood of water across your deck. You lose many men overboard, and must reduce your crew quality to Poor. Also, cross off one unit of cargo of your choice, if you had any. You will also have to make a SCOUTING roll at a Difficulty of 17 to avoid being washed overboard yourself. If you have a **rope**, you can tie yourself to the mast and will automatically succeed on this SCOUTING roll. If you do get washed overboard there is no chance you will be rediscovered by your crew again in these powerful waves.

Successful SCOUTING roll turn to **275**
Failed SCOUTING roll turn to **447**

428

Roll two dice:

2 – 4 A furious gale turn to **760**
5 – 9 A pleasant voyage turn to **175**
10 – 12 Traders from Teleos turn to **292**

429

Your undead crew are not a liability in this city of vampires. You can buy as much cargo as your ship has room for. You can also sell cargo here. All prices are for 1 Cargo Unit.

	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Furs	-	-
Grain	-	-
Metals	700 Shards	550 Shards
Minerals	420 Shards	375 Shards
Spices	-	-
Textiles	-	290 Shards
Timber	-	190 Shards
Slaves	850 Shards	700 Shards

You cannot buy ships in Iambus. Now when you have made the necessary amendments, turn back to **740**.

430

The base of the mountain projects directly out from the waterfall, and you can only surmise that solid rock lies beneath it... though the laws of nature seem to hold little sway here. One side of the mountain runs directly into a gaping hole in the waterfall which is bordered by huge stone statues that look as if they were built aeons ago. You can see a ship being guided by a ley line into the mouth of the river, before it is swallowed up by the darkness. As you near it, you notice a relatively wide and well travelled path running beside the river and through the waterfall.

You will require a light source to progress. If you are a Mage, you can illuminate one of your objects through sorcery. Otherwise, you will require a **lantern** or **candle**.

Proceed into the tunnel *Into the Underworld* **709**
Return to Iambus turn to **330**

431

You are invited to a sizeable party where wealthy merchants and royalty share stories and arrange trade. You can glean information from other attendees with a successful CHARISMA roll at difficulty 20. You can add 1 to the roll if you are a Troubador, and for each of the following titles; Masked Lord/Lady, Junior Court Rank and Senior Court Rank.

Successful CHARISMA roll turn to **99**
Failed CHARISMA roll turn to **356**

432

A merchant accompanied by three bodyguards walk toward you. You offer a greeting but he and his entourage ignore you and walk past.

Make a THIEVERY roll at a Difficulty of 19, adding 1 to your roll if you are a Rogue.

Successful THIEVERY roll turn to **38**
Failed THIEVERY roll turn to **540**

433

The followers all cower in the corners of the room. The snake-headed woman hisses at you angrily as she draws a large scimitar in each hand. ‘You do not belong here!’ If you have the codeword *Impeccable*, lose it and roll two dice. Reduce the snake demon’s Stamina by the number rolled.

Lesser Snake Demon COMBAT 23 (2 attacks) Defence 25 Stamina 40

The lesser demon has two attacks each round (roll her attack dice twice as if you were fighting two opponents at the same time). If you win, turn to **672**. If you flee, you will lose 4-24 Stamina as she strikes you in the back with her two scimitars (roll four dice and lose that many Stamina). Turn to **266**. If you lose, you are beheaded and thrown into the sea. Turn to **700**.

434 □

If the box is already ticked, there is little else to do here and you must set sail again. Turn to **425**. If it is empty, put a tick in it and read on. One of the knights sits up and turns to you, looking you up and down with glazed eyes. A number of others do the same, the sound of ancient chainmail echoing through the room. The eldest opens its mouth and a booming voice emanates forth as if from the chamber itself. 'Thankyou for paying your respects to the Crimson Knights, noble warrior. Your presence warms our hearts. Indeed the youthful have carried on our quest for glory.' You are asked to kneel and the eldest knight draws his crimson sword, and touches it to your head.

If you did not have the title Crimson Knight, gain it now. If you already had the title, instead choose either CHARISMA, COMBAT, or SANCTITY and roll two dice. If you score higher than the score of the chosen ability, add 1 to it.

'Now go forth, young Knight, and do our reputation proud.'

The knights all lie back and resume the peace of their eternal rest. With bolstered spirits you set sail again. Turn to **425**.

435

You have your best sailors board his ship and attempt to conduct repairs. Make a SCOUTING roll at Difficulty 18. If you succeed, you manage to stop the leak and save the ship (turn to **652**). Otherwise, the boat is simply taking on water too fast and it must be abandoned. You could either flee (turn to **156**) or take the merchant aboard your ship (turn to **378**).

436

You make a deal with a blacksmith to use his forge. It will cost you 1,000 Shards in raw materials and services. If you do not have the money or do not wish to spend it, turn back to the reference you were previously reading. If you decide to go ahead with the attempt, cross off the money and roll four dice. If you roll equal to or less than your Rank, you have succeeded. Turn to **200** in this book. If you roll higher than your Rank, the task is simply to great for your ability and you end up destroying the sword and losing all the money and materials you had prepared.

Cross off the **ancient scimitar** from your Adventure Sheet and turn back to the reference you were previously reading.

437

'Thief!' growls one of them as he raises his enormous scimitar to behead you on the spot. You will have to talk very fast to get your way out of this one. Make a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 22. If you succeed, turn to **696**. If you fail, you are executed on the spot. Turn to **700**.

438

Lady Nasitha will arrange lodging and food for you, allowing you to restore your Stamina to its normal unwounded score. She is simply too busy running the city to see you. Return to **600**.

439

The bosun kisses your feet, grovelling like a professional. As soon as you return to your ship and the mutineers set off on their won course you hear triumphant laughter on the wind. Perhaps you made a mistake?

Record the codeword *Insolent* and lose the codeword *Ill* or *Just* (you may choose which one to lose if you have both). Turn to **150**.

440

Your men stand by your side nervously as they await their impending doom. Two Reaver ships drop their longboats filled to the brim with scoundrels hungry for your treasure. You will have to inspire your men during this battle. Roll three dice and add your Rank. Add 2 if you are a Warrior and another 2 if you have the codeword *Curdle*. If you have the codeword *Impeccable*, lose it and add 2 to the roll as your crew rush out to flank the enemy. If you have the codeword *Inadequate*, lose it and deduct 2 from the roll due to the wasted time and blow to your crew's confidence.

19 or less	You are killed. Cross off your ship	turn to 700
20 – 23	Defeat. You are captured	<i>Over the Blood-Dark Sea</i> 472
24 – 27	The pirates flee but your ship is still stuck	turn to 271
28+	The pirates are massacred	turn to 590

441

A ship of interesting design with large silver sails is not too far port. If you have the title Distinguished Researcher, turn to **636** immediately. Otherwise, it sails past, ignoring your vessel. Turn to **325**

442

Make a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 19. If you succeed, you bolster your crew's spirits and can gain the codeword *Impeccable*. Now turn to **547**

443

You grab the overhanging walkway at the edge of the floating palace, your feet buffeted by sea spray below. Unfortunately the platform is slick with water and your grip quickly slips. If you have a **rope**, the makeshift grapnel you fashioned from a belaying pin saves you, and you can climb up to the platform (turn to **163**). If not, all that meets you is a watery doom as you are buffeted by the enchanted waves. Turn to **700**.

444

A small town named Carapace has erected itself on the back of an enormous turtle. Before you set foot on the island you are made to undergo a thorough quarantine procedure, and you are checked head to toe for disease by the chief shaman of the floating town. They insist it is just routine procedure to ensure that the afflictions of the outside world do not contaminate the secluded town, and it looks like you have passed.

Along the edge of the shell sit fishermen, idly passing their day as they throw back their catches. Stairs have been built for citizens to make the steep ascent from the edge of the giant turtle's shell to the town centre above. It is indeed an idyllic setting, with children playing in the street without fear of crime or poverty. Every family has its own herb garden, and farms have been established to provide the citizens with chicken eggs and the like. You receive friendly greetings from the younger folk, and slightly wary looks from the more cautious elders.

Go to the harbour	turn to 720
Go to the market	turn to 124
Recuperate here	turn to 351

445

You make your way into the central keep without a problem and sneak into the real bedchamber, satisfied when you hear the sound of snoring from the figure in the bed. As you creep over to the figure a raise your weapon, to your astonishment you discover the sleeping figure is actually the general's double. Unfortunately it is too late and you feel the strong arm of a man behind you as he places you in a rear chokehold. 'This time I will see the face of my would-be assassin!' chuckles General Murtabaht Singh as he strangles you into unconsciousness. Turn to **361**.

446 □

The moment you set foot on the small island you can feel the humidity. It is as if you had just docked in a tropic rainforest! In the centre of the island is a smoking hill, which you expect to be an active volcano. The regular sound of a hammer and anvil is almost deafening. Once you arrive at the foot of the volcano, you can see a small house, beyond which is a cavernous entrance to the heart of the mountain. By the time you get close enough to look into the glowing red cavern the heat is unbearable, and you can smell the scent of your hair burning. Roll one die and lose that much Stamina unless you have the title *Demoniac*. If you are still alive, the hammering ceases and a figure steps forward holding a large vulcanium hammer and a half-finished sword blade.

Danuo is an aged but muscular man, with the face weathered by experience. He wears nothing but a loincloth and seems to be able to tolerate the heat of the volcano.

If the box above is ticked, turn to **285**. If not, put a tick in it and continue reading. 'Few know of my existence here in the Cragdrift sea!' You explain how you came to learn of him. 'Well,' says Danuo, 'I suppose you want me to forge a sword for you then?' Danuo explains that he is still perfecting his technique to craft a perfect sword. He has managed to harness part of the power of a volcano in the blades he creates, but they must be forged from a specific metal called Vulcanium. If you wish for him to craft you a sword, he will require a lump of **vulcanium ore**. 'It is a rare substance and my supplies are running low. You will probably have to journey to the underworld to find some' he explains. Surely there must be somewhere closer than that, you wonder to yourself as you return to your ship. Turn to **89**.

447

You tread water alone in the middle of the ocean, your muscles aching as you grow weary. If you are wearing armour, you will have to make a SCOUTING roll to stay afloat for an extended period (a **ring**, **cape**, or other non-armour item that provides a defence bonus doesn't count). The Difficulty is 13 plus the Defence bonus of the suit of armour. Failure means that you drown, and must turn to **700** immediately. Otherwise, continue reading.

A few days pass and you feel your chance of salvation growing slim. Roll two dice, adding 1 if you are an initiate of either Alvir and Valmir or The Three Fortunes:

Score 2	turn to 209
Score 3 – 4	turn to 33
Score 5 – 6	turn to 167
Score 7	turn to 491

Score 8 – 9 turn to **247**
 Score 10 – 11 turn to **318**
 Score 12 + turn to **504**

448

Will you head downriver to Mithdrak, or up toward Vulture’s Peak?
 To Mithdrak turn to **50**
 To Vulture’s Peak turn to **300**

449

You can bank money with the merchants’ guild by writing the sum you wish to leave with the guild in the box here. (Remember to cross it off your Adventure Sheet.) If you have banked any money with the guild in another book in the *Fabled Lands* series, add it now to this box and erase it from the other book.

Money Banked

To withdraw money from your account, simply transfer it from the box to your Adventure Sheet. The guild charges 10% on any withdrawals. (So if you withdrew 50 Shards, for example, they would deduct 5 Shards as their cut. Round fractions in the guild’s favour.)

When you are ready to leave:

In Mithdrak turn to **50**
 In Auriculum turn to **380**
 In Kurani turn to **600**
 If paying a ransom turn to **578**

450

You are sailing in the Sea of Stilts, northeast of Chrysoprais. You estimate that you lie on the same latitude as Hopias and the Straits of Alvir.

Head north into open waters turn to **27**
 Head east turn to **220**
 Head west turn to **428**
 Head south turn to **453**
 Head for the eastern coast of Chrysoprais turn to **560**

451 □□□□

If you have the codeword *Indefatigable*, lose it and choose any one boon from the list to receive. If you have not yet won the favour of the family, you will have to succeed at a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 21. If you succeed, roll a die to see what you are offered. If you fail, you must tick a box above as you push your luck with the royal family. If you fail and there are no more empty boxes to tick, you are thrown in dungeon for being a public nuisance. Turn to **71**. Remember, you don’t need to tick a box if you use your codeword (*Indefatigable*) or succeed at your CHARISMA roll.

- 1 - 2 Training: CHARISMA, COMBAT or MAGIC
- 3 - 4 Suit of **splint armour** and a **scimitar (COMBAT +1)**
- 5 A brigantine (docked at Mithdrak with good crew)
- 6 500 Shards

If you roll the ‘training’ option, choose one of the listed abilities and roll two dice. If the total is greater than the relevant ability score, increase it by 1. When you have made the relevant changes, turn back to **400**.

452

The prince sends a servant to fetch you and you are brought to his audience chamber to see a bored looking bearded man with a gold turban. He sits up with a start. ‘An adventurer! Excellent!’

He welcomes you in and talks with you at length about his old adventuring days. ‘Ah, I do so wish I could go back to those times,’ he says whimsically as you share a bottle of fine wine. ‘Now I am cloistered in this mansion, supposed to be running a city in which I have no interest. Such is the curse of royal blood.’

Turn to **745**.

453

Roll two dice:

- 2 Something far worse turn to **98**
- 3 – 5 A storm turn to **724**
- 6 – 8 An uneventful journey turn to **650**
- 9 – 11 A marooned mariner turn to **242**
- 12 The walking city (note this paragraph) turn to **612**

454

As you enter the grounds, you see the Prince himself is waiting for you. 'I have been expecting you,' he says, and you feel a number of spear points pressed against your back as the palace guards surround you. You are escorted to a private room, where your hands and feet are shackled to ensure there is no resistance.

The guards leave you two alone and Prince Alaburdh holds a knife to your throat, forcing you to drink a vial of poison. 'I can't have you telling everyone about my plans now, can I?' You feel faint and begin to lose consciousness. 'Oh, and if you are resurrected, no one will believe anything you say... you are now a criminal, and every street corner will display a sign with your very face.'

Gain the codeword *Incomplete* and turn to **700**.

455

The guards eventually turn to you. 'We understand that you are a wanted man, but we appreciate your assistance in this matter. I'm sure the Prince will be happier to have his possessions returned than to have another petty criminal like you rot in the dungeons. We have decided to waive your reward and instead wipe your criminal record.' They pull out their logs and tell you that they will have your name cleared when they return to Kurani. Cross off any of the following codewords that you may have; *Bullion*, *Evade*, *Fracas* and *Incomplete*. Counting your blessings you head on your way before they change their minds. Turn to **18**.

456

The priest has foreseen that he will be the one to give you access to the library. Gain the codeword *Ingenious*. 'Be careful,' he warns, 'to know all of one's future is sometimes the path to madness!' Turn to **18**.

457

Since the rebirth process you are sure there is something you have forgotten, but just can't quite put a finger on it. Roll one die and lose one point from that ability score:

- | | |
|---|----------|
| 1 | CHARISMA |
| 2 | COMBAT |
| 3 | MAGIC |
| 4 | SANCTITY |
| 5 | SCOUTING |
| 6 | THIEVERY |

After you have made the necessary adjustments, turn to **768**.

458

The entrance to the tomb is closed, a large disc of granite rolled in its path. It is covered in strange arcane sigils – perhaps you can open it with the right power word? Otherwise you will have to rely on elbow grease.

Make either a MAGIC roll at a Difficulty of 18 or a COMBAT roll at a Difficulty of 20. Note that if you choose COMBAT you cannot apply bonuses from any weapon you may be carrying, but can add 1 to the roll if you are male.

Successful MAGIC or COMBAT roll	turn to 523
Failed roll or leave without trying	turn to 277

459

You finally return to the world with the realisation that you still have much to do. Your time in contemplation has strengthened your spirit. If you are a Priest, roll four dice and if the total is higher than your current Rank, gain 1 Rank (and one die worth of unwounded Stamina).

You stand up, your muscles feeling tight and joints aching a little. Despite this you feel surprisingly refreshed, and not particularly hungry at all. Restore 1 – 6 lost Stamina points and gain the codeword *Illuminate*. You return to the main island. If you had a ship docked at the Innis Shoals, turn to **623**. Otherwise, turn to **181**.

460

If you have the codeword *Indirect*, you have a peaceful night's sleep. Turn to **528**. If you do not have the codeword *Indirect*, continue reading.

You are forced to camp in the mountains as night falls. In the middle of the night when the moon is high you awaken with a start as you feel movement to your left. As your eyes slowly focus you can see you have been robbed, and the thief is standing over your possessions caught red handed! He looks as you in shock and turns to run with the loot he has already grabbed.

You will need to make a SCOUTING or THIEVERY roll at a difficulty of 16 to pursue him through the mountains.

Successful SCOUTING or THIEVERY roll	turn to 96
Failed SCOUTING or THIEVERY roll	turn to 502

Don't make the attempt (cross off 1-6 possessions of your choice and turn to **528**).

461

If you have the codeword *Chill*, turn to **259**. If you do not have the codeword *Chill* but have an animal of some sort (a **parrot**, **black cat**, or **guard dog**), turn to **567** immediately. Otherwise, turn to **376**.

462

The hull of your ship snags on a reef and you are stuck fast. You would need at least twice the number of crewmen to free the ship. This area is known as a haven for religious fanatics who seek solitude on the islands, however it is also known for pirates who plague mariners in exactly the same situation as you are in now... Roll two dice. You may add 1 if you are an initiate of Alvir and Valmir or the Three Fortunes. You may also add 1 if you have the title Blessed of the Three Fortunes.

2 – 5	The ship is lost.	turn to 271
6 – 8	Pirates as feared	turn to 311
9 +	Helped by a friendly group of priests	turn to 550

463

You make such a convincing act that the morning guard who has come to give you breakfast drops the bowl of gruel and hurries into the cell. You spring up just at the right time to catch him by surprise. You will have to break his neck or slay him with his own scimitar before he can call for help. Make a COMBAT roll at a Difficulty of 16, adding 1 if you are a Rogue. If you succeed, turn to **203** immediately. Otherwise, you are simply too slow and he calls for help as he grapples with you. You are quickly subdued. Turn to **637**.

464

As the Iambic pentameters approach, you tell your men to ready themselves for another gory battle. However when the vampires are within sigh, you see their leering grins fade to expressions of abject terror. They cry out in panic and turn their ships around, fleeing back from whence they came. Your reputation has preceded you, and the demonstration of your power has put the crew in high spirits. Increase your crew quality by one step (if they were already excellent, there is no change). You smile in satisfaction and continue your journey. Turn to **650**.

465

You enter the tent and see a large group of monks kneeling in deep meditation. You notice that although they all wear the same humble robes, they appear to hail from many different ports across the Lands. If you are an initiate of the Sage of

Peace or have the codeword *Jury*, turn to **185**. If not, you can ask the clerics here for healing, or you may become an initiate.

Ask for healing	turn to 243
Become an initiate	turn to 51

466

You are walking across the countryside in the middle of the isle of a thousand spires. Roll two dice:

2 – 5	A congregation	turn to 521
6 – 8	An uneventful journey	turn to 4
9 – 12	Whirling dervishes	turn to 44

467

With a bit of skill and luck you manage to get control of the of the ship in time. If you have three ticks next to the codeword *Iambus*, you can plot a course to the mysterious port. Turn to **188**. Otherwise your crew works hard to take advantage of the prevailing winds and steer clear of the Edge of the World. Feeling both amazed and humbled by the experience you plot a course back to the world of men. Turn to **327**.

468

The artificers and wizards of the walking city have various items for sale, most of which are magical in nature. They also sell items common for the adventuring wizard, such as rings and capes which can be worn in lieu of armour to avoid having to wear such bulky equipment that warriors prefer. Remember that two sources of Defence bonus are not cumulative, unless one of them is a temporary bonus, such as a **ring of defence +4 (three uses)**.

<i>Protective Equipment</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Wizard's cape (Defence +1)	150 Shards	120 Shards
Ring of guarding (Defence +2)	300 Shards	250 Shards
Ring of protection (Defence +5)	1000 Shards	800 Shards
Ring of defence +4 (three uses)*	-	600 Shards*

<i>Magical Items</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Amber Wand (MAGIC +1)	500 Shards	400 Shards
Ebony Wand (MAGIC +2)	1000 Shards	800 Shards
Cobalt Wand (MAGIC +3)	2000 Shards	1600 Shards
Selenium Wand (MAGIC +4)	4000 Shards	3200 Shards
Celestium Wand (MAGIC +5)	8000 Shards	6400 Shards

<i>Potions</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Comeliness (CHARISMA +1)	50 Shards	-
Strength (COMBAT +1)	50 Shards	-
Intellect (MAGIC +1)	50 Shards	-
Godliness (SANCTITY +1)	50 Shards	-
Nature (SCOUTING +1)	50 Shards	-
Stealth (THIEVERY +1)	50 Shards	-
Restoration	250 Shards	150 Shards

<i>Other Items</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Lockpicks (THIEVERY +1)	300 Shards	270 Shards
Magic lockpicks (THIEVERY +2)	600 Shards	540 Shards
Gloves of Sig (THIEVERY +3)	1200 Shards	880 Shards
Hydra's tooth	-	1500 Shards
Candle	2 Shards	1 Shards
Parchment	2 Shards	1 Shard
Divining rod	300 Shards	150 Shards
Ink sac	-	100 Shards
Witch's hand	250 Shards	200 Shards
Smoulder fish	-	250 Shards
Selenium ore	-	700 Shards
Spectral veil	1000 Shards	500 Shards
Uncanny Salts	100 Shards	90 Shards
Black cat	25 Shards	-

(* Price listed is for each use remaining)
When you are finished, return to **280**.

469

If you are suffering from the Curse of Covetousness, Rao Shivpuri smirks and hands you pouch of money. Turn to **386**. Otherwise, he strokes his chin and then nods with satisfaction. 'You drive a hard bargain, my friend,' he says as he hands you a heavy pouch. The deal is closed with a shake of hands. Cross off the **golden katana** and add the 10,000 Shards to your cash. Turn to **400**.

470

If you have the codeword *Evil* or the title Demoniac, turn to **641** immediately. If you have the codeword *Exultant*, turn to **306**. If you have neither codeword, turn to **534**.

471

The narrow Straits of Alvir permit safe passage between the Sea of Stilts and the Violet Ocean, assuming you are a skilled enough mariner to steer your vessel through.

Make a SCOUTING roll at Difficulty 14

If you succeed, turn to paragraph **40** in *Over the Blood-Dark Sea*.

Otherwise, you are forced back – turn to **220**.

472

You require a musical instrument to counteract the music of the dervishes. If you do not have an instrument you will have to sing. This is not a problem if you are a Troubadour, but if you are any other profession you will have to reduce your MAGIC roll by 2 for this attempt.

Make a MAGIC roll at a Difficulty of 21. You may add 1 to your roll if you are a Troubadour.

Successful MAGIC roll turn to **91**

Failed MAGIC roll turn to **388**

473

You give him the fight of his life and finish him with a light tap on the temple that knocks him unconscious momentarily. When he comes to, you help him to his feet and he thanks you for the lesson. 'Next time, I will fight better, I promise.' He collects his gear and then turns to leave. 'Until then, my friend.' Turn to **39**.

474

The temple of Tynnai, the God of War, is built in the shape of a spear with a long, pillared nave, and an altar at the far end. Two massive stone warriors guard its gates. Tynnai is depicted here as the insensate spirit of war – a blood-drenched warrior with the head of a maddened jaguar.

The temple warden, a retired knight of the Crimson Fort offers to initiate you into the worship of the greatest god of them all. 'If you desire to fight with the fury of heaven, there is no match for Tynnai!' The priest is very stubborn and will only bestow his god's blessing on those who follow the faith (initiates of Tynnai and Crimson Knights only). Unfortunately, he never received formal training as a priest and does not have the skill to return mortals to life.

Become an initiate turn to **737**

Renounce his worship turn to **752**

Seek a blessing turn to **557**

Leave the temple turn to **708**

475

You estimate the Forest of Woes to lie due west of your current position. ‘What do you say captain – should we head for coastal waters? The men are eager...’

Head west for coast waters	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 429
Head north	turn to 89
Head east	turn to 172
Head south for Umbart’s Vortex	turn to 303

476

You tell the high priest that you wish to renounce the worship of Nagil. He shows you your reflection in a mirror, then shatters it against the altar. When you ask if you must pay compensation to the temple, he shakes his head. ‘It is you who loses, not we.’

Do you want to reconsider? If you are determined to renounce your faith, delete Nagil from the God box on your Adventure Sheet. You must lose any outstanding resurrection arrangements. Also lose the title Chosen One of Nagil if you have it. When you have finished here, turn to **380**.

477

Without warning, a troop of tribesmen apprehend your crew! They are dragged out kicking and screaming, but you are left unmolested. It seems that as a bizarre custom of friendship, these cannibals share a meal with the captains of visiting vessels... except that the meal tonight will be some of your crew. You cannot begin to understand their strange ways.

Join in their custom	turn to 61
Refuse or fight them	turn to 216

478

Without a word the sea god departs and you feel yourself somewhat invigorated. Restore your Stamina to its normal unwounded score and write ‘Safety from Storms’ in your blessings box. This allows you to avoid the effects of the next storm you may encounter at sea. Once used it must be crossed off. Now turn to **275** to continue on your voyage.

479

‘That there pendant is a symbol of what was stolen from us,’ Lakha explains, pointing at your neck. ‘It belonged to the high priest of Sobha Rana, a Rakshasa who forged the union between us and humans in the ancient times. He used to proclaim that its clarity represented his vision for our future. It was stolen by Lorn

Mugal-Ji when he became tyrannical ruler of Auriculum and was instead used as a symbol of oppression.

Having obvious historical value to the Rakshasas here, you hand it to Lakha. Cross the **sapphire pendant** off your Adventure Sheet and turn to **157**.

480 □

If the box above is ticked, the tomb has been looted since you have been gone and there is nothing to do here. Turn to **277** immediately. If it was empty, put a tick in it and read on.

You descend the steps and have a feeling that these were not crafted by human hands... by your estimate the creatures must have been twice your height! The stairs end in a large antechamber, with murals depicting tiger-headed giants subjugating masses of human followers. This must be the tomb of a Rakshasa! From your estimation, the unmarked burial plots must have been its slaves, born to serve and die with their master. No wonder the forest is haunted, you think to yourself.

Beyond this chamber is a main room filled with a multitude of treasures! This Rakshasa must have been buried with all its worldly possessions, and it looks like you are the first to arrive. In the centre of the room is a stone coffin that is as tall as your shoulder even when lying down. You get an eerie feeling being here, and sense that you should avoid it at all costs.

Investigate the coffin further	turn to 295
Gather some loot and leave quickly	turn to 180

481

You lose your footing and tumble down a short way. Roll two dice and lose that many Stamina. Luckily you weren’t much higher up the mountain, you think to yourself. Turn to **587**.

482

The wind hisses as if exhaling a dying breath and the spectres disappear without a trace. The next morning as you stroll the deck you notice a strange item lying behind some barrels as if forgotten. It is a **spectral veil**. If you wish to keep it, note it on your Adventure Sheet and turn to **150**.

483

Possessions requisitioned

If you are here to collect your items, record what you wish to take on your list of possessions and erase the remainder (they will not be kept for you). When you are finished here turn back to the paragraph you were reading.

484

Lose the codeword *Impeccable* if you had it. One of the ships comes to within arms reach and you channel the power of your god toward them, your voice booming across the heavens like thunder. Half the crew vanish like smoke on the wind, the echoes of their final cries ringing in your ears. The remainder throw up their bloodless hands and cower as they beg to be spared. You and your crew board the ship and your holy aura is such that they cannot even look at you. They stare at the deck in abject terror as you line them up and behead them to ensure they never return to the world of the living. The crew of the other two ships watch on, their once leering grins turned to twisted expressions of fear. Your glare is enough to make them turn their ships and flee, quaking in their boots like frightened kittens.

You have displayed unshakable faith in the face of adversity. Your renown will spread with word of your victory. Gain the codeword *Intimidate*. Furthermore, raise your SANCTITY to 12. If it was already 12, raise it to 13 instead. This is an exception to the rule that no ability score may exceed 12. If you lose points of SANCTITY though despicable conduct (etc.), you cannot raise it to 13 again unless specifically instructed in the text. Such is the difficult path one walks to achieve true faith.

Turn to **650**.

485

You return to your villa and are greeted by your butler. A meal is prepared for you and can put your feet up and relax by the fireplace. You may stay here as long as you want. Restore your Stamina to full. You can leave any number of possessions or money here. When you go to collect your items, roll two dice and add 1 if you are initiate of The Three Fortunes:

- 2 A daring thief has managed to steal half of the money you left here.
3 – 13 Your money and possessions are fine

Items left in villa

When you are finished, turn to **50**.

486

Their torture yields no useful information and they eventually release you. However the experience has taken its toll. Lose 2 – 12 Stamina (the roll of two dice). If you still live, turn back to **244**.

487

Your attempted assault causes too much noise, or if you tried to misdirect them the guards become suspicious. Either way the alarm is raised and you soon have a troop of guards on your heels. Gain the codeword *Ingrate*. The only unguarded way out of the building will be through a nearby window. If you have a rope, turn to **123**. Otherwise, you are quickly apprehended. Turn to **361**.

488

If you have the codeword *Indicate*, turn to **663** immediately. Otherwise, read on.
Inside is just as richly decorated as a royal Chrysopraisian palace, and it would be a beautiful place to life if it were not so cluttered. Trau servants scurry to and fro, carrying every manner of item from books and food to things you had never seen before. Piles of exotic goods (and rubbish) are scattered throughout the entrance hall. A trau servant leads you along a safe path through all the commotion and you are soon in an equally cluttered study, the size of which amazes you. A variety of magical instruments are currently in use, along with tables covered in huge sprawling and ancient maps. An aging Chrysopraisian man in billowing robes stands at a large telescope mounted on the windowsill directed at the eye of the vortex.

He turns to you. 'Excellent, another adventurer! I have a task for you, and I assure that you will be well paid...'

- | | |
|---|--------------------|
| Enquire about how you may serve him | turn to 304 |
| Request some information | turn to 684 |
| Retrieve any items you may have left here | turn to 145 |
| Go aboard your ship and leave the vortex | turn to 52 |
| Wish to leave but don't have a ship | turn to 616 |

489

You suddenly recognise the face of Akkar the Bold, the adventurer who restored you to life in the Blessed Springs of Sokara! It appears there has been a serious case of mistaken identity. If you wish to protest, turn to **23**. If you remain silent, turn to **651**.

490 □

If the box above is already ticked, return to **524** to descend the mountain. If it is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading.

As you prepare to descend the mountain, you feel a foreign object in your rucksack. Pulling it out you marvel at the ornate sceptre fashioned in Chrysopraian style to resemble a lightning bolt. Add the **vajra baton (SANCTITY +5)** to your list of possessions and return to **524** to continue your descent.

491

You feel a great sense of relief as you are hauled aboard the passing ship. Unfortunately, you realise these are Uttakin slavers. You are stripped of your money and possessions (cross them off your Adventure Sheet). You are locked in shackles and the Uttakin captain looks down on you with an inscrutable stare.

‘Forget your former life,’ he advises you. ‘Now and forevermore you are a slave.’

Turn to **321** in *The Court of Hidden Faces*.

492

Cross off the money and make a SANCTITY roll at a difficulty of 16. You automatically succeed if you are carrying a **rana scimitar**. If you succeed, write SCOUTING in your blessings box. The blessing of Sobha Rana allows you to reroll any one failed SCOUTING roll. Once it is used, cross it off and you need only return here to receive a new one. Note that you cannot have more than one SCOUTING blessing at any one time. Now turn to **380**.

493 □

If the box above is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading. If it was already ticked, turn to **537** immediately.

As you draw the enchanted sword it tugs at your grip in an attempt to free itself. The **dancing scimitar** has three charges. At the beginning of battle you may unsheathe the scimitar and it will fly through the air, attacking your opponent of its own accord. Cross off one charge and the scimitar will make an attack before any combat rounds begin with its COMBAT score of 18, before falling to the ground. Then you can begin the normal combat procedure (if the opponent still lives).

Effectively, it grants you an additional attack with COMBAT 18 and no chance for the opponent to retaliate. Remember though, if you flee from battle you must cross the **dancing scimitar** off your Adventure Sheet as you will not be able to pick it up. Also, when the item runs out of charges it ceases to be a **dancing scimitar** and instead becomes a mundane **scimitar** and cannot be recharged in any way.

Now, you consider it wise to leave the area before they realise your crime. Turn to **50**.

494

A dishevelled man runs up to you, kneeling at your feet and pleading for assistance. You must stick out like a sore thumb here. ‘My daughter! Please save her!’ he implores. The man introduces himself as Charat, a part-time cobbler whose daughter appears to have been abducted in the night. ‘Children have been disappearing every night here, and they say terrible things... like hey are being sold on the black market, or worse, being sacrificed to gods! Please, after my wife passed away Indra is my only reason to live. You must save her!’

Charat explains that the authorities do nothing but subjugate the poor and they will not help in the matter. ‘Perhaps if you were to go to them they would hear you? Or maybe you could save her yourself?’

If you choose to accept the mission, record the codeword *Indra*. Now turn to **50**.

495

You realise you are over your head, and you will be quickly overwhelmed unless you have a back-up plan. All your exits are blocked, and short of teleportation you really have no escape. Luckily, the hut you are in displays a large idol of Badogor the Unspoken, an it counts as a temple. If you have a means of teleportation such as the **sacred rod of teleportation** or Targdaz’s recall spell, you can escape from here. Otherwise, you are overwhelmed and go to make a fine stew for the evening meal. Turn to **700**.

496

If you have the codeword *Ilk*, turn to **63** immediately. Otherwise, you are made to wait in a long line of merchants and nobles intent on and audience with the King. In the many hours you spend here rubbing shoulders with politically-minded individuals, you learn that the King of Chrysopra is now no more than a figurehead. He is old and not as sharp as he once was. His eldest son, Prince Alaburdh Deoraj now runs most of the royal business. He is known to

be ruthless in his approach to business, even with family friends, and you are encouraged to stay on his ‘good side’. The king’s youngest son, Prince Azimishtra Deoraj has been placed in charge of the city Kurani, and as a retired adventurer with little knowledge of politics has managed to run the economy there into ruin. His chief advisors practically run it for him now. Auriculum is now the only city in Chrysoprais where the royal family have little interest.

Eventually you are summoned to the chambers of Prince Alaburdh Deoraj. The man is in his late thirties, and though he has lived the pampered life of a royal, his eyes betray a calculated cunning that puts you slightly on edge. You stand before a raised platform where he and his father, the king of Chrysoprais, both appraise your worth. The elderly man slowly raises a shaking hand but before he can speak, Alaburdh interjects impatiently.

‘What service could you offer us?’

Make a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 19. If you are a Rogue or have the codeword *Indefatigable*, you automatically succeed. If you succeed, turn to **602** immediately. If you fail, the Prince waves his hand dismissively. ‘We have no need for a talentless fool. Be gone!’ Turn to **400**.

497

You recall the warning you received from the chief artificer of the Walking City and dissuade the boy from flying over water. He is easily convinced and in fact thanks you for your help, handing you a pouch of 250 Shards (add this to your money). You raise an eyebrow at him. ‘And where does a young man like you find such a sum?’

The boy just giggles and taps the side of his nose. Leaping onto his carpet he flies off leaving you to continue your journey. Turn to **18**.

498

In this cosmopolitan port there are many ships willing to take you as a paying passenger. Select a destination from the list, cross off the money and turn to the relevant entry. If you reconsider leaving Mithdrak by ship, turn back to **50**.

Kurani	15 Shards	turn to 260
Auriculum	15 Shards	turn to 106
Pethumar	15 Shards	<i>The Lone and Level Sands</i> 75
Hopias	20 Shards	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 176
Teleos	25 Shards	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 18
Port Skios	45 Shards	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 439
Aku	45 Shards	<i>The Court of Hidden Faces</i> 502
Dweomer	55 Shards	<i>Over the Blood-Dark Sea</i> 242
Meticiens	60 Shards	<i>Over the Blood-Dark Sea</i> 260

Smogmaw	65 Shards	<i>Over the Blood-Dark Sea</i> 535
Yellowport	65 Shards	<i>Over the Blood-Dark Sea</i> 224
Chambara	80 Shards	<i>Lords of the Rising Sun</i> 27

499

You aren’t distracted by their simple ploy, and as a third woman tries to take your belt pouch during the commotion you wheel around and grab her wrist. She struggles and curses at you and before you know it a passing town guard has arrived on the scene. ‘Help!’ She cries ‘I’m being assaulted!’ The other two accomplices vouch for her and make up a wild story. You will need to talk fast to get out of this sticky situation.

Make a CHARISMA roll as a Difficulty of 18. You may add 2 if you are a Rogue.

Successful CHARISMA roll	turn to 665
Failed CHARISMA roll	turn to 57

500

As you approach the vortex you spy an amazing floating palace, ornately designed in the traditional style of Chrysoprais. It is located around half way between the edge of the vortex and its centre, floating a few feet above the cyclonic waves. It remains surprisingly unaffected by the torrents of water gushing about it.

If you have the codeword *Illiad* and wish to stop here, note that your ship is docked at Umbart’s Palace and turn to **163**. Otherwise you will have to use all your skill to navigate the enchanted waters. Make both SCOUTING and MAGIC rolls at Difficulty 17. You may add 1 to the roll if you are a Mage:

Both rolls successful	turn to 282
One roll successful	turn to 52
Both rolls failed	turn to 381

501

The merchant’s guild in Kurani is extremely busy, with the wealthy from all over the *Fabled Lands* checking on investments and banking their large profits as they capitalise on the recent trade situation. Here you can bank your money for safe-keeping – or invest it in guild enterprises in the hope of turning a profit.

A merchant nearby smiles a toothy grin as he slips a heavy pouch of shards into his waistband. ‘The metal shortage here sure has made for interesting trade this season,’ he chuckles. Record the codeword *Implicate* and then choose from the options presented below:

Make a deposit or withdrawal turn to **449**
 Make an investment turn to **738**
 Check on investments turn to **645**

When you are ready to return to the city centre, turn to **600**.

502

You fall into his crude trap. Your leg is snagged and you trip, falling on your face and gashing your arms. Roll two dice and lose that many Stamina. The bandit pops out from behind a boulder and levels his short spear at your head. He grins in triumph as he holds you satchel over one shoulder.

‘A pity you had to wake up... but now I can’t let you live. Goodbye chum,’ he says whimsically as he raises his spear to strike. If you can succeed at a COMBAT or THIEVERY roll at a Difficulty of 16, you manage to dodge and wrench the spear from his hand. Turn to **96**. If you fail, your end is mercifully quick. Turn to **700**.

503

As you near, you can see your old crew working like slaves under the oppressive rule of their hijackers – pirates from the Violet Ocean. You know you will have no chance to parley with them, so attack is the only real option. If you are lucky, your old crew may recognise you and assist in overthrowing the hijackers. If you wish to assault the ship, turn to **703**. If you wish to leave it alone, they will not pursue you. Turn to **150** to continue your voyage.

504

A shadow in the water beneath you gets larger and larger and you feel the pull of the waves as an enormous body approaches. It must be the size of a fleet of ships! If you are an initiate of Heilmir, turn to **762** immediately. If you have the codeword *Infidel*, turn to **212** immediately. If you are an initiate of Alvir and Valmir, or you have the codeword *Covet* or a **sea-green lens**, turn to **728** immediately. If you have none of these, apply the enormous creature beneath the waves moves off east and you are tossed about in the waves it creates. Then eventually, silence. Turn to **447**.

505

Roll two dice

2 – 5	A huge wave	turn to 553
6 – 8	Message in bottle	turn to 146
9 – 12	A shipwrecked mariner	turn to 642

506

The safest way out of the mountain range would be to follow the river Ajantur. Othwerwise you could take your chances traversing the mountain paths toward the Crimson Fort or the forest to the north.

Follow the river	turn to 659
Head through the mountains	turn to 528

507

Their faces display their shock as turn and confront them, yelling a bold challenge at them as you draw your weapon.

Make a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 17. If you succeed, they flee and you can return to the city unmolested (turn to **50**). Otherwise, they stand their ground and approach you drawing long wavy daggers. You will have to fight them as one opponent:

Mercenaries	COMBAT 16	Defence 17	Stamina 25
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For every 5 Stamina the mercenaries lose, reduce both their COMBAT and Defence values by 1. If you win, you can take their knives, but they carry no other loot. List five **kris** on your Adventure sheet and turn to **50**. If you lose, turn to **283**.

508

The bosun turns to you wise-eyed. ‘Do you really think that is wise, cap’n? Ain’t nothing out there but the edge of the world... that’s suicide. Besides, the men gotta have a lot of confidence in you to follow you to certain death!’

If you have the codeword *Curdle*, you can lead your faithful crew to the Edge of the World. Turn to **143**. If you do not have the codeword or you have reconsidered your course, return to **250** and choose again.

509

‘Gods hold no sway in the underworld... except for the lord of death, Nagil. Instead, the denizens worship Demon Lords as if they were gods. These dark entities exist in corporeal form, residing in palaces or desecrated locations, but they do hold some powers of lesser deities. They can grant blessings to their followers, and curses to the unfaithful. Rest assured you will never find a temple to a demon lord outside of the land of roots... no wait a second...’ he walks over to a towering stack of ancient maps. ‘I believe there may well be an entrance to the underworld on an uncharted island in the Sea of Stilts. That may be where I heard about Kæla Karna... or was it the Violet Ocean? Anyway, if you ever visit a shrine to one of the dark deities make sure you do

not carry any symbols of the gods. Only the most sacrilegious will be spared from the wrath of the demon lords!’

The trau quickly usher you back to your ship and tell you to leave the vortex. Turn to **52**. If you do not have a ship docked here, turn to **616**.

510

You take morbid pleasure in running it through. The vampire utters a final howl and vanishes like smoke on the wind. All that remain are pile of musty and waterlogged grey robes and a number of antique rings, the value of which amounts to 450 Shards (mark the money directly on your Adventure Sheet). You feel satisfied having rid the world of such a vile creature and continue your journey. Turn to **79**.

511

They draw their knives and leap in to attack. These are experienced highwaymen and they surround you, attacking all at once, trying to catch you off guard and slide a knife into your ribs from behind. Treat them as one opponent:

Highwaymen COMBAT 16 Defence 17 Stamina 21

Unless you are a Rogue, before each combat round (including before combat starts), you must make a THIEVERY roll against their Defence score (essentially Difficulty of 17. If you fail, you must lose 1-6 Stamina as one of the highwaymen manages to flank you and strike at your vitals. If you are a Rogue you do not need to roll – you already know all the tricks of the trade!

If you wish to flee, roll two dice and lose that many Stamina from a vicious parting blow and turn to **197**. If you win, you can take their loot which amounts to 110 Shards and the suit of **leather armour (Defence +1)** that the leader was wearing. Turn to **197**.

512

The waters are fairly shallow near the coast and you are forced to drop anchor a fair way out. You take the cutter inland and leave it at the edge of the woods. Note that your ship is now docked at the Coast of Apsaras and turn to **358**.

513

Roll three dice and add your Rank. Add 1 if you have an average crew, add 2 if you have a good crew and 3 if you have an excellent crew. Subtract 2 for each cargo unit you are carrying.

24 or less	they catch up to you	turn to 643
25 +	you escape north	turn to 350

514

The merchants of Iambus deal almost exclusively in the trade of humans, and have very little interest in offering investment opportunities. However you can bank money with them. Your money can be accessed in most major cities in the underworld, such as Erebus or Ys.

Iambus will only accept underworld currency for banking – Mithrals. You can bank money with the merchants’ guild by writing the sum you wish to leave with the guild in the box here. (Remember to cross it off your Adventure Sheet.) If you have banked any money with the guild of the underworld in another book in the *Fabled Lands* series, add it now to this box and erase it from the other book. You will know if it is banked with the underworld as the currency will be in Mithrals.

Money Banked in Underworld

To withdraw money from your account, simply transfer it from the box to your Adventure Sheet. The guild charges 10% on any withdrawals. (So if you withdrew 50 Shards, for example, they would deduct 5 Shards as their cut. Round fractions in the guild’s favour) When you are finished, turn back to **330**.

515

An artificer explains to you that the process of recharging an item is not easy. Inexperienced wizards often either charge too much energy, destroying the item, or to little, wasting the material components. They explain that they are prepared to assist you only if you accept that success is not guaranteed...

It will cost 500 Shards to attempt to recharge an item that has exhausted at least one of its charges. The maximum number of charges any item may have at any one point in time is 3. Items eligible for recharging include, but are not limited to the following: **Rana scimitar, ring of defence +4, assassin’s dagger, sacred rod of teleportation, magic carpet**, etc.

Remember that if something happens to an item when all its charges are exhausted (such as the **sacred rod of teleportation** disintegrating or a **magic carpet** reverting to a **green carpet**), it cannot be recharged in this way. Now decide if you will attempt the recharge. You may only make one attempt at a time, after which you will be redirected here to decide whether you wish to attempt another recharge.

Make a recharge attempt	turn to 392
Leave without attempting	turn to 280

516

The merchant's guild in Mithdrak is extremely busy, with the wealthy from all over the *Fabled Lands* checking on investments and banking their large profits as they capitalise on the recent trade situation. Here you can bank your money for safe-keeping – or invest it in guild enterprises in the hope of turning a profit.

Make a deposit or withdrawal turn to **449**

Make an investment turn to **751**

Check on investments turn to **733**

When you are ready to return to the city centre, turn to **50**.

517

You are spotted prowling around the castle walls and you are apprehended for questioning. If you have the codeword *Incomplete*, your past misdemeanours incriminate you. Turn to **71** immediately.

If you have the codeword *Indefatigable* or can succeed at a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 20, the guards let you go with a warning. Lose the codeword *Indefatigable* if you had it and turn to **400**. If you fail the CHARISMA roll, your story does not convince the guards and you are hauled off to the dungeons. Record the codeword *Incomplete* and turn to **71**.

518

You make a donation of 15 Shards for the upkeep of the temple. You spend some time with your fellow monks and feel refreshed and ready to experience new wonders of the world. Restore 1 – 6 Stamina if injured (the roll of one die). You may also make a SANCTITY roll at a Difficulty of 17. If you succeed, write 'Luck' in the Blessings box on your Adventure Sheet. The Sage of Peace can be called on to help his followers at any time. The blessing can be used once to allow you to reroll any dice result, after which you must cross it off your Adventure Sheet. Remember that you can have only one Luck blessing at a time, and once it is used you will have to get a new one.

Turn back to **600**.

519

The walking city strides through the Sea of Stilts in a very specific pattern... you just haven't figured it out yet. Roll two dice:

Score 2 – 4 turn to **175**

Score 5 – 6 turn to **150**

Score 7 turn to **450**

Score 8 – 9 turn to **275**

Score 10 – 12 turn to **525**

520

The man you saved introduces himself as Raveender Anchal, and it just so happens that he is husband to the chief aide of Prince Azimishtra Deoraj in Kurani. 'As a disciple of the Sage of Peace, I spend much of my time with the homeless and assisting in the soup kitchens. Perhaps those cultists thought I was just another nameless face that wouldn't get noticed as missing...'

You tell him all about your recent adventures in Chrysorpais and notices your interest. 'You know, Prince Azimishtra was once an adventurer like you... that is before his father convinced him to retire and run the port of Kurani. If you ever want an audience with him I'm sure I could have my wife arrange it for you.'

Gain the codeword *Impress* and turn to **4**.

521 □

If the box above is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading. If the box is already ticked, turn to **286**. As the sun is low in the sky and you feel the cool breeze of night approaching, you notice a throng of people up ahead. They stand in a circle holding hands chanting.

Approach them turn to **597**

Leave before they notice you turn to **4**

522

You will only get one chance before the three of them are on you. Make a COMBAT roll at a Difficulty of 22. If you fail, you are torn to shreds before you even manage to draw your weapon. Turn to **700** immediately. If you succeed, turn to **94**.

523

The slab moves aside to reveal a series of stone steps descending into darkness. You will require a light source to proceed. If you are a Mage, you can illuminate the darkness, otherwise you will require a **lantern** or **candle**. If you do not have a light source, you must turn to **277** immediately. Otherwise, you can proceed into the tomb with your light source (remember to cross off the **candle** whenever you leave if you are using one). Turn to **480**

524

If you have the codeword *Jury*, turn to **490** immediately.

Descending the almost vertical rock face is no mean feat. Make a SCOUTING roll at a Difficulty of 22. You may add 2 if you have **climbing gear**, and 2 if you are an initiate of the Sage of Peace. If you manage to

succeed, turn to **296**. If you fail, you lose your grip and plummet toward your doom. If you have a **rope**, turn to **374**. Otherwise, the last thing you see is the ground rushing up to meet you. Turn to **700**.

525

You are roughly on the latitude of Hopias, an island port to the west. Kunrir lies far to the north and the Straits of Alvir provide passage to the Violet Ocean in the east. The towering mountain range of the great southern continent is visible on the horizon.

Head north	turn to 617
Head west	turn to 190
Plot a course through the Straits of Alvir	turn to 471
Enter coastal waters of Ankon-Konu	<i>The Lone and Level Sands</i> 48

526

If you have an animal of some kind (a **parrot**, **black cat** or **guard dog**), turn to **223** immediately. Otherwise, the next morning the man is nowhere to be found and your navigator has also disappeared under mysterious circumstances. Crew morale drops to an all time low. Reduce the quality of your crew by two grades (no lower than poor of course). Turn to **525**.

527

You eventually manage to control the flames but it takes some time to erect the spare sail. You have been drifting for hours and you have to recalculate your position. Roll two dice:

Score 2 – 4	turn to 450
Score 5 – 6	turn to 325
Score 7	<i>The Lone and Level Sands</i> 84
Score 8 – 9	turn to 650
Score 10 – 12	turn to 575

528

To navigate the mountains around Vulture's Peak will require a SCOUTING roll at a Difficulty of 16. If you fail, you become lost and must turn to **383** immediately. Otherwise, you successfully traverse the mountains to your intended destination:

The Crimson Fort	turn to 244
The Forest of Rakshasas	turn to 615
Vulture's Peak	turn to 300

529

The Forest of Rakshasas is a towering den of noise. The trees tower up to a canopy that blots out almost all sunlight, and the ground is covered with crawling insects of prehistoric proportions. If you have the codeword *Implore*, turn to **115**. Otherwise, roll two dice:

2 – 5	A giant centipede	turn to 654
6 – 8	A monstrous beetle	turn to 136
9 – 12	A hunting patrol	turn to 353

530

They are a number of members of the sect you helped overthrow. Some were executed yesterday and a few more are scheduled in the coming weeks. However, you can't seem to find Lord Sehastramal on the list... Nevertheless you take some morbid pleasure watching this group dance Nagil's jig on the gallows. Turn to **50**.

531

General Singh listens to the news with a furrowed brow, and then nods to himself. 'You have done very well to bring this news to me,' he says. As he clicks his fingers a grizzled old soldier by his side reaches over to a table and returns with an ornate sword. The general takes it and orders you to kneel. You are knighted on the spot. Record the title Crimson Knight in your titles and honours box. He then hands you the sword as an honour of the position you now hold. It is a talwar, the traditional scimitar of a warrior of Chrysoprais. The curved blade is a ruddy red colour, either a property of the strange metal or the remains of hundreds of slain foes. It is almost an antique! 'There are few swords of this make around today, all forged by my great grandfather,' he says. 'Do well to wield this with valour!'

Note the **crimson scimitar (COMBAT +6)** on your list of possessions. The sword is a symbol of your status as a Crimson Knight. If you ever attempt to sell it in a marketplace, note the paragraph you are reading at that time and turn to *The Isle of a Thousand Spires* **264**.

You are also awarded with chambers in the inner keep. Turn to **401**.

532

'You will be pleased to know that thanks to you my recent research paper received wide accolades from the scholarly community,' he says with pride. 'I'm famous!' You consider how rich you have made this man and begin to regret not charging more for your services. He sees your despondent look.

‘Don’t worry my friend – I noted you at co-author. It won’t be long before your fame spreads too...’

Your adventures have taught you much. Gain the title Distinguished Researcher. If you are a Mage, Troubadour or Wayfarer, the experience has broadened your reputation. Roll two dice, and if the number is higher than your CHARISMA, add 1 to it. If you are a Warrior, Rogue or Priest, you have gained a great deal of resourcefulness on your adventures. Roll two dice, and if the number is higher than your SCOUTING, add 1 to it. Finally, if you were not already a member of a college at Dweomer, you have been offered enrolment effective immediately. Whilst you have the title Distinguished Researcher you never have to pay college fees (ignore 11-12 in *Over the Blood-Dark Sea* 607) and have free use of the library (ignore the 50 Shard fee and MAGIC roll required in *Over the Blood-Dark Sea* 368). Note this on your Adventure Sheet and turn back to 304.

533

‘I can help you no longer,’ he explains. ‘You must walk the path for yourself. Keep your strength of faith and your resolve and you shall never fall.’ He disappears in the blink of an eye. You descend the peak. Turn to 524.

534

The sight is truly an honour to behold. Roll two dice and if you roll higher than your SANCTITY score you can add 1 to it. As you make a motion toward it the celestial stag turns and darts away. You are left alone again. Turn to 615.

535

The Mithdrak bazaar is indeed a sight to behold. All manner of wares are available, but to your dismay you realise that they mostly cater for the noblemen. Rich silk garments, exotic spices for cooking, and other things that are mostly for show and far less practical than you had hoped. Now you realise why the distant lands of Chrysoprais which were always fabled for its beauty and wealth, has never conquered another - they spend all their money of foppish pastimes!

Furthermore, there is a noticeable mark-up on arms and armour, and you overhear something about a military campaign in the north. Note that in Chrysoprais, to wear the hide or skin of a dead animal is considered uncouth, and as such leather armour is not available. Chrysopraisians tend to use thick cloths instead of leather.

<i>Armour</i>	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Leather Armour (Defence +1)	-	-
Ring mail (Defence +2)	120 Shards	100 Shards
Chain mail (Defence +3)	300 Shards	250 Shards
Splint armour (Defence +4)	-	400 Shards
 <i>Weapons</i>	 <i>To Buy</i>	 <i>To Sell</i>
No COMBAT bonus	60 Shards	60 Shards
COMBAT bonus +1	300 Shards	300 Shards
COMBAT bonus +2	-	600 Shards
 <i>Magical Items</i>	 <i>To Buy</i>	 <i>To Sell</i>
Amber Wand (MAGIC +1)	500 Shards	450 Shards
Ebony Wand (MAGIC +2)	-	800 Shards
 <i>Other Items</i>	 <i>To Buy</i>	 <i>To Sell</i>
Flute (CHARISMA +1)	250 Shards	200 Shards
Silver Flute (CHARISMA +2)	500 Shards	425 Shards
Centaur Flute (CHARISMA +3)	-	850 Shards
Compass (SCOUTING +1)	550 Shards	500 Shards
Rope	50 Shards	45 Shards
Lantern	100 Shards	90 Shards
Climbing Gear	110 Shards	90 Shards
Jewelled Turban	-	250 Shards
Green Carpet	200 Shards	150 Shards
Silver nugget	-	200 Shards

When you are finished here, turn back to 50.

536

You explore the nearby corridors, taking care not to alert any guards. Most of them end in unused rooms, function halls or guest quarters. This man must have a lot of money to waste! You pass by a door beyond which emanate strange mechanical noises. Your curiosity gets the better of you and you peek inside.

What you see makes you marvel. Beyond the door is a flight of stairs, leading down into a sunken open-air courtyard hidden in the centre of the mansion. In the middle of the courtyard stands a ship! The galleon is supported on a wooden frame, and technicians are crawling about it, passing each other tools and barking orders. Nearby there is a cart of selenium nuggets just

waiting to be pilfered! You believe you could probably take one without being noticed. If you decide to, add the **selenium ore** to your Adventure Sheet. Now you could attempt to sneak aboard the ship or head back to the main operation before a guard patrol arrives.

Sneak aboard the ship	turn to 251
Return to the operation	turn to 727

537

The item is cursed, and as soon as you attempt to draw it, the sword leaps from your hands and slashes at you vindictively. You will have to make a COMBAT or THIEVERY roll at a Difficulty of 21 to reflexively dodge the beheading blow. If you fail, you are killed in one swift motion. Turn to **700** immediately. If you succeed, you manage to evade the attack and it clatters to the ground. You dare not pick it up again. Cross the **dancing scimitar** off your Adventure Sheet.

Now, you consider it wise to leave the area before they realise your crime. Turn to **50**.

538

To find out how well your investments have done, roll two dice. Add 1 to the dice roll if you are an initiate of the Three Fortunes. Also add 1 if you have the codeword *Implicate*, add 2 if you have the codeword *Hunter*, and add 4 if you have the codeword *Eldritch*.

Score 2-3	Lose entire sum invested
Score 4-5	Loss of 50%
Score 6-7	Loss of 10%
Score 8-10	Investment remains unchanged
Score 11-12	Profit of 10%
Score 13-14	Profit of 50%
Score 15-16	Double initial investment
Score 17+	Triple initial investment

Now turn to **757**, where you can withdraw the sum written in the box there after adjusting it according to the result rolled.

539

At last the storm abates. Whilst you arrange makeshift repairs the navigator attempts to get a bearing on your current position. Roll one die.

Score 1 – 2	turn to 375
Score 3 – 4	turn to 150
Score 5 – 6	turn to 525

540

There is a sudden crack and a ringing in your ears as you are struck from behind. You will have to rely on your natural toughness to avoid blacking out. Make a COMBAT roll at a Difficulty of 16 using your unmodified COMBAT score (no bonus from items).

Successful COMBAT roll	turn to 667
Failed COMBAT roll	turn to 328

541

You feel numbness from one side of your body and you soon find it hard to stand. If you lost more than half of your normal unwounded Stamina score in this battle, the poison travels to your heart and you succumb. Turn to **700**. If you lost half your unwounded Stamina or less, one side of your face becomes paralysed and you cannot talk without slurring your speech. Reduce your CHARISMA by 2 until you can find a cure. Furthermore, your arm hangs limply at your side and you must drag your leg behind you. If you are lucky, it was your off-hand side and you can still manage to fight (barely). Roll two dice and add 1 if you are an initiate of either Maka or the Three Fortunes. Add another 1 if you have the title Blessed of the Three Fortunes.

2 – 6	Primary hand:	reduce COMBAT and THIEVERY by 6 each
7 +	Off-hand:	reduce COMBAT and THIEVERY by 4 each

The effects of the poison are powerful and you will find it difficult to function unless you can find a cure quickly. The penalties will last until you are cured. Now return to **672** and continue reading.

542

The cliff face is not particularly steep, but you will have to make your descent quietly or you may be noticed. Make a THIEVERY roll at a Difficulty of 16. If you succeed, turn to **135** immediately. If you fail, the merfolk are alerted to your presence and the skittish creatures dive back into the sea. Turn to **197**.

543

If you previously used **salt and iron filings** when you passed through the burial mounds, you may exit unmolested and reach the edge of the forest. Turn to **358**. Otherwise, as you exit the tomb you are surrounded by ghosts. More than two dozen of them fly forward slowly, their faces twisted in preparation to devour you. If you took the **sapphire amulet**, for some reason the faces of the ghosts turn to masks of fear, and they all kneel down and bow as you exit the forest (turn to **358**). Otherwise, they close in for the kill. They are enraged at your sacrilege and will avenge their master!

Make a SANCTITY roll at a difficulty of 22. If you fail, your death is painful but thankfully quick. Turn to **700**. If you succeed, you can hold them off until the rays of dawn pierce the canopy. The ghosts sigh as their hunt is spoiled for the day and they fade away for the moment. You hasten your pace, eager to leave the forsaken forest behind. Turn to **358**.

544

You lash out at him with the fury of hell incarnate. For a split second you see a glimpse of terror in the Saint's eyes before he is immolated in black flames and banished. You have destroyed the Saint of Vulture's peak.

You are now truly irredeemable, and upon your death your soul will be cast into hell for all eternity. If you are lucky, you may rise and one day become a Demon Lord, but for now you are still mortal. Record the codeword *Irredeemable*. You may never lose the title Demoniac under any circumstance and you automatically fail any SANCTITY roll. You become an absolute paragon of the underworld, your physical form now reflecting your true nature. Your eyes become narrow slits like a cat and your fingertips extend into razor sharp claws. Your hair is turned jet black and cascades down your shoulders like the mane of a nightmare. Increase your CHARISMA score to 13. It may never be reduced from 13 (just like your MAGIC score as a boon for being a Demoniac). Furthermore, you are always treated as if carrying a +6 weapon due to your wicked talons that could disembowel a man effortlessly. These do not consume an item slot on your Adventure sheet and can never be lost (even when resurrected). If you ever carry a weapon with a higher combat bonus you may use that one instead.

Unfortunately, interacting in the world above may be difficult, especially with those sensitive to the nature of your irredeemable soul. When presented with the option to enter a temple you may not take it unless otherwise forced into the choice. This excludes temples to Nagil or temples to Demon Lords.

You recall Kæla Karna promised you a great reward upon completion of your deed, and you descend the mountain eagerly. Turn to **524**.

545

The oars of the reaver ships make them powerful over short distances. This particular pirate captain looks intent on capturing your ship. Roll three dice and add your Rank. Add 1 if you have an average crew, add 2 if you have a good crew and 3 if you have an excellent crew. Subtract 2 for each cargo unit you are carrying.

19 or less	they catch up to you	turn to 297
20 +	you escape	turn to 150

546

To banish the dozens of ghosts would be an extraordinary feat, however your purity manages to hold them at bay for hours until finally the rays of dawn pierce the canopy. The ghosts sigh as their hunt is spoiled for the day and they fade away for the moment. Turn to **316**.

547

Your crew draw their knives and pick up belaying pins, preparing themselves for the fight of their lives. One of the ships crunches into the side of yours, and the vampire crew stroll aboard casually, smiling in anticipation of fresh blood. This will be the fight of your very life. Roll three dice (four if you are a Warrior) and add your Rank. Add 2 if your crew quality is excellent, and 1 if it is good. Add 2 if you have the codeword *Impeccable*, and then lose the codeword *Impeccable*.

29 or less	Crushing defeat	turn to 317
30 – 37	Vampires forced to retreat	turn to 26
38 +	Glorious victory!	turn to 681

548

The forest is eerie and filled with the sound of insects whose chirping mimic the cries of lost souls. Roll two dice:

2 – 5	A dead body	turn to 354
6 – 8	Ghostly figures	turn to 117
9 – 12	Mind games	turn to 258

549 □□□

Tick one of the boxes above. If all three boxes are already ticked, you have learned all you can from your sparring bouts and it is time you returned to the world and seek a real challenge (return to **708**). Otherwise, you test your mettle against the other soldiers and knights in the courtyards. They are all trying to prove themselves in front of the superiors, so there is a high probability that you may get injured!

Roll two dice. If you score higher than your COMBAT score you may increase it by 1. If you roll lower than your COMBAT score your overconfidence leads you to lower your guard against a reckless attack. Lose 1 point of Stamina permanently from a crippling injury. If you roll double 1, you receive a severe and chronic injury, reducing your COMBAT score by 1.

When you have finished here, return to **708**.

550

You find one of the only places without a treacherous reef bed. There are a few other ships here, and it is safe to dock here. If you do, note that your ship is now docked in the Innis Shoals and turn to **670**. Otherwise you can either:

Sail west into the Sea of Stilts turn to **617**

Sail east into the Violet Ocean *Over the Blood-Dark Sea* 96

551

You look down at the pebble, and then back at the abbot. ‘I don’t need to take the pebble,’ you say, ‘because I already have his teachings.’ The abbot nods in satisfaction.

Note that you are now an initiate of the Sage of Peace. This does not prevent you from also being an initiate of another temple, because the sage is not a jealous god.

‘Now you are ready to journey to Akatsurai,’ he says. ‘There you will find enlightenment.’ Surely you don’t have to travel to the other side of the *Fabled Lands* to achieve enlightenment, you think to yourself.

Turn to **662**.

552

He asks that you sign a waiver removing him from all liability in the event of your death or impairment. He also mentions that you may leave your non-essential possessions here for safe keeping. ‘I hope you have a resurrection arrangement,’ he mentions in passing. Turn to **145** if you have anything you wish to leave here.

He instructs you to mount a magical orb on the prow of your ship, explaining that he will be able to monitor the behaviour of the deep sea ley lines from his study. He spends a little time explaining the nature of ley lines and their interaction with wave activity to you. Record the codeword *Illiad* if you didn't already have it. 'Sail as close as you can to the mouth of the vortex for as long as possible,' he instructs, 'I will need as much data as possible.'

You board your ship and set sail toward the black eye of the vortex. Turn to **32**.

553

As you walk along the beach line kicking shells into the water you are suddenly buffeted in the back of the head by a large wave. Lose 1-6 Stamina. Looking up from the ground you are shocked to see a towering wall of water heading toward you... and it appears to be alive!

Water Elemental COMBAT 16 Defence 18 Stamina 40

You must have an enchanted weapon (+1 bonus or higher) to hit it, otherwise your strikes will simply go right through it! Whenever the elemental hits you in combat it tries to drag you into the water and you must roll your Rank or less on three dice to avoid being pulled in. If you are pulled into the water, turn to **619** immediately. You may flee at any time and take 1-6 Stamina of damage from a parting blow. If you defeat it, the elemental crashes onto the beach... though of course you won't find a body! Turn to **79**.

554

If you have the title *Demoniac*, turn to **582**. If you do not have the title but have at least one of any of the codewords *Clanger*, *Evil*, *Fracas*, *Iota*, *Judas*, and *Kink*, turn to **16**. Otherwise, turn to **433**.

555

A soldier approaches you on the road and explains to you that he is training to become a knight. He must challenge as many skilled warriors as possible in order to improve his swordsmanship. If you are a Warrior or you have either of the titles Paladin of Ravayne or Crimson Knight, he desires to have a practice duel with you. If you accept, turn to **214**. If you decline or fail to meet his requirements, the man bids you good day and goes on his way. Turn to **39**.

556

The temple of Alvir and Valmir is constructed from imported white marble and sits with a panoramic view of the harbour. Two tall spires twist their way skyward as if blown by an unseen breeze. In the nave of the temple, a mural depicts them as fishers hauling up the souls of the drowned in their nets.

Become an initiate turn to **235**

Renounce worship turn to **329**

Seek a blessing turn to **622**

Leave turn to **380**

557

The old knight may be stuck in his ways, but he certainly takes care of his own. As you are an initiate (or a Crimson Knight) he will give you Tynrai's blessing for free! Write COMBAT in the Blessings box on your Adventure Sheet.

The blessing works by allowing you to try again when fail a COMBAT roll. It is good for only one reroll. When you use the blessing, cross

it off your Adventure Sheet. You can only have one COMBAT blessing at any one time. Once it is used up, you can return here to receive a new one.

When you are finished, turn to **708**

558

The boy shrugs and flies off just in time. The men arrive and you realise that they are city guards from Kurani, and they have been chasing a thief! ‘Why did you not apprehend the robber – he is the one who raised the treasury of Prince Azimishtra Deoraj! We have no chance to catch up to him now that he has the Prince’s carpet... you have just let a criminal escape!’

If you were just given 250 Shards from the boy, the guards confiscate the Prince’s money regardless of your protests. If you have any of the codewords *Bullion*, *Evade*, *Fracas* or *Incomplete*, and do not have the codeword *Face*, the guards recognise you immediately and apprehend you. You would have no chance to outrun them on horseback. Turn to **71**. Otherwise, they give you a good flogging. Lose three dice worth of Stamina, however they will leave you alive so you cannot be reduced below 1 Stamina in this way. Now turn to **18**.

559

Trading in the walking city is relatively rare, as wizards and artificers are primarily concerned with the most obscure of items. However there might be something you could offer. You hear that exotic spices often make potent ingredients in arcane rituals, and that slaves make good human subjects for experimentation. All prices are for 1 Cargo Unit.

	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Metals	-	820 Shards
Minerals	-	700 Shards
Spices	-	950 Shards
Slaves	-	400 Shards

When you are ready to leave the harbour, your can:

Head back to the city centre	turn to 280
Set sail	turn to 519

560

The waters along the coast of Chrysoprais are relatively calm, and you pass a large number of ships as their captains go about their business in the bustling ports in the Sea of Stilts. Roll two dice:

2 – 4	A Chrysopraisian warship	turn to 120
5 – 9	A pleasant day or sailing	turn to 325
10 – 12	A ship of wizards	turn to 441

561 □

If the box above is ticked, turn to **653**. The body is that of a gold-skinned man. He is dressed in foreign clothes and is long since dead. On his body you find nothing but a **pathfinder’s gem** which you may take if you wish. Turn to **350**.

562 □

If the above box is ticked, turn to **431**. Otherwise, read on. You are approached by a well dressed and sophisticated man who has been watching you ever since you entered the district. He approaches you and shakes your hand, passing you a folded parchment. ‘You look like someone who would be interested in attending our function tonight...’ he says as he walks off. The parchment is beautiful, bordered with gold filigree. An address and cordial invitation is finely scribed with elaborate penmanship. It is not until you have left the district that you realise it is written in blood. Note the **party invitation** on your character sheet and turn back to **50**.

563

The approaching ship looks armed to the teeth and well manned by experienced police. You have only one chance to out run the ship before it gets too close. Otherwise you could hide aboard and allow your bosun to do the talking.

Try to outrun the vessel	turn to 693
Hide on board	turn to 331

564

Your cabin boy spots an uncharted island up ahead. It is relatively small and uninviting – no wonder it hasn’t been put on any maps.

Take the cutter ashore	turn to 19
Continue on your voyage	turn to 425

565

The chest is trapped, and unless you succeed at a THIEVERY roll at a Difficulty of 18, you are scythed by two blades aimed at your wrists. Roll four dice and lose that many points of Stamina. Furthermore, if you are injured by the blades you are also poisoned. This virulent centipede venom causes your hands to shake uncontrollably, reducing your COMBAT, MAGIC and THIEVERY scores by

2 until you can find a cure. If you have a blessing of Immunity to Disease/poison, cross it off immediately and you can ignore the effects of this poison.

Inside the box is 1,000 Shards and a piece of paper. Note the **catastrophe certificate** on your Adventure Sheet if you wish to keep it and turn back to the paragraph you were reading.

566 □

If the box above is already ticked, turn to **438** immediately. Otherwise, continue reading.

Upon your return to the city, Lady Nasitha arranges for an immediate meeting to learn of the results of your mission. She is overjoyed about the response! ‘You have strengthened ties that I had thought were severed many years ago... peace will reign between our great nations!’ She arranges food and lodging for you to recuperate from your travels. Restore your Stamina to its unwounded score. You are then ushered out of the mansion with a small pouch of 250 Shards. You had expected far better treatment than this, considering that you may have just averted a war!

Nevertheless you feel surprisingly content, and you can’t seem to explain why you don’t feel despondent about your poor treatment as the country’s saviour... Gain 1 Rank. Roll one die and add that many points to your normal (unwounded) Stamina score.

Turn to **600** and choose from the options presented there.

567

You awaken in the middle of the night to the sound of your animal. It is making a ruckus and appears extremely agitated. If you want to silence it and return to sleep, turn to **376**. Otherwise you could head on to the deck (turn to **336**).

568

Your crew rejoice and take turns to shake your hand. You send some of your provisions and water aboard and the bosun tells you that they will await your return in Mithdrak if you need them in the future. Lose the codeword *Ill* or *Just* (you may choose which one to lose if you have both) and note your old ship back on your Ship’s Manifest. The crew quality is poor, it has no cargo and is currently docked at Mithdrak. Now turn to **150** to continue your voyage.

569

You have a conversation with passing merchant who is sailing east for Sokara. ‘I hear the Druid’s Isle is a good place to trade, but I have never been there myself and know not of its current situation.’ He explains that he wants to know there is a

demand for. If you do not have the codeword *Aspen*, turn to **250**. If you do have the codeword, he thanks you for the information and gives you trade tip that will get you the best deal at Krateros in Atticala. Gain the codeword *Intuit* if you didn’t already have it. Turn to **250**.

570

You find a number of items of interest, however you note that they are all particularly exotic and expensive. There is little interest in purchasing your items as they have a number of their own artificers at the Temple.

<i>Magical Items</i>	<i>To buy</i>
Cobalt Wand (MAGIC +3)	2000 Shards
Selenium Wand (MAGIC +4)	4000 Shards
Celestium Wand (MAGIC +5)	8000 Shards

<i>Other Items</i>	
Divining Rod	150 Shards
Catastrophe Certificate	1500 Shards
Witch’s Hand	500 Shards
Verdigris Key	5000 Shards

When you have finished here, return to **29**.

571

If you have the codeword *Injure*, turn to **639** immediately. If you have the codeword *Imbibe*, turn to **187**.

The general is a busy man, and to seek an audience with him will require a successful CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 16. He will also automatically grant an audience to heroes of great renown. If you are at least 11th Rank, have the title Crimson Knight or succeed on that CHARISMA roll, turn to **31**. Otherwise, return to **708**.

572

You notice you are being followed by a group of five men dressed as nobles, though your instinct tells you they are no more than common thugs. It would be easy to lose them.

Lose them in the crowd	turn to 50
Turn around and confront them	turn to 507
Take them by surprise	turn to 362

573

If you are not searching for Danuo's island, return to **89** and continue reading. Danuo is an accomplished sorcerer and appreciates his privacy. To navigate through the misdirection and wards you will have to make a SCOUTING roll at a Difficulty of 20, adding 1 if you are a Mage and 2 if you have the title Distinguished Researcher. If you fail, return to **89** and continue reading. If you succeed, note that your ship is docked at Danuo's Island and turn to **446**.

574

Towering fists of water knock some of your best crewmen into the sea. Reduce the quality of your crew by two steps. Also, cross off 1 unit of cargo (if you had any). If you have multiple units of different cargo you may choose which one to lose. Turn to **640**.

575

You are sailing in the waters south of Chrysoprais. To your west lies the port of Auriculum, and closer north the city of Mithdrak. If you wish to go ashore at Mithdrak, note that your ship is docked at Mithdrak and turn to **85**. Otherwise you could:

Head west	turn to 411
Head east into coastal waters	<i>The Lone and Level Sands</i> 84
Head South toward the Edge of the World	turn to 93

576 □

If the box above is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading. If it was already ticked, turn to **478** immediately.

'I have few true followers in the land of mortals, for the deep sea is unforgiving,' he booms. 'In the Land of Roots however, my followers are numerous! Show me your devotion.'

Heilmir will give you one opportunity to demonstrate your conviction. He instructs you to dive down to the very bottom of the ocean and bring him the silt from a volcanic vent. If you accept his challenge, he waves his hand, granting you the ability to breathe underwater for a limited period. To begin your quest, turn to **109**. If you wish to leave without trying, he will scoff and leave. Turn to **275**.

577

Kumba Karna has found your piety repulsive and has rescinded you. Erase his name from your god box, but you are now cursed. Each demon lord had a specific hex to place upon those who anger them so that all in the underworld can see whom the sinner has crossed. Kumba Karna's specialty is the Curse of Immolation,

wherein your skin shrivels as if you have been horribly burnt in the pits of hell. Your hair has been scorched from your head and your skin weeps pus constantly, making everything you touch feel like agony. Your face is especially repulsive to look upon. Put your current CHARISMA score in brackets, and note that your new CHARISMA score is 1. It can be improved with items that grant bonuses, but never increases otherwise. If you gain a CHARISMA score increase or penalty in the course of your adventures, add it to your score in brackets. When you have the curse removed you can restore your CHARISMA to the score in brackets.

Libbyrsh chuckles when she sees your new appearance. 'You realise that only denizens of the underworld have even seen such a curse, let alone know how to remove it. Perhaps if you prove yourself to our lord Kumba Karna again, he will take pity on you...'

Note that the Curse of Immolation cannot be removed unless specifically stated in the entry. An instance where you may remove 'all curses' will not suffice. You could take the lesser demon's suggestion and venture into the underworld (remember you will need a light source), or you could leave by sea. If you had any possessions left here, Libbyrsh refuses to return them to you (turn to **669** and erase everything in the box, then return here).

Enter the tunnel	<i>Into the Underworld</i> 403
Wait for a passing ship	turn to 14

578

If you can pay the amount requested from your banked money, your captors let you free. They return your items but keep any cash you were carrying at the time. They give you a friendly wave as you leave and you hear them talking to each other. 'May as well let 'im live for now... we can just rob 'im again next time!' They laugh heartily. Turn to **50**.

If you cannot pay the ransom, the leader shakes his head. 'Pity,' he says as his accomplices hold you down and he draws his knife. Your death is thankfully swift. Turn to **700**.

579

While the guards are occupied, you leap onto the carpet, leaving the boy to his fate. The horsemen pursue you for a few minutes but it is simply futile and they give up when they lose sight of you. Eventually you come to a halt and marvel at your new acquisition. Add the **magic carpet (safe travel x2)** to your Adventure Sheet. It has two charges remaining which you can expend after rolling an encounter dice to avoid an unfavourable encounter. If you do so, chose the 'uneventful journey' option and remove one charge from the **magic**

carpet. When there are no charges left it simply becomes a **green carpet**. Note that it can only be used when travelling cross-country, and not when sailing or when in a city or town. Also, you can only carry one **carpet** on your person at any time because they are very bulky and heavy, even when rolled up.

It looks like you have used up some of the potency of the enchantment, but you figure there must be some other way to imbue it with power again. You ponder your interesting find as you walk back to the path. Turn to **18**.

580

If you have a **catastrophe certificate**, cross it off and turn to **550**. There is a thunderous crack and the wheel spins from your hand. The crew are tossed overboard like rag dolls and ship begins to take on water. Your efforts to save the ship and its crew are futile and you are forced to set out in the cutter. It screeches to a halt on a reef and you are tossed ashore one of the Innis islands. Turn to **271**.

581

If you have the codeword *Impede*, turn to **603** immediately. If you are an initiate of Kumba Karna, turn to **170**. Otherwise, read on.

You can hear the sound of chanting in low tones coming from a flame lit area in the centre of the island, where you can see a small number of low lying buildings crafted from slabs of granite. There are no guards, and the figures inside seem to be concentrating in prayer. You will have to make a THIEVERY roll if you wish to approach undetected. Alternately you could simply approach and make your presence known (treat it as a failed THIEVERY roll).

Make a THIEVERY roll at a Difficulty of 18. Reduce your roll by 2 if you are a Priest, and reduce it by 3 if you have a SANCTITY score of 9 or higher (don't include item bonuses, but include item penalties from evil items).

Successful THIEVERY roll	turn to 90
Failed THIEVERY roll	turn to 349
Leave before they notice	turn to 266

582

'Ah, our great lord Kumba Karna has indeed led you here,' says the snake demon. 'Come forth, young one.' If you are an initiate of Kæla Karna, turn to **407** immediately. Otherwise, she offers to induct you into the worship of their great lord Kumba Karna of the Land of Roots immediately. She explains that Kumba Karna will look after you well, and it in need of faithful mortal followers such as yourself.

Pledge yourself to Kumba Karna	turn to 309
Refuse	turn to 433

583

You are sat in a large hut that must be a meeting room of some sort. An ancient looking elder sits in front of a large wooden idol, which looks like an old aspect of Badogor. You are ushered to sit on the straw mats provided and the elder draws in the dirt to communicate with you. It appears that they see you as a friend and wish to share a feast with you. If you have the codeword *Infirm*, turn to **477** immediately. Otherwise, you spend a few hours eating the leftovers from their last meal, who you assume must have been the crew of the previous guests of the island. Restore one die worth of Stamina. Now turn to **649**.

584

'Good man,' he commends you with a hand shake. With a click of his fingers two servants fetch a coffer of coins and present it to you on their knees. Add 10,000 Shards to your Adventure Sheet and cross off the codeword *Ebb*. You have drawn the attention of a number of greedy looking bystanders so perhaps you should bank the money as soon as possible...

If you have the codeword *Incomplete*, turn to **154** immediately. Otherwise, return to **600**.

585

You flip through the pages of your future, astonished to see the account of what will happen to you written in past tense. You are driven insane and all you can remember is running out of the temple screaming and then throwing yourself off the edge of the cliff and into the sea. Turn to **22**.

586

This time you thank your luck as nothing untoward happens and you have a nice meal of grilled fish. Turn to **395**.

587

You set to work on your way up the peak. The base of the mountain is relatively easy to climb.

Make a SCOUTING roll at a Difficulty of 15.

Successful SCOUTING roll	turn to 296
Failed SCOUTING roll	turn to 481
Do not make the attempt	turn to 300

588

Make both MAGIC and SANCTITY rolls at Difficulty 18.

Both rolls successful turn to **482**

One or both rolls fail turn to **24**

589

‘Don’t worry cap’n,’ says the bosun, ‘we’ll wait for you at Mithdrak.’ Note that your ship is now docked at Mithdrak. The captain ensures that they requisition all of your personal possessions from your ship to be taken into evidence. Turn to **71**.

590

The Reaver ships turn and abandon their men. You capture the remaining survivors and force them to assist in freeing your ship from the reef and conduct minor repairs. You are finally able to set sail again. Note that you have 1 cargo unit of Slaves if you have room for it. You may jettison other cargo in its place. Although the attackers did not carry any money you may sell a number of their weapons if you have room to carry them. There are only six in good enough condition to resell. Note six **swords** on your character sheet if you have space to carry them. The fight has proven your mettle to the crew. If you are a Warrior, roll two dice. If you roll higher than your CHARISMA score you may increase it by 1. If you are any other profession, you may make the same roll but for COMBAT instead. Turn to **550**.

591

Where will you head from here?

Head west along the coast turn to **320**

Take the road to Kurani turn to **360**

Follow the river Ajantur to Vulture’s Peak turn to **659**

Head cross country toward the Crimson Fort turn to **466**

592

You will surely be hanged if they discover your identity. You will have to rely on your tongue to get you out of this one. Make both a CHARISMA and a THIEVERY roll, both at a Difficulty of 19.

Succeed at both rolls turn to **142**

Fail one roll turn to **486**

Fail both rolls turn to **361**

593

You are not as easily fooled as the security team must think as you manage to locate the general’s authentic bedchamber without great difficulty. However it is being guarded by two sentries. You will need to eliminate these sentries without a sound or you may be in big trouble. Either make a COMBAT roll at a Difficulty of 18 to slay them instantly, or a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 20 to misdirect them to leave their post. You may add 1 to either of these rolls if you are a Rogue.

Successful COMBAT or CHARISMA roll turn to **228**

Failed COMBAT or CHARISMA roll turn to **487**

594

Umbart listens to your story intently. Unless you have the codeword *Insane*, he simply doesn’t believe your fanciful tale – there are too many inconsistencies. The wizard has his trau servants usher you back to your ship and tell you to leave the vortex. Turn to **52** immediately. If you do not have a ship docked here, turn to **616**.

If you do have the codeword *Insane*, you explain the rest of your fantastic tale and he claps his hands with glee. ‘This will make a great addition to my new research paper!’ he clicks his fingers and a trau servant escorts you to collect a reward. Turn to **7**.

595

The bosun turns to you wise-eyed. ‘Do you really think that is wise, cap’n? Ain’t nothing out there but the edge of the world... that’s suicide. Besides, the men gotta have a lot of confidence in you to follow you to certain death!’

If you have the codeword *Curdle*, you can lead your faithful crew to the Edge of the World. Turn to **103**. If you do not have the codeword or you have reconsidered your course, return to **425** and choose again.

596

Completely engrossed in what you were doing, you fail to notice the town guard approaching. You turn around with a start as one armed man places a hand on your shoulder. ‘You are under arrest,’ he declares, preparing to clamp the shackles over your wrists.

Roll four dice. If you roll under your Rank you are able to escape from the authorities and only stop running when you are on the outskirts of the city. Turn to **395**. If you roll above your Rank, you are apprehended and escorted to the gaol in Mithdrak. Turn to **71**.

597

You get close enough to see that a young man is being restrained on a wooden altar, held to the ground with iron stakes. The other men and women turn to look at you. They wear red robes, hoods down so you can see their faces. They appear to be completely normal citizens of Chrysoprais – educated and well spoken. ‘What brings you here, stranger?’ asks a man holding a long, wavy bladed knife at his side.

If you have the title Demoniac or Unspeakable Cultist, turn to **155** immediately. Otherwise, you could attempt to gain their trust for now, ready to spring a trap and save the man. You are sure they won’t let you leave now that you know what they are about to do...

Gain their trust	turn to 313
Attack them	turn to 238

598

Prince Azim takes you to see the items he has collected from his adventuring days. ‘I used to use all of these when I roamed the land in search of quests just like you. They all came in handy, but I have little use for them now.’

Choose any one of the following items:

jade crown (CHARISMA +5)
celestium wand (MAGIC +5)
vajra baton (SANCTITY +5)
stone arrowhead (SCOUTING +4)
hand of glory (THIEVERY +4)

He is a little sad to see the item go, but he insists that you will put it to better use. ‘Better than sitting here and gathering dust. Take good care of it for me.’

Turn to **750**.

599

The temple of Alvir and Valmir was established in Mithdrak long ago by visitors from Atticala. It is possibly the only prestigious building that is not adorned with the towering spires of traditional Chrysopraian design, and is instead a great pillared edifice of blazing white marble on the esplanade looking out over the bay. The twin gods are responsible for storms at sea. In the nave of the temple, a mural depicts them as fishers hauling up the souls of the drowned in their nets.

Become an initiate	turn to 648
Renounce worship	turn to 252
Seek a blessing	turn to 148
Leave	turn to 50

600

The city of Kurani was established many centuries ago with the wealth of the royal family in Mithdrak. However looking upon it now you would not have guessed. The buildings were once beautiful but are in a state of disrepair, and the streets are unclean, filled with refuse from the inefficient garbage collection system. There is less divide in social class than can be seen in Mithdrak, and although the poor do not go hungry as often, the lack of policing means crime rate is rising. The king’s youngest son, Prince Azimishtra Deoraj was forced to retire from his adventuring career and run Kurani to carry on the family legacy, however his inexperience and lack of interest in politics is evident. If you have codeword *Imbibe*, turn to **222** immediately.

Go to the market	turn to 363
Visit the temple to the Sage of Peace	turn to 723
Look for the Brotherhood of the Night	turn to 749
Seek an audience with Prince Azimishtra	turn to 766
Go to the harbour	turn to 260
Take the road southwest to the Temple of the Eye	turn to 661
Take the road southeast to Mithdrak	turn to 360
Take the coastal road northeast to the Crimson Fort	turn to 186

601

You will have to use all your knowledge of the environment to get an upper hand in the oncoming battle. Make both THIEVERY and SCOUTING rolls at Difficulty of 18. You may add 1 to the rolls if you are a Rogue. If you succeed at *both* rolls, note the codeword *Impeccable* on your character sheet. If you fail *both* rolls, note the codeword *Inadequate* on your character sheet. No codeword is received for only one successful roll. Turn to **440**.

602

Prince Alaburdh strokes his beard. ‘Yes, someone of your talent may be useful indeed. Come, walk with me,’ he says gesturing as he leaves the hall. You get a strange feeling that he doesn’t want his father to hear what he is about to say.

‘I have a mission of the utmost secrecy. No one but the two of us will know of it.’ You listen intently as he takes you to a secure room. ‘As you may already know, General Murtabaht Singh of the independent barony of the Crimson Fort is preparing a campaign to take the Atticalan outpost of Hopias. He intends to declare war on Atticala believing that expanding the territory of

Chrysoprais will be in the best interests of our country. You will kill him,' he says coldly.

You learn that Singh was granted a his own domain within Chrysoprais for his great service to the country decades ago, and with that he was granted a degree of leeway. Indeed he amasses powerful armies to depend Chrysoprais, and the royal family has never questioned his loyalties to them. However now, his single minded action to start a war may be their downfall. Whilst the Prince agrees that one day they will conquer Atticala, now is not the right time. The general does not agree, and removing him from his position is the only thing that will stop this ball rolling.

'My wizards will ensure that he is not returned to life once you complete the deed. When Singh is removed, his armies will be in disarray and it will be an opportunity for one of his successors to take control of the fort. Of course, all possible successors share my... I mean, the royal family's view, and they will ensure there is no campaign. Everyone has a price. What is yours?'

Prince Alaburdh promises you a title, access to the treasury, and future employment in the same area. If you accept the mission, record the codeword *Ilk* and the codeword *Indefatigable*, then turn to **627** to choose a gift of goodwill that may help you in your mission. If you decline, lose the codeword *Indefatigable* if you had it, as you have fallen out of favour with the Prince. He then insists that you leave the palace before he decides to kill you for the information he has already told you. Turn to **50**.

603

Since you defeated the snake-headed demon here the island seems very bare, just as it was when you left it. As you are investigating the area you are confronted by a horde of withered wretches, rotting corpses from the underworld. It seems that they have been left here like guard dogs to keep prying eyes off the island. You must treat them as one opponent, and it is their strength in numbers that makes them a formidable foe.

Withered wretches COMBAT 26 Defence 15 Stamina 75

If you win, turn to **321** immediately. If you flee, you will lose three dice worth of Stamina from a parting blow, then, if you arrived by ship turn to **450**. If you did not arrive by ship, the only way for you to escape is down the dank looking tunnel in the centre of the island. The granite arch looks ancient, and on its weather-beaten surface you can just make out old carvings depicting demons bursting forth from hellfire. If you wish to enter the tunnel, you will need a source of light such as a **lantern** or a **candle**. If you are a Mage you can create light through sorcery.

Enter the tunnel *Into the Underworld* **403**
Leave the island by ship turn to **450**

604

Unless you have an edged weapon of some sort (such as a **sword**, **axe**, or **spear**), you will have no chance of bashing the ship free of the tentacles. Turn to **447**. If you do have an edged weapon, you leap into the water and slice at the black rubber arms. They are twice the thickness of your body!

Make a COMBAT roll at a difficulty of 18.

Successful COMBAT roll turn to **690**
Failed COMBAT roll turn to **447**

605

You pull close enough alongside and yell instructions to the captain. It takes a great deal of time, but you manage to guide him along the safe path through the vortex. Once at Umbart's palace, you spend time with him aboard his ship and explain how to safely navigate the vortex in detail. He thanks you wholeheartedly and offers you a gift from his ship. You can take one cargo unit of Textiles (if you have room for it on your ship) and 200 Shards. With that he goes on his way and you are free to continue your own adventures. Note that your ships is now docked at Umbart's Vortex and turn to **163**.

606

You spend some time discussing religious philosophy with the priests and learn that their All Seeing god, an aspect of Molhern, has only been worshipped in Chrysoprais for the last few decades. In fact, the practice was brought here by an old mage who took up the life of a priest and decided to found an order which could document the history of the *Fabled Lands*, past, present, and those things that have yet to pass. He is now long since dead, but his practice lives on in the Temple, though access to the records is a well guarded secret.

Now, if you are an initiate of Molhern *and* have either the title *Illuminate* of Molhern or are a Priest by profession, turn to **456**. Otherwise, he says 'I have foreseen that I will give you that secret... but not yet.' You must part ways.

Turn to **18**.

607

Since the rebirth process you notice that your new body is noticeably different. Roll one die and make the necessary amendments:

- 1 More beautiful: +1 CHARISMA
- 2 Golden hair: see *The Court of Hidden Faces* **681**
- 3 Physically stronger: +1 COMBAT
- 4 More robust: +2 unwounded Stamina *permanently*
- 5 More nimble: +1 THIEVERY
- 6 Blue skin: note this in your Titles box

After you have made the adjustments to your Adventure Sheet, turn to **768**.

608

You turn it over and the look on his face gives you a startle. His face is twisted in a silent scream, eyes wide open as if he died of sheer fright! You can take his money pouch which contains 260 Shards and a **candle**. Unfortunately after you leave the corpse you notice your skin has burst out in red blotches. You have contracted the Red Ague, a disease which reduces your COMBAT and CHARISMA scores by 1 each until you can find a cure. Turn to **316**.

609 □

If there is already a tick in the box above, return to **279** and continue reading. If not, put a tick in it now.

‘I am journeying to learn the song of the mermaids’ he explains. You tell the bard what you know about mermaids in the Violet Ocean and he thanks you greatly. ‘You have been a great help, but I have nothing to offer you in return.’ He thinks to himself momentarily, and then pulls out a leather pouch, handing it to you. Inside is a plain looking wooden flute. If you refuse the gift, turn to **240**. Otherwise, mark the **centaur flute (CHARISMA +3)** on your Adventure sheet. You bid him farewell and continue on your voyage. Turn to **125**.

610

You board the ship and order the old bosun on deck. He is petrified, knowing your reputation and power he feels he will surely be executed. The rest of the old crew all line up and stand to, awaiting their punishment.

Execute him and reclaim the ship	turn to 160
Forgive him and let him keep it	turn to 439

611

If you have the title Royal Assassin, turn to **139** immediately. Otherwise, you spend a miserable five months in the tiny cell, poorly nourished by the daily gruel and worm-ridden bread. Roll one die and lose that many Stamina *permanently*. However, if you have the codeword *Illuminate*, you manage to sustain yourself and lose only 1 permanent Stamina in this way.

The time in solitary confinement does give you an opportunity to practice your skills. You can either spend your days strength training, in focussed meditation or improving your less-than-reputable talents. Choose COMBAT, SANCTITY, or THIEVERY and roll two dice. If you roll higher than the relevant ability score you may add 1 to it.

You prove a model inmate and are let out ahead of time due to good behaviour. Lose the codewords *Bullion*, *Evade*, *Fracas* and *Incomplete* if you had any of them. You may turn to **483** and collect any items that had been confiscated from you before your imprisonment and then turn to **50**.

612

The cabin boy calls down from the crow’s nest, pointing off to the stern. A city on stilts appears to be making its way toward your ship! This must be the Walking City of which you have heard so much. If you wish to dock at the Walking City, turn to **280**. Otherwise, return to the paragraph you were just reading and treat it as if you had rolled ‘uneventful journey’ on your encounter roll.

613

The town guards recognise you and welcome you in. You are seen by the Captain of the guard who sits down for lunch with you and chats idly for an hour. You are offered lodging with the town guard where you may restore your Stamina to full. If you are completely destitute – no money on your person or in any financial institution, and no items in your possession or at any house in Mithdrak – the Captain of the Guard will give you 200 Shards and standard town guard equipment, comprising of a **Scimitar** and a suit of **Chainmail (Defence +3)**. When you are finished here, turn to **50**.

614

You are asked to donate 30 Shards for the materials required to conduct the ritual. ‘Are you sure you wish to renounce the All Seeing one?’ asks the head priest. ‘You may find it difficult to achieve clarity without his guidance,’ he warns. If you decide to go through with it, erase Molhern from the god box on your Adventure Sheet. No sooner than your first step as you walk away you are suddenly struck blind. As you cry out in surprise there are hushed murmurs from the other priests, but you get the feeling that this is a common occurrence. You eyesight slowly returns and you feel a slight sense of apprehension... turn back to **29**.

615

You are standing at the very edge of the Forest of Rakshasas.
 Press into the forest turn to **529**
 Head toward the Crimson Fort turn to **244**
 Head into the mountains to the south turn to **528**

616

‘Hmm, what a dilemma indeed,’ he mutters, ‘though a very common one. I must always keep this spell prepared for reckless adventurers...’ Before you can say another word he waves his hand and you are suddenly standing somewhere else...
 Turn to **50**.

617

Sailing this close to the Innis Shoals is bound to have risks. Storms plague the archipelago and daring pirates flaunt the strict policing of the Sea of Stilts, sailing westward to assault unsuspecting merchants. Roll two dice:

2 – 3	Daring Pirates	turn to 97
4 – 6	A Storm brewing	turn to 680
7	An uneventful journey	turn to 150
8 – 10	A familiar ship?	turn to 379
11 – 12	Spectral forms	turn to 461

618

‘I would like to make an offer for that blade,’ he says confidently. ‘The Akatsurese are known to be the best craftsmen in all the *Fabled Lands*. I would like to own one of their blades. What would you want in return?’

Request 5,000 Shards	turn to 386
Demand 10,000 Shards	turn to 469
Request that he forge a weapon of equal value	turn to 685
Not for sale	turn to 189

619

You are pulled into its domain and whilst in the water it is nigh invulnerable to attack. It has the same Stamina score as before (if you wounded it):

Water Elemental COMBAT 20 Defence 25 Stamina **

Each round of combat you must make a SCOUTING roll Difficulty 15 plus your armour bonus (a **ring**, **cape** or other item doesn’t count) or be drowned. If you drown or are killed by the elemental, turn to **700**. If you somehow manage to win, turn to **11**.

620

You are on a mission to find the book of the dead and return it to the temple of Nagil in Auriculum. You take your time and eventually find a leather case containing a sheave of papers written in an ancient text. By the symbols that you can recognise you figure this is it. Add the **book of the dead** to your Adventure Sheet.

Now, if you have the title Distinguished Researcher, turn to **147**. Otherwise, you look through other books at random and they are written in such an ancient dialect that you simply cannot understand them. Furthermore, as you turn the pages they start to disintegrate in your hands. There is nothing else of interest here. You could:

Loot the bodies	turn to 387
Leave the ruins	turn to 198

621

You return Charat’s daughter and he rewards you with all that he has – 200 Shards and a place to stay and store your equipment. You can visit him anytime in the poor quarters. Now turn to **50**.

622

If you are an initiate it costs only 5 Shards to propitiate the twin gods of the sea. A non-initiate must pay 20 Shards. Cross off the money and write Safety from Storms in the Blessings box on your Adventure Sheet. The blessing works by

allowing you to ignore any *one* storm at sea. When you use the blessing, cross it off your Adventure Sheet.

You can have only one Safety from Storms blessing at a time. Once it is used up, you can return to any branch of the temple of Alvir and Valmir to buy a new one.

When you are finished here, turn to **380**.

623

To your surprise, your ship is missing! You search high and low, and eventually find a note scrawled by your bo’sun who is obviously only barely literate. It says that they waited for a few days and eventually went looking for you. When they found you they couldn’t shake you out of your meditative state, and before rations ran low they made way for the nearby port of Aku where they will await your return. Note that your ship is docked at Aku.

You walk over to another captain with the hope of buying passage. When you hear about the date you are given a sudden shock of realisation – it has been 7 weeks... turn to **181**.

624

You misjudge your timing and the ship slips off the guide of the ley line. Without the primordial magic of the line, your ship suddenly capsizes and tumbles into the blackness. You are doomed to fall into the void for eternity. That is unless you collide with something or have the wherewithal to end your life with your own blade. Either way turn to **700**.

625

You are sailing in the Cragdrift Sea on the same latitude as Kunrir and the Forest of Woes. Umbart's Vortex lies somewhere to the south of your current position. Where will you plot your next course?

Head north	turn to 202
Head west	turn to 704
Head east for Kunrir	<i>The Court of Hidden Faces</i> 400
Plot a course for Umbart's Vortex	turn to 303
Sail south around Umbart's Vortex	turn to 100

626

'I see you have journeyed far and wide, my faithful follower,' Heilmir bellows. With a wave of his hand you are cured of all ailments. Restore your Stamina to its normal, unwounded value and remove the effects of any poisons, diseases and curses you may be suffering from. Furthermore, he grants you a blessing of 'Safety from Storms' which you may use to ignore the effects of the next storm you may encounter at sea. Remember you can only have one blessing of the same type at a time. Turn to **275**.

627

You leap onto the carpet, but not before the city guard have been able to identify you. Gain the codeword *Incomplete*. You soon lose the horsemen as they become tiny specs in the distance. You chat with the boy and he confesses that he is on the run from the authorities for stealing from the treasury in Kurani. 'First time I acquired this fantastic carpet, but there were just so many interesting things there I had to go back. Look,' he says, opening a sack filled with coins, jewels and magical items. You ask him how a boy so young can become such a good thief and it turns out that there is a branch of the Brotherhood of the Night in Kurani. He tells you the secret code that will allow you to access their black market. Gain the

codeword *Indefinite*. Furthermore, the boy is on a high from the successful escape and he offers you something from his hoard at random. Roll a die and consult the list below:

- 1 **sextant (SCOUTING +3)** and a **mariner's ruttier**
- 2 **warhammer (COMBAT +4)**
- 3 **dorje pendant (SANCTITY +4)**
- 4 1,500 Shards
- 5 **cobalt wand (MAGIC +3)**
- 6 **hand of glory (THIEVERY +4)**

He sets you down somewhere off the path and you make your way on your journey again. Turn to **18**.

628

Roll four dice. If you roll equal to or lower than your Rank, you manage to flee to your ship in time. Turn to **425**. If you roll higher than your Rank, the revered dead takes advantage of your surprise and deftly cuts you in twain with his enchanted sword before returning to his place of rest. Turn to **700**.

629

The hand of the thief is used up in the creation process. Cross the **severed hand** and the cash off your Adventure Sheet. A few days later the artificer calls you back into his workshop and presents you with macabre looking necklace at the end of which hangs a pallid hand covered in arcane symbols. Add the **hand of glory (THIEVERY +4)** to your Adventure Sheet and turn to **280**.

630

If you have the codeword *Illustrate*, turn to **530** immediately. If not, read on. The group of criminals had stolen a prized possession of in palace of the prince of Mithdrak. Little did they know it had been enchanted by the High Sorcerer to lay a compulsion on the mind of any potential thief that prevented him from leaving Mithdrak. The thieves were eventually caught by the city guard. Return to **50**.

631

There are plenty of artificers looking for business, but you are warned that magic is never an exact science, and there is always the risk that things can go horribly wrong. Many a wizard has been maimed by an experiment that has backfired! If you have the codeword *Indubitably* and wish to visit the chief artificer of the Walking City, turn to **237**. Otherwise you could:

Have an item enchanted	turn to 372
Have an item recharged	turn to 515
Have an item crafted	turn to 129
Have a new body created	turn to 58
Return to the city centre	turn to 280

632

The fish leaps from your hands, transforming into a water sprite. It giggles as it waves its hands. ‘And here is your reward!’ it says before swimming away. You have been cursed – lose all your blessings. Shaking your head for your foolishness you head off. Gain the codeword *Increment* and turn to **395**.

633

You are clinging to the almost vertical rock face with the summit in sight. Make a SCOUTING roll at a Difficulty of 21. You may add 1 if you have **climbing gear**, and 2 if you are an initiate of the Sage of Peace. If you manage to succeed through skill of sheer faith, you reach the summit. Turn to **88**. If you fail, you lose your grip and plummet toward your doom. If you have a **rope**, turn to **374**. Otherwise, the last thing you see is the ground rushing up to meet you. Turn to **700**.

634

The captain is a merchant from Golnir. He is headed for Mithdrak but is willing to put you into port if it is nearby. Where will you request to be dropped off?

Aku	<i>The Court of Hidden Faces</i> 444
Pethumar	<i>The Lone and Level Sands</i> 20
Mithdrak	turn to 50

635

The pirates take your cargo, all your possessions and your cash. They also seize your ship for themselves. Cross all these off your Adventure Sheet and Ship’s Manifest. They are convinced it is worth leaving you alive, at least.

‘Yes, that way we can prey on you again in the future,’ says their leader with a feral grin. ‘Every good fisherman knows to throw some of his catch back!’

You are put off on an island in the Innis Shoals. As the pirates sail off, you vow revenge. Turn to **670**.

636

Wizards aboard the ship hail you from the deck with a friendly greeting. It turns out they are have come on a mission from Dweomer and heard you were near Mithdrak. ‘We read your latest work – a fantastical journey indeed! You and

Umbart should be proud of your achievement’ says the lead wizard, an grey bearded man from Golnir. ‘We brought you a gift from the council,’ he says, producing a strange book bound in red leather. ‘They believe it will help you with further exploration and documentation of the mystical wonders of the *Fabled Lands*.’

It is a vade mecum, a book of teleportation. Note the **vade mecum** (*The Court of Hidden Faces* **550**) on your Adventure Sheet. Whenever you want to consult the book, note down the paragraph you are at and turn to **550** in *The Court of Hidden Faces*.

After a glass of sherry in their cabin you bid them farewell and return to your ship. Turn to **325**.

637

The guards never fall for another of your ruses you are taken to a cell in the dungeon one level below... maximum security. You are whipped for your insolence every so often, and spend a miserable year in the tiny cell, poorly nourished by the daily gruel and worm-ridden bread. Roll two dice and lose that many Stamina *permanently* from malnutrition and lasting scars. If you have the codeword *Illuminate*, you manage to sustain yourself and may roll only one die (and lose that many Stamina permanently).

The time in solitary confinement does give you an opportunity to practice your skills. You can either spend your days strength training, in focussed meditation or improving your less-than-reputable talents. Choose COMBAT, SANCTITY, or THIEVERY and roll two dice. If you roll higher than the relevant ability score you may add 1 to it.

You are eventually let out, but the police say they will be keeping a careful eye on you. Lose the codewords *Bullion*, *Evade*, *Fracas* and *Incomplete* if you had any of them. If you had a ship docked at Mithdrak, it is long gone. Cross it off your manifest and gain the codeword *Ill*. You may turn to **483** and collect any items that had been confiscated from you before your imprisonment and then turn to **50**.

638

You discover that the priests here worship an aspect of the god Molhern, known here as the All Seeing. If you are an initiate of Molhern or have the title *Illuminate* of Mohern, a priest sees that you have travelled from distant lands to pursue the teachings of their deity and will give you a blessing for free. Otherwise it will cost 25 Shards.

Request a blessing	turn to 339
Become an initiate of the All Seeing	turn to 263
Renounce worship	turn to 614
Investigate the rest of the temple	turn to 29

639

You discover a Colonel Murvinder Singh has been promoted to general to take over his cousin's duties. He is extremely busy with the change in command and has far more important things to attend to. You are quickly dismissed. Turn to **708**.

640

It may take some time to recalculate your current position. Roll two dice:

Score 2 – 4	turn to 475
Score 5 – 6	turn to 625
Score 7	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 211
Score 8 – 9	turn to 275
Score 10 – 12	turn to 375

641

The celestial stag bows its head as you approach, and when your guard is down it gores you. The last thing you feel are the great silver horns shredding your intestines. Turn to **700**.

642 □

If the box about is empty, put a tick in it and read on. If it was already ticked, turn to **686** immediately. As you stroll along the coast in the moonlight, you spot a grey form washed up on the beach. You get a little closer and realise it is a man! He must have been shipwrecked off the coast. Obviously hearing the sound of your footsteps, the man raises his head weakly and reaches a hand toward you. 'Help... me...'

Make a MAGIC , SANCTITY or SCOUTING roll at a Difficulty of 18.	
Successful roll	turn to 323
Approach the man	turn to 126
Leave him be	turn to 79

643

Your ship tilts precariously as one of the underworld vessels crunches into its side, spewing forth all manner of misshapen forms that you can only surmise to be the crew. A lesser demon with the head of a ferocious black mongrel strides toward you. If you have the title Demoniak, turn to **409** immediately. Otherwise, You will

have to parley for your life and that of your crew. Some degree of holy power will assist you, as the creatures will shy away from godliness. Make both a CHARISMA and SANCTITY roll, both at a Difficulty of 20.

Both rolls successful	you are all set free...	turn to 368
One roll successful	your crew are abducted.	turn to 394
Both rolls failed	carried off to hell;	turn to 66 in <i>Into the Underworld</i>

644

As you walk down the path, you notice that your belt pouch seems inexplicably lighter... to your dismay it looks as if you have been robbed by a cunning cutpurse during your stroll. Cross off half your Shards, rounding up. Furthermore, you are missing one of your items that must have been lifted too. Roll a die. If you roll odds, it is the first item on your Adventure Sheet, and if you roll evens, it is the last item. Now turn to **39**

645

To find out how your investments have done, roll two dice. Add 1 to the dice roll if you are an initiate of the Three Fortunes. Also add 1 if you have the codeword *Intrinsic*, add 2 if you have the codeword *Jacynth*, and add 3 if you have the codeword *Eldritch*.

Score 2-3	Lose entire sum invested
Score 4-5	Loss of 50%
Score 6-7	Loss of 25%
Score 8-9	Loss of 10%
Score 10-11	Investment remains unchanged
Score 12-13	Profit of 25%
Score 14-15	Profit of 75%
Score 16-17	Profit of 150%
Score 18+	Profit of 200%

Now turn to **738**, where you can withdraw the sum written in the box there after adjusting it according to the result rolled.

646

As an initiate, a blessing from Kumba Karna will cost you 10 Mithrals here. This demon lord is known for his ferocity in battle and his skill as a general. If you purchase the blessing, write COMBAT in your blessings box. This allows you to reroll any one failed COMBAT roll, or any one attack roll during a fight. Once used it must be crossed off, and you need only return here for a new one. Remember that you may only have one COMBAT blessing at any one time. Turn back to **170** when ready.

647 □

If the box above is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading. If it is already ticked, turn to **750** immediately.

Prince Azim marvels at your story and asks for every intimate detail of your journey. ‘Fantastic! I do so wish I could have been there. It would have been the adventure to end all adventures! You have brought me some closure, and I will reward you.

If you already have a **Rana scimitar** on your Adventure Sheet or in a storage place somewhere, turn to **598** immediately. Otherwise, he pulls the sword from the sash around his waist and hands it to you. To receive a sword crafted specifically for a prince is an honour indeed!

You humbly receive the blade – it is as light as a feather! ‘Don’t let its weight fool you,’ Azim says, ‘when swung that blade could cleave the head off a horse without an ounce of effort. Furthermore, it has been enchanted by the royal mystic. When the blade is thrown into the ground, the pommel will always point unerringly north.’

Note the **Rana scimitar (COMBAT +6)** on your list of possessions. It has three charges, which can be used to reroll any failed SCOUTING roll of your choice (exactly like a blessing). Once the charges are used it is essentially a mundane scimitar with a +6 COMBAT bonus, though perhaps the enchantment could be replenished somehow?

Now turn to **750**.

648

Becoming an initiate of Alvir and Valmir gives you the benefit of paying less for blessings and other services the temple can offer. It costs 40 Shards to become an initiate. You cannot do this if you are already an initiate of another temple.

If you become an initiate, write Alvir and Valmir in the God box on your Adventure Sheet – and remember to cross off the 40 Shards. Once you have finished here, turn to **599**.

649

If the box above is already ticked, you are allowed to leave. Turn to **275**. If it is empty, leave it that way and continue reading.

The elder opens up a cabinet lined with the heads of their previous meals. Some have been pickled, and others have been shrunken. He is willing to trade you a **shrunken head** or a **severed hand** for any one of the following; **pirate captain’s head**, **dead head**, **demon’s head**, or **witch’s hand**. He is only willing to trade with you once, so any time that you make the trade, tick the box above. You are then escorted back to your ship. Turn to **275**.

650

You are sailing in the Sea of Stilts, somewhere between Mithdrak and Pethumar.

Head north for open waters turn to **190**

Head west into coastal waters turn to **560**

Head due south turn to **327**

Head east for Pethumar *The Lone and Level Sands* **400**

651

Well, you owed him your life but there is one debt you won’t need to pay off. Lose the codeword *Aklar*. As his head topples into the basket below you can’t help but feel that you have caused an imbalance in karma. Lose all your blessings and return to **50**.

652

The merchant is rather angry. ‘That will be 200 Shards for the inconvenience’ he demands.

Make a CHARISMA roll at Difficulty 16. If you succeed, he counts himself lucky for today and waives the fine. Turn to **675** immediately. If you fail, he insists that you pay or he will pursue the relevant authorities and have you charged. You can either cross off the 200 Shards and turn to **675**, or if you can’t or won’t pay you can simply send him back to his ship and sail away (turn to **156**).

653

The body looks like a Sokaran buccaneer. By the looks of the gold teeth and clothing he was likely an unfortunate captain, either mutinied or sunk at sea. The bosun suggests taking his head in the event that a reward could be collected. Note the **pirate captain’s head** on your Adventure Sheet if you wish to take it and turn to **350**.

654

You have been walking and hacking through the undergrowth for an hour now, and sit down momentarily to take a well earned rest. As you rummage through your pack to retrieve some trail rations, you pull back your hand in surprise. A giant centipede the size of your arm crawls out of your pack and you instinctively crush it under your heel (with surprising effort!). Unfortunately the bite of the centipede is poisonous and causes your hands to shake uncontrollably, reducing your COMBAT, MAGIC and THIEVERY scores by 2 until you can find a cure.

If you have a blessing of Immunity to Disease/poison, cross it off immediately and you can ignore the effects of this poison.

Turn to **227**

655

If you have more than one of the following codewords – *Bullion*, *Clanger*, *Evil*, *Fracas*, *Iota*, *Judas*, or *Kink*, the peak is completely empty and your only option is to descend. Turn to **524**. Otherwise, turn to **278**.

656

You stumble across an old shrine to a long forgotten god. It is carved into the mountainside and must be at least twice your height, suggesting that it may not have been crafted by human hands. The carving depicts an armoured warrior holding his sword aloft as he is carried by angels. It looks distinctly Atticalan in design. If you wish to leave 30 Shards at the shrine and stay there in prayer, turn to **701**. Otherwise all you can do is continue on your trek. Turn to **528**.

657

Your weapon passes right through one and it turns to you with a sorrow filled face. The spectre reaches out and grabs your arm and the whole world goes black. Turn to **376**.

658

Their ship pulls alongside yours and a gangplank drops onto your deck. ‘Apprehend this criminal,’ he commands as his men swarm aboard your ship. You realise that your weapons and armour are still in your cabin...

- | | |
|---------------------|--------------------|
| Talk your way out | turn to 49 |
| Fight them | turn to 399 |
| Surrender willingly | turn to 589 |

659

You are following the river Ajantur that runs between Vulture’s Peak and Mithdrak, the capitol of Chrysoprais. On the outskirts of the city you can see women using exotic dyes on cloths and rinsing them in the river in preparation for trade, and acres of silk crops ready for harvest. Roll two dice:

- | | | |
|--------|-----------------------|--------------------|
| 2 – 5 | A commotion | turn to 110 |
| 6 – 8 | An uneventful journey | turn to 448 |
| 9 – 12 | Religious pilgrims | turn to 405 |

660

Roll two dice:

- | | | |
|---------|----------------------------|--------------------|
| 2 – 4 | An approaching storm front | turn to 743 |
| 5 – 9 | An uneventful journey | turn to 425 |
| 10 – 12 | An uncharted island | turn to 564 |

661

The road between the temple of the Eye and Kurani is relatively quiet, only ever frequented by religious zealots and curious adventurers. Roll two dice:

- | | | |
|--------|-----------------------|--------------------|
| 2 – 5 | A magic carpet | turn to 42 |
| 6 – 8 | An uneventful journey | turn to 18 |
| 9 – 12 | Wandering monks | turn to 218 |

662

The temple to the Sage of Peace is surprisingly smaller than you had envisaged. ‘The king of Chrysoprais whose palace resides here was one of our greatest benefactors and he was a great follower of the path to enlightenment,’ says the abbot. ‘Unfortunately in his old age his eldest son has taken political power and our teachings fall on deaf ears.’ The temple is a haven for the poor and hungry, who are neglected by the wealthy citizens of Mithdrak.

- | | |
|----------------------------------|--------------------|
| Become an initiate | turn to 302 |
| Seek a blessing (initiates only) | turn to 422 |
| Return to the city centre | turn to 50 |

663

‘Welcome back!’ Umbart says joyfully. You describe your experience in vivid detail and he claps his hands with glee. ‘You have certainly performed beyond my expectations! I believe that this data will assist in my research, and you will be rewarded of course.’ Erase the codeword *Indicate* and turn to **145** to collect any gear you may have left with Umbart for safekeeping, then return here immediately and continue reading.

If you also have the codeword *Loam*, turn to **265** immediately. Otherwise, he waves a hand and a trau servant escorts you to arrange a reward. Turn to **7**.

664 □

If the box above is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading. If it was already ticked, turn to **395** immediately. You realise that not many people leave the outskirts of Auriculum, with nothing but the looming forest to the north. The road is almost completely empty, save for a few rough looking

travellers by the side of the river. Unfortunately you have stumbled upon half a dozen highwaymen plotting a robbery in Auriculum later tonight. They loom to you and draw their scimitars.

Make a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 18.
 Successful CHARISMA roll turn to **127**
 Failed CHARISMA roll turn to **687**

665

The guards believe you and the three women are taken under arrest. ‘What will become of them?’ you ask. ‘Depends on the judge’s mood I guess,’ replies the leader. ‘Either rot in the dungeon or, if they’re lucky, lose a hand on the chopping block. Don’t really care.’

Lucky? You wonder to yourself about the judicial system in this land as you continue your journey. Turn to **448**.

666

The rest of the night is a blur. Your mind is a mess as you struggle to find who you really anymore. You have gradually fallen from the path you once thought you would walk and your soul is now tainted beyond recognition. Gain the title Demoniac. As long as you retain this title, your SANCTITY score is permanently reduced to 1, and it may never be increased in any way, nor do you gain any benefit from SANCTITY blessings or items that grant a SANCTITY bonus. From this point on your dreams are haunted by demons coercing you to join them in the underworld, and your waking moments are filled with the whispers of devils. You lose any initiate status with the Sage of Peace, and the title Enlightened One if you had it (and may never obtain these again as long as you have the title Demoniac). As long as you have this title, you may never become a priest through any means. If you are a Priest, your profession now changes to Mage.

For all the restrictions imposed on your tortured soul, the calling of the underworld has its benefits. Increase your MAGIC score to 12. If your MAGIC score was already 12, it increases to 13 permanently. This is an exception to the rule stating that no Ability score may rise above 12. As long as you have the title Demoniac, your MAGIC score may not be reduced by any means.

If at any time you wish to follow the whispers of your nightmares and be drawn into the underworld, you may turn to **666** in *Into the Underworld*. Note this option on your character sheet.
 Turn to **50**.

667

The three men pull out clubs and the merchant shrugs off his ornate robes to reveal his armour. You will have to fight all four of them as one opponent.

Brigands COMBAT 18 Defence 18 Stamina 26

Unless you are a Rogue, before each combat round (including before combat starts), you must make a THIEVERY roll against their Defence score (essentially Difficulty of 18). If you fail, you must lose 1-6 Stamina as one of the highwaymen manages to flank you and strike you in the back of the head. If you are a Rogue you do not need to roll – you already know all the tricks of the trade!

You cannot flee as these expert brigands have already surrounded you. However, you notice that they are not trying to kill you. If you are reduced to 0 Stamina you are knocked unconscious and must turn to **328**. If you win, you can take their loot which amounts to 260 Shards and the suit of **ring mail (Defence +2)** that the leader was wearing. Turn to **291**.

668

That night you are escorted to an audience chamber lined with nobles, rich merchants, barons, counts, and all manner of wealthy individuals. In a booth at the top sits the king, with his eldest son alongside. You are the fourth act and will have to ensure your tales of adventure are good enough to earn favour in the royal family. Throughout the night you see the king’s eyes light up when he hears tales of court intrigue, the slaying of monsters and rescuing of damsels, whilst his son retains an expression of mild disinterest.

Deduct 10 from your Rank and then add this number to your CHARISMA for this roll. The difficulty is 26.

Successful CHARISMA roll turn to **253**
 Failed CHARISMA roll turn to **59**

669

If you have just been resurrected, transfer all the items listed below to your Adventure sheet and then turn to **170**.

If you have a resurrection arrangement, you can deposit up to 12 items here and any amount of money. Iibyyrsh reminds you that she is not a bank, so once you leave an item with her she will not return it until you are resurrected. Transfer the items you wish to deposit into the box below:

Possessions deposited for resurrection

When you are ready, turn back to **170**.

670

This particular island appears a little more accessible than the others. There are a small number of people here, mostly religious zealots looking for divine inspiration away from the rest of civilization. If you wish to find a place to engage in serene contemplation, turn to **706**. Otherwise, there is little else to do here. Turn to **181**.

671 □

If the box above is ticked, turn to **370** immediately. Otherwise, put a tick in it and continue reading. You clamber aboard and the child laughs as he makes it speed through the air. The wind is so great that you have to hold on to the edge of the rug to avoid falling off! After a few minutes the boy turns to you. 'Dare me to fly to Auriculum?' he says rhetorically, pointing across the straits of Chrysoprais. 'I'll bet 250 Shards that I could make it...'

If you have the codeword *Indubitably*, turn to **497** immediately. Otherwise, you could jump off now (turn to **18**), or dare him to fly you both there (turn to **153**).

672

Gain the codeword *Impede*. Furthermore, increase your COMBAT score by 1. Now if you were injured in the fight, you soon discover that her blades were coated in what was likely her own poison. If you have a blessing of Immunity to Disease/Poison, cross it off and continue reading. If you did not have that blessing, turn to **541** immediately.

On the body you find two **scimitars (COMBAT +4)**. You could also take the **demon's head** as a gory trophy. Mark it on your Adventure Sheet if you wish. Surprisingly, you find no Shards in the temple, just some strange onyx coins. Add 500 Mithrals to your cash. You also find a cache of random items. Roll a single die three times to see what you find:

- 1 **silver flute (CHARISMA +2)**
- 2 **lockpicks (THIEVERY +1)**
- 3 **splint armour (Defence +4)**
- 4 **amber wand (MAGIC +1)**
- 5 **compass (SCOUTING +1)**
- 6 **ring of protection (Defence +5)**

When you are finished, you notice that the followers have fled the scene. Turn to **266**.

673

Cross off the money and then lose the codewords *Bullion*, *Evade*, *Fracas* and *Incomplete* if you had any of them. Now you are a free man. Turn to **600**.

674

You greet your old friends and Lakha spends time with you drinking tasteless tea and regaling stories of the ancient world. If you wish you may also spend time hunting with them. If so, roll two dice and if you roll higher than your SCOUTING score, add one to it. If you roll equal to or lower, you are made to under go some kind of ancient initiation rite in Rakshasa society and your body is horribly scarred. Lose 2 from your unwounded Stamina score *permanently*. When you are ready to leave you may either head deeper into the forest (turn to **227**) or leave. Turn to **615**.

675

You are sailing along the Straits of Chrysoprais. The merchants who frequent this course, give you friendly waves.

Exit the Straits to the North turn to **382**

Exit the Straits to the South turn to **411**

676 □

You return to see the young priest in high spirits. 'I have finally learnt the secret of resurrection,' he says triumphantly. You just hope that he has mastered it by the time it comes to bringing *you* back...

As a reward for your service, he offers you a resurrection arrangement for free. Whenever you wish to accept the reward simply tick the box above and write 'Temple of Nagil – Auriculum, *The Isle of a Thousand Spires* **333**' in your resurrection arrangement box. If you die you will be brought back here. If it was already ticked, the priest charges you the paltry sum of only 150 Shards per resurrection arrangement regardless of initiate status.

As a further reward, he offers you a safety deposit box here for you to store up to three items and any amount of cash for when you return to the world. Whenever you make a resurrection arrangement here, transfer the items you wish to store in the box below. He warns you that this is not a privilege to be abused, and once deposited you cannot recollect them until you are resurrected here.

Safety deposit box – temple of Nagil (up to 3 items)

When you are finished, turn to **380**.

677

Hands burst out of the ground and grab your ankles. The world around you spins as a gaping maw erupts from the forest floor, threatening to swallow you into the underworld. If you have the title Demoniatic, the pull is irresistible and you give in to temptation. Turn to **666** in *Into the Underworld*. Otherwise, you sink into a state of gibbering madness and your sanity is all but gone. Turn to **22**.

678

You misplace your foot and the rock beneath crumbles. You drop a fair distance, protecting your head and neck as you are battered from every side. Roll five dice and lose that many Stamina points. If you are still alive, turn to **296**.

679

Whilst you are sailing through these waters again you simply cannot sleep. You sit in your bed, staring out the porthole. Despite the lantern's warmth you are still shivering. Turn to **150**.

680

The sky is the colour of burning sulphur. From behind the clouds conies the growl of thunder. The sailors mutter in fear. 'It is the wrath of Elnir,' says the mate. 'He summons us to our doom!'

The jagged reefs of the Innis Shoals loom closer and closer. Roll one die if your ship is a barque, two dice if it is a brigantine, or three dice if a galleon. Add 1 to the roll if you have an excellent crew; subtract 1 if you have a poor crew.

Score 0 – 3	You are thrown overboard	turn to 447
Score 4 – 5	The ship hits a reef	turn to 580
Score 6 – 8	The mast splits	turn to 213
Score 9 – 19	You weather the storm	turn to 539

681

You batter one of the fiends overboard and it howls in frustration – Vampires cannot swim! You brave crew know that whilst they are no match for the creatures in combat, they may have a chance if they follow your tactic. They team up and work hard under your instruction, and when the vampires have realised their folly they attempt to retreat but you give them no quarter. You cut them down one by one, and the captain desperately turns his ship about, his once leering face twisted in abject terror. 'Mo mercy!' you yell as the crew batter the remaining few into a bloody pulp. They throw up their bloodless hands and cower as they beg to be spared. You line them up and behead them to ensure they never return to the world of the living. They vanish like smoke on the wind, the echoes of their final cries still ringing in your ears. All that remains are a few piles of musty old grey robes, some ornate jewellery worth 700 Shards (note the money directly in your petty cash), and a **scarab amulet** which may add to your list of possessions if you wish.

You have displayed valiant leadership and mettle in the face of adversity. Your renown will spread with word of your victory. Gain the codeword *Intimidate*. Also, you may add 1 to your choice of either CHARISMA or COMBAT. If you are a Warrior, roll four dice. If the total rolled is higher than your Rank, gain 1 Rank. If you are not a Warrior, your reputation as a skilled and fearless commander will precede you. You may change your profession to Warrior if you desire.

Turn to **650**.

682

You are following the river that runs from the forest of Apsaras to the trading port of Auriculum. On the outskirts of the city you can see women using exotic dyes on cloths and rinsing them in the river in preparation for trade, and acres of silk crops ready for harvest. Roll two dice:

2 – 5	Highwaymen	turn to 664
6 – 8	An uneventful stroll	turn to 395
9 – 12	Catch a fish	turn to 45

683

They hammer of anvils in the back is almost deafening here. The armoury is extensive, however surprisingly the clerk here mentions that none of the items on the racks are for sale. 'The general is preparing for a large campaign and needs all the equipment he can get.' If you are willing to sell any second-hand arms or armour you are assured of a good price here.

<i>Armour</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Leather (Defence +1)	45 Shards
Ring mail (Defence +2)	95 Shards
Chain mail (Defence +3)	190 Shards
Splint armour (Defence +4)	380 Shards
Plate armour (Defence +5)	760 Shards
Heavy Plate (Defence +6)	1520 Shards

<i>Weapons</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
No COMBAT bonus	45 Shards
COMBAT bonus +1	225 Shards
COMBAT bonus +2	450 Shards

When you are finished here, return to **708**.

684

Umbart is a very busy man and will only make the time to help you if you have made the time to help him. If you have the codeword *Indicate*, he will answer any one of your questions for free, and then you will be hastily ushered out by his trau servants. Otherwise, you will have to make a CHARISMA check at a Difficulty of 20, adding 2 if you are a Mage and 1 if you are an initiate of Molhern. If you succeed, he will answer one of your questions for an exorbitant fee of 400 Shards. If you fail, Umbart simply has no time for you and you are made to leave the vortex:

Codeword <i>Indicate</i> or successful CHARISMA roll	turn to 76
Failed CHARISMA roll	turn to 52
Failed CHARISMA roll but you do not have a ship	turn to 616

685

If you are suffering from the Curse of Covetousness, he smirks and hands you pouch of money. Turn to **386**. Otherwise, continue reading.

Rao Shivpuri strokes his chin. ‘Yes, I will do as you request,’ he says with determination. The deal is sealed with a handshake. You wait for weeks, given a room in the wealthy district care of the weapon smith. Restore your stamina to full. Eventually a messenger arrives at your door to escort you back to the armoury. Shivpuri greets you and gestures to the table where a long object is wrapped in a purple silk cloth. He unfurls the sword and lays it on a satin cushion – it is indeed a beautiful sight, the curved blade so highly polished that it displays your undistorted reflection. ‘This is a **Rana scimitar**,’ he explains, ‘a blade of which I have only made six. One is wielded by Prince Azimishtra Deoraj himself, and others have

been used as gifts in trade negotiations between Chrysoprais and the other great nations of the *Fabled Lands*.’

You pick up the blade – it is as light as a feather! ‘Don’t let its weight fool you,’ Shivpuri says, ‘when swung that blade could cleave the head off a horse without an ounce of effort. Furthermore, it has been enchanted by the royal mystic. When the blade is thrown into the ground, the pommel will always point unerringly north.’

Note the **Rana scimitar (COMBAT +6)** on your list of possessions. It has three charges, which can be used to reroll any failed SCOUTING roll of your choice (exactly like a blessing). Once the charges are used it is essentially a mundane scimitar with a +6 COMBAT bonus, though perhaps the enchantment could be replenished somehow?

Return to **400**.

686

You help a shipwrecked merchant to his feet and spend some time with him talking of his misadventures. It turns out his ship was hijacked – a very common problem for ships in this area. You sit around a fire and discuss politics, trade routes and stocks, among other things. You learn a little trade secret to ensure you will get the best deal in Krateros, a city in far north Atticala. Gain the codeword *Intuit* if you didn’t already have it. You soon part ways.

Turn to **79**

687

You will have to fight them. Treat all six as one opponent.

Highwaymen COMBAT 13 Defence 16 Stamina 29

If you wish to flee, you will take 2-12 damage from a parting blow, and you can turn to **395**. If you defeat them, you may take their loot, which amounts to 350 Shards. If you have the codeword *Impeccable*, they have an additional few pouches of jewellery and gold, amounting to another 900 Shards. Lose the codeword *Impeccable*. You kick the bodies into the stream to float downriver. Anyone else in Auriculum considering pilfering as a profession is likely to be dissuaded... Turn to **395**.

688 □

If the box above is ticked, the wizard declines to even see you, and all other potential teachers have been warned about your disastrous record. Turn back to **280**. If it is empty, leave it that way and read on.

You can pay for magical training with an old wizard who has since retired. He needs some money for spell components which you are likely to waste, and his time (which you are also likely to waste). The more money you spend, the more likely you will benefit from the exercise. Choose how much you wish to spend in increments of 400 Shards. For every 400 Shards you cross off, you may roll one die. Add the total of the roll together and if it is higher than your MAGIC score, add 1 to it. You may not raise your MAGIC score higher than 12.

If you roll equal to or lower than your MAGIC score, you attempt an experiment far beyond your skill and cause a large explosion that destroys part of the wizard's laboratory. Tick the box above. The wizard is unlikely to take you as a student again!

When you have rolled the dice and made the necessary adjustments (or if you did not wish to undergo the training), turn back to **280**.

689

You are approached by the same man who passed you the invitation. 'It is good to have one of our southern brethren here this evening' he says as he introduces you to the other attendees. 'We have all heard much about the work of Badogor in the lands of Ankon Konu. We were like you once - a little uncivilised, but we all have the same tastes, don't we? Speaking of tastes, I hear that tonight will be especially scrumptious!' You have the trust of the attendees and it would be easy to make an excuse and slip out of the manor. If you wish to do so, turn to **50**. Otherwise, turn to **17**.

690

The tentacles withdraw and your ship bobs up, throwing your men about like toys. You call out for them to throw you a rope when you are suddenly whipped below the surface. A thick tentacle has grabbed you and pulls you contemptuously to the murky depths. By its size and colouration you can only surmise that you are in the deadly grip of a deep sea kraken. If you are an initiate of Heilmir, turn to **310** immediately. Otherwise, you hack at the limb, trying to hold your breath. You will have to injure it enough to either sever the tentacle or force it to let you go.

Black Tentacle COMBAT 0 Defence 10 Stamina 90

You must reduce the tentacle to zero Stamina, only then will it let you go. It doesn't roll to damage you, however you will soon run out of air. You have a number of rounds equal to your SCOUTING score (unmodified by items) before you drown. Keep track of your rounds each time you roll to damage it, and once your round tally equals your unmodified SCOUTING score you lose consciousness. Turn to **700**. If you reduce the tentacle to zero Stamina before your round tally equals your SCOUTING score, turn to **366**.

691

If you had the codeword *Insolent*, lose it. Now turn to **275**.

692

You recall the time when you meditated in the Innis Shoals for weeks on end without nourishment. You can attempt to use regular meditation to sustain you and ignore the effects of the Curse of Unquenchable Thirst. Make a SANCTITY roll at a Difficulty of 20. If you succeed, you find a way to nourish your body and counteract the effects of the curse. Cross it off and continue on your voyage (turn to **475**). If you fail, turn to **475** and lose one Stamina point...

693

The police are used to chasing villains and their ship is built to be powerful over short distances. As soon as you attempt to flee the captain steers along your course in pursuit. Roll three dice and add your Rank. Add 1 if you have an average crew, add 2 if you have a good crew and 3 if you have an excellent crew. Subtract 2 for each cargo unit you are carrying.

19 or less	they catch up to you	turn to 331
20 +	flee into other waters	turn to 428

694

You reach in and grab what you can. A **mermaid's comb** and a **bag of pearls**. As soon as you move to leave, she opens her eyes with a start. The group dive back into the water and as she realises she has been robbed the mermaid looks back at you and curses something in their alien language. If you had blessing of Safety from Storms, lose it. If you didn't, lose another blessing of your choice instead. Add whatever you wish to take to your Adventure Sheet and continue on your journey. Turn to **197**.

695

If you had any crew with you, you watch them go mad with thirst, some even trying seawater out of desperation. Over the next few days all of them perish before your eyes. You make camp and await the inevitable. Lose 2 – 12 Stamina from exposure, unless you have a **tent**. If you still live, continue reading.

Just when you are about to abandon hope, out of nowhere an old man appears in the blink of an eye. He wears priestly robes and carries an old magical tome. He pulls out a straw mat and prepares to meditate, completely oblivious to your presence. Still unsure whether you are hallucinating or not, you make a move toward the priest and he jumps up with a start. 'By Tyrnai's

teeth!’ he exclaims, ‘No one ever comes here! Why do you disturb my solitude?’ You attempt to explain your situation but the old man seems to think you are invading his island of serene contemplation on purpose. He opens his book and grabs your wrist and with an audible pop you are suddenly in another place altogether. He looks at you sternly. ‘Hrmph... and don’t come back!’ he grunts as he disappears as quickly as he came.

Turn to **50**.

696

You explain how you heard tell of the Rakshasa lord buried in the forest of Apsaras and journeyed there to pay homage to him. You praise their race for their nobility and humble yourself as a mere slave to the ancient Rakshasa empire of Chrysoprais. You manage to convince them that the spirit of the lord entrusted you with a quest to return this pendant to the this forest, though you were not privy to the meaning of it.

They stare at you coldly, the tiny slits of their cat eyes piercing your soul. Turn to **21**.

697

You can only hope that there are no ghosts residing in these burial plots, or perhaps that they are busy with another adventurer in the forest! Roll two dice, adding 1 if you are a Priest and 2 if you are an initiate of the Three Fortunes.

2 – 8	The ghosts rise from their slumber	turn to 117
9 +	You luck out... this time	turn to 458

698

You explain the situation and show him the suspicious invitation. ‘We have been after this sect for a while. If this invitation is what I think it is then it must be our lucky day... yours too.’ He explains that the sect is notorious for cannibalism, and recently more and more people are going missing. ‘We have had our eye on Lord Sehastramal for a while, but he has strong political sway in Mithdrak and has been able to weasel out of our investigations. If we could catch them all in the act there would be absolutely no doubt, and we could have them tried and executed.’ He says that if you are willing to attend the party he could have an armed guard surround the building, to ambush on your command. If you choose to accept the mission, record the codeword *Interpol*. Turn to **50**.

699

‘I want nothing of myself,’ you say plainly. ‘To want of the self defeats the Sage’s teaching that desires beget loss.’

The Sage smiles and disappears. Gain 1 Rank and the title Enlightened One if you did not already have it.

You descend the peak. Turn to **524**.

700

You are dead. Cross off all the items and money you were carrying, and your ship if you were travelling by sea. If you have a resurrection deal, turn to the paragraph in the relevant book. If not, this really is the end of your adventuring career. Begin a new character and start at paragraph **1** in any Fabled Lands book.

701

Cross off the 30 Shards and make a SANCTITY roll at a difficulty of 15. If you succeed, mark CHARISMA in your blessings box. This allows you to reroll the result of any one failed CHARISMA roll. Remember that you can only have one CHARISMA blessing at any one time, and once it is used you need only return here to pray for a new one. Turn to **528**

702

The adventurer is someone named Seronus Fifthblade, charged for a string of crimes for which the penalty is beheading. If you have the codeword *Aklar*, turn to **489** immediately. If not, you watch the poor adventurer as his head topples into a basket and make a pact that you will never find yourself in a similar situation... turn to **50**.

703

Your ship crunches into the side of the old one and your crew leap onto the deck wielding knives and belaying pins. ‘I have come to reclaim what it mine!’ you yell to the pirate captain, drawing your weapon. If you succeed at a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 17, you manage to stir your old crew into action to assist you. Gain the codeword *Impeccable*.

Roll three dice (four if you are a Warrior) and add your Rank. You may add 1 if you have a good crew and 2 if you have an excellent crew. Add a further 2 if you have the codeword *Impeccable*, and then lose that codeword.

19 or less	You are killed in battle	turn to 700
20 – 24	Forced to flee	turn to 183
25 +	Reclaim the ship	turn to 568

704

Waters this close to the vortex are known for their frequent and ferocious storms. Roll two dice:

2 – 6	A storm on the horizon	turn to 305
7	An uneventful journey	turn to 475
8 – 11	Ships from the underworld	turn to 211
12	Carapace. Note this paragraph number	turn to 74

705

You manage to find your way to the upper levels and an exit. If you succeed at an additional THIEVERY roll (Difficulty 19) you find a storeroom where your gear is being kept along the way. Note this paragraph number and turn to **483**, recording any items you wish to collect. If you fail you will just have to leave without the gear. Erase it from the box. Now if there is a tick in the box above, turn to **50** immediately. Otherwise, put a tick in it and read on.

Your daring escape will go down in history in the streets of Mithdrak! Gain 1 point in THIEVERY. If you are a Rogue, roll four dice. If the total rolled is higher than your Rank, gain 1 Rank. Now turn to **50** with your well earned freedom.

706

If you are a Priest or an initiate of the Sage of Peace, turn to **30**. Otherwise, you find the whole practice of self deprivation on this desolate island a waste of time. You manage to spend a brief day or two in contemplation before wondering why you even had the crazy idea in the first place. Turn to **181**.

707

Whilst sailing in the peaceful waters south of Chrysoprais, trouble is the last thing you had expected. If you have a **catastrophe certificate**, cross it off and turn to **250**. You awaken in the middle of the night to the cries of your crew – the sails are ablaze! You have no idea how this happened, but you will have to attend to it quickly or it could set the rest of the ship on fire. You could use sorcery to summon a wave, or extinguish the flames through more conventional means.

Make a SCOUTING roll at Difficulty 17 or a MAGIC roll at Difficulty 19.		
Successful SCOUTING or MAGIC roll		turn to 527
Failed SCOUTING or MAGIC roll		turn to 161

708

The Crimson Fort is truly a sight to behold. Armed soldiers practice swordplay in the courtyard to the constant beat of many blacksmiths' anvils. It is astounding to

think that the king is comfortable for an independent baron to have amassed so much power. If you have the codeword *Jump* or *Ilk*, turn to **384**. Otherwise, what will you do here?

Visit the Armoury	turn to 683
Visit the temple of Tynnai	turn to 474
Visit your chambers (if Crimson Knight)	turn to 401
Seek an audience with the General	turn to 571

When you wish to leave the fort, lose the codeword *Impeccable* if you had it and turn to **244**.

709 □

If the box above is not ticked, tick it now and read on. If it was already ticked, return to **34** and roll two dice following the listed options.

Make a THIEVERY roll at a Difficulty of 18.	
Successful THIEVERY roll	turn to 572
Failed THIEVERY roll	turn to 283

710

Despite your efforts you simply cannot gain control of the ship and the crew all drop to their knees and pray for deliverance. In their final hour they can only make their peace and hope their souls will find their way safely to the afterlife. If you have a **catastrophe certificate**, cross it off and turn to **53**. If not, you hold your breath as your ship teeters on the edge and then tumbles into the blackness. You are doomed to fall into the void for eternity. That is unless you collide with something or have the wherewithal to end your life with your own blade. Either way turn to **700**.

711 □

If the box above is ticked, Umbart has already told you all he knows of Iambus. Return to **76** and choose again. Otherwise, put a tick in it and read on.

‘Ah I have not heard of that name for a long, long time... and I know for sure it is not marked on any of my maps! No one returns from there, unless they return as the undead! You see the isle is safely hidden from mortals, in a realm of eternal darkness, for the vampire kind cannot abide sunlight.’

Your eyes widen. ‘An island populated completely by vampires?’

Umbart nods, and you can see the fascination in his eyes. ‘The port itself is called Iambus, and they are known to set out from there in archaic quinqueremes in search of mortal blood. Only they know how to find Iambus, and the few brave adventurers who have attempted have never returned. If you

were to somehow journey there and tell me what it is like, it would surely make my new research paper a best seller! I could be famous!’

‘We could be famous,’ you correct him.

‘Yes, indeed,’ Umbart nods. ‘Well, if you do intend to travel there you will need to know where it is and how to dock at their port. I’m sure they have some manner of protection to prevent mortals from finding their home. I happen to have a theory that you can test – vampires can smell the scent of mortal blood, so you are likely to be killed on sight. However if you use a **spectral veil** you may be able to mask it from them. It is only a theory however... so don’t blame me if you get yourself killed!’ Note the codeword *Iambus* if you didn’t already have it and put a tick in the first box beside it. If you already had the codeword, put a tick in the next available box.

The trau quickly usher you back to your ship and tell you to leave the vortex. Turn to **52**. If you do not have a ship docked here, turn to **616**.

712

You slit the child’s throat and watch him wrestle helplessly as he dies a slow and painful death. Gain the codeword *Iota*. If you now have at least three of the following codewords – *Clanger*, *Evil*, *Fracas*, *Iota*, *Judas*, and *Kink*, turn to **666**. Otherwise turn to **299**.

713

‘These heavy burdens have laid on your shoulders for a long time,’ he says as he holds out his hand. You place your hand in his. Gain the codeword *Ink* and lose all of the following codewords – *Bullion*, *Clanger*, *Evil*, *Fracas*, *Iota*, *Judas*, and *Kink*. He then disappears in the blink of an eye. The faint smell of sandalwood lingers on your fingertips. You descend the peak. Turn to **524**.

714

You open your hand to find a single shiny Shard. You shake your head in dismay. Add 1 Shard to your money if you can be bothered, and turn to **79**.

715

Inside the ruins it is surprisingly untouched. No animals have made their homes here, and it looks as if tomb robbers have never even set foot within its walls. As you progress, the hallway opens out into a series of chambers. Each wall is lined with alcoves containing skeletons of the revered dead. Some are still dressed in their armour or ceremonial burial robes, with their skulls propped up on pillows and arms crossed over their chests. Others are so old that all that remains are piles

of dust. There is only a slight musty smell here, and none of the eerie sensations that you had expected. Rather, a sense of peace.

As you explore the chambers you eventually come across what you assume must be the historical records and sacred texts of this ancient society. Books, scroll cases and sheaves of parchment line the shelves within this large antechamber. If you have the codeword *Impromptu*, turn to **620** immediately. If you have the title Distinguished Researcher, turn to **147**. Otherwise, you look through books at random and they are written in such an ancient dialect that you simply cannot understand them. Furthermore, as you turn the pages they start to disintegrate in your hands. There is nothing else of interest here. You could:

Loot the bodies	turn to 387
Leave the ruins	turn to 198

716

The hungry ghosts cannot abide your innate holiness and they shriek in frustration. Eventually they whirl off into the distance and leave you alone in the dark. Turn to **4**.

717 □

If the box above is already ticked, you have a good conversation with Ulgraghsk who updates you on the situation in the Land of Roots. You eventually bid him farewell and turn to **475**. If the box is empty, put a tick in it and continue reading.

‘Our mistress wishes to reward you for your continued service and hopes that this relic will assist you in her... I mean, your missions.’ The dog-headed demon pulls out an object wrapped in roughly stitched hide that you can only surmise to be human skin. He hands you a wand that appears to be forged from the long and wickedly sharp finger bone of an ancient dragon. Add the **draconium wand (MAGIC +8)** to your list of possessions. As long as you are an initiate of Kæla Karna, you cannot lose this item. Even when you are resurrected, she will ensure that you are brought back still clutching the wand in a death grip.

‘Our mistress will continue to watch over you,’ Ulgraghsk says with fervour, ‘as long as you continue to serve her...’

Turn to **475**.

718

You find the manor without difficulty. There are dozens of attendees and they all make you feel very underdressed. Your **party invitation** is taken at the

door (cross it off your possessions), as are any weapons and armour you may be carrying. Note that they are stored at the door of the manor and may be collected when you leave. You are directed to a room for pre-drinks. The other guests are surprisingly talkative and deal with topics from politics to trade routes. If you have the title Unspeakable Cultist, turn to **689**. Otherwise, turn to **17**.

719

You will have to be very careful when dealing in this area in case the vengeful merchant actually follows through on his promise to arrest you.

Make a **THIEVERY** roll at a Difficulty of 20. If you have the codeword *Face*, you automatically succeed. If you succeed, turn back to **260** and choose from the options presented. If you fail, turn to **293**.

720

The harbour of carapace is a series of pontoons extending out the rear flank of the enormous turtle's shell. There are very few ships docked here, and most of the denizens of carapace find it so idyllic that they stay forever. Much of the floating island is self sufficient and the people here even manage to read livestock, but there are certain things that simply must be imported.

You can buy goods from the warehouses only if you own a ship which is docked at Carapace. You can buy as much cargo as your ship has room for. You can also sell cargo here. All prices are for 1 Cargo Unit.

	<i>To Buy</i>	<i>To Sell</i>
Furs	140 Shards	110 Shards
Grain	-	275 Shards
Metals	-	800 Shards
Minerals	-	550 Shards
Spices	680 Shards	550 Shards
Textiles	250 Shards	225 Shards
Timber	300 Shards	240 Shards

Now, if you have any cargo units of Slaves, turn to **217** immediately. Otherwise, when you are ready to leave the harbour you can either head in to the city centre (turn to **444**), or leave by ship. If you have your own ship and wish to set sail, turn to **60**. Otherwise, you could pay for passage but your options are quite limited. If you do not have enough money for a fare and you have no items that can be sold in the marketplace, you are forced to beg for a ride. A kind sailor will take you to Mithdrak for however many shards you have on you.

Port Skios	20 Shards	<i>Legions of the Labyrinth</i> 439
Aku	25 Shards	<i>The Court of Hidden Faces</i> 502
Pethumar	50 Shards	<i>The Lone and Level Sands</i> 75
Mithdrak	50 Shards	turn to 8

721

The monks ask for only a small donation to assist in the upkeep of the temple and feeding the hungry. They will heal you of 1 – 6 Stamina (the roll of one die) for 3 Shards or allow you an extended stay to heal 2 – 12 Stamina (roll two dice) for 5 Shards.

When you are finished, cross off the money and turn to **380**.

722

The storm keeps up for days. Your only recourse is to strike the sails and let the ship run before the wind until it blows itself out. Roll one die if your ship is a barque, two dice if it's a brigantine, three if it's a galleon. Add 1 to the roll if you have a good crew; add 2 if you have an excellent crew.

1 – 4	The ship is capsized	turn to 447
5 – 20	You weather the storm	turn to 765

723

There is one temple in Kurani dedicated to the Sage of Peace, whose example guides men towards enlightenment. Here the clerics can live a life of monastic contemplation, far from the materialistic needs of the wealthy that have come to dominate the lives of many people in Chrysoprais. Lay worshippers can also come to a temple for healing, blessings and advice.

Ask for healing	turn to 152
Seek a blessing (initiates only)	turn to 518
Become an initiate	turn to 747
Leave the temple	turn to 600

724

A storm sweeps with relentless speed across the sky, blotting out the sun. If you have a blessing of Safety from Storms, cross it off and turn to **650**. Otherwise turn to **767**.

725

It may take a moment to get your bearings again. Roll one die.

Score 1	turn to 411
Score 2 – 3	turn to 575
Score 4 – 5	turn to 650
Score 6	turn to 190

726

You manage to avoid the regular guard patrols and find yourself standing in a large treasure chamber with all manner of valuables. The longer you stay here, the more likely you will be caught by a guard patrol. Decide how many items you will take from the list below and mark them on your Adventure Sheet.

casket of gems
centaur flute (CHARISMA +3)
dancing scimitar
long spear (COMBAT +3)
ebony wand (MAGIC +2)
ring of protection (Defence +5)
chest of Shards
nirvana talisman (SANCTITY +3)
sextant (SCOUTING +2)
pouch of onyx coins
magic lockpicks (THIEVERY +2)

When you have made the necessary amendments, turn to **194**.

727

Your entry must have been perfect because you see no guard patrols at all. In fact, it makes you uneasy that everything is going so smoothly. The door opens with a slight clunk, and the room inside is illuminated by the light from the corridor. Coins, gems and shining jewellery greet you. The group of you begin to fill up sacks of loot, taking turns to watch the corridor. About half-way through your collection, one of the ancient-looking antique statues raises its hands and crunches one rogue's head between its huge palms.

Roll one die.

1	The victim was you... turn to 700
2 – 6	You are safe. Continue reading.

The golem lets out a bellow that will no doubt alert any nearby guards.

Your share of the loot amounts to 2,000 Shards – mark this on your Adventure Sheet now and turn to **741**.

728

You are buffeted by the waves from a beast swimming toward you and you hold your breath as you are pulled under by some kind of deep sea current. Strangely you feel sand beneath your feet... land! You are tossed upon the beach, hundreds of miles from where you sank! You can't explain it, but simply thank the twin gods for your good fortune. Turn to **380**.

729

Your relentless questions have aroused suspicion during the course of your search, and before you know it you have been accosted by a group of hooded rogues in a back alley. They all pull out wooden clubs and move to surround you. You must fight them as one opponent.

Brotherhood COMBAT 20 Defence 20 Stamina 35

Unless you are a Rogue, before each combat round (including before combat starts), you must make a THIEVERY roll against their Defence score (essentially Difficulty of 20). If you fail, you must lose 1-6 Stamina as one of the rogues manages to flank you and strike you in the back of the head. If you are a Rogue by profession you do not need to roll – you already know all the tricks of the trade!

You cannot flee as these expert cutthroats have already surrounded you. If you win, you search the bodies but find nothing of value. Turn to **600**. If you are reduced to 0 Stamina you are knocked unconscious and later wake up in the gutter, stripped of all your possessions and money. Cross them off your Adventure Sheet and turn to **600**.

730 □

If the box above is ticked, turn to **745** immediately. If it is empty, leave it that way and continue reading.

The prince sends a servant to fetch you and you are brought to his audience chamber to see a bored looking bearded man with a gold turban. He sits up with a start. 'I thought it was you when they mentioned your name!'

It turns out that this is the very Prince Azim who handed you a sack of money in Old Harkuna! He welcomes you in and talks with you at length about his old adventuring days.

'Ah, I do so wish I could go back to those times,' he says whimsically as you share a bottle of fine wine. 'Now I am cloistered in this mansion, supposed to be running a city in which I have no interest. Such is the curse of royal blood.'

If you are 14th Rank or less, he lets you keep the money he asked you to hold for safekeeping, insisting that you will need it if you are to continue

your adventures. Tick the box above and turn to **745** now. If you are 15th Rank or higher he requests that you return the 2,000 Shards. At any time you can cash out the money and return here to pay him and put a tick in the box. Now, turn to **600**.

731

You learn that the Rakshasa race were tiger-headed giants who once lived peacefully alongside humans in Chrysoprais. Naturally larger and more powerful, they eventually decided that it was their birthright to rule the isle and subjugated the human race. After a decade of misery, man overthrew their oppressors with greater numbers and in their kindness allowed the Rakshasas to live in exile in the forest to the north. 'That is how the forest received its name.' says the noble proudly.

Turn to **356**.

732

The faint starlight up ahead guides you toward the underworld exit. The tunnel opens out to a void of eternal starlit darkness. The waterfall at the Edge of the World parts around an aeons old structure built to facilitate travel to the underworld. You see an enormous needle of rock projecting from the edge of the world and you marvel at the gothic city that has been built around it, defying the laws of gravity, with buildings overflowing in all directions.

If you arrived here by ship, turn to **391**. Otherwise, continue reading. You can see a harbour at the base of the pinnacle of rock where dozens of Iambic pentameters are docked. It is bizarre that the water fall off the Edge of the World above plummets into the void below and yet the ships remains suspended there as if defying the laws of nature. In fact, from your current point of view, their crew should be falling off the deck to their doom, but instead are able to walk about it freely. As you walk along the wide path that leads you out of the tunnel and onto the base of the enormous needle of rock, your mind reels in confusion as you see the huge projection of rock now standing above you like a mountain, yet the buildings now appear to be on their sides...

You shake your head and try to refocus, but it takes some time. Up ahead you can see the pale forms of vampires milling about the base of the mountain. They turn to acknowledge you.

If you have a **spectral veil**, turn to **330**. Otherwise, turn to **256**.

733

To find out how well your investments have done, roll two dice. Add 1 to the dice roll if you are an initiate of the Three Fortunes. Also add 2 if you have the

codeword *Hunter*, add 2 if you have the codeword *Jacinth*, and add 3 if you have the codeword *Eldritch*.

Score 2-4	Lose entire sum invested
Score 5-6	Loss of 50%
Score 7-8	Loss of 10%
Score 9-10	Investment remains unchanged
Score 11-12	Profit of 10%
Score 13-14	Profit of 50%
Score 15-16	Double initial investment
Score 17+	Triple initial investment

Now turn to **751**, where you can withdraw the sum written in the box there after adjusting it according to the result rolled.

734

You make a donation of 15 Shards for the upkeep of the temple. You spend some time with your fellow monks and feel refreshed and ready to experience new wonders of the world. Restore 1 – 6 Stamina if injured (the roll of one die). You may also make a SANCTITY roll at a Difficulty of 17. If you succeed, write 'Luck' in the Blessings box on your Adventure Sheet. The Sage of Peace can be called on to help his followers at any time. The blessing can be used once to allow you to reroll any dice result, after which you must cross it off your Adventure Sheet. Remember that you can have only one Luck blessing at a time, and once it is used you will have to get a new one.

Turn back to **380**.

735

There are numerous taverns available in the wealthy district predominantly frequented by merchants and adventurers. You are recommended to steer clear of inns in the poorer quarters as whilst they are cheaper, you have a high chance of being robbed, or worse...

Decide how long you will stay here and pay 2 Shards per day. For each day you spend here you can restore one lost Stamina point. Turn back to **50** when ready.

736

Men and goods are washed overboard by huge waves that snap your hawsers like twine. Lose 1 Cargo Unit (if you have any cargo) and reduce your crew quality by one step – i.e. an excellent crew becomes good, a good crew becomes average, and an average crew becomes poor. (A poor crew can't get any worse!) At last the storm blows itself out. Turn to **125**.

737

Becoming an initiate of Tynnai gives you the benefit of receiving blessings that will help you channel the fury of battle. To qualify as an initiate you must have a COMBAT score of at least 7. Unlike other temples, there is no entry fee. You cannot become an initiate of Tynnai if you are already an initiate of another temple. If you choose to become an initiate (and meet the qualification) write Tynnai in the God box on your Adventure Sheet.

Once you have finished here, turn to **708**.

738

Lose the codewords *Eldritch*, *Intrinsic* and *Jacinth* if you have them.

You can invest money in multiples of 100 Shards. The guild will buy and sell commodities on your behalf using this money until you return to collect it. ‘Be advised that investments can go down in value as well as up,’ one of the guild traders reminds you.

Write the sum you are investing in the box here – or withdraw a sum invested previously. Once you’re done, turn to **501**.

Money invested

739

A noble tells you that the rumoured existence of a saint at its peak draws huge crowds of followers from all over the *Fabled Lands*. ‘They say he can forgive your sins and grant you a new life. Those who have been touched by him return changed.’

‘Vulture peak?’ asks a merchant as he overhears your conversation. ‘Why would you want to go there? Its only for religious zealots and useless peasants who choose to beg from a god than us... well, maybe that is a good thing. The less beggars we have the better,’ he mumbles walking off.

Turn to **356**.

740

The harbour of Iambus consists of a long jetty built along a ley line that guides ships from Iambus to the mortal realm and back safely. Dozens of Iambic pentameters, the archaic quinquereme favoured by vampire sailors, are line up along the harbour. If you have a ship here, you could set sail. If you have a mortal crew it would be foolish to attempt to trade with the vampires, as they will likely

smell their fresh blood and devour them. However, if you have the codeword *Lucid*, you have the option to trade freely.

Visit the warehouses (only with <i>Lucid</i>)	turn to 429
Set sail up the waterfall to the land of mortals	turn to 755
Sail through the falls to the underworld	turn to 149
Return to the city centre	turn to 330

741

You backtrack through the corridors as fast as your muscles will push you, leaping obstacles and dashing across the lawns. Roll four dice and if you roll greater than your Rank, you are apprehended and the merciless merchant Harvin Vishuamitra sees to it that you are executed on the spot. Turn to **700**. If you roll equal to or less than your Rank, you manage to vault the wall with superhuman skill and flee into the night.

The tense experience may have improved your skills as a Rogue. Roll four dice and if they total higher than your Rank, gain 1 Rank.

Now turn to **600**.

742

You learn that a settlement has been build atop the shell of the Great Turtle. ‘They call it Carapace,’ says the nobleman. ‘A real haven for those long sea voyages. The citizens are extremely friendly but quite daft. They think they can make a paradise on earth, free from all the vices of man – crime, greed, oppression. Like that is ever possible,’ he scoffs.

He warns you to be aware of their strict quarantine procedures. They cannot afford to have disease ravage their secluded community and will turn you down if you are afflicted with even a common cold!

Turn to **356**.

743

Walls of black storm clouds tower on the horizon, threatening to swallow your ship. If you have a blessing of Safety from Storms, cross it off and turn to **425**. Otherwise turn to **722**.

744 □

Your daring may just have paid off! Roll two dice and if you score higher than your THIEVERY score, add 1 to it. Now, if you took the **casket of gems**, cross it off. It was placed there purposely to trick greedy robbers and they turn out to be nothing but worthless glass baubles. The **chest of Shards** contains 800 Shards, and can be crossed off with the money added directly to your cash.

The **pouch of onyx coins** contains 650 Mithrals, a strange currency that can also be added directly to your cash. If you took the **dancing scimitar**, tick the box above and turn to **537**. If it was already ticked, turn to **493** instead.

Now, you consider it wise to leave the area before they realise your crime. Turn to **50**.

745

He tells you there is one quest he never managed to accomplish before retirement – to seek out the port named Iambus. ‘It is an absolute mystery,’ he explains. ‘Few even know the name, let alone its location or what lies there. I am still filled with curiosity about this place, and if you were to find out more information, or perhaps even manage to go there, I would reward you well.’

If you accept the quest, note the codeword *Imp*. If you already have information about Iambus, or have even travelled there, turn to **269** immediately. Otherwise, turn to **600**.

746

Otherwise your crew holds on as you guide your ship along the ley line. It teeters on the edge of the world, sea foam buffeting your face, and then all of a sudden as if pulled by an otherworldly force, you are hauled back onto the Sea of Stilts. The crew works hard to take advantage of the prevailing winds and steer away from of the Edge of the World. Feeling both amazed and humbled by the experience you plot a course back to the world of men. Turn to **327**.

747

If you have the codeword *Jury*, inexplicably the abbot initiates you on the spot. Turn back to **723**. Otherwise, you will have to be instructed in the sacred doctrine. To comprehend this doctrine requires a SANCTITY roll at a Difficulty of 16. Success means you are made an initiate. The monks are open-minded and aren’t bothered if you were already an initiate of another god; you can be both. You can renounce initiate status of the Sage of Peace freely at any time.

If you attempt the SANCTITY roll and fail it, the doctrine is so confusing that you must lose 1 from your SANCTITY score.

Turn to **723**.

748

The sky turns black and spits lightning. Your crew grow fearful. ‘Lay her a-hold!’ cries the bosun in panic. ‘Bestir yourselves, lads, or we’re done for!’

If you have a blessing of Safety from Storms, cross it off and turn to **125**. Otherwise the storm hits with titanic fury, throwing vast fists of water up from the

sea to batter your ship’s frail timbers. Roll one die if your ship is a barque, two dice if it is a brigantine, or three dice if a galleon. Add 1 to the roll if you have an excellent crew; subtract 1 if you have a poor crew.

Score 0 – 4	Your ship sinks	turn to 447
Score 5 – 7	A few casualties	turn to 736
Score 8 – 19	you weather the storm	turn to 125

749

You have heard rumours that the Brotherhood of the Night have established a base of operations here in Kurani, capitalising on its rising crime rate and lax policing. It will not be easy to locate the brotherhood due to the naturally wary and secretive nature of the members.

If you have the title Nightstalker or the codeword *Indefinite*, you are able to track down their headquarters. Turn to **346**. Otherwise you will have to make a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 23. You can add 2 to your roll if you are a Rogue.

Successful CHARISMA roll	turn to 346
Failed CHARISMA roll	turn to 729

750

Prince Azim arranges lodging for you in a large mansion. You have servants to wait on you hand and foot, and a secure safety deposit box to store your goods. You can rest here for as long as you like and restore your Stamina to its unwounded score. Furthermore, the royal physician sees to it that you are cured of any poisons or diseases you may be suffering from.

Items in mansion

When you are ready to leave, turn to **600**.

751

Lose the codewords *Eldritch*, *Hunter* and *Jacinth* if you have them.

You can invest money in multiples of 100 Shards. The guild will buy and sell commodities on your behalf using this money until you return to collect it. ‘Be advised that investments can go down in value as well as up,’ one of the guild traders reminds you.

Write the sum you are investing in the box here – or withdraw a sum invested previously. Once you're done, turn to **516**.

Money invested

752

To renounce the worship of Tynnai, you must suffer the 'Wrathful Blow'. A priest will strike you once – it is better to be struck by a priest than by Tynnai himself! This old retired knight doesn't look like a pushover, and you are surprised that he doesn't even charge a fee to renounce Tynnai's worship...

If you are determined to renounce your initiate status, delete Tynnai from the God box on your Adventure Sheet. The man smashes you across the jaw, saying 'I'm doing you a favour – believe me!' Lose 1 unwounded Stamina point *permanently*. If you earlier arranged a resurrection with any branch of the temple of Tynnai, it is cancelled with no refund.

When you have finished, turn to **708**

753

'The forest north of Auriculum? Yes I know the one,' says the merchant nodding. 'Real bad for trade y'now. Poor Chrysopraians can't get no wood for themselves – gotta have it all imported. They say that forest is haunted, and anyone who ventures in is sure to return a gibbering mess. They can't even log the forest north of here what with the Rakshasas and all.'

Turn to **356**.

754

You scurry through the grounds, staying out of sight of the two night guards posted at the front of the building itself. The leader consults his schematics and directs you all through a low lying window into a basement. Once inside, you make your way through corridor after corridor adorned with expensive paintings and ceramics. You eventually reach what looks like the door to the merchant's walk-in safe, which is locked with a bizarre looking device that turns and clicks, opening only when the correct combination of numbers is entered in a tumbler. One to the rogues sets to work, dialing the device one click at a time with his ear pressed against the door. It looks like it may take some time. In the meantime you could:

Explore nearby corridors turn to **536**

Stay on the look out for guards turn to **727**

755

Sailing up the ley line back to the realm of mortals may not be as easy as sailing down. The principles go against all laws of nature, so you are required to make a MAGIC roll at a Difficulty of 22.

Successful MAGIC roll	turn to 746
Failed MAGIC roll	turn to 624

756

'Ah, a man after my own heart,' says the rogue interviewing you and you are escorted to meet the leader of the brotherhood. Gain the codeword *Indefinite* if you didn't already have it. You are allowed to sit in a room where a man sits at a low table, surveying schematics of some sort. You cannot tell his age or nationality as a veil of black silk hangs across his face from a plain looking black turban. He peers at the drawings through a slit in the veil revealing two piercing azure eyes.

'Welcome, new friend,' he says in a voice that is barely a whisper.

'Feel free to peruse our wares... this is why you have come, is it not?'

If you are a Rogue, and the box above is empty, put a tick in it and turn to **416**. If it was already ticked or you are not a Rogue, you can browse the items below. The Brotherhood is only interested in sales and will not purchase any items from you.

<i>Items for sale</i>	<i>To Buy</i>
Climbing gear	90 Shards
Witch's hand	400 Shards
Parrot fungus	150 Shards
Selenium ore	700 Shards
Mariner's ruttier	250 Shards
Faery mead	250 Shards
Uncanny salts	90 Shards
Verdigris key	1500 Shards
Green carpet	50 Shards
Jewelled turban	200 Shards
Courtier's mask	650 Shards
Demon's head	750 Shards

When you have finished, if you have the codeword *Indirect*, turn to **764** immediately. Otherwise, turn to **600**.

757

Lose the codewords *Eldritch*, *Hunter* and *Implicate* if you have them.

You can invest money in multiples of 100 Shards. The guild will buy and sell commodities on your behalf using this money until you return to collect it. ‘Be advised that investments can go down in value as well as up,’ one of the guild traders reminds you.

Write the sum you are investing in the box here – or withdraw a sum invested previously. Once you’re done, turn to **347**.

Money invested

758

The ship is swept far out to sea. Men and goods are washed overboard by huge waves that snap your hawsers like twine. Lose 1 Cargo Unit (if you have any cargo) and reduce your crew quality by one step – i.e. an excellent crew becomes good, a good crew becomes average, and an average crew becomes poor. (A poor crew can’t get any worse!) At last the storm blows itself out. Turn to **725**.

759

‘A real marvel,’ says the merchant you are conversing with. ‘A city of wizards and artificers – they created their own domain that can stride the Sea of Stilts. Some even say that’s how the sea got its name!’

You learn that the wizards have very little interest in the outside world, and trade with them is relatively limited. They do not produce anything for export, though they do make a large array of exotic magical items which they sell to the occasional adventurer that frequents their city.

‘They do have an interest in slaves though – and they pay good money for such cargo. I’d hate to imagine what happens to them though...’

Turn to **356**.

760

Storm clouds swell like black mushrooms above a churning sea. If you have a blessing of Safety from Storms, cross it off and turn to **175**. Otherwise turn to **722**.

761

The moment you place the ore in the basin, the lightning crackles around it and the ship lurches, throwing you to the deck. Cross the **selenium ore** off your Adventure Sheet. The other men all cower in the cabin or hold onto something to avoid falling

off. Instinctively you leap over to the wheel and grab hold of it with bone-white fingers. Your stomach jumps into your throat as the ship wobbles as it rises. Once you have control of the wheel, the ship stabilises and its ascent isn’t as disconcerting as it was at the beginning. Peering over the edge you can see the guards on the ground growing smaller and smaller, and eventually the mansion is a tiny spec on an island the size of your fist.

Note the ‘Windbrisk’ on your Ship’s Manifest. It is a galleon with no cargo, and the few technicians that cower in the cabin constitute a poor quality crew. Now turn to **681** in *The City in the Clouds*.

762

The deep sea god Heilmir busts forth in the form of a colossal shark. He stares at you with a huge beady eye and then dives back into the ocean, sending you beneath the waves as you are tossed about. When you surface, you witness an amazing sight – a ship has been drawn up from the depths. It floats unmanned, waiting for you to board. You climb up the rope ladder and stride the deck, which looks as if it has been covered with barnacles for decades. The deck is littered with the bodies of sailors, blue from the cold. As if their souls were forced back into their bodies all at once, they gasp, spluttering up sea water.

‘I thought we were gonners,’ says the bosun in a croaky voice. The crew’s skin slowly returns to its normal colour and they tell you stories of how they dreamed of being trussed up in a net in the deepest ocean. Bizarrely, they all seem to have had the same dream...

They proclaim you their captain and ask for a heading. ‘Somewhere dry please, cap’n,’ requests the bosun. Name your new ship and add it to your Ship’s Manifest. It is a brigantine with an average crew.

Now roll two dice to see where you are.

Score 2 – 3 turn to **350**

Score 4 – 5 turn to **475**

Score 6 turn to **375**

Score 7 turn to **275**

Score 8 turn to **525**

Score 9 – 10 turn to **175**

Score 11 – 12 turn to **650**

763

The treasury is well guarded, and getting in without being identified will not be easy. Make a THIEVERY roll at a Difficulty of 20.

Successful THIEVERY roll turn to **726**

Failed THIEVERY roll turn to **517**

764

As you turn to leave, you feel a sudden jolt of pain as an unknown assailant stabs you in the back. As you crumble to the floor and slowly drift out of consciousness, you hear a voice, muffled as if far off in the distance.

‘An eye for an eye, a life for a hand’

Turn to **700**.

765

At last the storm abates. The navigator has no idea of the ship’s current position. After makeshift repairs, you limp towards the coast to try to get your bearings. Roll one die.

Score 1 – 2 turn to **425**

Score 3 – 4 turn to **225**

Score 5 – 6 turn to **175**

766

If you have the codeword *Imp*, turn to **269** immediately. If you have the codeword *Ebony*, turn to **730** instead.

Otherwise, you find that prince Azimishtra has very little interest in the banal pastimes of royalty, like diplomacy, politics, trade and foreign intrigue. Being a retired adventurer he may be more interested in your daring exploits. If you have the codeword *Impress*, you are granted an audience immediately (treat it as an automatic success on the following CHARISMA roll). Otherwise you will have to make a CHARISMA roll at a Difficulty of 26, adding one to the roll for each Rank you have above 10th. If you fail, your reputation does not pique his interest and you will not be granted another attempt until you gain a Rank.

Successful CHARISMA roll turn to **452**

Failed CHARISMA roll turn to **600**

767

It is as though night has fallen suddenly in the middle of the day. Thunderheads hunch on the horizon like vast brooding crows. Lightning streaks yellow fire across the tortured sky and the storm hits with full force.

‘Doomsday!’ shrieks the bosun. ‘Repent or be damned!’

Rain rattles against the juddering canvas; waves lash the deck. Roll one die if your ship is a barque, two dice if it is a brigantine, or three dice if it is a galleon. Add 1 to the roll if you have an excellent quality crew; subtract 1 if you have a poor quality crew.

Score 0 – 4

Your ship sinks

turn to **447**

Score 5 – 7

A few casualties

turn to **758**

Score 8 – 19

you weather the storm

turn to **725**

768

The wizard kindly offers to teleport you to any city within the range of his spell for free, included as part of your resurrection arrangement. Looks like you really did get a good deal!

Aku

The Court of Hidden Faces **10**

Dweomer

Over the Blood-Dark Sea **100**

Mithdrak

turn to **50**

Pethumar

The Lone and Level Sands **85**

Teleos

Legions of the Labyrinth **299**

769

The trau squeals with glee and snatches the mead from you. They run off without another word. Cross the **faery mead** off your Adventure Sheet. As you are about to leave you notice that the trau you had bumped in to must have dropped something on the ground during the commotion. Add the **vulcanium ore** to your Adventure Sheet if you wish and turn back to **330**.

770

You explain your plan to propagate peace between the two countries by switching Singh’s declaration of war with Lady Nasitha’s message. You are proud of your accomplishment but the Prince does not approve.

‘I pay you to kill, not to think!’ he yells. ‘It looks like I will have to find someone more reliable to execute the will of the royal family. Now leave this palace before I consider killing you for what you know.’

Gain the codeword *Ingrate* and turn to **50**.